



Kellogg Consulting Club 2024 Casebook

Welcome to the Kellogg Consulting Club 2024 Casebook!

Building upon the foundation of the Kellogg Casebook archives, we made some major and minor changes to the Casebook this year. Key features of the Kellogg Consulting Club 2024 Casebook are below:

- Winning entries from the 2023 Case competition: Andrew's Simple Delights (authored by Steve Azzolino '24, a profitability case for a beloved local restaurant) followed by Pandora Coaching (authored by Jake Zellner '24, an Opportunity Assessment in a non-traditional industry) make their debut. We hope you enjoy their cases!
- Sample Frameworks: Examples of some of the more common frameworks you'll use while casing
- Case Math: Tips and tricks for improving accuracy and speed for the math portion

Please don't hesitate to contact us with any questions or suggestions that you may have regarding the Casebook.

A stylized, cursive signature in purple ink that reads "David King".

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Contents (3/4)

Detailed case contents

Case	Page	Case type	Industry	Format
Avalon	65	Opportunity Assessment	Energy, Utilities & Mining	
Busch's Barber Shop	75	Market entry	Hospitality & Leisure	
Bubbly LLC	86	Market entry	Retail & CPG	Interviewer-led
Chic Cosmetology	97	Market entry	Hospitality & Leisure	
Chicouver Cycle	106	Market entry	Transportation & Logistics	
Dark Sky	118	New product	Aerospace & Defense	
DigiBooks	129	Market entry	Retail & CPG	Interviewer-led
Evanston Eagles	139	Operations	Media & Entertainment	
Events.com	152	Profitability	Technology	
Garthwaite Healthcare	162	Profitability	Healthcare	Interviewer-led
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Lobster Woman UPDATED!	241	Financial Decisioning	Fisheries	
Maine Apples	254	New product	Agriculture & Food	
Money Bank Call Center	260	Cost reduction	Legal & Professional Services	
Montoya Soup	267	Cost reduction	Retail & CPG	

Contents (4/4)

Detailed case contents (continued)

Case	Page	Case type	Industry	Format
Mustard Clinic	279	Operations	Healthcare	Interviewer-led
Orrington Office Supplies	289	Operations	Engineering & Construction	
Plastic World	299	Mergers & Acquisitions	Private Equity	
Rotisserie Ranch	308	New product	Retail & CPG	Interviewer-led
Salty Sole Shoe	315	Profitability	Retail & CPG	
Sosland Sports	325	Market entry	Hospitality & Leisure	Interviewer-led
Swagger Llamas	333	Growth Strategy	Technology	
Tacotle	345	Profitability	Agriculture & Food	
Vitality Insurance	361	Profitability	Financial Services	
Wildcat Wings	371	Operations	Transportation & Logistics	
Wine & Co	381	Opportunity Assessment	Agriculture & Food	
Winter Olympics Bidding	391	Opportunity Assessment	Entertainment & Media	
Zephyr Beverages	399	Mergers & Acquisitions	Retail & CPG	
Zoo Co	406	Mergers & Acquisitions	Financial Services	
Andrew's Simple Delights NEW!	415	Profitability	Retail & CPG	
Pandora NEW!	427	Opportunity Assessment	Education Services	

How to use this book

Planning your case preparation (1/2)

Case curriculum

- The Case Curriculum provides a sample list of cases curated by the KCC Exec team to give candidates a wide range of 'classic' and 'unusual' cases from a variety of industries and Casebooks
- The curriculum is provided to support case selection for practice but is completely optional and in no way required
- The Curriculum features 25 cases, but this is by no means a minimum nor a maximum number of suggested cases
- Cases are of increasing difficulty (as determined subjectively by the KCC Exec team) so don't feel dejected if you feel as though you're not getting better at casing

		Case	Casebook
September / October	<u>Easy</u> Cases selected to build familiarity with the case interview process (primarily profitability and cost cutting)	DigiBooks	Kellogg 2024
		Dark Sky	Kellogg 2024
		Zephyr Beverages	Kellogg 2024
		Sosland Sports	Kellogg 2024
		Orange Yoga Studio	Fuqua 2014
November	<u>Moderate</u> Straightforward cases that challenge candidates' reliance on pre-canned case-frameworks	Maine Apples	Kellogg 2024
		Chic Cosmetology	Kellogg 2024
		Goodbye Horses	Fuqua 2016
		LifeRenew	Haas 2015
		California Parking Lot	Columbia 2017
Break	<u>Hard</u> Complex 'pressure' cases that challenge multiple skills and cannot be solved with traditional frameworks.	Tacotle	Kellogg 2024
		Orrington Office Supply	Kellogg 2024
		Mexico City Airport Taxi Services	Wharton 2009
		Garthwaite Healthcare	Kellogg 2024
Winter Break		Salty Sole	Kellogg 2024
		Mustard Clinic	Kellogg 2024
		Bubbly LLC	Kellogg 2024
		Coyotes	Fuqua 2014
		Kellogg Capital	Kellogg 2024
Early Jan	<u>Confidence Boosters</u> Cases selected to encourage custom framework creation. No major complexity ahead of impending interviews.	Swagger Llamas	Kellogg 2024
		Ski Resort	BCG
		Contact Lens Manufacturer	Darden 2011
		Supermarket Deli Turnaround	BCG
		Maldovian Coffins	McKinsey

Planning your case preparation (2/2)

Use of a single casebook alone is unlikely to prepare you adequately for success in the interview room. Suggested resources to supplement this casebook with include:



Other school casebooks

Most popular with Kellogg
Students: Fuqua 2014,
Sloan 2011, Wharton 2012



Firm representatives

For internship applicants,
cases with firm reps tend to
happen Dec onwards



Sponsored students

Firms make sponsored students
known at Presentations or on their
school recruiting webpages



Recorded case interview analysis

Ask your IPG leader for more
information on these (eg. Victor
Cheng LOMS)



Casing textbooks

'Case Interview Secrets' and
'Case in Point' help get started
with basic cases early on

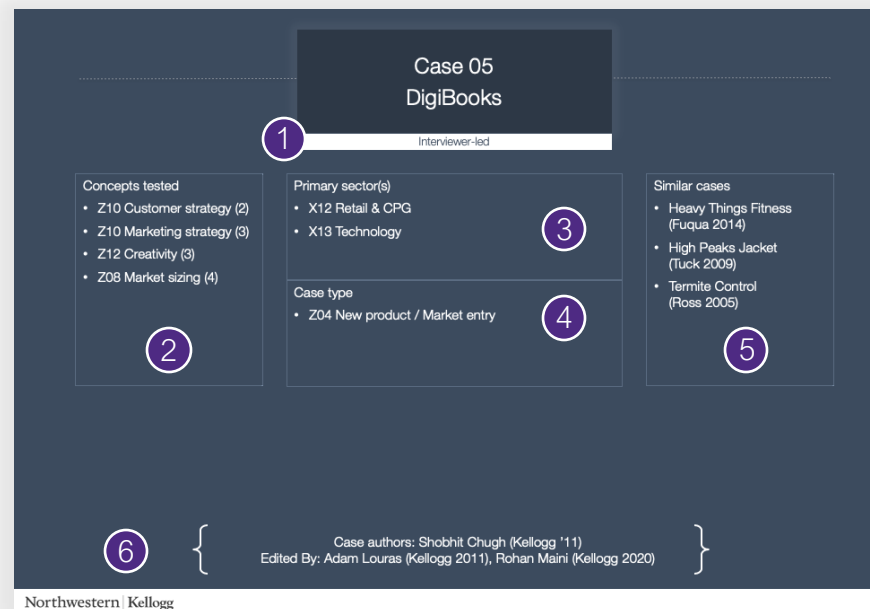


Reading cases

Useful way to quickly gain broad
case 'experience', but not a
substitute for actual casing!

Understanding individual case pages (1/4)

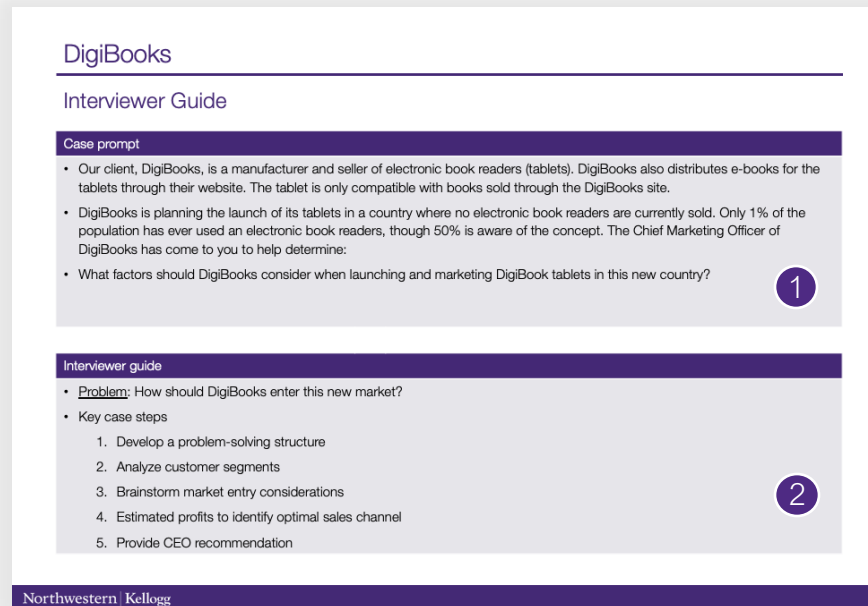
The Case title page contains details that help inform case selection



- | | |
|---------------------------------|---|
| 1 Format | Calls out interviews that follow the McKinsey-style, interviewer-led case format |
| 2 Concepts tested | Provides a reference to the main concepts that the case tests (see page 16 for more information) |
| 3 Primary sectors | Provides a reference to the primary sectors involved in the case (see page 14 for more information) |
| 4 Case type | Provides a reference to the predominant case type (see page 15 for more information) |
| 5 Similar cases | Provides examples of cases that test similar concepts as this case |
| 6 Additional information | Contains miscellaneous information about the case |

Understanding individual case pages (2/4)

The Interviewer guide provides interviewers with a summary of the case structure



1 Case prompt

This is the information that is provided up front to the interviewee; it introduces the key case context and headline problem that the interviewee is to answer in the course of the case

2 Interviewer guide

This section provides a 30-second summary on how the case can be solved. Numbered list not only provides an ideal list of steps to solve the case, but aligns exactly with subsequent areas of the case that may be covered during the course of the interview

Understanding individual case pages (3/4)

The Interview prompt page contains all pre-structure information

DigiBooks

1 Experience: Tell me about a time that you lead a team to meet an aggressive deadline.

Case prompt

- Our client, DigiBooks, is a manufacturer and seller of electronic book readers (tablets). DigiBooks also distributes e-books for the tablets through their website. The tablet is only compatible with books sold through the DigiBooks site.
- DigiBooks is planning the launch of its tablets in a country where no electronic book readers are currently sold. Only 1% of the population has ever used an electronic book readers though 50% is aware of the concept. The Chief Marketing Officer of DigiBooks has come to you to help determine:
- What factors should DigiBooks consider when launching and marketing DigiBook tablets in this new country?

2

Clarifying information

- Industry Definitions: Electronic book readers: Is a software, hardware and network platform that utilizes wireless connectivity to enable users to shop for, download, browse, and read e-books, newspapers, magazines, blogs, and other digital media.
- Client Characteristics: DigiBook's Tablet: Uses an e-ink electronic paper display that features 16 shades of grey. This allows for a 12 hour long battery life and easy readability.
- Locations: DigiBook has never sold a product outside of the US.
- Competitive Dynamics: No competitors in the e-book or tablet space plan to enter this country
- Market Characteristics: Total population of the country 76MM, high literacy level

3

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- | | |
|----------------------------------|--|
| 1 Fit/Experience question | New this year, fit questions (experience for Interviewer-led cases) are provided ahead of each case |
| 2 Case prompt | As summarized on the previous slide, this section introduces the key case context and headline problem |
| 3 Clarifying information | Provides additional pieces of information that should be provided to the interviewee if requested |

Understanding individual case pages (4/4)

Case solving pages are broken down into numbered parts

The screenshot shows a case page titled "DigiBooks". It is divided into three numbered sections:

- 1 Part 2**: A purple header bar with the text "2. Analyze customer segments".
- 2 Interviewer prompts**: A section titled "Provide Exhibit A" containing two bullet points:
 - Through research, we found several segments. We are only able to target one segment with our product.
 - Using a 3-year projection, which segment should DigiBook target?
- 3 Solution**: A section containing several bullet points:
 - If unclear, the interviewee should answer based on Revenue Potential (i.e. ignore probability of purchase) assuming all tablet sales happen immediately (ignore TVM).
 - The missing data is that the average price of an e-book is \$10, for each of the segments, and that e-books and tablets have the same margin
 - Using Exhibit A, interviewee should calculate:
 - SR Revenue = $[(15 \text{ books} \times \$10 \times 3 \text{ Years}) + (\$200 \times 1 \text{ tablet})] \times 8\text{M People} = \5.2B
 - OR Revenue = $[(10 \text{ books} \times \$10 \times 3 \text{ Years}) + (\$125 \times 1 \text{ tablet})] \times 20\text{M People} = \8.5B
 - RR Revenue = $[(5 \text{ books} \times \$10 \times 3 \text{ Years}) + (\$175 \times 1 \text{ tablet})] \times 10\text{M People} = \3.25B
 - Takeaway: Segment to be targeted = Occasional Readers (OR) with a Revenue Potential of \$8.5B

At the bottom, it says "Northwestern Kellogg" and "78".

1 Part number

Each part number aligns with the numbered list on the interviewer guide (see page 10 for more information)

2 Interviewer prompts

Above the dotted line, interviewer guidance (including instructions about when to provide the interviewee with Exhibits) and contextual / problem voiceover is provided.

3 Solution

Below the dotted line: full working, part solutions, takeaways and interviewee assessment criteria are provided.

Finding cases (1/4)

Introduction

- Consultancies hiring for generalists typically issue a wide range of cases from random industries, functions or problem areas.
- If you are interviewing with a boutique consultancy or specific practice area, you should expect to see a higher proportion of cases that are directly related to the type of work they do. For example...
 - ‘ZS Associates’ cases skew towards pharmaceutical industry clients
 - ‘BCG Digital Ventures’ cases typically involve a technology problem
- In the KCC Casebook, each ‘Case title page’ contains details that help inform case selection to aid easy searching for cases that test a certain industry sector, case type or concept. The casebook uses three character references to aid ‘Ctrl+F’ searching across ‘Case title pages’ (see page 9 for more information). A list of references is provided in the next three pages.

Finding cases (2/4)

Industry sectors

Industries	Description
X01 Aerospace & Defense	Production, sale, and service of commercial vehicles, military weapons and systems designed to operate on land, sea, and air. Also includes production of aircraft and space vehicles (usually satellites) for both military and commercial use.
X02 Agriculture & Food	Agriculture, husbandry or farming, is activity of cultivating plants, animals, and other life forms for food, fiber, and fuel.
X03 Energy, Utilities & Mining	Utilities provide basic amenities, such as water, sewage services, electricity and natural gas. Mining companies locate and extract metal and mineral reserves, then used in jewelry-making, industrial applications, and investments.
X04 Engineering & Construction	Construction of buildings, civil engineering projects, and other industrial plant construction. The industry includes highway, tunnel, bridge, and other civil engineering operations, as well as commercial, residential and industrial buildings.
X05 Entertainment & Media	Comprised of businesses that produce and distribute motion pictures, television programs and commercials, streaming content, music and audio recordings, broadcast, radio, book publishing, video games and supplementary services
X06 Financial Services	Financial services are provided by the finance industry, which encompasses a broad range of businesses that manage money, including banks, credit-card companies, insurers, accountancies, stock brokerages and investment funds.
X07 Government & Public sector	Includes public goods and governmental services such as law enforcement, public infrastructure, transit, and education,
X08 Healthcare	The healthcare sector consists of companies that provide medical services, manufacture medical equipment or drugs, provide medical insurance, or otherwise facilitate the provision of healthcare to patients
X09 Hospitality & Leisure	The leisure and hospitality industry sector includes a broad category of fields within the service industry such as lodging, food services, event planning, theme parks, transportation and other tourism oriented products and services.
X10 Legal & Professional Services	Professional services are occupations in the tertiary sector of the economy requiring special training in the arts or sciences. Some professional services require holding professional licenses such as architects or lawyers.
X11 Pharmaceuticals	The pharmaceutical industry discovers, develops, produces, and markets drugs for use as medications to be administered to patients, with the aim to cure them, vaccinate them, or alleviate the symptoms.
X12 Retail & CPG	Retailers sell products, mainly consumer packaged goods (CPG) to end users/consumers. CPG refers to a broad spectrum of manufacturers, sellers, and marketers of (typically packaged) physical goods.
X13 Technology	Businesses involved in manufacturing of electronics, creation of software, computers or products and services relating to IT. The technology sector offers a wide arrange of products and services for consumers and businesses.
X14 Telecommunications	Comprised of companies that make wireless or wired communication possible on a global scale, (eg. phone, internet)
X15 Transportation & Logistics	Transportation and logistics involves planning, implementing, and controlling movement and storage of goods.

Finding cases (3/4)

Case types

Case Type	Description
<u>Y01</u> Cost reduction	Identifying internal or external costs that are out of line
<u>Y02</u> Growth strategy	Identifying ways in which a firm can optimally grow
<u>Y03</u> Mergers & Acquisitions	Evaluating whether a firm should merge or purchase another company
<u>Y04</u> New product / Market entry	Analyzing a firm's opportunity to expand into a new product, business or segment
<u>Y05</u> Operations	Identifying problems in internal or customer-facing processes
<u>Y06</u> Opportunity assessment	Examining the potential purchase / sale of a new or existing business or installation / abandonment of infrastructure
<u>Y07</u> Profitability	Analyzing causes for recent drop in profits / ways to increase profits

Finding cases (4/4)

Business concepts

Business Concept		Description
Quantitative	Z01 Accounting	Tests some aspect of accounting. Typically, this will be a simple Income Statement, Balance Sheet or Statement of Cash flows. Most common concept tested is depreciation/amortization.
	Z02 Net Present Value	Tests ability to calculate the net present value of cash flows over time (or at a point in time). Usually in the context of investment, market entry or company acquisition case.
	Z03 Breakeven analysis	Generally used in market entry cases, break-even analysis tends to test ability to determine how many units (or what price) a product should sell in order to cover a fixed cost.
	Z04 Capacity	Tests understanding of production capacity, in particular long and short run considerations.
	Z05 Elasticity	Tests understanding of price elasticity of demand or supply, usually in the context of price changes' impact on quantity sold and by extension revenue.
	Z06 Macroeconomics	Tests understanding of macroeconomic variables trends than affect businesses including: inflation, foreign exchange rates, recessions, international trade.
	Z07 Market share	Tests understanding of the client and its competitors' market share. This may include understanding of typical features of concentrated and fragmented markets.
	Z08 Market sizing	Tests ability to develop a structured approach to sizing a market. Emphasis is on mathematical approach rather than accurate estimation of market size or dependent variables.
	Z09 Microeconomics	Tests understanding of microeconomics, for example the role of demand and supply in market pricing.
Qualitative	Z10 Customer marketing strategy	Tests understanding of marketing to customer segments. May involve analyzing their needs, WTP, buying decision, preferred distribution channel etc.
	Z11 Competitive analysis	Tests ability to analyze relevant aspects of the competition in relation to the client's business situation.
	Z12 Creativity	Tests ability to develop creative options, usually as part of a brainstorming exercise.
	Z13 Organizational changes	Tests ability to develop recommendations around the organizational structure, people and/or culture.
	Z14 Pricing strategy	Tests ability to develop options and methodologies to price a new product or reprice an existing one.
	Z15 Supply/value chain	Tests understanding of players and activities involved in sale of a product, from the delivery of source materials from suppliers to manufacturers, to delivery to the end user.
	Z16 Vertical integration	Tests ability to develop a practical solution involving vertical integration of the supply chain.

Getting the most out of a case (1/3)

Interviewee ■

Interviewer ■

Best practices before a case



Share focus areas

Inform your interviewer of any specific areas that you would like feedback on



Share your caselog

Share an up-to-date caselog with your interviewer so you don't accidentally repeat a case



Don't sneak a peek!

Replicate a real-life case interview experience by going in completely in the dark



Be ready

The Zoom basics – test your audio, video, internet, and log in a few minutes early



Brush up on the industry

Review unfamiliar industries with KCC's industry primers or online (eg. Vault.com)



Review the case

Familiarize yourself with the case ahead of time to avoid having to check guidance



Do the math beforehand

Gain practice with the math required and understand where common traps may lie



Prep exhibits

Ideally, share exhibits using a dedicated window (PDF/Browser)

Best practices during a case



Take it seriously

You might be interviewing with a friend, but a formal atmosphere will be more valuable and provide a realistic interview experience



Keep quiet!

While silence may be uncomfortable, resist the urge to jump in with pointers, hints, or additional information



Ask fit questions

Almost all interviews start with fit or Experience questions, so the KCC now provides such a suggested question before each case prompt

Best practices after a case



Provide high-level performance assessment

Be honest with the interviewee about their performance. If it was a good case, tell them. If it was poor, it's even more important to tell them!



Provide detailed feedback

After providing a high-level performance assessment, explain why by running the interviewee through each part of their case



Give feedback!

A case is a two-sided conversation. Tell the interviewer how they could do anything differently in terms of case or performance assessment delivery

Virtual Interview best practices



- Follow recommended dress attire
- Check lighting in the room, and set neutral or virtual background
- Join the meeting ~10 minutes before the start time
- Use earphones for audio and test the mic and speakers before hand
- Ensure that your profile shows your first and last name



- Avoid reading from a screen or notes
- Make eye contact with either the camera (preferred) or the screen
- Be clear and concise in your messaging
- It is ok to ask clarifying questions if you didn't hear something clearly over video call
- Bring your best energy and smile



- Don't panic if you lose connection. Reach out to the interviewer/recruiter to re-establish connection
- Be calm! Companies understand that tech issues can happen, hence interruptions will not impact your interview
- Interviewer would appreciate your composure as consultants often face tech issues while working with clients
- If you have computer issues, consider borrowing laptop from your friend to join back the meeting

Sample Fit Questions

Professional Questions

- Tell me about yourself / Walk me through your resume
- Why Kellogg?
- Why consulting?
- Why firm XYZ?
- Why city XYZ as your home office?
- What do you like to do for fun?
- Why should we hire you?
- What are your strengths?
- What are your weaknesses / areas of improvement?
- What are your short term and long-term goals?
- Do you see yourself doing consulting for long term or just for few years?
- What is one thing that you want me to remember about you?
- What is your leadership style?
- What motivates you?
- What constitutes a successful internship for you?

Behavioral Questions

- Tell me about a time when you had to solve a tough problem.
- Tell me about a time when you resolved a conflict.
- Can you tell me about a time when you went above and beyond / showed initiative?
- Tell me about a time when you influenced senior leadership.
- Tell me about a time when you made a decision under pressure with limited information.
- Tell me about a time when you failed and what did you learn from that situation?
- Tell me about a time when you persuaded a group.
- Tell me about a time when you have used analysis to guide your decision-making process.
- Tell me about a time when you had a disagreement with your boss/team and how you handled it.
- Tell me about a time when you had to deal with a difficult teammate.
- Tell me about a time when you had to deal with an ambiguous situation
- Tell me about a time when you set your goals too high or too low.
- Tell me about a time when you worked with people who approached things differently than you.

Evaluating case performance (1/2)

Evaluation criteria

Case skills and driving the case		Grade
Problem definition	Clearly understands and defines the problem/ question; summarizes the essence of the issue	
Problem breakdown	Breaks problem into most important components	
Structure	Uses a structured and thoughtful approach to solve the problem (e.g. draw issue tree with critical pieces of analysis)	
Prioritization	Identifies critical path to the recommendation and most important issues/components	
Information	Identifies and addresses key pieces of information and assumptions needed to solve the problem	
Solution oriented	Formulates hypothesis when needed and maintains focus on the recommendation	
80-20 approach	Deep dives into identified critical issues to develop a recommendation (80% of solution with 20% of analysis)	
Recommendation	Ends up with a pragmatic/ realistic solution that answers the initial question; supported with the analysis	

Communication skills		Grade
Structure	Shares thinking process throughout the case and aligns his communications with the structure of the case	
Focus	Highlights key insights, important findings and critical issues	
Questions	Ask clear questions related to the case process and solution	
Engagement	Engages with the interviewer during the solution of the case	
Support	Clearly supports any conclusion or important claim with relevant arguments	
Business language	Feels comfortable discussing the case with business terminology	
Body language	Communicates naturally and uses body language to support the communication process	

Evaluating case performance (2/2)

Evaluation criteria (continued)

Polish and interpersonal skills		Grade
Self confidence	Shows confidence when solving and attacking the case without sounding arrogant	
Quantitative skills	Feels comfortable handling complex calculations and analytics; shows clear calculations and data framing	
Analysis	Deep dives in identified critical issues or components and comes up with a solution for each issue	
Interpersonal skills	Drive a conversation and acts naturally	
Balance	Good balance of quantitative and qualitative analysis during the solution	

Business sense and high level thinking		Grade
Creativity	Identifies or uses different approaches to solve the problem. Out of the box thinking; uses creative methods and arrives at creative solutions	
Synthesis	Summarizes key findings through the solution of the case and translates them into insights or important take-aways	
Concepts	Clearly understands and uses the key business concepts to solve the case	
“So what” thinking	Clearly addresses and articulates what each analysis, conclusion or recommendation means to the case, solution or the client	
Testing	Frequently tests assumptions and conclusions with reality checks or other quick analysis	
Assessment	Assesses risks and consequences for the recommendations; identifies key next steps to further prove the solution	
Business sense	Uses common sense and realistic thinking to get to pragmatic recommendations; has the ability to think from different perspectives (e.g. client, competitor, consumer, etc.)	

Case Feedback Form

After every practice case with a Kellogg student, the interviewer is expected to use the **KCC Casing Feedback Form** to provide detailed feedback to the candidate on the following case components:

- Case Starts
- Chart
- Math
- Brainstorming
- Recommendation

Once the form is submitted, the system will send the feedback responses to both the interviewee and the interviewer.

It is a good practice that interviewees keep a record of all their feedback forms and review them as they continue casing.

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KCC Casing Feedback Form

Section 2 of 6: Case Starts

Sections:

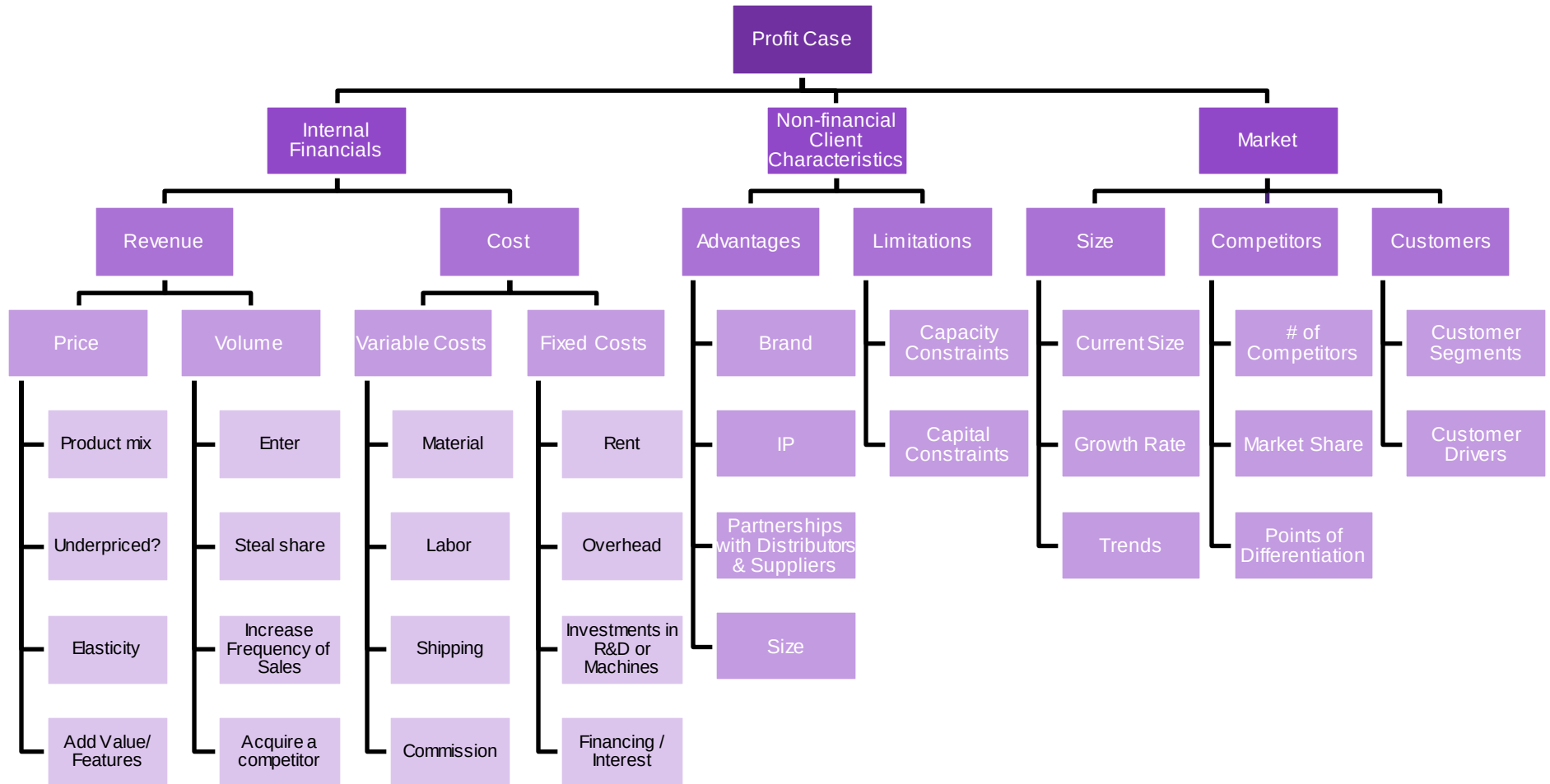
- 1 - Introduction
- 2 - Case Starts
- 3 - Chart
- 4 - Math
- 5 - Brainstorming
- 6 - Recommendation

What did you think of the candidate's framework?

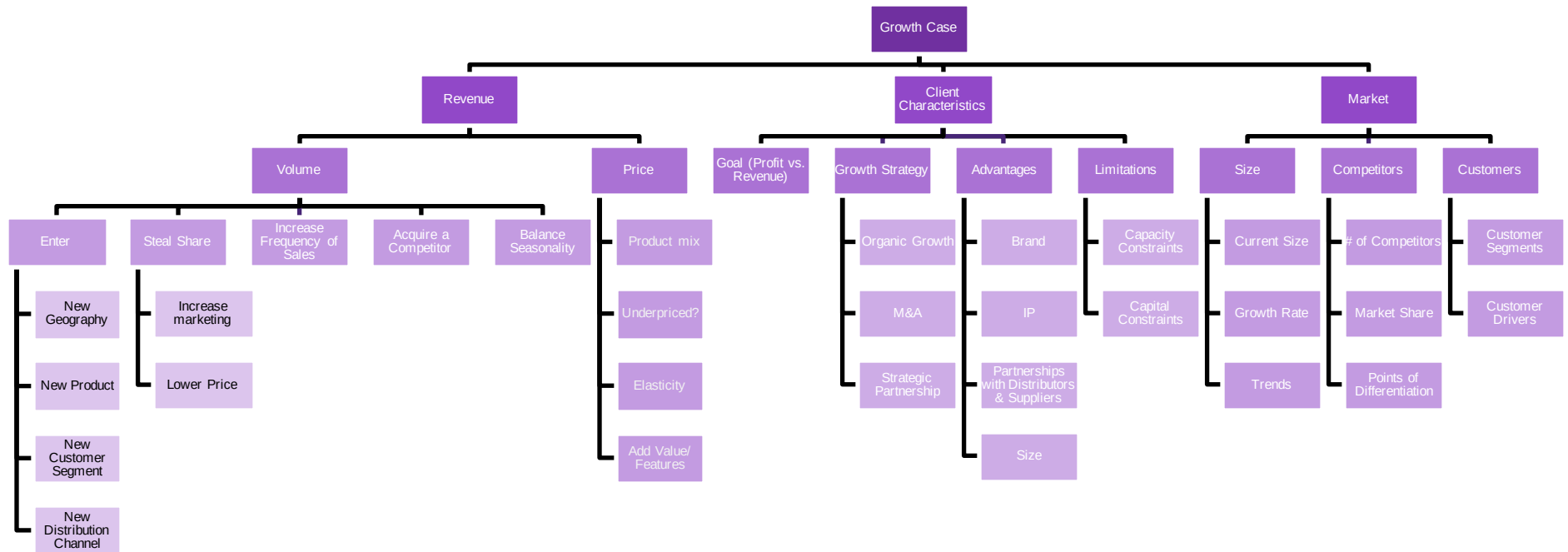
	Not quite	Good	Excellent
MECE	☐	☐	☐
Tailored	☐	☐	☐
Top-down voiceover	☐	☐	☐
Appropriately prioritized	☐	☐	☐
Hypothesis driven / answer first	☐	☐	☐

Sample Frameworks

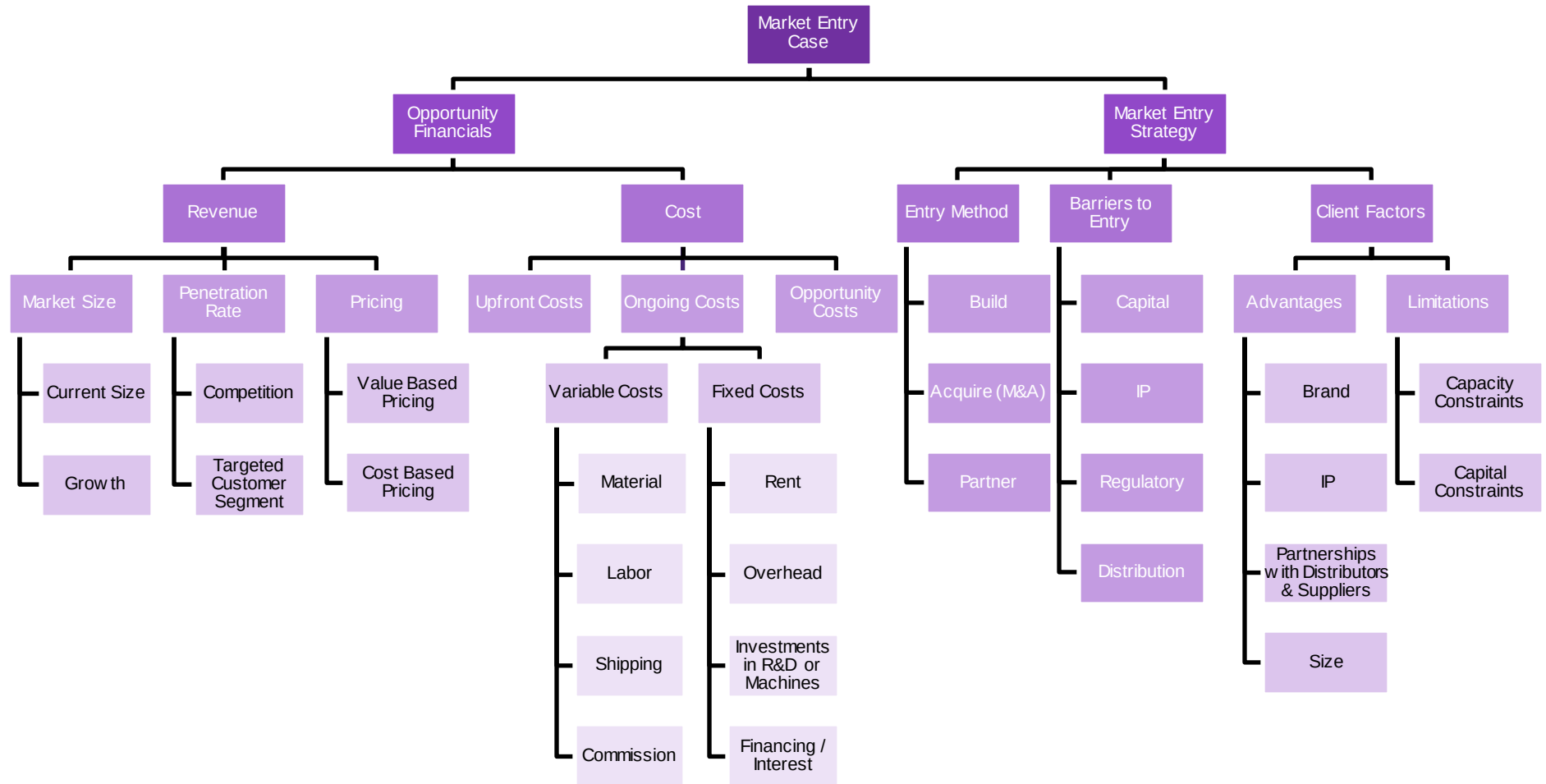
Sample Framework: Profitability



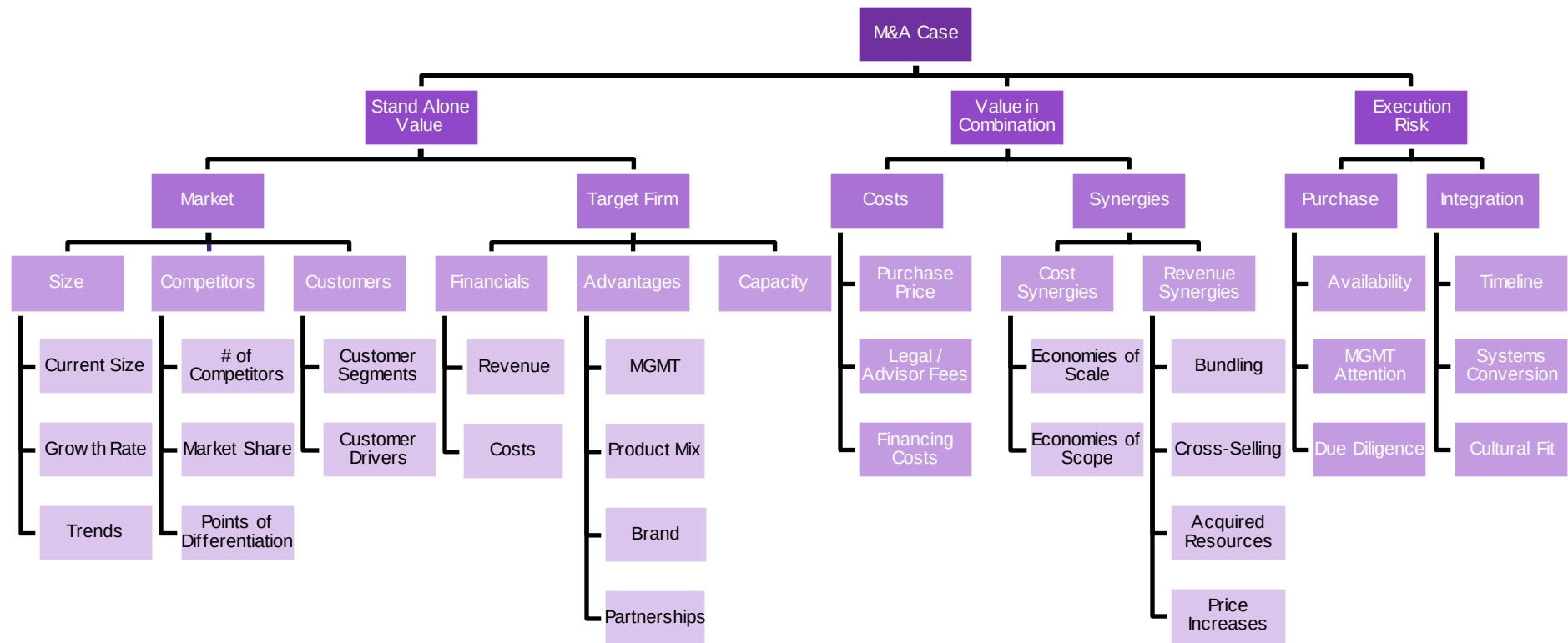
Sample Framework: Growth



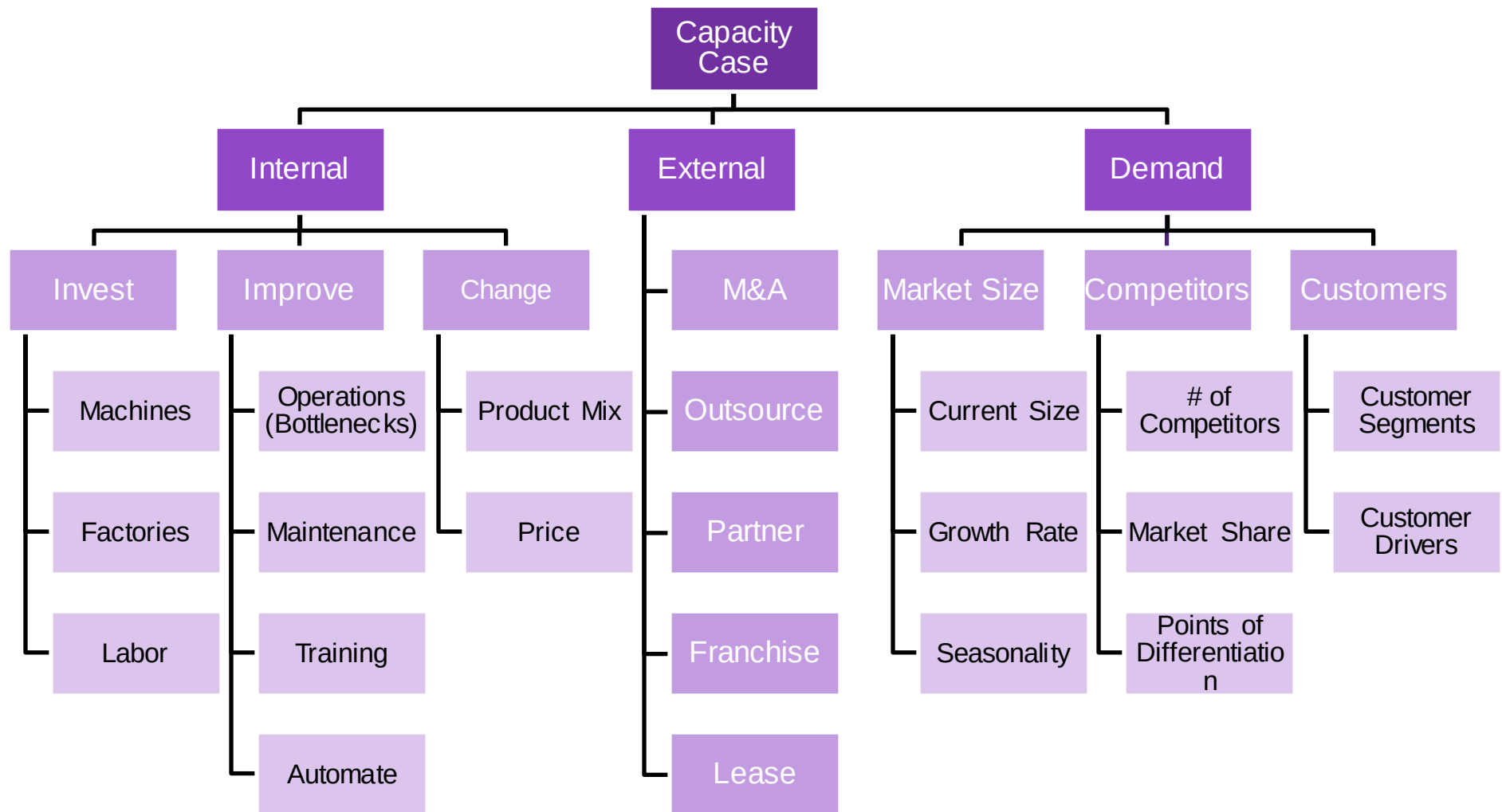
Sample Framework: Market Entry



Sample Framework: M&A

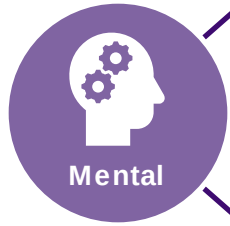


Sample Framework: Capacity



Case Math

Case Math Tips



- Know why you're doing the math
- Write your equation in words first
- Use smart estimations



- Format your math page like an Excel table
- Have separate scratch paper
- Manage your 0s in a consistent way
- Box your answers



- Engage your interviewer throughout
- Remain calm and confident
- Don't be afraid to take a step back and acknowledge mistakes

Profitability

$$\text{Profit} = \text{Revenues} - \text{Cost}$$

$$\text{Profit} = (P * Q) - (Q * VC + FC)$$

$$\text{Profit margin} = \frac{\text{Revenue} - \text{Costs}}{\text{Revenue}}$$

Return on Investment

$$ROI = \frac{\text{Return} - \text{Investment}}{\text{Investment}}$$

Net Present Value

Present Value of a Cash Flow

$$PV = \frac{\text{Cash Flow at time } t}{(1 + \text{Discount Rate})^t}$$

Present Value of a Perpetual Cash Flow:

$$PV = \frac{\text{Cash Flow}}{\text{Discount Rate} - \text{Growth Rate}}$$

Breakeven

$$\text{Breakeven Price} = \frac{\text{Total Fixed} + \text{Investment Costs}}{\text{Qty}} + \text{Variable Costs}$$

Things you need to know

Factors

- $4 = 2 \times 2$
- $5 = \frac{10}{2}$
- $25 = \frac{100}{4}$
- $48 = 3 \times 16$
- $60 = 4 \times 15$
- $75 = 3 \times 25$
- $100 = 4 \times 25$

Decimals/percentages

- $\frac{1}{2} = .50$
- $\frac{1}{3} = .333$
- $\frac{1}{4} = .25$
- $\frac{1}{5} = .20$
- $\frac{1}{6} = .167$
- $\frac{1}{7} = .143$
- $\frac{1}{8} = .125$
- $\frac{1}{9} = .111$
- $\frac{1}{10} = .1$
- $\frac{1}{11} = .0909$
- $\frac{1}{12} = .0833$
- $\frac{1}{13} = .077$
- $\frac{1}{14} =$

Break Down numbers into easy factors

- $8 \times 35 = ?$
 - $4 \times 2 \times 35$
- $48 \times 25 = ?$
 - $48 \times \frac{100}{4} = 12 \times 100$
- $75 \times 24 = ?$
 - $= 100 \times \frac{3}{4} \times 24$
- What is 15% of \$248,000?

Order is important

- $125 \times 40 \times 900 = ?$
 - 36000×125
 - 5000×900
- $20 \times 15 \times 30 = ?$
 - 300×30

Double and halve

- $6 \times 35 = ?$
 - 3×70
- $6.5 \times 14 = ?$
 - $13 \cdot 7$

Industry Primers

Airlines



Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
- Airlines provide transport services for individuals and commercial freight - Airlines provide different tiers of services such as Business class, economy etc.	- Declining profit margins - Intra-regional growth domination - Smaller aircraft / Low-cost carriers growing fastest - Increased stock of fuel-efficient aircraft - Digital –get social ‘Meet & Seat’ - Historical trend towards consolidation - Emergence of no-frills long-haul	- Revenue: - Passenger / Cargo - Business / Economy class - Meals / Duty free - Internet / In-flight entertainment - Extra baggage - Seat charges - Costs: - Fuel - Takeoff / landing fees - Capital / operating leases for aircraft - Unionized workforces

“American and United have been using Big Data to predict which airports are likely to see the biggest growth. Austin is predicted to be a city to watch as tech firms leave San Francisco for the growing Texan tech hub.”

Alcoholic Beverages



Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
- Categories - Beer - Wine - Spirits (Liquor)	- Low calorie - Trend towards micro-breweries and crafts - Shift towards Seltzers - Consolidation in beer manufacturers - Premiumization - More drinking at home	- Revenue: - Restaurant Sales - International - Niche and premium products - New products / packaging - Costs: - Packaging - Raw materials - Shipping - Taxes & Regulation - Lobbying

“Craft spirits are the next big thing, and larger brands are starting to hop on the craft bandwagon as well.”

Automotive



VOLKSWAGEN

HYUNDAI



HONDA

FCA

Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
- Activities - Design - Production - Marketing - Sales (dealerships) - Servicing - Heavy capital investment required for product development - Parts market fragmented - Competitive	- Duties on imports - Driverless technology - Developing markets - Alternative fuel and hybrids - Car sharing - IoT connected cars - Car health monitoring / Big Data - Cross-over vehicles 3D printing	- Revenue: - Novel products - Engineering quality - Gas prices - Discounts/Rebates/Financing - Economy/employment - Costs: - Plants - Raw materials - Designers - Engineers - Distribution - Warranty / repairs

“Nissan-Renault alliance shows that synergies may not be realized because of culture clashes and integration difficulties across diverse product portfolio. Same for Daimler-Chrysler”

Banking and Financial Services

Goldman Sachs

BANK OF AMERICA



VISA

bitcoin

Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
- Types - Diversified FS firms - Consumer retail banking - Consumer loans and credit cards - Asset Management/Wealth Management - Cryptocurrency - Investment Banking	- Regulation following 2008 financial crisis - Consolidation of banks - End to proprietary trading (betting with own assets) - Dodd-Frank drove strict capitalization requirements - Challenger 'neo-banks' like Monzo - Cryptocurrencies like Bitcoin - Movement to online-only banking	- Revenue: - Retail: Investments / loans with deposits - IB: Fees for advisory work - CC: Fee per transaction paid by merchant - Crypto: Fees earned by miners - Asset: Fees on AUM and performance - Costs: - R&D - Employees - Systems - Security - Compliance

“FinTech operators from Monzo to Bitcoin seek to radically remodel consumer financial services. However, though massively beneficial to consumers, their benefits are all easily replicated.”

Computer Software



Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
• Development, maintenance and publication of software for business and consumers	• Freemium revenue models • Subscription models • Piracy an ongoing issue • Inorganic growth growing versus organic • Microsoft's reemergence as an innovative force • Two-speed software: Basic and Advanced	• Revenue: ○ Advertising ○ Subscription ○ Direct Sales • Costs: ○ Development costs ○ Engineering ○ Testing ○ Piracy and litigation

“The age of physical distribution is pretty much over. Piracy remains an issue”

Energy (Hydrocarbons)



ExxonMobil

PETROBRAS



Transocean



Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
- Upstream (E&P): - Exploration - Drilling/Well completion - Production - Midstream (links production and consumption): - Gathering - Field processing - Transportation (incl. Pipelines) - Storing - Downstream (refinement and sale of end-products): - Refining - Petrochemicals - Marketing - Distribution - OPEC	- Upstream - Post-BP regulation - Liability for spills \$1-4k per barrel - New drilling technology for previously uneconomic fields 45% cut in upstream capex is now reversing - Deferred maintenance to save costs - Supply-related challenges following ongoing decline in new discoveries - Midstream: - New oilfields have limited access to pipelines (rail growing importance) - Highly volatile market; susceptible to geopolitics	- Revenue: - Economic environment - OPEC prices - Rig count/utilization - Drilling revenue: per day, foot drilled, all-inclusive - Costs: - Upstream: E&P - Midstream: Transport, storage - Downstream: Refining, marketing - Lobbying

“The Trump administration is opening up lease sales for oil and gas drilling in 1.6m acres in the Arctic National Wildlife Refuge, where there is an estimated 12 billion barrels of crude”

Energy (Renewables)



Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
• Players: ◦ Equipment suppliers ◦ Renewable energy production ◦ Energy retailers • Sources ◦ Wind ◦ Wave ◦ Solar ◦ Hydro ◦ Biofuel ◦ Geothermal ◦ (Nuclear)	• Better technology to store energy (eg. Tesla Powerwall) • Improving generation efficiency (eg. solar) • Scarcity of raw materials • Increasing cost efficiency beyond hydrocarbons • Government targets for % energy from renewables • State subsidies	• Revenue: ◦ Government subsidies ◦ Fees from customers • Costs: ◦ High upfront capex ◦ Low ongoing ◦ Labor ◦ Maintenance costs ◦ Regulatory fees

“In many instances, renewable energy generation is more efficient than fossil fuels. We just need a better way to store.”

Healthcare Payers

UNITEDHEALTH GROUP®

Anthem.

aetna®

Humana.



Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
• Underwrite health insurance policies • Plan offerings ○ Fee-for-service ○ Health maintenance org ○ Preferred provider ○ High deductible ○ Pharmacy benefits	• Healthcare reform pressures payors' bottom lines: ○ Eliminates coverage caps ○ Increasing medical loss ratios ○ Control of rate hikes ○ Payors forced onto exchanges • Consolidation expected • Evolving customer expectations • Preventative model of care using IoT • Shift to value-based model of care • Advancements in technology • Regulatory uncertainties	• Revenue: ○ Government-paid ○ Employer-paid ○ Individual-paid • Costs: ○ COGS (medical goods and services) ○ Labor

“AI, IoT, Big Data can help drive medicine towards more preventative care which is cheaper for insurers.”

Hospital Facilities



Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
- Types - Acute care - Rehabilitation - Psychiatric - Nursing homes - Assisted-living facilities - Many hospitals are non-profit (some are US government owned)	- Shortage of qualified medical staff - US government accounts for 50% spend - Consolidation to reduce costs	- Revenue: - Inpatient admissions - Outpatient procedures - Reimbursement rates - Employer-based coverage tied to unemployment - Costs: - Labor - Bad debt - Tax / exemption

“Americans will no longer need to make 30 phone calls to figure out how much it will cost to deliver a baby or get an X- ray. A price list will be available online.”

Household Durables



Crate&Barrel



BOSCH



SONY

Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
• Durable goods with lifespan of 3 years+ • Types of products ○ Furniture ○ Appliances (white) ○ Electronics (brown)	• Moderate growth in developed markets • High growth in developing markets with growing middle class • Tied to economic and housing growth • Raw material prices increasing • Shift towards online purchasing • Sustainable and environmentally friendly products • Consumer IoT and brand loyalty	• Revenue: ○ Seasonal ○ Higher margin (due to long purchase cycle) ○ Planned obsolescence • Costs: ○ Large inventories ○ Capital intensive manufacturing ○ R&D ○ Compliance and regulation ○ Currency and tariffs ○ Supplier network ○ Distribution network

“CIoT products have a payback period that consumers are not yet aware of. For example, smart washing machines that start when energy prices are lowest, or smart home security that lowers your insurance premiums”

Industrial Machinery and Components



SIEMENS

Honeywell

Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
- Industry that provides goods to produce other goods - Sub-categories: - Electrical equipment - Industrial automation - Heavy machinery - Construction and engineering - Aerospace and defense	- Tighter consumer spending / stagnant growth - Trend towards concentration - Increasing emerging market demand - Local assembly simplifies shipping - Aftermarket service revenue - Omnichannel and digital sales - Pay-per-use revenue model (EaaS) - Plug-and-produce - Smart products, IoT, Big Data - Software/firmware revenue model	- Revenue: - New products - Quality/defects - After-sales service - Specialized components for specific customer segments - Costs: - R&D - Raw materials (metals to oil) - Shipping - Import duties

“GE spun off their ‘GE Digital’ business to position themselves to capture a larger share of the IoT space. IoT is expected to grow 4x to \$1 trillion.”

Household Non-Durables



Kimberly-Clark



COLGATE-PALMOLIVE

L'ORÉAL

Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
• Consumables / non-durables with lifespan of less than 3 years ○ Household – soap, detergent ○ Personal – skincare, haircare, cosmetics • Competition ○ Concentrated markets (big players and specialized local players) ○ Shelf-space / scale / promotions critical	• High growth in emerging, low in developed • High customer power (mass-market retailers) • Sustainability and environmentally friendly packaging matters • Private labels gaining share • Scarcity of raw materials • 1B new middle-class consumers • The rise of the digital consumer • The shift to value • Demographic shifts, including aging • Increasingly volatile input costs (natural-resource shortages and a few big suppliers)	• Revenue: ○ Volume of goods sold ○ Product portfolio mix ○ Premium pricing • Costs: ○ Capital intensive ○ Marketing ○ R&D ○ Raw materials ○ Compliance

“One billion new middle-class consumers in emerging markets...critical for all industries but especially FMCG / CPG”

Media and Entertainment



Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
• Create, license and distribute content ◦ TV & Film ◦ Radio ◦ Books ◦ News ◦ Video games • Conglomeration common	• Much dependent on economic growth • Some inelastic segments (cable, internet) • Movement to internet streaming: ◦ Piracy ◦ Big data and customization ◦ Expectation of free content ◦ Reduced costs ◦ Consumption on mobile (5G) ◦ Geographic convergence ◦ Targeted advertising ◦ 4K and AR	• Revenue: ◦ Subscription ◦ Pay-per-view ◦ Streaming royalties ◦ Product placement ◦ Infomercials • Costs: ◦ Creative talent ◦ Data centers ◦ Streaming facilities

“Over half of Netflix’s top 50 shows are licensed from NBCUniversal, WarnerMedia etc. who are planning their own streaming services.”

Medical Devices

Medtronic

 DePuy Synthes
PART OF THE JOHNSON-JOHNSON FAMILY OF COMPANIES

 FRESENIUS

Baxter

Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
- Healthcare products that achieve intended purpose not through chemical action or being metabolized - Examples - Surgical instruments - Electro-medical equipment - In-vitro diagnostic substances - Irradiation equipment - Dental equipment	- Aging population in the West - Growing use of western medicine in developing markets - Acquisition of technology is common, as organic, in-house R&D is lengthy, risky, and expensive - Proliferation of diabetes drugs (Ozempic, Wegovy, etc.) has decreased valuation of companies with cardiovascular portfolios - Devices are becoming increasingly tech-enabled and consumer-facing	- Revenue: - Device sales - Equipment maintenance (relevant for companies who sell capital equipment) - Royalties - Costs: - Manufacturing of products - R&D (10 years plus) - Sales & Marketing - Quality and Regulatory compliance

“3D printing provides flexibility to make changes quickly and easily during product development and refinements.”

Mining and Precious Metals

GLENCORE

RioTinto

 AngloAmerican

BHP

 VALE

Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
- Construction and operation of mines as well as building and operating production facilities - Commodity market - Types of firms (non-integrated) - Exploration: find areas to mine - Development: develop identified mines - Production: extract from mines - Output - Gold, silver, diamonds - Copper - Minerals	- Gold growth is inversely related to stock market - Most gold used for jewelry - Technology makes mining more efficient - High capital requirements - Supply impacted by regulation - Remember <u>scrap recovery</u>	- Revenue: - Output x Market Price - Costs: - Production (equipment, labor, etc.) - Location - Ore Quality - Mine Type (underground/open-pit)

“Advanced technology will become necessity for competitiveness. Digitalized mining, enabled by IoT applications shift competitive edge to developed markets because of availability of network connectivity, power & skilled labor.”

Non-alcoholic beverages



Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
- Highly concentrated: 90% with - Coca Cola - PepsiCo - Cadbury-Schweppes - Categories: - Carbonated soft-drinks - Juice drinks - Sports / Energy drinks - Bottled water - Usually not vertically integrated (bottlers)	- Soft-drinks flat or declining in developing countries but some growth in emerging - Fastest growing: sports, energy, water - Packaging preferences vary by market - Niche products: - Protein drinks - Packaged coffee	- Revenue: - Supermarkets - Restaurants - International - New, niche products - High-end premium labels to extract max customer benefit as profit - Costs: - Marketing - Advertising - Packaging - Taxes - Wages

“Is Coke getting boring? The Coca-Cola company seeks to reverse decline in developed markets with questionable new flavorings from peach to mango”

Online data services and storage



Google Drive



Dropbox



box



OneDrive



amazon drive

Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
• Virtual-environment services and products ○ Data search ○ Cloud data storage ○ Social networking ○ Big data analytics ○ Music / video streaming • Competition focused around ○ Innovation ○ Consumer / Business segments	• Freemium business models mainly used • SaaS growth • Privacy concerns (GDPR) • Cyber security concerns • Quantum computing is a massive carrot • Hybrid solutions (eg. Cloud-on-premise)	• Revenue: ○ Advertising ○ Subscriptions ○ Direct sales ○ Cost of mobile data • Costs: ○ Innovation ○ Engineers ○ IT infrastructure

“Google and Dropbox (and cryptocurrency miners) are heading to the Arctic circle to save on datacenter cooling costs”

Pharmaceuticals



Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
• Discovers, develops, produces, and markets drugs for use as medications for patients • Types of drugs ○ OTC ○ Prescription • Sales ○ Europe and NA make up 70% markets ○ High barriers to entry	• Ageing population in the West • Growing use of western medicine in developing markets • Big Pharma often purchase or partner with small companies with potential • Insurers often need to cover a drug for it to be commercially successful • Regulatory landscape uncertain • Consolidation of patient access • Patents last 20 years max, and drug prices sharply decrease when generics enter	• Revenue: ○ Insurers coverage and plan economics ○ OTC to combat generics when patents expire • Costs: ○ High upfront R&D (10 years plus); low variable costs ○ Sales & Marketing ○ Regulatory compliance ○ Licensing ○ Patent protections

“Fierce rivalry among hunters/drug companies to buy new medicines. Pfizer seeks smaller pharma companies’ specialty drugs to revive their overall portfolios”

Private Equity



Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
- Investment funds that buy and restructure private companies - Process: - Uses OPM (hedge funds, pension funds, university endowments, HNWI's) - Uses debt financing to purchase companies (also reduces tax burden) - Buys and restructures (often cost-cutting) - Targets: - Promising companies - Fixer-uppers - Sales - Insurers	- Record levels of 'dry-powder' (\$1T) - Cheap debt	- Revenue: - Fees on AUM - Performance fees - Costs: - Employee's salary - Research and due diligence fees

“The spread of digital technology across all industries has played to private equity’s strengths of identifying trends early and having the space to manage businesses through change, away from the glare of public markets.”

Restaurants



Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
- Types of restaurant: - QSR - Casual Dining - Full table service - Franchising model: - Franchiser licenses brand, know-how, procedures and IP - Franchisee pays fee	- Increasing food and energy prices hurting profit - Minimum wage and high rents for service people make hiring difficult - Growth overseas (growing middle classes) - Fast casual stealing share from QSR - Often hit first by poor economy - Changing customer preferences: - Healthy - Organic - Sustainable - Local - Vegan / Vegetarian	- Revenue: - Food and beverages - Catering - Merchandise - Licensing - Tips at counters and waiters - Costs: - Ingredients - Labor - Rent - Customer research

“Tipping options on touch-screen tills: a new way to raise high-margin revenue and pave the way for reduced labor in QSR and Casual Dining restaurants”

Retail



Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
• Second largest industry in the US • Sub-industries: ○ General merchandise ○ Apparel ○ Consumer electronics ○ Home improvement ○ Office supplies ○ Drugs ○ Automotive ○ Specialty ○ Food ○ Hypermarkets / Super-centers	• High-street dying and online growing • Intense price competition • Intense cost pressures • Growth of private-label • Niche specialty offerings • Tax avoidance • Targeted promotions through analytics • Brick and Mortar stores are focusing more on an immersive retail experience	• Revenue: ○ 80% revenue from top 20% • Costs: ○ Inventory management ○ Real estate ○ Minimum wage

“The number of shoppers visiting retailers on Boxing Day has fallen for the third year in a row as worries about the economy and the rise of internet shopping takes its toll on high streets.”

Semiconductors

SAMSUNG



Qualcomm

BROADCOM



TEXAS INSTRUMENTS

Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
- R&D, production and marketing of semi- conductors used in computers and digital devices - Memory - Microprocessors - CICs (commodity integrated circuit) - SOCs (system on a chip) 80%+ are in East Asia - Highly cyclical industry - Moore's law (semiconductor speeds double every 2 years)	- Movement away from vertical integration to outsourcing manufacturing - Fabless companies (design and sale only) means foundries gain supplier power from learning curve - Increasing demand from: - IoT - Autonomous vehicles 5G - AR/VR - Regular litigation from patent infringement	- Revenue: - New chip price can fall 50% in a year - Long lead time before R&D > revenue - Costs: - Cost-efficiency critical in industry - Moore's law expectation means R&D critical - Long lead time before R&D > revenue - Fabless

"The global quantum computing market will be worth \$1.9 billion in 2023, increasing to \$8.0 billion by 2027."
 "Qualcomm's patent gives it unimaginable supplier power versus Apple"

Telecommunications



verizon

T-Mobile

Sprint

COMCAST

Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
- Allow consumers to communicate with one- another through a complex network of phones, mobile phones, and computers. - Telephone - Fiber optics / Broadband Internet - Radio - Satellite - Cell phone networks (3G / 4G / LTE) - A commodity market	- Growth a by-product of serviced delivered over mobile networks - Cybersecurity 5G - Often bundle with similar products (media and entertainment) - Opportunities to segment through Net Neutrality	- Revenue: - Subscription fees - Bundling - Network capacity / signal sub-leasing - Replacement of wired broadband with wireless 5G - Costs: - High capital-intensity - Billing systems

“Many telcos around the world have already developed 5G architecture and initiating their field tests this year. 5G network- related expenditure might have to increase 60%, roughly doubling TCO through 2025.”

Utilities



nationalgrid



Overview	Trends	Framework Considerations
• Generate, manage and provide energy and resources to the general population. • Often state-owned, but move towards privatization • Supplier segments ○ Generators ○ Network operators ○ Traders ○ Providers / Retailers • Types of utility: ○ Water ○ Electricity ○ Gas	• Electricity demand growth (40% more needed by 2020) • Price-inelastic • Commodity business • Trends: ○ Regulation ○ Demand fluctuation ○ Price volatility ○ Competition ○ Smart-meters	• Revenue: ○ Mainly from billing and extras ○ Smart-meters reduces household consumption • Costs: ○ Hedges to mitigate volatility ○ Marketing ○ Billing systems

“Smart-meters allow for better understanding of usage and allows for provision of better rates along with Nest-like benefits. However, there are privacy, accuracy and price discrimination concerns”

2024 Cases

Case 01

Avalon

Concepts tested

- Z12 Creativity (1)

Primary sector(s)

- X03 Energy, Utilities & Mining

Case type

- Y06 Opportunity assessment

Similar cases

Case author(s): Pairoj Kiatpanya (Kellogg 2021)

Avalon

Interviewer guide

Case Question

- Our client is Avalon government, particularly the Avalon department of energy. Avalon is a small developing country. The department is responsible for all electricity production inside the country.
- The country is doing very well with GDP growth at 5% on average over the last decade. As economies grow, electricity demand increases. The energy department wants to ensure that the country has enough electricity supply to sustain the GDP growth by adding new power plants. There are many options to consider: solar, wind, coal, natural gas, nuclear and etc.
- The government wants to know which type of power plants they should build? And what are the factors they should consider?

Interviewer guide

- Your client is in a public sector. The case tests candidates ability to really think (as opposed to apply a framework and practice lots of cases) as they will typically not be as familiar with the topic. The objective of a government agency is clearly not just profit (but profit may be part it). The candidates are encourage to be creative. They should think about different stakeholders and impacts of the decisions on different fronts (cost, environment, local industry and etc.).
- The case is structure to be more of a interviewer-led case style.

Avalon

Fit: What is your greatest weakness? Tell me about a team experience when you were hampered by this weakness.

Case Question

- Our client is Avalon government, particularly the Avalon department of energy. Avalon is a small developing country. The department is responsible for all electricity production inside the country.
- The country is doing very well with GDP growth at 5% on average over the last decade. As economies grow, electricity demand increases. The energy department wants to ensure that the country has enough electricity supply to sustain the GDP growth by adding new power plants. There are many options to consider: solar, wind, coal, natural gas, nuclear and etc.
- The government wants to know which type of power plants they should build? And what are the factors they should consider?

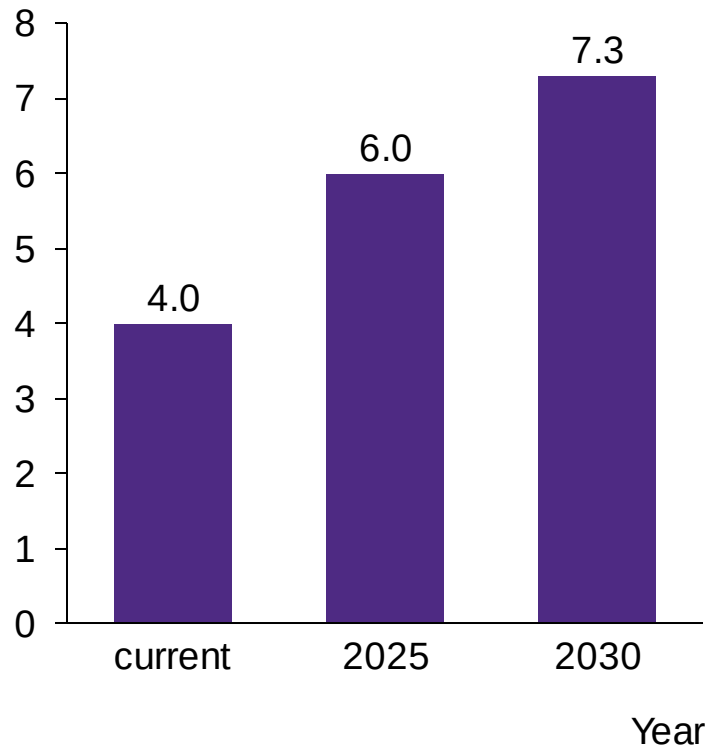
Clarifying information

- **Location/natural resources:** Avalon is a small island located in a tropical area of the Pacific ocean. It has no access to natural resources such as coals or natural gas. All these natural resources have to be imported. However, it has abundance of wind.
- **Electricity demand:** Electricity demand is projected to increase significantly as the economy grows and the country moves toward electricity vehicles in the near future.
- **GDP growth:** Most of the growth comes from foreign investments, as international companies outsource their manufacturing to a cheaper labor market. These companies not only care about having access to cheap electricity supply but also clean and sustain source to maintain their brand image.
- **Market:** The Avalon energy market is essentially a regulated market. A regulated market means that Avalon government sets all the electricity price. The government essentially monopolizes the energy market (like most developing countries do).
- **Objective:** The govt wants to make sure that its people have sufficient, clean, cheap and reliable (uninterrupted) energy supply.

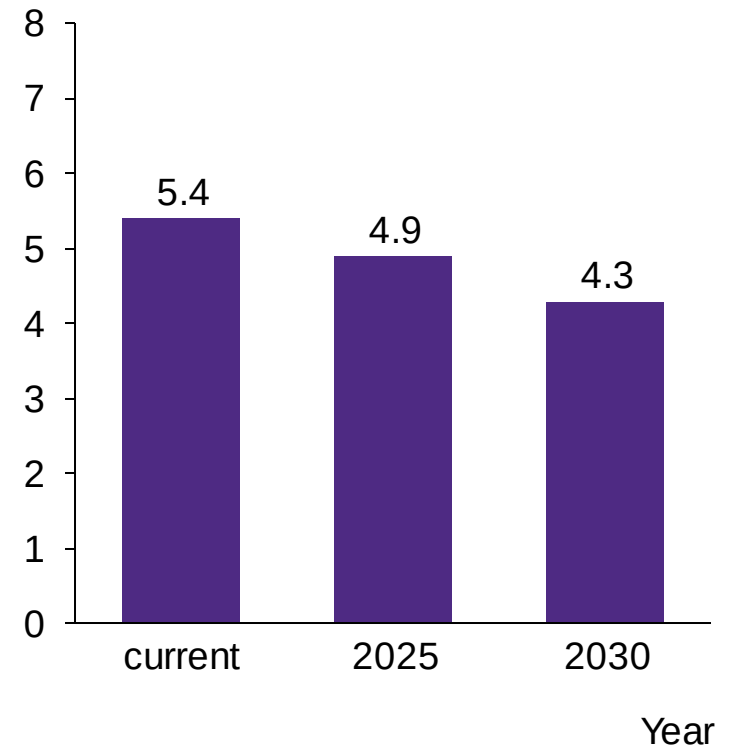
Avalon

Exhibit A – Electricity demand and supply projection

Projected demand (GW)



Projected supply capacity* (GW)



Note:

* Power supply is decreasing because old power plants will be retired.

1. Lead time for building a new power plant is two years.

2. Avalon government sets a minimum grid capacity of at least 20% above the projected demand to ensure a reliable supply of electricity.

Avalon

Exhibit B – Costs of wind, solar and natural gas

	Unit	Wind	Solar	Natural gas
Lifetime	Year	15	10	20
Load factor	%	50%	20%	80%
CAPEX	\$/kW	1000	900	1200
Fixed O&M costs	\$/kW-year	20	10	20
Variable O&M costs	\$/MWh	0	0	5*

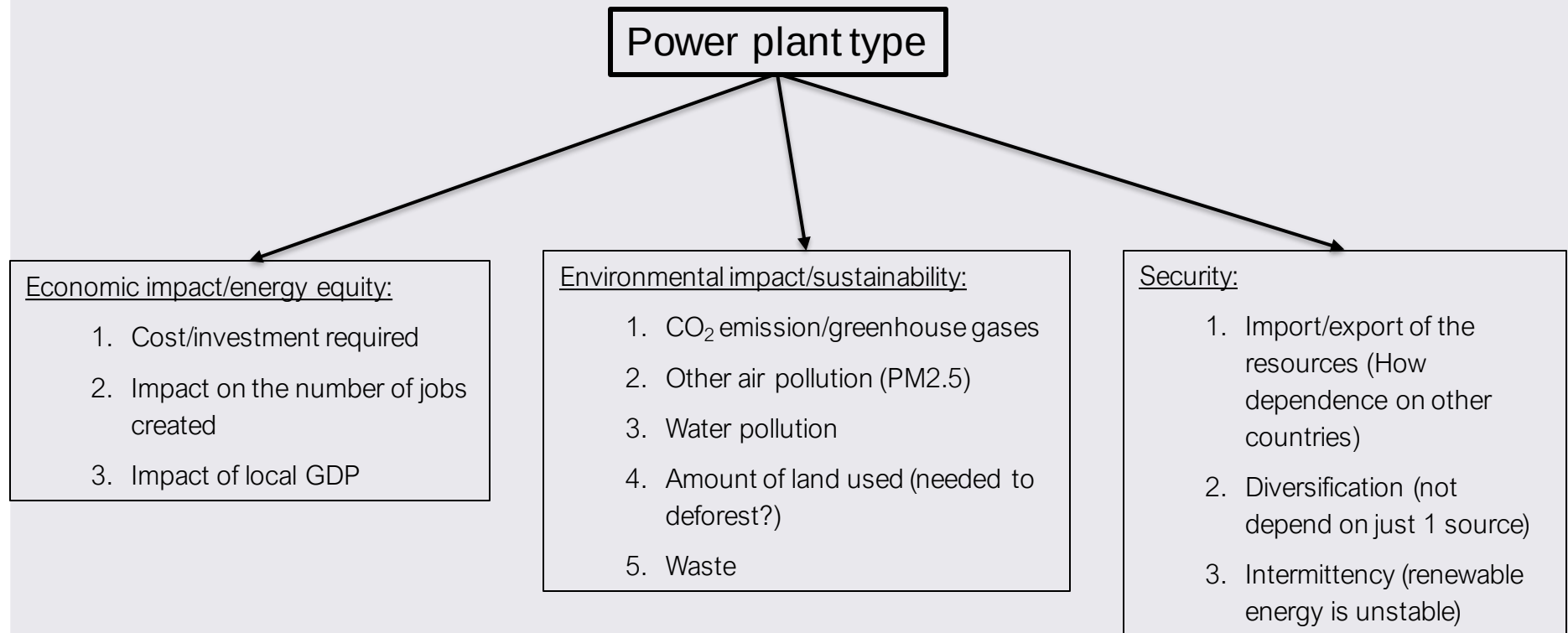
Note:

1. Load factor = running time/total time [Load factor for wind and solar farms depends on amount of wind sun available in that location]
 2. Output[kWh] = CAPEX x load factor
 3. 1 MWh = 1000 kWh
 4. There are 365 days in a year
- * Base on the project cost of natural gas in the market

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

The three main factors below are just an example and guideline.



Part 2

2. Calculate the required additional amount of electricity capacity

Provide Exhibit A

- The graphs show the projected electricity demand and supply based on the current energy plan and economic growth. They show that the country won't have enough electricity supply to meet with the projected demand. We want the candidates to calculate how much capacity is needed by 2025 and 2030.
- To calculate the required capacity, follow the steps below.
 - Since the government sets a buffer of at least 20% of the projected demand, the easiest way is to calculate how much total capacity is needed by multiplying demand by 1.2 (1+20%).
 - After we get the total required capacity, we can subtract the projected supply to find how much have to be added. Please note that the capacity adds in 2025 will still be available in 2030.
 - Finally, it takes two years to build any power plant. Hence, 2.3GW of power plant has to start building in 2023 and 2GW has to start building in 2028.

	2025	2030
Minimal required electricity capacity	$6 \times (1 + 20\%) = 7.2$	$7.3 \times (1 + 20\%) = 8.6$
Projected supply	4.9	4.3
Additional capacity needed	2.3 (7.2 – 4.9)	2 (2.3GW was already added in 2025) (8.6 - 4.3 + 2.3)

- Note: An extra point for candidates who point out that there is an inefficiency in 2020 (or inconsistent with the given information). The electricity demand in 2020 is 4 GW. The required electricity supply capacity is only 4.8 GW ($4 \times (1 + 20\%)$). Having 0.6 GW of supply capacity extra (5.4 - 4.8) is a waste of investment. The 0.6 GW capacity of power plants would never be used.

Part 3

3. Cost analysis calculation

Provide [Exhibit B](#)

- Suppose now that after the initial evaluation, Avalon government is considering three types of power plants: a wind farm, a solar farm and a natural gas power plant. How should the government decide among the three options?
-
- The idea is to compare costs of different technologies. The easiest way to do this is to convert everything to the same unit. We recommend to convert everything to \$/kWh but other units can be correct as well.
 - Steps:
 1. Find the running hours. This is the total time that the assets will be utilized in its lifetime: $24 \text{ hours} \times 365 \text{ days} \times \text{load factor} \times \text{lifetime}$
 2. Adding the Capex to the fixed O&M costs. However, the fixed O&M occurs every year so we have to multiply the O&M by the lifetime of the technology. The results will give you the total fixed cost.
 3. Dividing fixed cost (Capex + fixed O&M) by the running hours: $\frac{\text{Capex}}{\text{running hours}}$ [\$/kWh]. This will convert Capex from \$/kW to \$/kWh.
 4. Add the results from step 3 to the variable O&M costs.
 - Solutions are on the next page!

Part 3

3. Energy cost calculation

Provide [Exhibit B](#)

- Suppose now that after the initial evaluation, Avalon government is considering three types of power plants: a wind farm, a solar farm and a natural gas power plant. How should the government decide among the three options?
- The idea is to compare costs of different technologies. The easiest way to do this is to convert everything to the same unit. I recommend to convert everything to \$/kWh.

		Unit	Wind	Solar	Natural gas	Comments
1.	Running hours	hours	65,700 (~65,000)	17,520 (~17,500)	140,160 (~140,000)	24 hours x 365 days x load factor x lifetime
2.	Capex plus fixed O&M	\$/kWh	1300	1000	1600	(Fixed O&M x lifetime) + Capex
3.	Converting to \$/kWh	\$/kWh	0.019 (~0.02)	0.057	0.011	Capex plus fixed O&M / running hours
4.	Adding variable O&M	\$/kWh	0.019 (~0.02)	0.057	0.016	Step 3 + variable costs

- Note:
 - We encourage the candidate to round up the number to make the calculation easier.
 - We assume no cost of capital. A good candidate will ask about the cost of capital for in the Capex.
 - One insight we get from the calculation is that Natural gas is the cheapest.
 - One risk of investing in the natural gas is that the cost depends on the costs of natural gas (raw materials). Variable costs for natural gas is ~31% of the total costs.

Part 4

4. Provide client recommendation

- Based on the cost analysis alone, Avalon government should invest in the natural gas power plant. The demand projection is predicting a significant requirement for new electricity generation. However, more analysis on pollutions, impact on the local GDP, dependence on other countries and etc., have to be done. One possible recommendation is to invest in all three types of power plants to diversify the risks. Candidates must identify risks for whatever his/her recommendation is.
 - This includes but not exhausted:
 1. Risks of higher cost for natural gas.
 2. Risks of protests from environmentalists.
 3. Risks of having access to the raw materials (natural gas).
 4. Intermittency nature of the wind and solar (renewable energy) if the candidates recommend wind or solar.
 5. Etc.
-
- Excellent interviewees will create a creative structure to look at the problem as a whole. They will also identify that the government needs large capital investment. This is essential for a developing country, as the country may not have the necessary capital investment.
 - Another extra point for the candidates is if they identify or mention cost of capital for the cost analysis section.

Case 02

Busch's Barber Shop

Concepts tested

- Z08 Market sizing (2)
- Z12 Creativity (5)

Primary sector(s)

- X09 Hospitality & Leisure

Case type

- Y04 Market entry
- Y06 Opportunity assessment

Similar cases

- Snack Foods Acquisition (Columbia 2017)
- Surfboard Wax in Hawaii (Fuqua 2014)
- Chic Cosmetology (Kellogg 2021)

Case author(s): Michael Eidem (Kellogg 2020)
Edited by: Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020)



Busch's Barber Shop

Interviewer guide

Case Question

- Your friend, a current MBA student, has his heart set on starting a barbershop in Evanston after graduation.
- There are plenty of barbershops and salons near the Northwestern campus, but your eager friend argues they are either (A) vastly overpriced or (B) cheap, but really low quality.
- He wants your help coming up with a plan.

Interviewer guide

- Problem: Develop a market entry strategy for Busch's Barber Shop
- Key case steps:
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Confirm market attractiveness (size)
 3. Calculate revenue and costs for two potential locations
 4. Evaluate profitability of potential loyalty program
 5. Brainstorm other areas of consideration
 6. Provide client recommendation

Busch's Barber Shop

Fit: Tell me something about yourself that is not on your resume.

Case Question

- Your friend, a current MBA student, has his heart set on starting a barbershop in Evanston after graduation.
- There are plenty of barbershops and salons near the Northwestern campus, but your eager friend argues they are either (A) vastly overpriced or (B) cheap, but really low quality.
- He wants your help coming up with a plan.

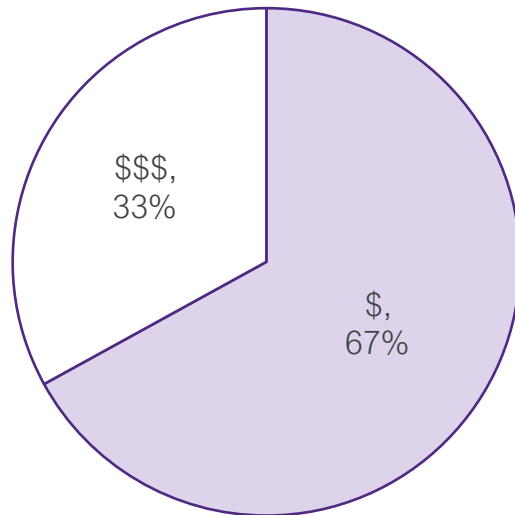
Clarifying information

- **Customers:** For this analysis, your friend wants to focus solely on a target market of the male population of Evanston.
- **Competitive dynamics:** Highly competitive, segmented into two distinct groups (high price & low price). Friend believes there is a profitable space in between these two segments.
- **Market:** Growing at GDP the past five years.
- **Your Friend:** No specific experience in the cosmetology area, has enough savings to fund initial upfront costs and early ongoing costs. Profitability is the main goal in the short term (wants to be profitable in year one to justify his decision not to take a high-paying consulting job).
- **Product:** Barbershop only intends to initially sell haircut service. Any other additional products or services can be considered in the future.

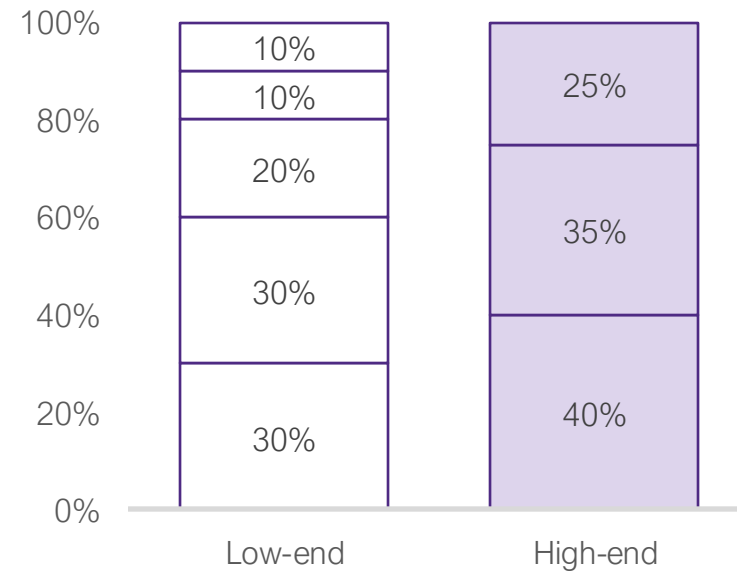
Busch's Barber Shop

Exhibit A – Market analysis

Where do men in Evanston get their haircut?



Competitors' market share



Notes:

- Men's haircut market split between two groups, high-end (avg price \$50) and low-end (avg price \$20).
- Evanston Adult Population: 60k (50% male)

Busch's Barber Shop

Exhibit B – Market Entry Projections

		Expected Customer Steal		Upfront Costs		Ongoing Costs	
Description		From Low-end	From High-end	Equip.	Advert.	Rent	Labor
Location #1	Downtown	10%	5%	\$30k	\$20k	\$4k	4 workers, \$15/hr
Location #2	Not Downtown	5%	5%	\$30k	\$25k	\$1k	2 workers, \$15/hr

Notes:

- Projections of customer steal based on consumer survey. Survey described new barbershop as in-between quality at price point of \$30.

Busch's Barber Shop

Part 1

1. Develop framework for how to approach this new venture

A sample case structure would include the following:

- **Client:** Specific goals, strengths, capabilities, resources
- **Market:** Size, growth, competition, customer segmentation
- **Profitability**
 - Expected customer volume, target customers
 - Price elasticity, pricing method (ex: loyalty), service mix
 - Costs: Fixed costs (rent, equipment, merchandise, advertising), variable costs (labor)
- **Go-to strategy:** Build, acquire, partner with additional co-owner
- **Barriers:** Capital, local regulations, attracting talent
- **Risks:** Competitive response, no differentiation, opportunity cost

Following discussion of framework, interviewee should be asked to briefly market size the adult men's haircut market in Evanston
(See next page)

Busch's Barber Shop

Parts 2-3

2. Confirm market attractiveness (size)

Interviewee should make educated guesses regarding:

- City population size (~60k)
- Male/female ratio (~50/50)
- What % of male population pays for haircuts (i.e. likely omitting young kids, those who cut their own hair, bald men)
- What % of men in Evanston get their haircut in Evanston vs downtown Chicago near their place of work.
- Average annual haircuts per person being considered
- Price segmentation (average price for cut, high end vs low end portions of the market and distribution between the two)
- End result should be a total annual dollar amount spent on haircuts by men in Evanston.

There is no correct answer to this exercise. A good interviewee will show creativity, structure, and intuition regarding making educated guesses. Push interviewee to move quickly since this is not the primary purpose of the overall case.

3. Calculate revenue and costs for two potential locations

Provide Exhibits A & B

Your friend thinks there is a profitable middle ground between the low cost/low quality cut and the high cost/high quality cut markets.

Additional information:

- An average male in Evanston pays for 10 haircuts per year
- Barbershop will be open 10 hours/day, 360 days/year
- Assume customers stay with the same barbershop once they make a decision (i.e. customers don't switch back and forth between shops).

Lead interviewee towards calculating 1st year profit in each location to determine optimal choice [see next page for solution].

Busch's Barber Shop

Part 3 (continued)

3. Calculate revenue and costs for two potential locations (Exhibit A & B)

Adult male population count in each segment:

Market	Adult Male Customers
Low-end	$= 60k * 50\% * 2/3 = 20k$
High-end	$= 60k * 50\% * 1/3 = 10k$

Projected revenue calculation of each location:

Location	Total Customers Stolen	Revenue
Downtown	$= 20k * 10\% + 10k * 5\% = 2.5k$	$= 2.5k * 10 \text{ cuts/yr} * \$30/\text{haircut} = \$750k$
Not Downtown	$= 20k * 5\% + 10k * 5\% = 1.5k$	$= 1.5k * 10 \text{ cuts/yr} * \$30/\text{haircut} = \$450k$

Cost calculations of each location:

Location	Upfront Costs	Rent	Labor	Total
Downtown	$= 30k + 20k = 50k$	$= 48k$	$= 4 * \$15/\text{hr} * 10\text{hr/day} * 360\text{days} = \$216k$	\$314k
Not Downtown	$= 30k + 25k = 55k$	$= 12k$	$= 2 * \$15/\text{hr} * 10\text{hr/day} * 360\text{days} = \$108k$	\$175k

First year profitability:

Location	Revenue	-	Total Cost	=	Profit
Downtown	$= \$750k$	-	\$314k	=	\$436k
Not Downtown	$= \$450k$	-	\$175k	=	\$275k

Takeaway: Downtown location has higher projected first year profits.

Optional brainstorming question: What other factors should be considered when choosing a potential shop location?

Potential answers: Long term plans, proximity to other stores, ease of transportation to location, visibility, layout of store, capacity constraint for future growth, preference of target demographic

Busch's Barber Shop

Part 4

4. Evaluate profitability of potential loyalty program

Your friend (after having chosen the downtown location) is considering implementing a loyalty reward system as part his marketing strategy. He's decided that such a system would reward customers by giving them their 10th haircut for free. He projects this will result in a 10% increase in total first year customers. Is this a profitable decision?

One method is to calculate the new annual customer count, determine expected annual revenue, and compare with previously calculated revenue. Costs assumed to remain constant since no marginal costs for additional haircuts (employees paid hourly, assume no additional employees required).

New expected annual customer count:

= (Previously calculated total customers) * 110% = $2500 * 1.1 = 2750$ customers

Expected revenue with loyalty program:

= (# of expected customers) * (average # haircuts paid for annually) * (price) = $2750 * (10 - 1) * \$30 = \$742.5k$

Takeaway: Revenue without loyalty program was \$750k. Since costs do not change, not profitable decision.

Additional insight: Revenue decline is minimal (~1%), are there potential advantages of increasing customer base by 10% that would still make implementing loyalty program attractive? (example: implement loyalty program for only the first year to build customer base, upsell products such as shampoo/additional services to this larger customer base, etc.)

Busch's Barber Shop

Part 5

5. Brainstorm other areas of consideration (optional)

Additional optional brainstorm questions:

1. What changes could be made to make this loyalty program profitable?
 - Decrease frequency of freebies, make reward 50% off instead of free cut, etc.
2. Instead of the loyalty program, your friend is considering introducing a membership-based pricing. In this system, a customer would pay a set price every month for unlimited haircuts. What are pros and cons of such a system, and if it was implemented, how would you think about setting the price?
 - Pros (more predictable revenue stream, potentially increased data on customers, differentiation)
 - Cons (adverse selection likely to occur with only customers who would overuse membership signing up, potentially unhappy employees if tips reduce based on different payment scheme)
3. One key to success will be finding quality employees without having to pay as high of a base wage as high end competition. What are some possible methods of attracting and retaining talent in this scenario?
 - Possible options: more flexible work schedule, end of year profit sharing to make employees feel invested in store's success, finding rising stars in the lower end market who haven't had the chance to move to the high-end yet, etc.

Busch's Barber Shop

Part 6

6. Provide client recommendation

Overall:

- Your friend should choose the downtown location for starting his new barbershop without the loyalty program.
- Projected first year profits of ~\$430k
- Implementing free 10th haircut results in decreased revenue at current growth expectations.

Risks:

- Numbers assume immediate customers acquisition: unrealistic without effective marketing campaign.
- Competitive response: high end stores may offer discounts or decrease price if they experience large loss of customers, although, projected market steal from this segment is only 5%, unlikely to cause drastic response.
- Customers might not find quality increase enough to justify increased price compared to other low-end options.
- Opportunity costs: what other business options could your friend be pursuing with his saved capital? Are there other locations better suited than Evanston? Would it be more efficient to buy a current existing shop instead of starting a new one?

Next steps:

- Perform due diligence on buying an existing shop.
- Perform more extensive customer surveys to confirm existing projections.
- Research how to hire qualified barbers to meet expectations of improved quality compared to low level shops.
- Sign lease, purchase equipment, bring on advisor (since friend has no previous experience), develop marketing strategy.
- Evaluate changes to proposed loyalty program to improve profitability.

Case 03

Bubbly LLC

Interviewer-led

Concepts tested

- Z04 Capacity (2)
- Z06 Macroeconomics (4)
- Z08 Market Sizing (3)
- Z12 Creativity (4)

Primary sector(s)

- X12 Retail & CPG

Case type

- Y04 New product / Market entry
- Y07 Profitability

Similar cases

- Personal Care Company (CBS 2017)
- DigiBooks (Kellogg 2021)
- RRH Industries (USC 2010)

Case authors: Eli Derrow (Kellogg 2021)
Edited By: Kathy Hoe (Kellogg 2021)



Bubbly LLC

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client, Bubbly LLC, is a company that specializes in low-cost hand soap products that are distributed only in the United States
- The company has one manufacturing facility in the U.S., and last year, 2014, it reached maximum capacity of 1M units
- Given the location of their raw materials, Bubbly recently acquired a production facility in Nigeria to double production capacity and reduce costs: products are 20% cheaper than U.S. production including shipping costs. The new plant, however, is not expected to be fully operational until 1 year from today.
- The CFO of the firm has come to us to ask:
 - What immediate steps can be taken to improve profitability as we wait for the second plant to become operational?
 - Given the new factory they will have in Nigeria, what factors should Bubbly consider when deciding if they should enter the West African market with their products?

Interviewer guide

- Problem: How can Bubbly LLC improve short and long-term profitability?
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Analyze the product mix
 3. Estimate profits to identify optimal product mix for new market
 4. Brainstorm market entry considerations
 5. Provide CEO recommendation

Bubbly LLC

Fit: Tell me about a time you changed how you went about an analysis due to new information.

Case prompt

- Our client, Bubbly LLC, is a company that specializes in low-cost hand soap products that are distributed only in the United States
- The company has one manufacturing facility in the U.S., and last year, 2014, it reached maximum capacity of 1M units
- Given the location of their raw materials, Bubbly recently acquired a production facility in Nigeria to double production capacity and reduce costs: products are 20% cheaper than U.S. production including shipping costs. The new plant, however, is not expected to be fully operational until 1 year from today.
- The CFO of the firm has come to us to ask:
 - What immediate steps can be taken to improve profitability as we wait for the second plant to become operational?
 - Given the new factory they will have in Nigeria, what factors should Bubbly consider when deciding if they should enter the West African market with their products?

Clarifying content

- **Products:** Bubbly LLC's products include bar soap, bottled soap (e.g. foam and liquid), and hand sanitizer.
- **Locations:** Bubbly currently only sells online direct-to-consumer within the United States. They are not considering retail locations.
- **Competitive Dynamics:** It is a competitive and fragmented industry in the U.S., suggesting Bubbly has little room to move on price.
- **Nigerian Market Entry Characteristics / Timing Considerations:** At the time of the case (2015), there was a significant outbreak of the Ebola Virus Disease in the region. The additional production facility can be used to either supply additional product to the U.S. market or to the local West Africa market. Further information on the market to be provided later in the case.
- **Timeline and Goal:** Immediate steps is defined as the next three months. Market entry should be profitable within one year. Entering the market will cost an additional \$500K.

Bubbly LLC

Exhibit A – Bubbly U.S. Product Mix Financials (2014)

Product	Price / Unit	Variable Cost/ Unit	Units Sold
Bar Soap	\$6.00	\$4.00	200,000
Bottled Soap	\$6.50	\$5.50	720,000
Hand Sanitizer	\$2.00	\$1.95	80,000

Bubbly LLC

Exhibit B – Bubbly U.S. Product Mix Trends

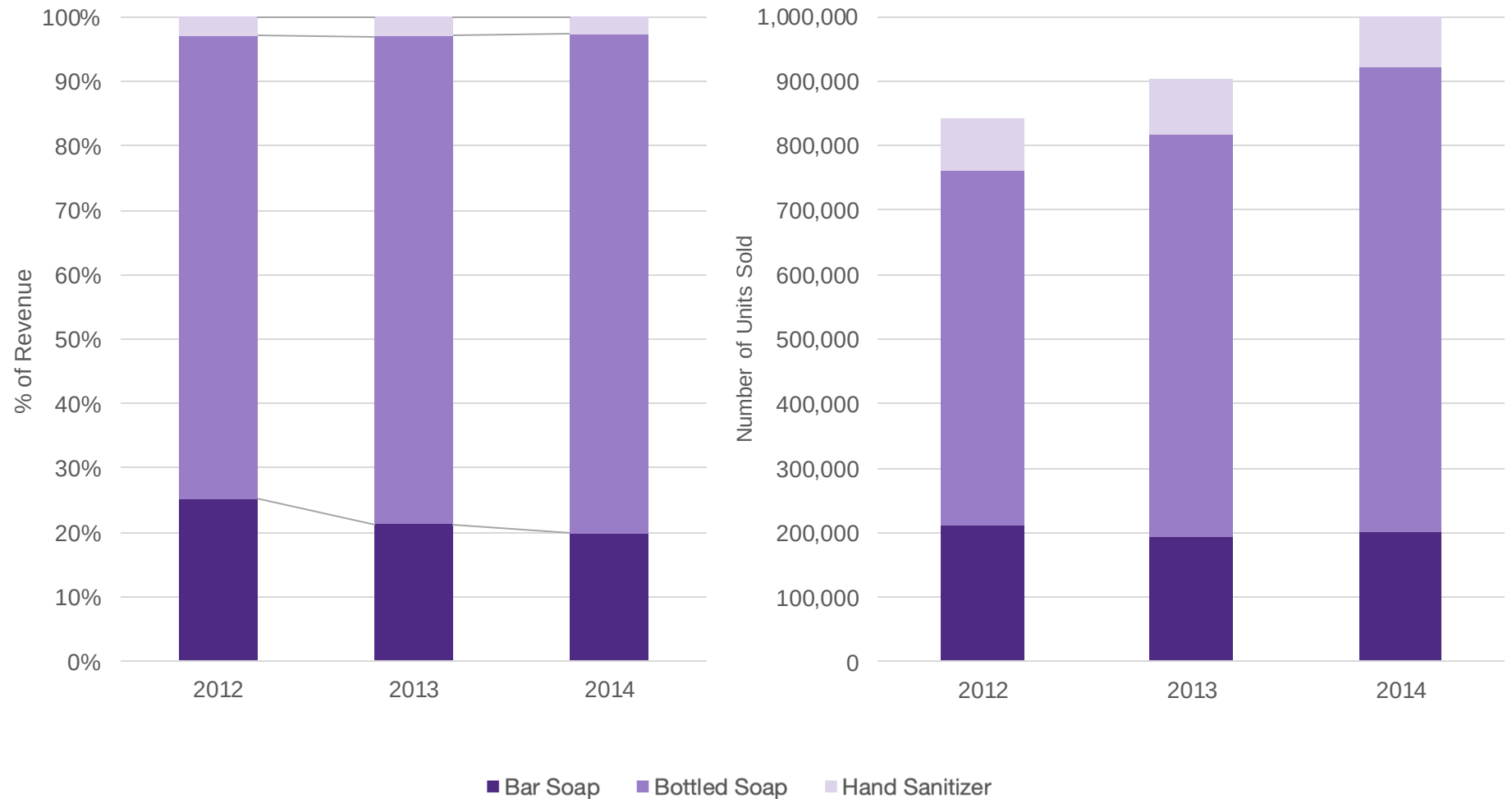
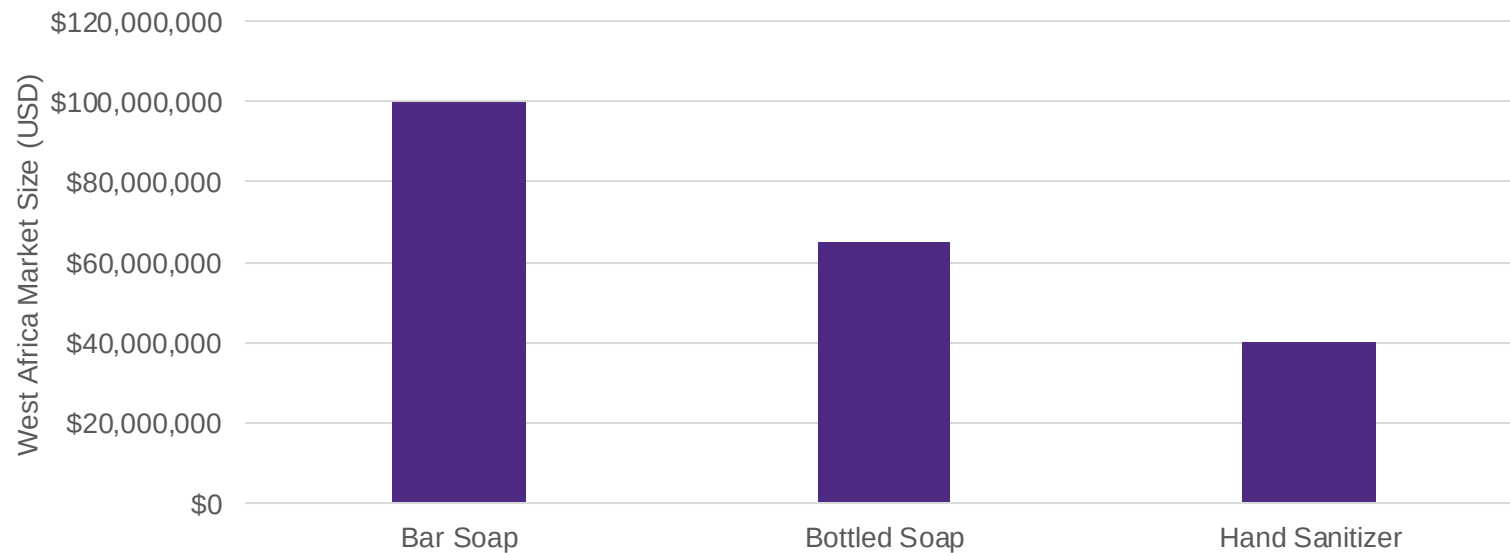


Exhibit C – West Africa Market Entry Financials (2014)



Average Price	\$4.50	\$4.00	\$2.00
Anticipated Penetration	0.9%	5.0%	3.5%

Bubbly LLC

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

- A structure should cover the key areas needed to determine how Bubbly should improve profitability in the short-term and whether they should enter the West African market. Key elements expected to be included in this framework to be successful later in the case are:

Short-Term (At Capacity)	Longer-Term (Market Entry)	
Given the plant is at capacity, the interviewee should focus on the product mix and components such as: - Product Profitability (Revenue – Costs) - Trends (e.g. what products are growing, cannibalization) Other reasonable considerations include price pressure and increasing fixed and distribution costs. The interviewee may also consider improvements to the factory itself (e.g. invest in improved machinery, etc.) but interviewer can state the plant is at maximum efficiency.	<u>Market Conditions</u> – better than our current market? 1. Size 2. Growth 3. Trends Penetration into the Market	
	<u>Product Mix</u> – if strong market, what should we sell? 1. What is there demand for? 2. What is the most profitable? 3. How would we promote / distribute our products?	
	<u>Risks</u> - Regulatory - Currency Risk - Cultural	<u>Capabilities / Benefits</u> - Synergies - Diversification - Reputational (Ebola)

Bubbly LLC

Part 2

2. Analyze the product mix

Provide Exhibit A and B

- We have initial data on both the recent pricing and variable costs associated with the three main products Bubbly LLC sells; they note that in production each product can be swapped 1:1 quickly (e.g. if they do not make 1 hand sanitizer, they can make 1 bar).
- How should Bubbly LLC change its U.S. product mix in the near-term if they are willing to shift up to 10% of unit production? What would be the annual profitability improvement?
- If necessary, tell the interviewee that variable costs have not changed over time and fixed costs are irrelevant. We expect recent trends in consumer demand to continue (i.e. Bar Soap demand will be flat at ~200k units; growth mainly in Bottled Soap).

Product	Price / Unit	Variable Cost / Unit	Profit Margin	Units Sold	Total Profits
Bar Soap	\$6.00	\$4.00	\$2.00 (33%)	200,000	\$400,000
Bottled Soap	\$6.50	\$5.50	\$1.00 (15%)	720,000	\$720,000
Hand Sanitizer	\$2.00	\$1.95	\$0.05 (2.5%)	80,000	\$4,000

- The above calculations illustrate that Bar Soap has the highest profit margin, but Bottled Soap is the biggest absolute contributor to profitability. Importantly, hand sanitizer has extraordinarily low profitability and production should be cut dramatically.
- From Exhibit B, the interviewee should also notice almost all growth is coming from Bottled Soap; one may also suspect that Bar Soap's pricing may be decreasing (and thus profit margins as well).
- Takeaway: Given product profitability and trends, even though Bar Soap has the highest profit margins, Bubbly should shift all 80k units of Hand Sanitizer production to Bottled Soap for an additional ~\$76K in profit.
- Interviewer should now direct attention to the longer-term situation and provide information on West Africa.

Bubbly LLC

Part 3

3. Identify if Bubbly should enter West Africa and what the optimal product mix should be for new market

Provide Exhibit C

- Bubbly LLC conducted this market analysis and determined there is a one-time \$500K cost to enter the West Africa market today. Could Bubbly LLC make a profit within the next year from a West Africa market entry?

Product	Market Price / Unit	Variable Cost Nigeria Plant (80% U.S)	Profit Margin (Nigeria)	Market Size	Penetration	Total Est. Revenue	Units	Total Profits
Bar Soap	\$4.50	\$3.20	\$1.30 (28%)	\$100M	0.9%	\$900K	200K	\$260K
Bottled Soap	\$4.00	\$4.40	N/A	\$65M	5.0%	N/A	N/A	N/A
Hand Sanitizer	\$2.00	\$1.50-\$1.60*	~\$0.40 (20%)	\$40M	3.5%	\$1.4M	700K	\$280K

- Immediately, the interviewee should recognize that based on the 20% discount given previously in the case the Bottled Soap is not a profitable product to bring to West Africa and should disregard it. If asked, costs are not expected to be lowered any more.
- As discussed in Part 2, demand trends in the U.S. are expected to continue so the opportunity cost is minimal in the medium-term (i.e. with only ~10% annual U.S. growth, the majority of the Nigeria factory's production will be used for a new market for years).
- Takeaway: Entering the market with 200K units of Bar Soap and 700K units of Hand Sanitizer would be worthwhile as the profits (\$540K total) are above the one-time entry cost of \$500K. Outstanding interviewees will recognize that any hand sanitizer that was removed from production in the U.S. can be produced with remaining capacity in Nigeria (80K * \$0.40 = \$32K additional profit).

*Given 20% off \$1.95 is not straightforward, somewhere in the range of \$1.50-\$1.60 can be estimated.

Part 4

4. Brainstorm market entry considerations

- Bubbly has agreed to move forward with selling their product in the West Africa market. What factors should they consider during their implementation?
-
- A simple framework may be the 4Ps approach:

Product	Price	Place	Promotion
What are trends in the market (e.g. hand sanitizer viewed as preferred product for epidemic) and are there additional products (e.g. detergent) to consider?	The prior figures were average market prices; do we want to go above or lower than the competition?	Currently we sell online; do we think we can gain more market share in profitable products via retail outlets or third-party selling?	Do we want to have some sort of initial discount or loyalty program? How do we advertise?

- Additional factors to consider are brand awareness, reputational impact, concerns around offering the same product for a lower price in a different region (e.g. price arbitrage), and time horizon (e.g. if the U.S. continues it's growth would we enter this market and then continually ramp down products in West Africa to supply U.S. demand?)
- There is no one takeaway from the brainstorm, though the interviewee should mention these markets are very different and connect any decisions made in West Africa back to how they may impact the U.S.

Part 5

5. Provide CFO recommendation

- Request interviewee provide recommendation to the CFO walking into the room – if asked do *not* allow time to write it down
- Bubbly LLC should shift U.S. production of Hand Sanitizer to Bottled Soap and should enter the West Africa market
 - Shifting production of Hand Sanitizer to Bottled Soap in the U.S. will result in an increase of profitability of \$76K
 - Bubbly should enter the West Africa market with Bar Soap and Hand Sanitizer for \$40K in profits the first year and ~\$540K thereafter
- Risks could include: Price arbitrage for regional pricing? Do we exit the West Africa market as the U.S. continues to grow?
- Mitigation steps include: Conduct market entry analysis using U.S. pricing, consider additional West Africa plant given demand
- Strong interviewees immediately recognize hand sanitizer production in the U.S. should stop, and that with current trends in the U.S. (only ~10% growth a year), the Nigeria plant will likely have significant idle capacity that they could use to enter the West Africa market – otherwise the U.S. plant would be shut down due to higher variable costs.
- Outstanding interviewees should recognize at minimum all future hand sanitizer production should be moved to the Nigeria plant due to the increased profit margins and can wrap in contextual hints (e.g. Ebola crisis at the time). They recognize the nuances of a product entry in an emerging market (e.g. pricing arbitrage) and that because unit production is 1:1, Bubbly LLC should always focus on the product with higher *absolute* \$ margin as opposed to % profit margin. These interviewees lay out tables appropriately and completes relatively complex calculations at a fast pace.

Case 04

Chic Cosmetology

Concepts tested

- Z03 Breakeven analysis (1)
- Z12 Creativity (2)
- Z07 Market share (3)

Primary sector(s)

- X09 Hospitality & Leisure

Case type

- Y04 Market entry

Similar cases

- Busch's Barber Shop (Kellogg 2021)
- Yumy Co (Yale 2012)

Case author(s): Peter Manoogian (Kellogg 2012)
Edited by: Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020)

Chic Cosmetology

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client is a for-profit, specialty college named Chic Cosmetology University (CCU). Founded in 2005, CCU is a program for high school graduates seeking their professional cosmetology license. CCU is currently the market leader for cosmetology education with campuses in ten major metropolitan areas in the US.
- CCU has capital to invest in a new campus and is considering Chicagoland as a location – should they do it?

Interviewer guide

- Problem: Will CCU be able to enroll enough students to offset the initial investment and achieve positive profit?
- Key case steps:
 1. Evaluate CCU revenue and cost structures
 2. Brainstorm CCU customers
 3. Project CCU's market share
 4. Provide client recommendation
- Note: It is critical that the interviewee lands on the figures presented (or is course corrected toward them before proceeding)

Chic Cosmetology

Fit: What would be the hardest part about starting at our firm?

Case prompt

- Our client is a for-profit, specialty college named Chic Cosmetology University (CCU). Founded in 2005, CCU is a program for high school graduates seeking their professional cosmetology license. CCU is currently the market leader for cosmetology education with campuses in ten major metropolitan areas in the US.
- CCU has capital to invest in a new campus and is considering Chicagoland as a location – should they do it?

Clarifying information

- **Goal:** Achieve positive operating profit for the new campus two years after opening
- **Format:** Enrolled students take classes at a physical campus for one school year to earn degree (FY begins on 9/1)
- **Reputation:** CCU has the best campuses and equipment in the industry, and boasts strong job placement into top local salons
- **Growth:** CCU and industry enrollments growing at 5% per year
- **Competitors:** 2-3 other large specialty colleges, and lower-cost community colleges
- **Industry:** H.S. Diploma and cosmetology degree required to enter the field
- **Students:** 98% of cosmetologists are women

Chic Cosmetology

Exhibit A – CCU 2010 financials (31-Aug-2010)

Student enrollments (all campuses)	10
Revenue from enrollments	\$150,000
Total fixed campus costs	\$48,000
Buildings and equipment	\$32,000
Recruiting, general, and administrative	\$16,000
Total variable campus costs	\$80,000
Instructors	\$40,000
Student supplies	\$40,000
Operating profit	\$22,000

Notes:

- All units in '000s

Chic Cosmetology

Exhibit B – CCU and major competitor locations (31-Aug-2010)



Campus	2010 share*
San Francisco, CA	8%
Los Angeles, CA	14%
Minneapolis, MN	15%
Dallas, TX	14%
Houston, TX	10%
Atlanta, GA	16%
Miami, FL	12%
Philadelphia, PA	12%
New York City, NY	16%
Boston, MA	8%

*Measured as share of total 'potential' students, as defined by CCU

Chic Cosmetology

Part 1

1. Evaluate CCU revenue and cost structures

Provide Exhibit A after interviewee asks about revenues or costs

- How many students will CCU need to break-even in year 1?
 - If asked, the investment initial Chicagoland campus cost is \$4.5M in initial building costs to renovate its chosen site. These costs can be amortized evenly over a three year period. Assume fixed costs remain flat per year.
-
- Interviewee should calculate
 - Total fixed costs per year = \$6.3M (\$4.8M + \$1.5M from amortization).
 - Gross profit per student = \$7K
 - Average revenue per enrollment = \$15K (revenue / total enrollments)
 - Total annual fixed cost per campus = \$4.8M (\$48M / 10)
 - Total variable cost per student = \$8K (\$80M / 10K)
 - Gross profit per student = \$7K (\$15K - \$8K)
 - Break-even number of enrollments per year = 900 (\$6.3M / \$7K)
 - Next step: Interviewee should tackle the overall opportunity in the area and how many year 1 enrollments CCU could expect

Chic Cosmetology

Part 2

2. Brainstorm CCU customers

- What types of schools / students do you think CCU targets?
-
- Possible responses (schools):
 - Public schools (private HS more likely to have grads go to 4yr univ)
 - HS's in middle-class cities (may be an affordability issue w/lo income)
 - Closest to the campus (geography)
 - Possible responses (students)
 - Female HS graduates
 - Not attending 4yr college
 - Interested in cosmetology
 - After a few of the above criteria are noted, share:
 - CCU has identified 1,000 targeted high schools in the Chicagoland area
 - Within these HS, CCU's market research estimates that on average 6 students per HS have "potential" for CCU enrollment

Part 3

3. Project CCU's market share

Provide Exhibit B to the interviewee

- 80% of enrolled students come directly from high school, the other 20% of students come from the “Adult” market
 - What is the highest share we could expect CCU Chicago to capture in Y1?
-
- Campuses w/competitors present tend to have a lower share (10%) than those w/out (15%)
 - However, presence of >1 competitor does not have an increased negative impact on market share (Boston has 8% share w/only one competitor)
 - Interviewee should assume a projected 10% market share for a Chicago campus (one competitor)
 - 10% market share equals 750 enrollments
 - Takeaway: CCU cannot break even based on the enrollment number estimated

Part 4

4. Provide client recommendation

- Overall, our client should NOT enter the Chicago market under the current cost structure. Even with a 10% market share assumption in year 1, the Chicago campus will enroll only 750 students, this is 150 fewer than the 900 required to break-even.
 - The client should also consider several qualitative issues:
 - Consider offering scholarships to increase the number of potential students and/or conversion rate of potential students
 - Consider other cities beyond Chicagoland that currently do not have a CCU presence, or add a second campus to a city such as NYC that has high market share and potentially low capacity
 - Perform market research in other cities to understand if there is a greater potential per target high school to increase ROI
 - Consider ways to reduce fixed costs (e.g., transporting equipment / materials from campuses that are not at capacity)
-
- **Strong interviewees** identify several of the qualitative issues listed above as ways in which CCU could proceed
 - **Outstanding interviewees** will recognize that the 10% market share is for campuses that have been in place for at least three years, therefore Chicago is unlikely to achieve that share in year 1 or 2; this rules out the feasibility of the follow-up question that suggests the possibility of reducing the one-time investment from \$4.5M to \$300K.

Case 05

Chicouver Cycle

Concepts tested

- Z12 Creativity (1)
- Z02 Net Present Value (2)
- Z03 Breakeven analysis (3)

Primary sector(s)

- X15 Transportation & Logistics

Case type

- Y04 New product / Market entry

Similar cases

- Fast Food Co. (Columbia 2017)
- Duck Island Beer Co. (Fuqua 2016)

{ Case authors: John Ng (Kellogg 2018)
Edited By: Michael Eidem (Kellogg 2020) }

Chicouver Cycle

Interviewer Guide

Case prompt

- Our client, Chicouver Cycle (pronounced “Chai-cover”), is a bikesharing startup. Like other bikeshare operators in cities around the world, Chicouver Cycle owns bicycles and rents them out to users one trip at a time.
- Chicouver Cycle wants to know how they should launch operations in the city of Chicouver. They have specifically asked us to recommend one or more of Chicouver’s neighborhoods to enter.

Interviewer guide

- This case tests the interviewee’s ability to move beyond the typical market entry framework to consider practical issues of launching a sharing economy business.
- Key case steps:
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem - identify factors for comparing different neighborhoods as potential launching grounds.
 2. Analyze cost and revenue drivers for different neighborhoods and trip types.
 3. Compute profitability for different operating models (docking versus dockless bikeshare systems)
 4. Provide client recommendation

Chicouver Cycle

Fit: You're interviewing for a generalist role, however, are there particular industries or functions that you're especially interested in?

Case prompt

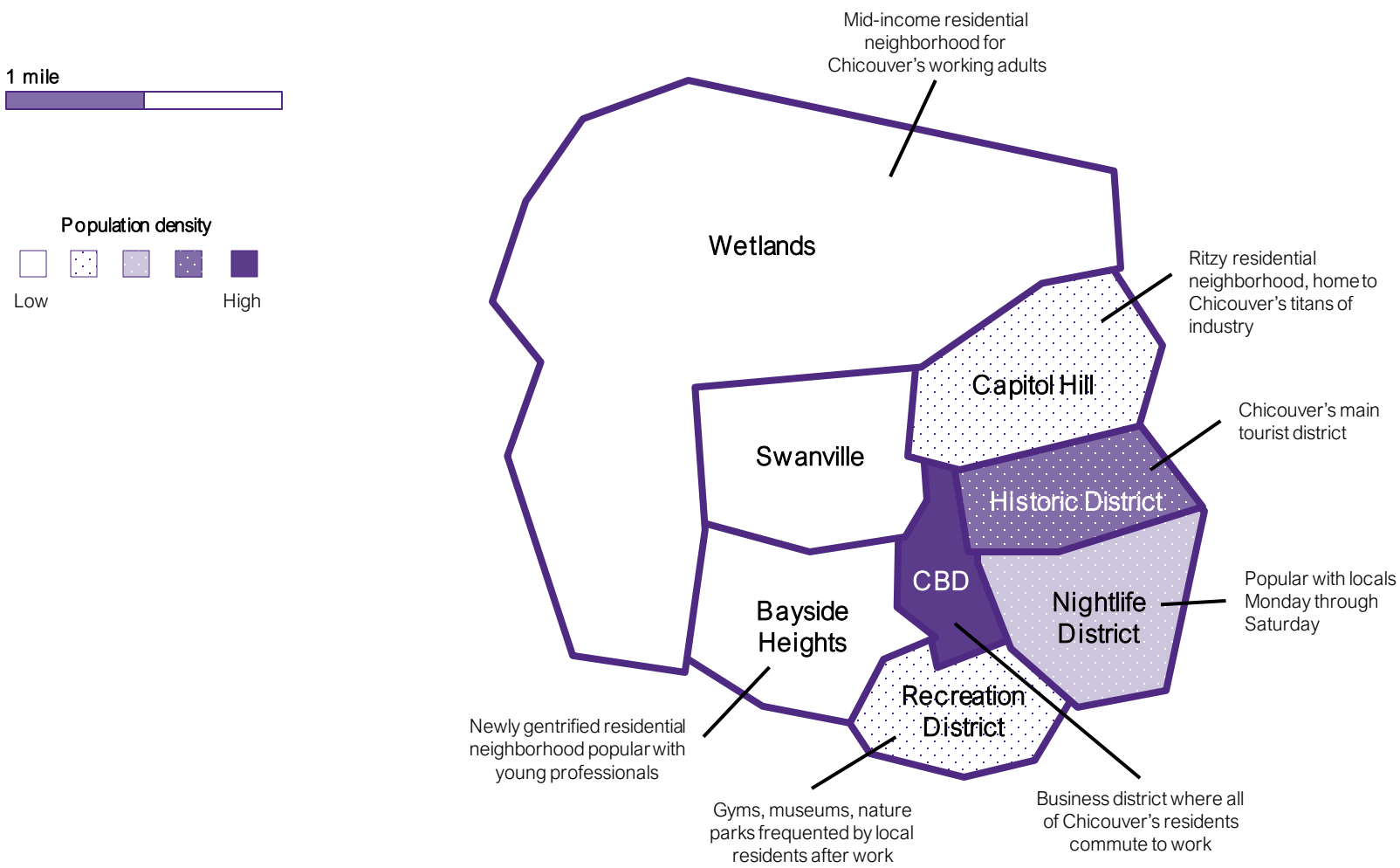
- Our client, Chicouver Cycle (pronounced “Chai-cover”), is a bikesharing startup. Like other bikeshare operators in cities around the world, Chicouver Cycle owns bicycles and rents them out to users one trip at a time.
- Chicouver Cycle wants to know how they should launch operations in the city of Chicouver. They have specifically asked us to recommend one or more of Chicouver’s neighborhoods to enter.

Clarifying information

- **Customers:** Chicouver residents are avid bicyclists. The city is also a popular tourist destination
- **Competitive Dynamics:** There is currently no existing bikeshare system in Chicouver.
- **Company:** Our client wants to generate cash from initial launch to fund further growth. Profitability is important.
- **Product:** Most bikeshare systems charge \$1 per trip. Our client will charge the same. Our client is choosing between two models of bikesharing systems: docking and dockless.
- **Other:** The city of Chicouver has worked with other sharing economy platforms before; permitting will not be an issue. Chicouver has reasonable weather for biking all year round.

Chicouwer Cycle

Exhibit A – Chicouwer’s Neighborhoods



Chicouwer Cycle

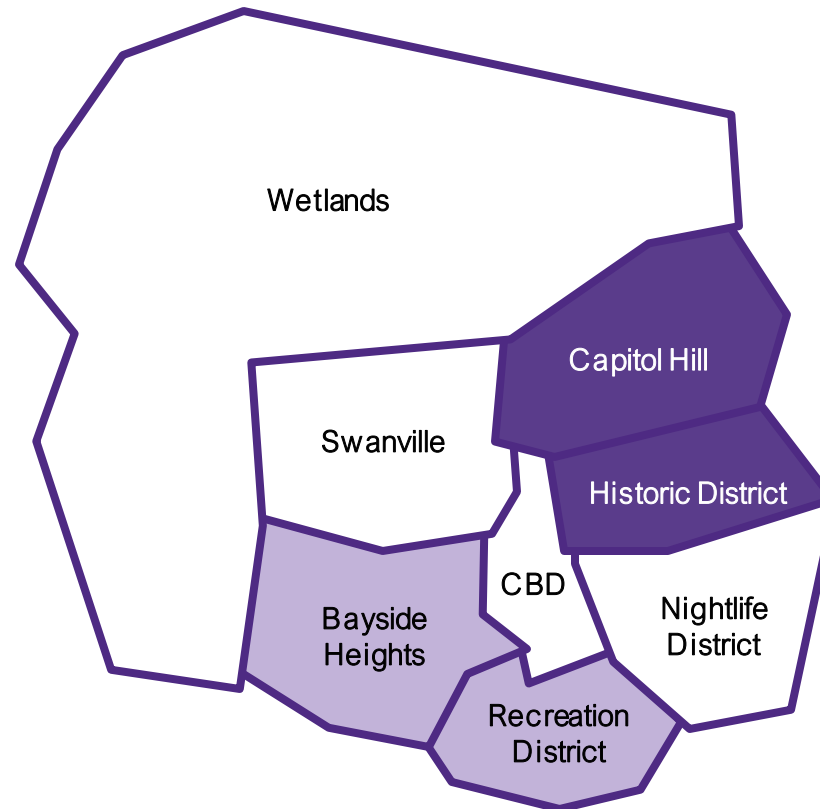
Exhibit B – Chicouwer's Topography

1 mile



Topography

		
Flat		Very hilly



Chicouver Cycle

Exhibit C – Projections by Type of Bikeshare Trip

Trip Type	Expected No. of Trips Per Week (K)	No. of Bikes Needed to Meet Demand (K)	Utilization (%)
Commuting	500	50	4%
Tourism	400	5	24%
Recreation	300	4	22%
Nightlife	600	30	7%

Notes:

- Utilization = # hours bike is used each week / total # hours in a week

Chicouver Cycle

Exhibit D – Bikeshare Systems

DOCKING System



Users must start and end trips at a docking station.

DOCKLESS System



Users pick up any available bike and end a trip anywhere within the service area.

Chicouver Cycle

Exhibit E – Projected Costs

Costs		Docking System	Dockless System
Annual cost per bike		\$200	\$200
Annual cost per docking station*		\$10,000	n/a
Annual distribution cost per bike	Flat	\$100	\$200
	Moderately Hilly	\$500	\$1,000
	Very Hilly	\$2,000	\$4,000

*Notes:

- Each docking station holds 20 bikes

Chicouver Cycle

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

An ideal structure focuses mostly on the specific question at hand: which neighborhood(s) should Chicouver Cycle look to launch in first? Additional elements of a new venture/market entry framework help to round out a complete view of the problem.

Key elements expected to be included in this framework are:

- **Overall Market:** Who are the target customers and what are their preferences, what does the competitive landscape look like (even though there aren't other bikesharing companies, what are available substitutes), what are the overall economic trends in the city of Chicouver and how will that impact the sharing economy?
- **Our Client:** What are our core competencies, have we launched in other cities previously and learned from that experience, do we have a current image/brand, how lean are we looking to be at initial launch, what are our future aspirations (other products, services)?
- **Profitability:** What will the expected costs be (marketing, bikes, docking equipment, labor, technology development and maintenance, etc.) and how much revenue can we expect to earn (user volume, ride frequency, payment level and structure)?
- **Location Choice:** The prompt specifically focuses on location, so the interviewee should consider factors that matter when analyzing neighborhoods as potential launching grounds: population density, neighborhood uses, household income, topography (critical for bikeshare!), etc.

Chicouver Cycle

Part 2

2. Analyze cost and revenue drivers for different neighborhoods and trip types.

After discussing initial framework, when interviewee raises questions regarding how to evaluate which neighborhood to enter...

Provide Exhibit A & B

- There is a lot of info in Exhibit A: population density, what takes place in each neighborhood, and who is in each neighborhood.
- There are 3 residential neighborhoods where people commute from home to work in CBD. After work, residents travel from the CBD to the recreation and nightlife districts. Tourists tend to stay within the historic district.
- Terrain matters: it's easier to bike on flat terrain than hilly terrain, and this may affect our revenues or our costs.
- Interviewee should discuss how these different characteristics of neighborhoods affect the attractiveness of each for market entry.
- Interviewee may need help seeing that there are different types of trips taking place within and between neighborhoods.

Provide Exhibit C

- Exhibit C lays out 4 types of trips that people take in Chicouver. Interviewee may note that while commuting and nightlife have the greatest number of trips, they require many bikes to provide an acceptable level of service, leading to low utilization.
- No calculations needed at this time, but interviewee should raise issue of revenues and costs. If asked about revenues, tell interviewee that our client will charge \$1 per trip. When asked about costs, ask interviewee to quickly brainstorm major cost items.

Chicouver Cycle

Part 3

3. Compute profitability for different operating models (docking versus dockless bikeshare systems)

- When the interviewee raises the need to look at costs and revenues...

Provide Exhibit D & E

Calculate revenue and costs for each distinct trip type to determine which neighborhoods should be targeted:

- Revenue = $(\$1) * (\# \text{ of weeks}) * (\# \text{ of trips})$ *(Assume 50 weeks in a year)*
- Cost of bikes = $(\$200) * (\# \text{ bikes})$
- Number of stations = $(\# \text{ bikes}) / 20$ Cost of Stations = $(\$10,000) * (\# \text{ stations})$
- Distribution costs = $(\text{distribution costs}) * (\# \text{ bikes})$

Type	# Trips	# Bikes	Terrain	Revenue	Bike Cost	# Stations	Station Cost	Dist. Cost (docking)	Dist. Cost (dockless)	Docking Profits	Dockless Profits
Commute	500	50K	All 3 (use flat)	$\$1 * 500K * 50 = 25M$	$\$200 * 50K = 10M$	$50K / 20 = 2500$	$2500 * \$10K = 25M$	$\$100 * 50K = 5M$	$5M * 2 = 10M$	$25 - 10 - 25 - 5 = -15M$	$25 - 10 - 10 = 5M$
Tourism	400	5K	Very hilly	$\$1 * 400K * 50 = 20M$	$\$200 * 5K = 1M$	$5K / 20 = 250$	$250 * \$10K = 2.5M$	$\$2000 * 5K = 10M$	$10M * 2 = 20M$	$20 - 1 - 2.5 - 10 = 6.5M$	$20 - 1 - 20 = -1M$
Recreation	300	4K	Moderate	$\$1 * 500K * 50 = 15M$	$\$200 * 4K = 0.8M$	$4K / 20 = 200$	$200 * \$10K = 2M$	$\$500 * 4K = 2M$	$2M * 2 = 4M$	$15 - 0.8 - 2 - 2 = 10.2M$	$15 - 0.8 - 4 = 10.2M$
Nightlife	600	30K	Flat	$\$1 * 500K * 50 = 30M$	$\$200 * 30K = 6M$	$30K / 20 = 1500$	$1500 * \$10K = 15M$	$\$100 * 30K = 3M$	$3M * 2 = 6M$	$30 - 6 - 15 - 3 = 6M$	$30 - 6 - 6 = 18M$

Chicouever Cycle

Part 4

4. Provide client recommendation

- **Recommendation:** Chicouever Cycle should launch a dockless system in the nightlife district:
 - This will generate \$18m in profits per year, driven by the nightlife district's high volume of projected bikeshare trips.
 - Going dockless will save \$15 in station costs in exchange for a doubling of distribution costs to \$6m, which are relatively low thanks to the nightlife district's flat terrain.
 - Going forward, a dockless system will also entail lower costs and higher profits than a docking system as Chicouever Cycle expands to other neighborhoods and serves other trip types. Choosing the right operating infrastructure with the eye to future growth is important for a bikeshare system.
- **Next Steps:**
 - Utilization of bicycles for nightlife trips is low. Our client should explore ways to increase utilization and improve margins by using the same bikes to target additional trip types, such as recreation trips. Recreation is a good candidate because the recreating and nightlife districts are geographically adjacent.
 - Our client should investigate ways to reduce distribution costs. One idea is to incentive users to end trips in specific locations that won't require Chicouever Cycles to send someone to redistribute the bikes later on.
 - Chicouever Cycle should increase loyalty among customers and raise switching costs to protect itself from other sharing economy transportation competitors, including other bikeshare companies that may enter the city.

Case 06

Dark Sky

Concepts tested

- Z12 Creativity (1)
- Z05 Elasticity (2)
- Z14 Pricing strategy (2)

Primary sector(s)

- X01 Aerospace & Defense

Case type

- Y04 New product / Market entry

Similar cases

- Fruit Cart Vendor (Stern 2012)
- Sgt. Slaughter (Fuqua 2010)
- Ice Cream Dream (Darden 2016)

{ Case author(s): Sean Burrow (Kellogg 2011)
Edited by: Eugene Kim (Kellogg 2015), Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020) }

Dark Sky

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client, Dark Sky, is a small manufacturer of unmanned (ie. remotely piloted) data collection aircraft.
- Dark Sky produces the Assessor, an aircraft originally designed for unmanned weather exploration.
- In 2006, the United States military began purchasing Assessors for use in Intelligence, Surveillance and Reconnaissance (ISR) missions. The Assessor is profitable, but sales have stagnated and the client wishes to grow.
- What are some steps Dark Sky could take to achieve growth?

Interviewer guide

- This case intentionally uses terminology that may not be familiar to the typical MBA student. This is meant to challenge the interviewee to dismiss superfluous information and to focus on the business problem.
 1. Analyze historical growth and brainstorm growth strategies
 2. Explore attractiveness of prototype products
 3. Brainstorm other product selection considerations
 4. Provide client recommendation

Dark Sky

Fit: What is your greatest weakness? Tell me about a team experience when you were hampered by this weakness.

Case prompt

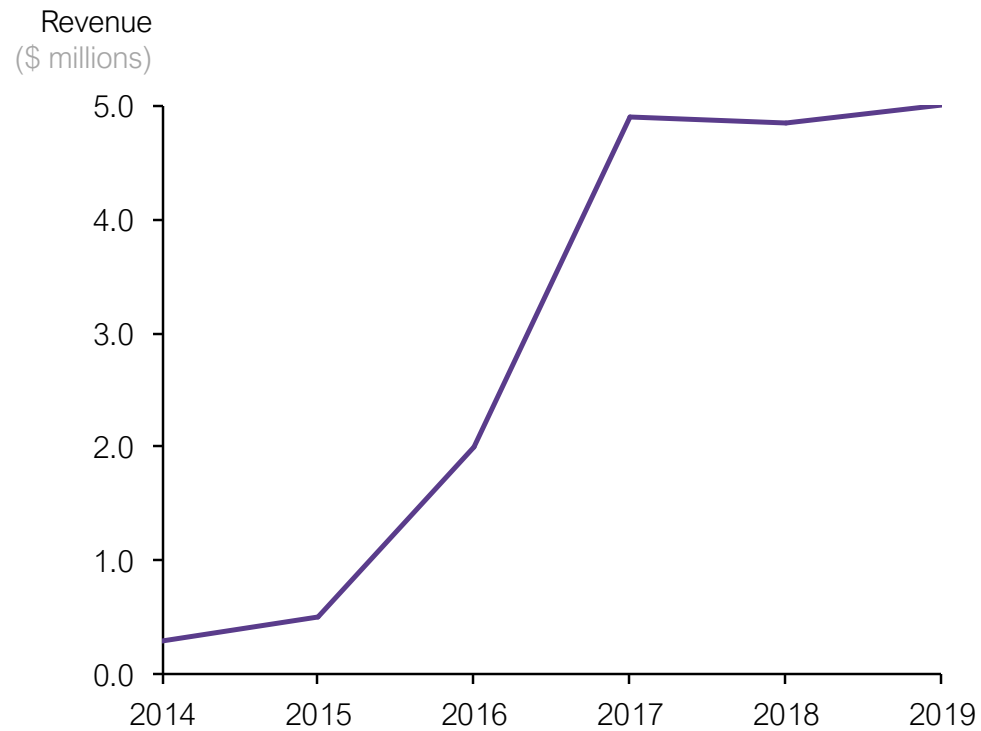
- Our client, Dark Sky, is a small manufacturer of unmanned (ie. remotely piloted) data collection aircraft.
- Dark Sky produces the Assessor, an aircraft originally designed for unmanned weather exploration.
- In 2006, the United States military began purchasing Assessors for use in Intelligence, Surveillance and Reconnaissance (ISR) missions. The Assessor is profitable, but sales have stagnated and the client wishes to grow.
- What are some steps Dark Sky could take to achieve growth?

Clarifying information

- **Customer / Price:** Dark Sky's only customer is the US Military, with which they have a Cost-Plus-Fixed-Fee contract. The contract has been extended in the past and is up for renegotiation; the Military has agreed to a marginal inflationary price increase
- **Company:** Dark Sky has additional capacity to manufacture. They are too small to acquire competitors.
- **Product:** Dark Sky designs a unique aircraft that is launched from a catapult device; the aircraft can be launched from ships at sea or from harsh terrain (e.g. desert, mountains). Dark Sky only sells the Assessor, but has other prototypes designed.
- **Competition:** There are approximately 20 competitors that manufacture unmanned aircraft.

Dark Sky

Exhibit A – Historical revenue (2014 – 2019)



Dark Sky

Exhibit B – New product sales forecast (2020)

New Product Offering	New Product Sales (units sold)		Price Per Aircraft
	Navy	Army	
SeaBird	50	--	\$220,000
SandBird	--	60	\$210,000
JointBird	38	52	\$180,000

Dark Sky

Exhibit C – Impact of new product on existing sales (2020)

New Product Offering	New Product Sales (units sold)		Price Per Aircraft	Assessor unit sales lost (cannibalized)
	Navy	Army		
SeaBird	50	--	\$220,000	40%
SandBird	--	60	\$210,000	70%
JointBird	38	52	\$180,000	90%

Dark Sky

Part 1

1. Analyze historical growth and brainstorm growth strategies

Provide Exhibit A when the interviewee asks about revenue

- The military started purchasing the Assessor in 2016. The price of the aircraft has remained constant at \$100,000 per unit. Throughout the past decade, The Assessor has been Dark Sky's only source of revenue.
 - How many units were sold in 2019 and what was the growth rate from 2015 to 2019? How could Dark Sky grow?
-
- How many units were sold in 2019?
 - $\$5,000\text{k} \div \$100\text{k/unit} = 50 \text{ units}$
 - What was the growth rate from 2015 to 2019?
 - $(\$5,000\text{k} - \$500\text{k}) \div (\$500\text{k}) \times 100 = 900\%$

Organic	Inorganic
• Increase penetration with US military • Product development – develop new products for the military • New market entry to new markets or customers • Increase / reduce prices (based on demand elasticity)	• Joint Venture – to increase market accessibility or product offering. • M&A – add additional capacity and/or products.

Part 2a

2a. Explore attractiveness of prototype products

Provide Exhibit B after Exhibit A asks about new products

- Dark Sky has developed several aircraft prototypes designed specifically for military missions. The company has the capability to continue producing the Assessor and to introduce one new aircraft.
 - To maximize short-term growth, which aircraft should Dark Sky produce?
-
- To calculate the revenue for each scenario, the interviewee should add Assessor sales to the sales of the new product.
 - Assessor sales are based on:
 - 50 units sold with no new product launch
 - Cannibalization forecast specific to each new product launch
 - \$110,000 per aircraft
 - New product sales can be easily calculated using shortcuts. For example:
 - SeaBird: $\$220k * 100 = \$22m$... then half of this
 - SandBird: $\$210k * 100 = \$21m$... then half of it and add (10% of \$21m)
 - JointBird: Add to get 90... then $\$180k * 100 = \$18m$, subtract (10% of \$18m)

Part 2b

2b. Explore attractiveness of prototype products

Provide Exhibit C only if the interviewee asks about cannibalization

- The introduction of a new aircraft will have a negative impact on Assessor sales. Which aircraft should Dark Sky produce?
-
- Assessor Sales (Units, Revenue):
 - No new product = 50 aircraft, \$5,500,000
 - With SeaBird = $50 + (50 * (-40\%)) = 50 - 20 = 30$ aircraft, \$3,300,000
 - With SandBird = $50 + (50 * (-70\%)) = 50 - 35 = 15$ aircraft, \$1,650,000
 - With JointBird = $50 + (50 * (-90\%)) = 50 - 45 = 5$ aircraft, \$550,000
 - New Product Revenue:
 - SeaBird = $50 * \$220,000 = \$11,000,000$
 - SandBird = $60 * \$210,000 = \$12,600,000$
 - JointBird = $(38 + 52) * \$180,000 = 90 * \$180,000 = \$16,200,000$
 - Total Revenue:
 - Assessor Only = \$5,500,000
 - Assessor and SeaBird = $\$3,300,000 + \$11,000,000 = \$14,300,000$
 - Assessor and SandBird = $\$1,650,000 + \$12,600,000 = \$14,250,000$
 - Assessor and JointBird = $\$550,000 + \$16,200,000 = \$16,750,000$

Part 3

3. Brainstorm other product selection considerations

- If the candidate doesn't start by listing other considerations relevant to selection of a new aircraft, ask them to brainstorm.

Development

- Speed: How quickly could Dark Sky start manufacturing a third model (i.e. can Dark Sky produce SandBird this year, and be producing SandBird and SeaBird the following year)? If so, what are the revenue implications?
- Costs: How profitable are the four aircraft models in comparison? Note: Because Dark Sky has a Cost-Plus-Fixed-Fee contract, profitability for each aircraft is likely equivalent. For this reason, Dark Sky should focus on maximizing the number of aircraft sold. • How much and how long is the payback period for the investment in manufacturing each type aircraft?

Portfolio

- If Dark Sky produces JointBird, is \$550,000 in Assessor revenue worth the associated cost to produce the aircraft? Should resources be allocated to another project?

Customer

- Potential benefits of having two customer bases for new product (Navy and Army).

Part 4

4. Provide client recommendation

- Based on 2020 forecasted revenue alone, Dark Sky should introduce the JointBird to the US Military in order to boost growth.
 - Among the three new prototype product, the JointBird is forecasted to maximize short-term revenue
 - However, there are several connected issues that Dark Sky should consider to include profitability, long-term revenue forecasts, competitive response, etc.
-
- Excellent interviewees will identify cannibalization as a consideration before beginning revenue calculations

Case 07

DigiBooks

Interviewer-led

Concepts tested

- Z10 Customer strategy (2)
- Z10 Marketing strategy (3)
- Z12 Creativity (3)
- Z08 Market sizing (4)

Primary sector(s)

- X12 Retail & CPG
- X13 Technology

Case type

- Z04 New product / Market entry

Similar cases

- Heavy Things Fitness (Fuqua 2014)
- High Peaks Jacket (Tuck 2009)
- Termite Control (Ross 2005)

{ Case authors: Shobhit Chugh (Kellogg '11)
Edited By: Adam Louras (Kellogg 2011), Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020) }

Interviewer Guide

Case prompt

- Our client, DigiBooks, is a manufacturer and seller of electronic book readers (tablets). DigiBooks also distributes e-books for the tablets through their website. The tablet is only compatible with books sold through the DigiBooks site.
- DigiBooks is planning the launch of its tablets in a country where no electronic book readers are currently sold. Only 1% of the population has ever used an electronic book readers, though 50% is aware of the concept. The Chief Marketing Officer of DigiBooks has come to you to help determine:
- What factors should DigiBooks consider when launching and marketing DigiBook tablets in this new country?

Interviewer guide

- Problem: How should DigiBooks enter this new market?
- Key case steps
 1. Develop a problem-solving structure
 2. Analyze customer segments
 3. Brainstorm market entry considerations
 4. Estimated profits to identify optimal sales channel
 5. Provide CEO recommendation

DigiBooks

Experience: Tell me about a time that you lead a time to meet an aggressive deadline.

Case prompt

- Our client, DigiBooks, is a manufacturer and seller of electronic book readers (tablets). DigiBooks also distributes e-books for the tablets through their website. The tablet is only compatible with books sold through the DigiBooks site.
- DigiBooks is planning the launch of its tablets in a country where no electronic book readers are currently sold. Only 1% of the population has ever used an electronic book readers though 50% is aware of the concept. The Chief Marketing Officer of DigiBooks has come to you to help determine:
- What factors should DigiBooks consider when launching and marketing DigiBook tablets in this new country?

Clarifying information

- Industry Definitions: Electronic book readers: Is a software, hardware and network platform that utilizes wireless connectivity to enable users to shop for, download, browse, and read e-books, newspapers, magazines, blogs, and other digital media.
- Client Characteristics: DigiBook's Tablet: Uses an e-ink electronic paper display that features 16 shades of grey. This allows for a 12 hour long battery life and easy readability.
- Locations: DigiBook has never sold a product outside of the US.
- Competitive Dynamics: No competitors in the e-book or tablet space plan to enter this country
- Market Characteristics: Total population of the country 76MM, high literacy level

DigiBooks

Exhibit A – Market segments



Exhibit B – Channel decisions

Channel	Reach as a % of Total potential market	E book Gross Margin %	E-reader Gross Margin %	Penetration	Overheads
Retail	50%	50%	30%	40%	\$20M
Internet	50%	50%	60%	10%	\$10M

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

- A structure should cover the key areas needed to explore in order to determine how DigiBooks should launch and market the tablets in this country. Key elements expected to be included in this framework are:
- Segmentation, targeting and positioning: Are there particular segments in the population that will be ideal customers for us?
- Product: What key capabilities are people looking for? Can we use our existing products or do we need to develop a new one for this country?
- Price: What price should the tablets and books be sold at? What is customers willingness to pay? Should we price the tablet at a low price so as to capture most of the market, and make margin on e-books?
- Promotion: How should the tablets be marketed? What promotion mechanisms should be used?
- Place/Distribution: Should the tablets be sold through retail channels, internet or other alternative means?
- Selection of e-books: Is a wide selection of books available for this country?

Part 2

2. Analyze customer segments

Provide Exhibit A

- Through research, we found several segments. We are only able to target one segment with our product.
 - Using a 3-year projection, which segment should DigiBook target?
-
- If unclear, the interviewee should answer based on Revenue Potential (i.e. Ignore probability of purchase) assuming all tablet sales happen immediately (Ignore TVM).
 - The missing data is that the average price of an e-book is \$10, for each of the segments, and that e-books and tablets have the same margin
 - Using Exhibit A, interviewee should calculate:
 - SR Revenue = $[(15 \text{ books} \times \$10 \times 3 \text{ Years}) + (\$200 \times 1 \text{ tablet})] \times 8 \text{M People} = \5.2B
 - OR Revenue = $[(10 \text{ books} \times \$10 \times 3 \text{ Years}) + (\$125 \times 1 \text{ tablet})] \times 20 \text{M People} = \8.5B
 - RR Revenue = $[(5 \text{ books} \times \$10 \times 3 \text{ Years}) + (\$175 \times 1 \text{ tablet})] \times 10 \text{M People} = \3.25B
 - Takeaway: Segment to be targeted = Occasional Readers (OR) with a Revenue Potential of \$8.5B

Part 3

3. Brainstorm market entry considerations

- DigiBooks is now considering how it should sell its e-book readers: through retail stores or through the internet.
- How would you go about evaluating this decision?

	Pros	Cons
Retail	• Should encourage trial of the product • Retailers can help with joint marketing campaigns • Retailers can help with customer service, returns	• Lower margin due to value chain expansion • Will take time and money to set up and adds training costs
Internet	• Likely cheaper to establish, will result in higher margins	• Hard to encourage trial

- Takeaway: We should do some sort of financial analysis to determine which channel is more attractive.

Part 4

4. Estimated profits to identify optimal sales channel

Provide Exhibit B

- Based on revised market estimates, we decided to price the e-reader at \$100 and target the Occasional Reader segment.
 - Using this information and Exhibit B, can you estimate the profit potential of each of these sales channels? Which should we choose?
 - What segment would you recommend to your client?
-
- If unclear, the interviewee should answer this with a 1-year Profitability calculation for each of the Sales Channels and back out the Upfront Investment. They should ignore all other costs.
 - There is no missing data; however, the Market Size of 20M people in the OR segment is needed from Exhibit A and the price per e-book of \$10.
 - Using Exhibit B, interviewee should calculate:
 - Retail Profit = $[(10 \text{ Books} \times \$10/\text{book} \times 50\%) + (\$100/\text{tablet} \times 30\%)] \times (20\text{M People} \times 50\% \text{ reach} \times 40\% \text{ Penetration}) = \$320\text{M} - \$20\text{M} = \300M
 - Internet Profit = $[(10 \text{ Books} \times \$10/\text{book} \times 50\%) + (\$100/\text{tablet} \times 60\%)] \times (10\text{M People} \times 10\% \text{ Penetration}) = \$110\text{M} - \$10\text{M} = \100M
 - Takeaway: Sales Channel to Use = Retail with a profit of \$300M

Part 5

5. Provide CEO recommendation

- Overall, DigiBooks should launch the e-book reader for the Occasional Reader segment through the Retail Sales Channel.
- Based on our calculations, we expect to earn a \$300MM annual return

Other items to consider:

- What advertising mechanisms do we use in this case?
 - Do we setup a manufacturing facility in the country or do we source the products from our current manufacturing facilities?
 - Are there any prospects of competitors entering the market?
-
- Strong interviewees notice key nuances in the case such as: Time Value of Money impacts on Exhibit A and Probability of Purchase or Penetration on Exhibit A
 - Outstanding interviewees detail various elements of marketing strategy of a new product launch. They lay out tables appropriately and completes relatively complex calculations at a fast pace.

Case 33

Evanston Eagles

Concepts tested

- Z05 Elasticity
- Z12 Creativity
- Z13 Organizational changes

Primary sector(s)

- X05 Entertainment & Media

Case type

- Y05 Operations

Casing Skills tested

- Opening framework
- Creative idea organization
- Goal-focused case solutioning
- Empathetic communication

Case author(s): Drew Johnson (Kellogg 2023)
Edited By: Aditi Kannan (Kellogg 2023)

Evanston Eagles

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client is the general manager of the Evanston Eagles, Evanston's professional basketball team
- It's halfway through the season and the Eagles' star player, Tripp Richmond, suffered a serious injury in last night's game. Specifically, Richmond's left ankle buckled as he landed after collecting a rebound. Although the team physician initially suspected a sprained ankle, this morning's MRI delivered a more concerning diagnosis: Richmond tore his peroneus longus, a lateral ankle tendon.
- Richmond's presence on the court is essential to the team's success, so his injury puts the team at-risk of missing the playoffs. In collaboration with medical staff, our task is to address Richmond's injury in the way that best allows the team to make the postseason.
- Additionally, the general manager is curious about the financial impact of the decision we recommend, as attendance and fan engagement generated when Richmond plays is substantial
- With half of the 80-game regular season remaining, how should the Eagles react to Richmond's injury?

Interviewer guide

- This case is intended to challenge the interviewee's creativity and critical thinking by presenting an unusual business problem relating to professional athlete injury management. Although interviewees will likely acknowledge unfamiliarity with sports medicine, strong casers will navigate this uncertainty with insightful questioning, strong logical thinking, and empathy for the athlete and his organization.
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Assess the Eagles' competitive position
 3. Brainstorm options for addressing Richmond's injury
 4. Evaluate the competitive impact of possible medical treatments
 5. Evaluate the financial impact of our recommendation
 6. Provide client recommendation

Evanston Eagles

Fit: Tell me about a time when you navigated a professional challenge by leveraging previous knowledge or experience from an unrelated domain

Case prompt

- Our client is the general manager of the Evanston Eagles, Evanston's professional basketball team
- It's halfway through the season and the Eagles' star player, Tripp Richmond, suffered a serious injury in last night's game. Specifically, Richmond's left ankle buckled as he landed after collecting a rebound. Although the team physician initially suspected a sprained ankle, this morning's MRI delivered a more concerning diagnosis: Richmond tore his peroneus (peh-ruh-nee-uhs) longus, a lateral ankle tendon.
- Richmond's presence on the court is essential to the team's success, so his injury puts the team at-risk of missing the playoffs. In collaboration with medical staff, our task is to address Richmond's injury in the way that best allows the team to make the postseason.
- Additionally, the general manager is curious about the financial impact of the decision we recommend, as attendance and fan engagement generated when Richmond plays is substantial
- With half of the 80-game regular season remaining, how should the Eagles react to Richmond's injury?

Clarifying information

- **Goal:** Our client's primary goal is for the Evanston Eagles to make the postseason this year. Our client's secondary goal is to articulate the financial impact of any decision we recommend.
- **Prognosis:** Although peroneus longus tendon tears are uncommon, the Eagles medical staff is confident Richmond will eventually return to play at full strength. How quickly Richmond returns, though, is uncertain and largely dependent on the chosen medical treatment.
- **Competition:** The Evanston Eagles are a perennial leader in the Chicago Conference of the Midwestern Basketball Association (MBA). They currently lead the conference standings and – prior to Richmond's injury – were favored to win the MBA championship.

Evanston Eagles

Exhibit A – Chicago conference standings through 40 games

Standing	Team	Record	Games Back
1	Evanston Eagles	32 – 8*	--
2	Skokie Snails	28 - 12	4
3	Wilmette Wildcats	27 - 13	5
4	Naperville Ninjas	26 - 15	6
5	Glenview Geese	24 - 16	8
6	Schaumburg Snakes	21 - 19	11
7	Oak Park Owls	20 - 20	12
8	Joliet Jaguars	20 - 20	12
9	Rosemont Racers	19 - 21	13
10	Lincoln Park Lemurs	17 - 23	15
11	Des Plaines Dingoes	17 - 23	15
12	Elgin Elephants	14 - 16	18
13	Morton Grove Monkeys	13 - 17	19
14	Barrington Blue Devils	13 - 17	19
15	Hyde Park Hyenas	10 - 30	22

*Richmond has played in every game so far this season

Evanston Eagles

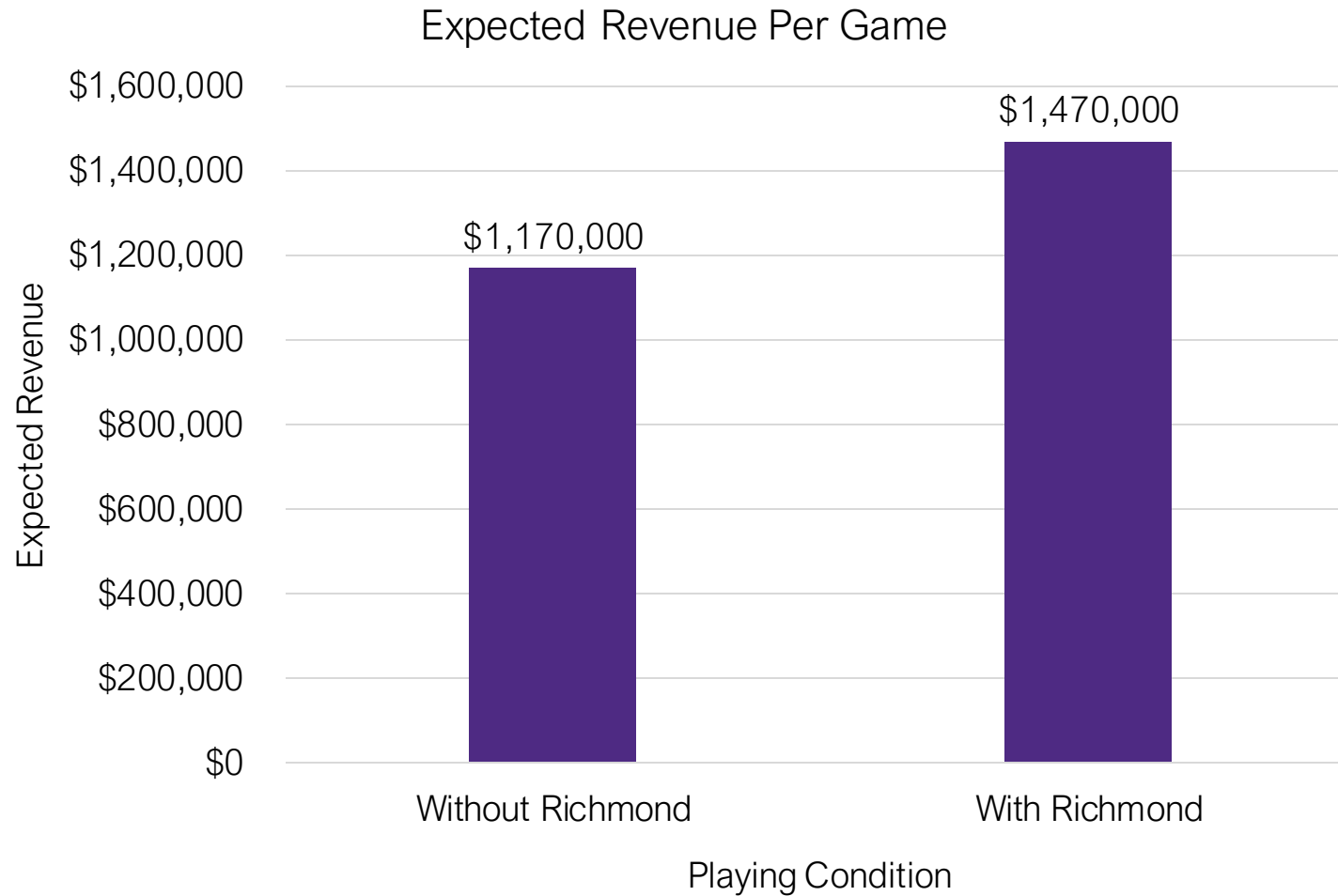
Exhibit B – Medical treatment options (from team physician)

Treatment*	Cost	Games Played if Treatment is Successful	Probability of Success
Walking boot	\$200	25	35%
Physical therapy	\$3,000	30	20%
Regenerative injections	\$7,000	20	10%
Surgical repair	\$50,000	15	80%

*Assume only one treatment will be pursued. Treatments cannot be combined or compounded.

Evanston Eagles

Exhibit C – Revenue



Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

- Structure should cover areas worthy of exploration to determine how the team's performance will be impacted by Richmond's injury, how the team can best react to Richmond's injury, and the financial impact of the interviewee's recommended action plan
- Example structure below:

Market	Injury Response	Financial Impact	Other Considerations & Risks
• What is the team's current competitive position? • How will Richmond's injury impact the team's competitive position? • What metric is used to determine postseason eligibility? • What performance level is necessary for the Eagles to achieve their goal?	• How might the Eagles respond to the news of Richmond's injury? • Strong interviewees will mention both internal (ex. medical treatment) and external (ex. trade player) options • See part 3 • What is the expected competitive impact of each possible response?	• What is the cost of our recommended response to Richmond's injury? • How will attendance be impacted by a star player's absence? • How will in-game spending be impacted by a star player's absence? • What is the financial impact of making or missing the playoffs?	• Public and media perception of the team's response • Richmond's long-term future with the Eagles could be jeopardized if injury is mismanaged • Richmond's mental health during on-court absence • General manager's reputation and competency is at risk • Response to anticipated drop in locker-room morale

Part 2

2. Analyze team's competitive position

Provide Exhibit A when the interviewee asks about the team's competitive positioning

- Interviewee should ask about the impact Richmond's injury will have on team performance during the remaining 40 games
 - When appropriate, present interviewee with the following:
 - The conference's top six teams at the end of the regular season make the playoffs
 - Analysts project that the sixth-place team will win 52 games
 - Historically when Richmond is absent, the Eagles win 40% of games
 - "In a worst-case scenario where Richmond cannot return this season, how many games behind sixth place will the Eagles finish?"
-
- Eagles record during the final 40 regular-season games without Richmond: $40 \text{ games} * 40\% = 16$
 - Final win count = existing wins + projected wins without Richmond = $32 + 16 = 48$
 - Wins behind sixth place if Richmond does not return = $52 - 48 = \underline{4 \text{ games}}$
-
- After understanding Richmond's absence will cause the Eagles to miss the playoffs, strong interviewees will drive into a brainstorm of ideas about how the team can get Richmond back on the court. This is part 3 of the case.

Part 3

3. Brainstorm ideas for responding to Richmond's injury

- If potential responses were given appropriate attention in the interviewee's opening framework, ask the interviewee to comment on the pros and cons of each possibility
- Else, present the interviewee with the following: "You have a meeting with the team physician this afternoon to discuss treatment options to get Richmond back on the court. In the meantime, the general manager calls you to hear your initial thoughts on how the team could react to Richmond's injury news to have a chance at making the playoffs. What do you tell her?"
 - Optional follow up: "What are the pros and cons of each recommendation?"

- Sample brainstorm below

Internal		External
Conservative	Surgical	
• Rest • Physical therapy • Walking boot/crutches • Ankle brace • Therapeutic injections (ex. steroids) • Regenerative injections (ex. stem cells)	• Peroneus longus tendon repair	• Trade Richmond for a healthy player • Promote a player from the minor/development league • Sign a free agent

Part 4

4a. Recommend a medical treatment – interviewer guidance

Provide Exhibit B when the interviewee asks about medical treatment information

- If the interviewee requests information about any the “external” options referenced in the sample response of part 3, inform them that, unfortunately, no players of Richmond’s caliber are currently available in the open market
- If Richmond does not return, the Eagles will fall four wins short of sixth place (part 2). Thus, the interviewee should recommend any option that increases the team’s expected win count (compared to the worst-case scenario) by at least four.
- For each scenario, interviewee should calculate expected wins if the treatment is successful and compare this number to the expected wins if the treatment is unsuccessful. This difference, multiplied by the probability of a successful treatment, is the expected increase in wins by pursuing that treatment.
- If interviewee needs assistance, ask the following:
 - “For each treatment, if it is successful, how many wins can the Eagles expect once Richmond returns?”
 - “If the treatment is unsuccessful, how many wins can the Eagles expect during this same time period?”
 - “What is the difference in wins between the two outcomes? What is the probability of this difference occurring?”
- Strong interviewees will acknowledge significant cost differences between options but will remain focused on the primary goal of helping the Eagles make the playoffs. Cost should not factor into the interviewee’s treatment recommendation.
- Sample calculations provided on the next slide

Part 4

4b. Recommend a medical treatment – sample calculations

- The following are necessary for the calculations and are provided earlier in the case. Interviewees may need to be reminded of these figures:
 - Win rate when Richmond plays: 80%
 - Win rate when Richmond does not play: 40%
- Interviewee should recommend surgical repair, as it is the only proposed treatment with an expected win increase of more than four. Other treatment options, although cheaper, will not allow the Eagles to make the playoffs.

Treatment	Expected wins if successful (games played * win rate)	Expected wins if unsuccessful (games not played * win rate)	Difference in successful vs. unsuccessful outcome	Expected additional wins (difference * probability)
Walking boot	$25 * 80\% = 20$	$25 * 40\% = 10$	10 wins	$10 \text{ wins} * 35\% = 3.5 \text{ wins}$
Physical therapy	$30 * 80\% = 24$	$30 * 40\% = 12$	12 wins	$12 \text{ wins} * 20\% = 2.4 \text{ wins}$
Regenerative injections	$20 * 80\% = 16$	$20 * 40\% = 8$	8 wins	$8 \text{ wins} * 10\% = 0.8 \text{ wins}$
Surgical repair	$15 * 80\% = 12$	$15 * 40\% = 6$	6 wins	$6 \text{ wins} * 80\% = \underline{\underline{4.8 \text{ wins}}}$

Part 5

5. Evaluate the financial impact of our recommendation

Provide Exhibit C when the interviewee asks about the financial impact of our recommendation

- “What is the expected regular-season revenue impact of treating Richmond’s injury surgically compared to pursuing no treatment?”
 - If interviewee asks for details about revenue sources: “Major revenue sources include ticket sales, concessions, and merchandise”
-
- Difference = $\$1,470,000 - \$1,140,000 = \$300,000$ per game Richmond plays
 - Expected number of games played by Richmond if surgical repair is pursued: $15 \text{ games} * 80\% \text{ success probability} = 12 \text{ games}$
 - $12 \text{ games} * \$300,000 \text{ more per game} = \$3,600,000$
 - $\$3,600,000 - \$50,000 \text{ cost of surgical repair} = \underline{\$3,550,000 \text{ expected regular-season-revenue increase}}$
 - Strong interviewees will note that by making the playoffs, the Eagles will play additional games, which will provide significant revenue opportunities. Postseason revenues do not need to be quantified by the interviewee.

Evanston Eagles

Part 6

6. Provide client recommendation

- “The general manager just invited us to join her in the owner’s luxury suite at tonight’s home game and wants to talk over your final recommendation. What will you tell her?”
- To give themselves the best chance of making the playoffs, the Evanston Eagles should pursue surgical repair of Tripp Richmond’s torn ankle tendon
 - Exhibit A and subsequent analysis indicates that if Richmond does not return this season, the Eagles will not make playoffs
 - Exhibit B and subsequent analysis indicates that surgical repair of Richmond’s injury will result in an expected increase of 4.8 wins compared to Richmond missing the remainder of the season
- Exhibit C and subsequent analysis indicates that pursuing surgical repair of Richmond’s injury will result in an estimated financial gain of \$3.5M compared to doing nothing and letting Richmond sit the remainder of the season
- Below are notable risks that the interviewee may mention in their recommendation (not exhaustive):

Risk	Next Step
20% possibility that Richmond is unable to return this season even after surgical treatment	Investigate promotions and pricing adjustments that will be profit-maximizing at lower attendance levels
Competitive decline makes the team a less desirable destination for top players and free agents	Ensure Richmond returns next season; Reevaluate roster to reduce reliance on a single star player
Disagreement between Eagles’ management and Richmond regarding appropriate response	Include Richmond (or proxy) in analysis and decision-making process
Fan and media criticism regarding injury response and anticipated competitive decline	Work with internal communications team to craft media response

Case 08

Events.com

Concepts tested

- Z14 Pricing strategy
- Z07 Market share

Primary sector(s)

- X13 Technology

Case type

- Y07 Profitability

Similar cases

- Maine Apples (Kellogg 2021)
- Montoya Soup (Kellogg 2018)

Case author(s): Alex Fabry (Kellogg 2020)

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client is Prospect Equity Partners ('Prospect'), a prominent Private Equity firm that invests in the technology space. They have recently acquired Events.com due to strong commercial wins and momentum in the market
- Events.com is a leading SaaS-based registration/ticketing platform for Endurance events (5K runs, Marathons, Triathlons, Mud Runs, etc.). They make money by taking registrations and processing payments for events and charging a fee per transaction (similar to Ticketmaster or Eventbrite) (\$100 registration price x 10% Fee = \$10 in Revenue for Events.com)
- Events.com has doubled market share since 2015, but in the last two years revenue is flat and profits are down, despite growing share. Prospect wants you to determine what is causing this and come up with a plan to improve profitability

Interviewer guide

- Problem: Are the costs associated with the DM program justified by the savings?
- This case is about a PE-portfolio company in Tech that has been undergoing a decline in profitability, despite commercial wins and market share growth. Events.com made a pricing change that has harmed profitability and needs to make a change
 1. Analyze profitability issues
 2. Identify root cause of issue
 3. Quantify price change impact
 4. Provide client recommendation

Fit: What has been the most risky project that you have worked on?

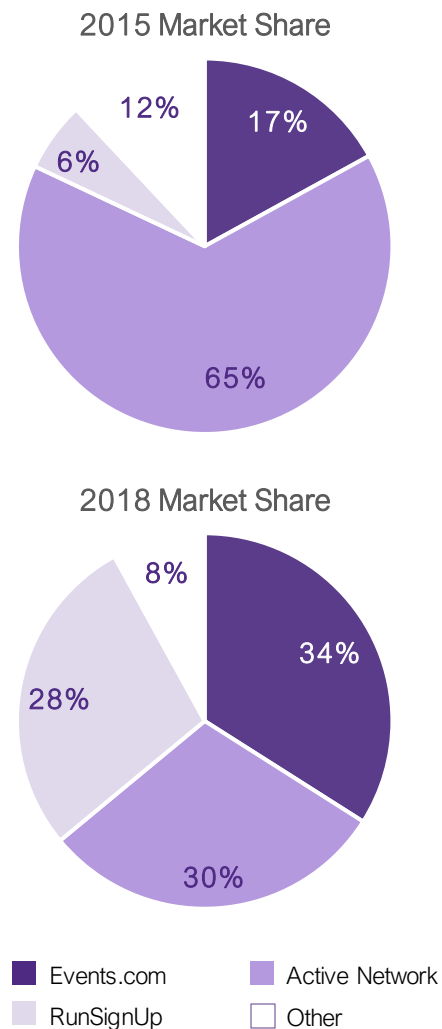
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- Events.com has doubled market share since 2015, but in the last two years revenue is flat and profits are down, despite growing share. Prospect wants you to determine what is causing this and come up with a plan to improve profitability

Clarifying information

- **Market:** The market has declined ~4% per year since 2015, driven by low participation in experiential runs like Color or Mud Runs
- **Competition:** Two main other players in space: Active Network and RunSignUp. No recent entrants.
- **Customers:** Customers are all in the US. Historically, local 5K events are targeted, but Events.com recently signed IRONMAN triathlon in Q4 2017, which has \$125M in transaction volume per year, and other premium events
- **Product:** The product platform is called EventWorks Endurance, and has been around for 10+ years
- **Company:** No changes have been made to company since being acquired by Prospect

Exhibit A – Historical P&L and Market Share



\$m	2015	2016	2017	2018
Revenue	25.0	35.0	39.9	39.9
Variable Costs				
Payment Processing Costs	3.3	4.7	8.0	11.9
Server Hosting Costs	3.8	5.3	4.8	4.8
Total Variable Costs	7.1	9.9	12.8	16.7
Fixed Costs				
Headcount	5.0	5.3	5.5	5.5
Marketing	1.5	1.7	1.8	2.0
SG&A / Other Costs	2.0	2.1	2.2	2.2
Total Fixed Expenses	8.5	9.0	9.5	9.7
Operating Income	9.4	16.1	17.6	13.5
Operating Income Margin	38%	46%	44%	34%

Exhibit B – Payment Processing Breakdown

	2017	2018
Number of events	4,023	5,051
Total registrations	8.0M	7.9M
Dollars processed	\$399M	\$595M
Events.com Revenue	\$39.9M	\$39.9M
Payment Processing Expenses	\$8.0M	\$11.9M

Exhibit C – Pricing Structure

Old Pricing Structure	
Fee per transaction	10.0%

New Pricing Structure		
	Price under \$50	Price over \$50
Fixed fee per transaction	\$3.00	\$5.50

Part 1

1. Analyze profitability issues

Provide Exhibit A when asked about Profitability (or revenue/costs)

- Using Exhibit A, have a discussion around what is driving the decline in profitability
-
- Interviewee should note that market share growth is from stealing share from Active Network, but largely ignore the share data
 - Interviewee should focus on 2017 and 2018 and notice that payment processing costs have increased drastically, hypothesizing that is due to an increase in processing volume or processing rate (since this is a variable expense), and ask for more information on payment processing
 - Interviewee should ignore other expenses, as the growth is not material

Part 2

2. Identify root cause of issue

Provide Exhibit B when about Payment Processing Costs or Revenue

- Provide the additional information along with the exhibit:
 - Price per Registration declined as higher priced customers (smaller events with fewer total registrations) were acquired (Ironman Triathlon) and lower priced customers did not renew
 - If interviewee is stuck, start a discussion about pricing and how it affects revenue, and have the interviewee calculate the payment processing rate, average fee, and average price per registration in 2017 and 2018.
 - Interviewee should now isolate whether the processing costs increase is driven by rate or volume, and should calculate the processing rate to confirm (Payment Processing Expenses / \$'s Processed)
-
- 2017: $\$8\text{m} / \$399\text{m} = 2\%$; 2018: $\$11.9\text{m} / \$595\text{m} = 2\%$
 - Interviewee should now realize cost increase is driven by volume and that registrations and volume are up, although revenue is down, leading to analysis of the components of revenue
 - Avg. fee rate (Revenue / \$'s Processed):
 - 2017 = 10%; 2018 = 6.7%
 - Price per registration (\$'s Processed/Registrations):
 - 2017 = \$50; 2018 = \$75

Part 3

3. Quantify price change impact

Provide Exhibit C when asked about Pricing

- Provide the additional information along with the exhibit:
 - Pricing was changed due to competitive pressure
- Interviewee should realize that pricing was changed from variable (10% fee) to a tiered fixed fee pricing, and as the price per registration increased, this caused revenue to be flat, despite acquiring customers
- Candidate should realize 'Over \$50' pricing should be changed, and when prompted, let interviewee know that customer surveys have indicated that a 2.25% "Credit Card Fee" can be added to "Over \$50" tier with negligible customer losses, and that ~\$375m of volume is over \$50
- Interviewee should now calculate revenue increase from adding 2.25% fee
 - $2.25\% * \$375m = \$8,437,500$
 - Do not allow rounding

Part 4

4. Provide client recommendation

- Interviewee should summarize that a change in pricing to fixed fee tiered pricing caused revenue to remain flat and profitability to decline. They should recommend adding a 2.25% variable fee to the 'Over \$30m', which will add ~\$8.4m of revenue and profitability
- Risks: Additional increases to average price per registration, customer reaction to pricing increases
- Next Steps: Roll-out strategy for pricing change, investigation of ways to further change pricing to guard against additional increases in average price per registrations (add additional pricing tiers, customer/market research to figure out customer willingness to pay, etc.); Could look at targeting new sets of lower priced customers; consider acquiring RunSignUp to take over strong market position and stratify offerings; or exiting market due to its decline.
- **Excellent interviewees** demonstrate the ability to analyze a P&L and think through how variable costs and revenues are related, along with testing brainstorming on pricing strategy.
- **Outstanding candidates** will quickly focus on the correct items in the P&L and make the connections between pricing, revenue, and variable costs and how that has eroded profitability, despite being the market share leader.

Case 09

Garthwaite Healthcare

Interviewer-led

Concepts tested

- Z12 Creativity (2)
- Z15 Supply/value chain (4)
- Z16 Vertical integration (4)

Primary sector(s)

- X08 Healthcare

Case type

- Y07 Profitability

Similar cases

- Mustard Clinic (Kellogg 2021)
- Insurance for Underserved (Wharton 2017)

Case author(s): Aaron Mowery (Kellogg 2013)
Edited by: Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020)



Garthwaite Healthcare

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client is Garthwaite Healthcare Co (GHC), a health insurance firm located in the Midwest.
- Customers pay GHC a fixed monthly premium per person covered under the plan. In exchange, GHC pays for all health services that each member requires (eg. physician care, prescription medications, hospitalization).
- In recent years, GHC's financial and competitive position has begun to decline, and the CEO has retained our firm to help them determine what is causing the problem and how to fix it.

Interviewer guide

- Problem: How can GHC reduce its total cost to serve its policy holders?
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Brainstorm medical cost sources and solutions
 3. Calculate administrative costs
 4. Develop commission sharing arrangement
 5. Provide client recommendation

Garthwaite Healthcare

Experience: Tell me about a time when you had to come up with a creative solution for a problem.

Case prompt

- Our client is Garthwaite Healthcare Co (GHC), a health insurance firm located in the Midwest.
- Customers pay GHC a fixed monthly premium per person covered under the plan. In exchange, GHC pays for all health services that each member requires (eg. physician care, prescription medications, hospitalization).
- In recent years, GHC's financial and competitive position has begun to decline, and the CEO has retained our firm to help them determine what is causing the problem and how to fix it.

Provide all Clarifying information even if the interviewee does not request it

Clarifying information

Client Characteristics

- GHC is a mutual insurance company, meaning profits are returned to members in the form of lower premiums the following year. As such, GHC does not seek to maximize profit – it seeks to minimize cost, but does expect to earn a 5% profit margin.
- GHC's prices reflect underwriting of risk and the underlying cost to serve a customer

Competitive Dynamics

- Market share is steady, despite presence of major national health insurance company UHC (which has 30% share)

Industry Economics

- National medical cost inflation is 10% over the past 5 years. GHC's cost increase in this period is 12% and UHC's is 10%.

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

- The interviewee should lay out a structure for analyzing the case.
- The interviewee could have determined that revenue is not relevant to this case based on information given in the Case prompt, so the interviewee should focus on cost.
- Costs in this case break out into fixed costs and variable costs:
 - Variable costs (medical costs – claims made by policyholders)
 - Fixed costs (administrative costs – e.g., marketing & sales, underwriting, finance, HR)
- Specifically, we will need to understand how these costs have changed in recent years.

Part 2

2. Brainstorm medical cost sources and solutions

- Medical costs are the largest component of GHC's costs. However, GHC's medical costs are increasing faster than the national average. What are some potential reasons why this is taking place? What potential opportunities could you explore to reverse this trend?
-
- Medical cost = (Number of claims per customer) x (Number of claimants) x (Cost per claim)

	Number of claims per customer	Number of claimants (% of customers claiming)	Cost per claim
Problems	GHC customers sicker on average	- GHC customers older than average - Low deductibles incentivize more claims on average	GHC pays more per procedure than average
Solutions	- Enhance wellness programs - Introduce pre-enrollment diagnosis diagnosis to improve cost estimates	- Increase marketing efforts toward younger customers - Increase deductibles	Conduct benchmarking study to determine competitors' costs

Part 3

3. Calculate administrative costs

- GHC administrative costs are also higher than average. The biggest driver of this is high cost of sales. GHC policies are sold through independent agents, each of which works with a 'General Agency' that acts as a sales support organization.
 - How much does GHC pay in commissions each year?
 - What are some potential approaches GHC could take to reduce its cost of sales?
 - What potential strategic issues exist with these approaches?
- After interviewee explains how they would calculate commission expense, provide the below:
- Commission (10% of annual premiums) is paid to the General Agency, which passes a share to the independent agent. Total commission paid is, on average, \$25 per agent, per month. There are 500,000 agents.

- Total commission expense = $\$25 * 500,000 * 12 = \$150,000,000$

Approaches	Issues
• Reduce commission percentage • Cap commission to a certain level per year • Change commissions from percent of premium to flat fee (% increases annually with inflation)	• Agents could shift business from GHC to another carrier that pays higher commission • Agents would lose incentive to sell if their commission is capped

Part 4

4. Develop commission sharing arrangement

- The team has decided to pay a flat commission directly to agents, and to pay the General Agencies a separate fee for the support services they provide to agents. If the total commission paid to both parties is set at \$20 per member per month, what share should be given to the General Agencies?
- If interviewee asks, explain they should find the maximum amount that should be allocated to the General Agencies.

Additional information

- General Agencies perform three activities: training, application processing, and performance management.
- If GHC were to perform these activities internally, they would cost:
 - Training: \$6,000,000
 - Application processing: \$9,000,000
 - Performance management: \$15,000,000

Potential approach

- The total cost of the activities that General agencies perform is \$30,000,000 ($= \$6,000,000 + \$9,000,000 + \$15,000,000$).
- There are 500,000 members and 12 months in a year.
- The maximum amount of money GHC should be willing to pay the General Agencies for the activities performed is the per member, per month cost of these activities ($\$30,000,000 / (500,000 \times 12) = \5

Part 5

5. Provide client recommendation

- Taking into account what you've learned thus far as well as your own additional hypotheses, what initiatives would you recommend to the CEO at this point?
-
- Our client should take action to reduce both medical costs and administrative costs.
 - At this point, the interviewee should synthesize the findings from the interview into several clear initiatives, for example:
 - Enhance marketing efforts to attract more young customers and bring down the average claims per member.
 - Conduct a benchmarking study to determine opportunities for reductions in payments for medical services.
 - Change the commission structure to flat fee per member per month. This achieves the goal of reducing commission expense, while at the same time keeping an agent's incentive to sell more business.
 - **Strong interviewees** will demonstrate the ability to analyze issues using a clear structure and will draw out the implications of their analysis. The quantitative calculations in this case are elementary, but the process to get to them is somewhat more complicated

Case 10

Health Coaches

Concepts tested

- Z10 Customer strategy (2)
- Z08 Market sizing (3)
- Z12 Creativity (4)

Primary sector(s)

- X08 Healthcare

Case type

- Y05 Operations
- Y06 Opportunity assessment

Similar cases

- Mustard Clinic (Kellogg 2021)
- TV Screens (Wharton 2017)
- Vitality Insurance (Kellogg 2021)

{ Case author(s): David Wellner (Kellogg 2011)
Edited By: Craig DePriester (Kellogg 2012), Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020) }

Health Coaches

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client is a large national healthcare payer (health insurance company, think Aetna) exploring the launch of a new disease management ('DM') program to better serve its 5 million members.
- The idea is to hire and train a team of 'Health Coaches' to manage a portfolio of patients to reduce the costs of overall health expenditures (eg. reminders to take drugs, provide limited medical advice, suggested diet, exercise etc). Studies show that once a month contact with each patient reduces health spending by 5% on average.
- Should our client launch the program? If so, what steps should it take?

Interviewer guide

- Problem: Are the costs associated with the DM program justified by the savings?
- Problem solving steps
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Explore market segmentation
 3. Calculate program profitability
 4. Brainstorm other ideas to boost profitability
 5. Provide client recommendation

Health Coaches

Fit: Tell me about a project where you used your problem solving skills.

Case prompt

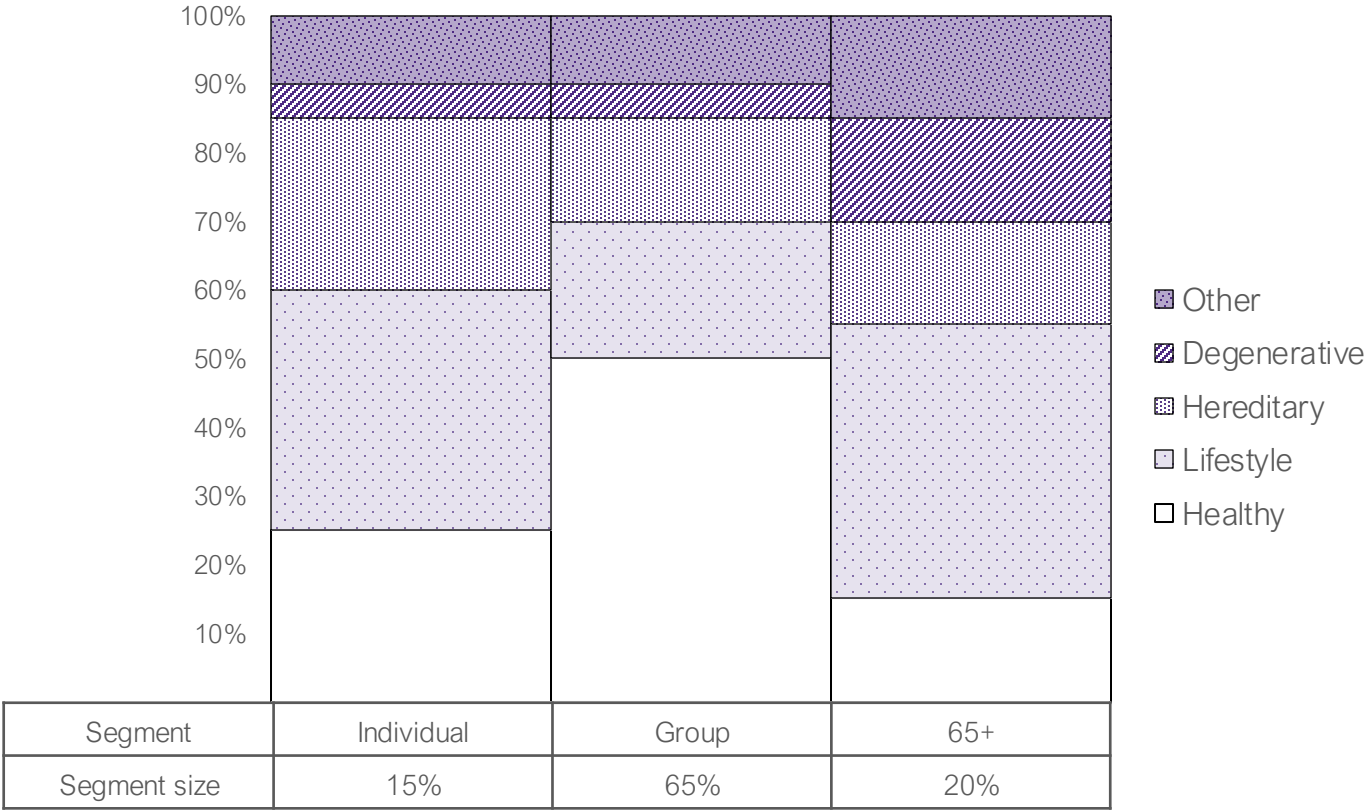
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- Should our client launch the program? If so, what steps should it take?

Clarifying information

- **Industry:** The whole industry is under pressure to innovate new products that will control spending
- **Company:** Assume client is first to market
- **Operations:** Past attempts to purely automate DM have yielded minimal savings
- **Health Coaches:** All activity conducted remotely via phone/email, typically by a nurse that wants to work from home
- **Patients:** It's difficult to actually reach patients, so Coaches can contact 8 members per day (assume 25 days per month)
- **Costs:** Annual costs per Coach: \$60K salary +20% other (training, benefits, laptop, etc.). There are no other program costs

Health Coaches

Exhibit A – Client’s member segmentation by disease type



Health Coaches

Exhibit B – Average cost data

	Average cost PMPM*		
Segment	Lifestyle	Hereditary	Degenerative
Individual	\$600	\$150	\$150
Group	\$400	\$100	\$100
65+	\$1,200	\$300	\$300

*Notes:

- PMPM = Per Member Per Month

Health Coaches

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

- The interviewee should drive towards quantifying the savings
- Consideration of qualitative issues is ideal.

Program Savings	Program Costs	Risks
• Customer segmentation by disease area and cost per member	• Communication systems • Health Coach Salary • Training	• Assumption accuracy • Competitive response • Regulatory, liabilities

Health Coaches

Part 2

2. Explore market segmentation

Provide Exhibit A when the interviewee asks about segments or disease areas

- Group are employee sponsored plans (e.g. ,if you work for our consultancy, you are in a group plan), Individual are non-groups (eg. private contractors, unemployed, etc). 65+ (see note below chart).
 - Which disease area should we look at first?
- Interviewee should choose to focus on the 65+ segment
 - 65+ patients are the sickest,
 - Sicker patients are likely to drive higher costs
 - Higher costs provides greatest benefit for DM
- Interviewee should choose to focus on lifestyle diseases
 - Lifestyle diseases make up the largest portion of sick members
 - As diseases primarily brought on by behavior, this segment is likely to benefit from DM
- Number of 65+ lifestyle = 20% segment x 40% lifestyle x 5m members = 400,000

Health Coaches

Part 3

3. Calculate program profitability

Provide Exhibit B when the interviewee asks about medical costs

- Note: lead with Exhibit A. If the interviewee leads with profitability, steer him/her to first think about customer segmentation.
 - What can we do with this information?
-
- Cost per Coach = \$60k base + 20% = \$72k
 - Size of Portfolio = 8 patients per day x 25 days per month = 200 patients per year
 - Savings for one portfolio = \$1,200 cost per month x 12 months per year x 5% average savings x 200 patients = \$144k
 - Overall savings = (\$144k savings - \$72k costs) x 2,000 coaches = \$144m profit per year
 - Takeaway: Profit is \$72K per Health Coach (double the cost of a coach)
 - Based on PMPM lifestyle cost data, Individual segment is break-even (50% less savings), Group segment is a loss

Health Coaches

Part 4

4. Brainstorm other ideas to boost profitability

- There are 650,000 Group members with lifestyle diseases left 'uncoached.' Is there a way to make the segment profitable?

More efficient DM program	Seek additional revenue sources	Client selection
• Coaching at work • Bi-monthly contact • Automated correspondence • Better training for Health Coaches	• Employers might be willing to pay a fee to enroll in service • Government support as a state-approved or sponsored program	• Target members who will respond with savings well above 5%

Health Coaches

Part 5

5. Provide client recommendation

- Client should launch the Health Coaching program, and first focus on lifestyle diseases in the 65+ segment
 - Launch a pilot program to prove out assumptions (eg. 5% cost reduction, Coach portfolio capacity, etc.)
 - First expand to entire 65+ lifestyle segment (\$144M per year savings per coach, a 2x return on each Health Coach)
 - Consider introducing to Individual lifestyle segment despite break-even (customer retention, moral rationale, etc.)

As first to the market, client plans to expand Health Coach program externally. Who should they target?

- The program yields the greatest savings in the 65+ lifestyle disease segment. However, the client should keep in mind that more lifestyle members will increase overall health care costs, considerably (still almost 4x after savings).
- As an alternative, the client could sell its Health Coach service to other payers.

-
- **Excellent interviewees** should use common sense to make reasonable assumptions before you provide required inputs.
 - **Outstanding interviewees** are able to keep track of all units from a math perspective.

Case 11

Healthy Foods

Concepts tested

- Z10 Customer strategy (2)
- Z10 Marketing strategy (2, 3, 4)
- Z12 Creativity (3)

Primary sector(s)

- X12 Retail & CPG

Case type

- Y02 Growth Strategy

Similar cases

- Dark Sky (Kellogg 2021)



Case authors: Milija Medic
Edited By: Mauricio Atri (Kellogg 2012), Tuhina Kapoor (Kellogg 2020)



Healthy Foods

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client is Healthy Foods, a wholesaler serving a variety of clients with Food products. The client is profitable but they want you to help them find revenue growth opportunities from their current business.
- How can we help Healthy Foods drive their revenue growth?

Interviewer guide

- Problem: How can Healthy Foods increase revenue?
- Problem solving steps:
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Identify main customer types and their current contributions
 3. Analyze client's wallet share for different customers
 4. Share of Wallet analysis and Wallet Size versus Share of Wallet
 5. Provide client recommendation

Healthy Foods

Fit: Tell me about a time you had to lead a diverse team?

Case prompt

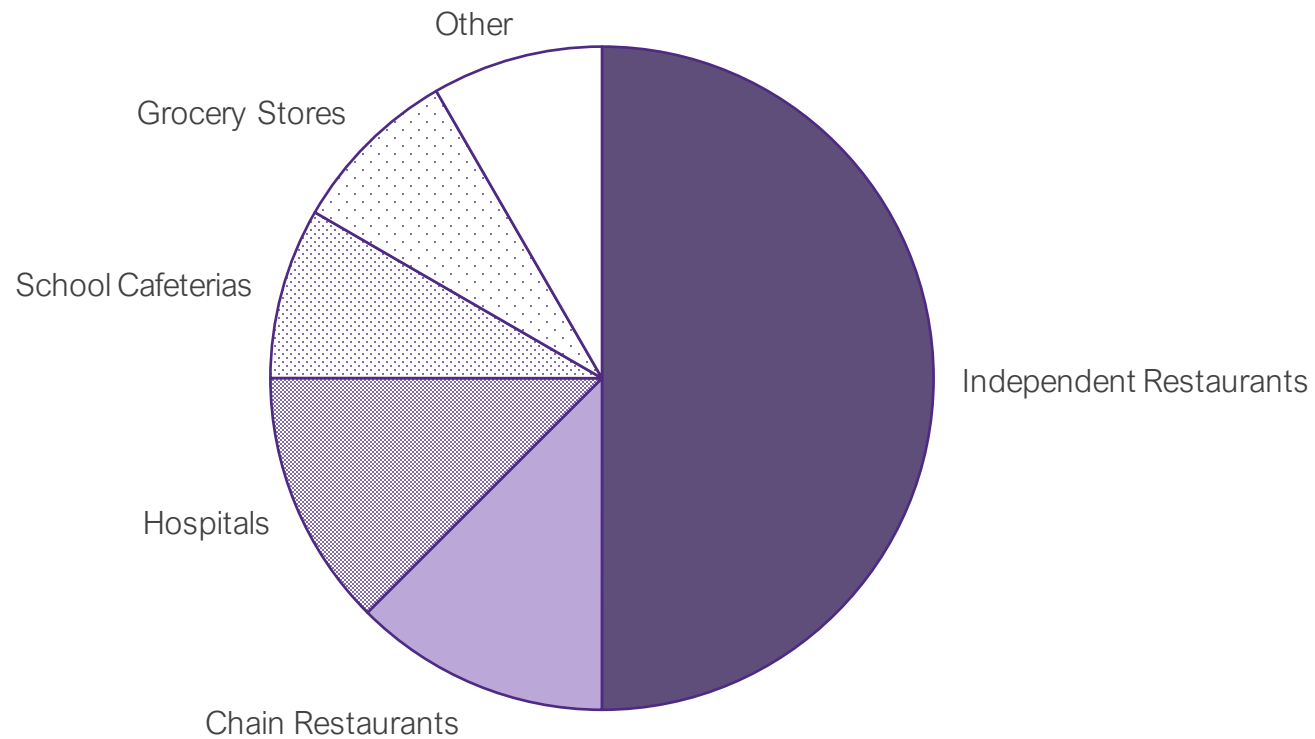
- Our client is Healthy Foods, a wholesaler serving a variety of clients with Food products. The client is profitable but they want you to help them find revenue growth opportunities from their current business.
- How can we help Healthy Foods drive their revenue growth?

Clarifying information

- **Customers:** The client serves various customer categories (shown in Exhibit A).
- **Customer sensitivities are (highest to lowest):**
 - Price
 - Convenient delivery
 - Help with location planning
 - Help with menu
 - Web site development
 - Inventory
 - Help with management optimization
- **Competition:** The client is one of the market leaders and is not losing the market share

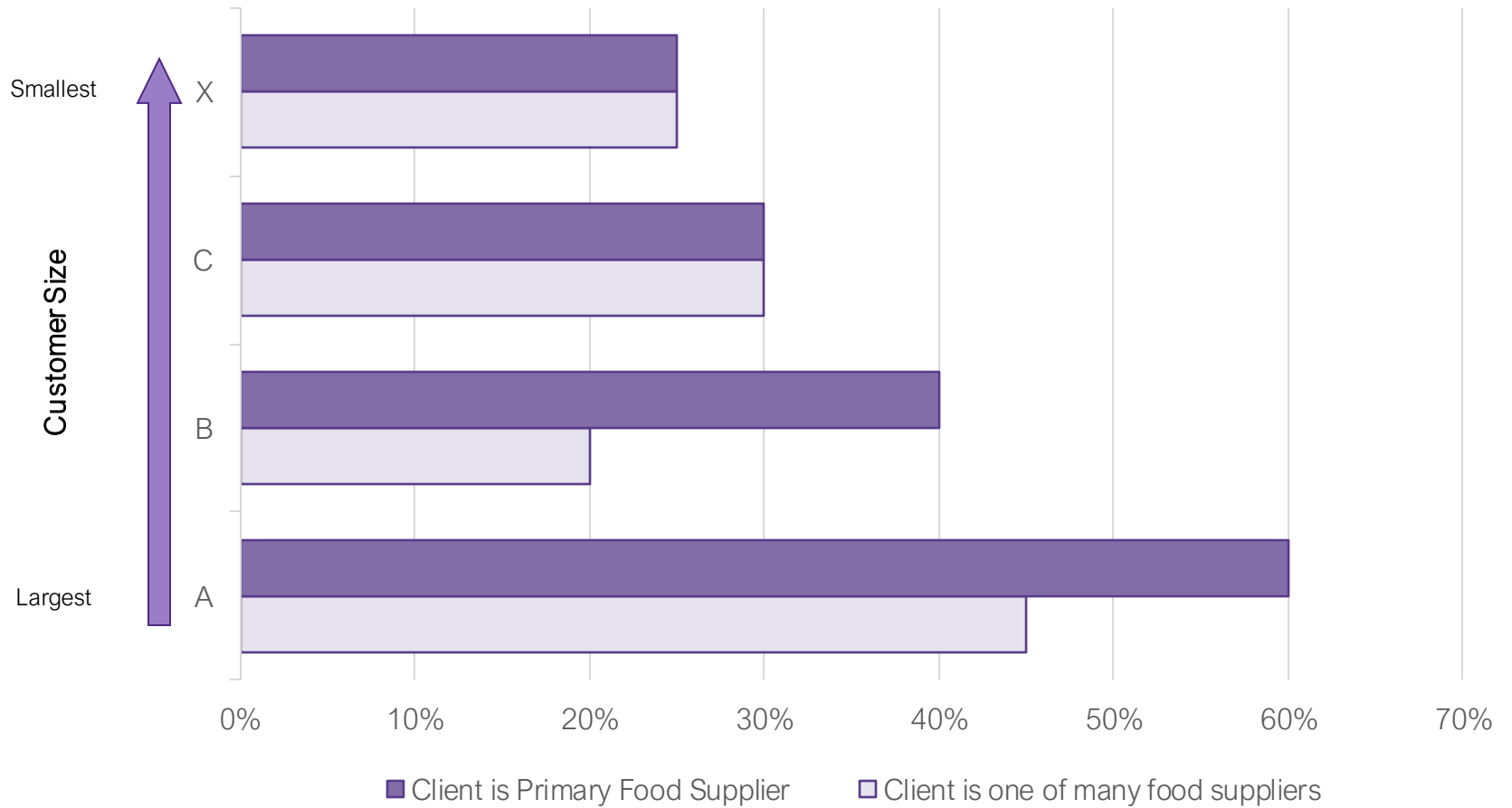
Healthy Foods

Exhibit A – Revenues by Customer Type



Healthy Foods

Exhibit B – Client's Share of Wallet



Healthy Foods

Exhibit C – Wallet Size vs. Share of Wallet for the Smaller-Revenue-Generating Customer Categories



Healthy Foods

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

- A structure should cover the key areas needed to explore in order to determine how Healthy Foods can explore new revenue growth opportunities. Key elements expected to be included in this framework are:
- **Market:** Overall trends, offerings by competitors and customer preferences
- **Segmentation, targeting and positioning:** Are there particular segments in the population that will be ideal customers for us? How are positioned in the market?
- **Product and channel mix:** What is our current mix of products offered and what markets and channels do we service? What is the menu?
- **Price:** What price are our products sold at? Is there scope for increasing the price? Can we bundle any of our offerings?
- **Promotion:** How are our products marketed? What promotion mechanisms are being used?
- **Volume:** Who are our customers? How do we reach them? What is our wallet share with them?

Healthy Foods

Part 2

2. Identify main customer types and their current contributions

- The client has some information about the customer segments that it sells to:

Provide Exhibit A

-
- The interviewee will probably explore opportunities for growth in the independent restaurant category. If they inquire about customer satisfaction and sensitivities, provide information from the 'Clarifying information' section, and emphasize that the needs of this segment are already met.
 - The interviewee should inquire about the Share of Wallet in the customer categories to get a better idea on where the growth opportunities lie.

Healthy Foods

Part 3

3. Analyze client's wallet share for different customers

Provide Exhibit B when the interviewee realizes they need to understand Share of Wallet

- The interviewee should recognize that Share of Wallet in the highest-revenue-generating customer categories is already high, and that the client is already a key provider for a lot of them.
- Ask the interviewees to list all options to increase revenue and the reasons behind (brainstorming exercise).
- Help interviewee to reach that the growth opportunity in the smaller revenue-generating customers, where client's Share of Wallet is smaller. Now the interviewee should formulate the criteria to prioritize among the smaller revenue-generating customer types: the bigger their Share of Wallet and the smaller client's Share of Wallet, the better.

Part 4

4. Share of Wallet analysis and Wallet Size versus Share of Wallet

- Share Exhibit C when the interviewee realizes they will need to understand the Share of Wallet vis-à-vis Wallet Size

Provide Exhibit C

- The bigger the Size of Wallet and the smaller client's Share of Wallet, the larger the revenue growth opportunity for the client.
- Using Exhibit C, the interviewee should identify the hospitals and the hotels as the most promising candidates for revenue growth given their large wallets and small client's Share of Wallet. The interviewee should identify the strongest sensitivities these clients would have and suggest ways to increase client's Share of Wallet there.

Part 5

5. Provide client recommendation

- In the current business, the largest growth opportunities lie in customer segments: hospitals and hotels.
 - The interviewee should suggest ways to better serve those customers and increase client's Share of Wallet there, capturing significant new revenues due to the large Wallet Size of those clients.
-
- Excellent interviewees identify Share of Wallet as an important parameter, quickly recognize that there is little opportunity for growth in the largest-revenue-generating customers, and come up with the size of wallet vs. Share of Wallet plot as a good prioritization tool for identifying promising customer categories for the client's revenue growth.

Case 12

High Q Plastics

Concepts tested

- Z11 Competitive Analysis
- Z12 Creativity

Primary sector(s)

- X04 Engineering & Construction

Case type

- Y01 Cost reduction
- Y05 Operations
- Y07 Profitability

Similar cases



Case Authors: Erin Brooks (Kellogg 2011)
Edited By: Uri Kalir (Kellogg 2012), Tuhina Kapoor (Kellogg 2020)



High Q Plastics

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client, High Q Plastics, is an automotive parts supplier in the U.S. They primarily manufacture and sell plastic injection-molded parts, such as grills, door handles, decorative trim etc., to automotive customers.
- The client has two primary revenue sources: large automotive OEMs, and aftermarket. The client has recently seen declining profits, primarily due to increased price competition from new overseas competitors in China. Annual profits have declined from \$50M to \$20M over the past few years.
- *What is the reason behind declining profitability? How can High Q improve profits? Can they reach \$100M in profits by 2014?*

Interviewer guide

- Problem: How can High Q generate \$100m in profits by 2014?
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Brainstorm ideas to improve profits
 3. Determine whether the profit goal can be met
 4. Provide client recommendation
- An effective interviewee should demonstrate clear and MECE approach at dissecting profitability, structured brainstorming in improving profits (e.g., brainstorming in buckets) and effectively using exhibits to outline the correct approach to calculating 2014 profits.

High Q Plastics

Fit: Tell me about a time you had to navigate a conflict and come up with a creative solution.

Case prompt

- Our client, High Q Plastics, is an automotive parts supplier in the U.S. They primarily manufacture and sell plastic injection-molded parts, such as grills, door handles, decorative trim etc., to automotive customers.
- The client has two primary revenue sources: large automotive OEMs, and aftermarket. The client has recently seen declining profits, primarily due to increased price competition from new overseas competitors in China. Annual profits have declined from \$50M to \$20M over the past few years.
- *What is the reason behind declining profitability? How can High Q improve profits? Can they reach \$100M in profits by 2014?*

Clarifying information

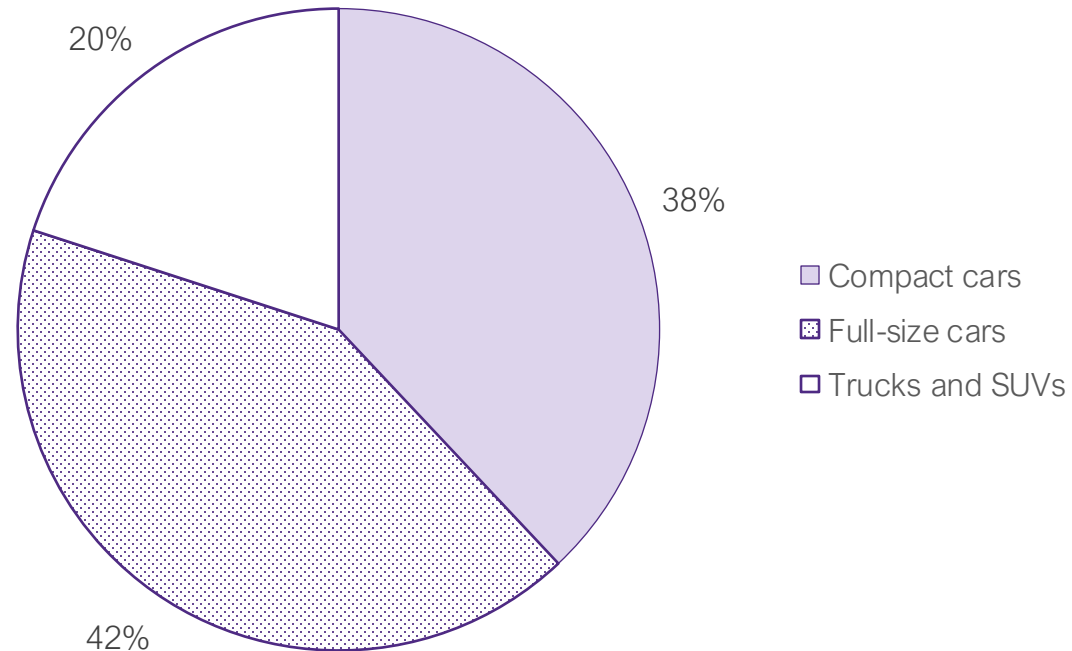
- **Industry Characteristics/Market Economics**
 - Automotive sales overall still growing steadily, driven by emerging markets
 - Automotive manufacturing is leaving the U.S.
- **Client Characteristics**
 - Client is currently one of the leaders in this category
 - Client has U.S.-based manufacturing
 - Revenues have been slowly declining over last 5 years
 - Client's products are of a higher quality than most Chinese competitors' products
- **Competitive Dynamics**
 - Automotive OEM customers are looking to reduce cost, driving increased price competition among parts suppliers

High Q Plastics

Exhibit A – High Q's 2010 Financials, By Facility

\$m	Plant A	Plant B	Plant C	Plant D
Revenues	100	100	100	100
Labor	20	40	60	30
Material	55	40	20	35
Overhead	20	15	15	30
Net Profits	5	5	5	5

Exhibit B – 2010 U.S. Automotive Market

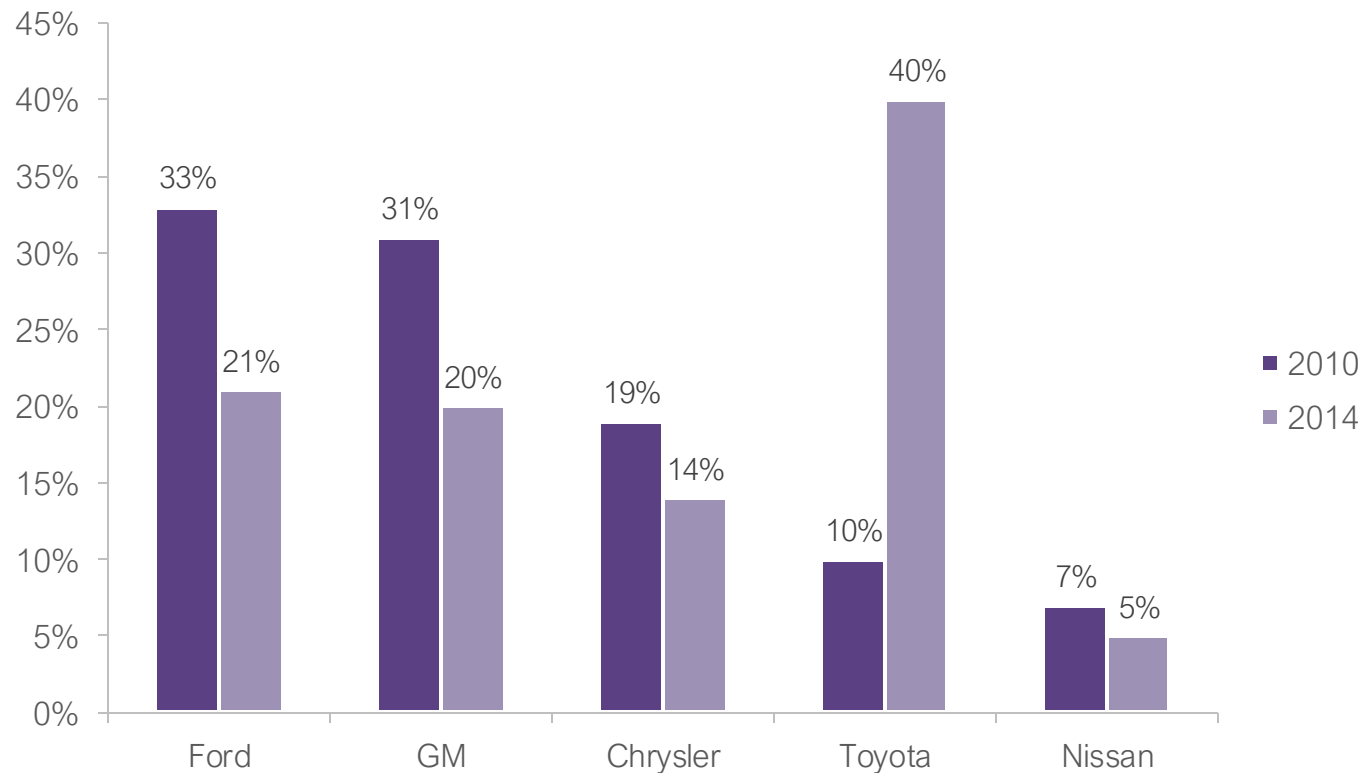


Additional Information:

- 2010 US Automotive Sales = 16 million units

High Q Plastics

Exhibit C – U.S. Truck / SUV Market Share (2010 – 2014)



Additional information:

- High Q supplies 70% of Toyota's business
- Average price of High Q products sold to Toyota = \$20

High Q Plastics

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

What key questions would you ask an industry expert in order to better understand the reasons behind High Q's declining profits?

An effective structure should address the following factors:

- **Industry:** What is the sales volume trend? What is the % of demand and growth of OEM vs. aftermarket segment? Is one of these segments more profitable than the other?
- **Competitors:** Who are they? What is their relative market share? What are their prices vs. our clients'? What is their cost structure vs. our clients'? Do they have a technology or quality competitive advantage relative to our client?
- **Revenue:** How have our clients' prices changed in recent years? Have they declined across all customers and products?
- **Costs:** What trends is our client seeing in their cost structure? Increasing labor or material costs?

High Q Plastics

Part 2

2. Brainstorm ideas to improve profits

The CEO of High Q wants to know if \$100M in annual profits is achievable by 2014. What would you need to know in order to determine this? What data would you ask for?

What ways can you think of to increase revenues? What ways can you think of to reduce costs?

After asking the interviewee the above questions, he / she should come up with 2-3 ways each for cost reduction and increasing revenues:

- **Reduce Cost:** find alternative material sources, invest in process automation to reduce labor, consolidate multiple manufacturing sites to reduce SG&A costs, relocate close to customers to reduce transportation costs.
- **Increase Revenue:** segment customers to determine sensitivity to price, increase marketing in aftermarket segment, negotiate long-term contracts with OEM customers.

High Q Plastics

Part 3

3. Determine whether the profit goal can be met

Our client is planning on implementing lean manufacturing across all 4 of its U.S. plants, in order to provide cost savings and increase profits.

Provide Exhibit A

- The client is expecting to produce 80% of 2010 volumes in 2014. They are also planning on reducing prices by 10% due to increased competition.
 - Lean manufacturing implementation across all plants will provide an additional 20% savings in raw material, and 30% savings in labor. What is the change in profits the High Q CEO can expect from 2010 to 2014, based on this information?
-
- Please see solution on the next page.

High Q Plastics

Part 3 (Continued)

3. Determine whether the profit goal can be met

- The interviewee should use the information provided in Exhibit A to calculate the following profitability for each plant in 2014, and walk the interviewer through the calculation steps. It is important to first note that revenues, labor, and material will decrease by 20% due to the reduced quantity output from each plant, plus the additional 20% savings in material and 30% in labor. Revenue will decrease by an additional 10%, in a cost cutting maneuver. Overhead costs will not change.

All figures in \$m				
	Plant A	Plant B	Plant C	Plant D
Revenues	72.0	72.0	72.0	72.0
Labor	11.2	22.4	33.6	16.8
Material	35.2	25.6	12.8	22.4
Overhead	20.0	15.0	15.0	30.0
Net Profits	5.6	9.0	10.6	2.8
Total 2014 Profits				28.0
Additional Profits				8.0

- From this calculation, the interviewee should reference back to question 2. Even with the lean manufacturing implementation, High Q is still a long way from the CEO's goal of \$100M in annual profits, and this is therefore not a realistic target. A strong interviewee should note the importance of aligning a client's expectations.

High Q Plastics

Part 3 (Continued)

3. Determine whether the profit goal can be met

- High Q 's CEO has also asked us to take a look at competitive dynamics among the automotive OEMs, in order to predict any increase in profits from increased sales. Hand out exhibits 2 and 3.
- Based on the information given, what do you expect High Q will see in additional profits due to Toyota's predicted 30% increase in market share in truck and SUVs?

Provide Exhibit B & C

The interviewee should be able to use the information provided in the Exhibits to calculate the following revenue growth ("Sales" figures below are in units/vehicles). Rounded answers (\$13 or \$14M) are fine, given that interviewee has already demonstrate math proficiency.

	2010	2014
US Auto Market	16,000,000	
U.S. Truck & SUV Sales	3,200,000	
Toyota Truck & SUV Sales	320,000	1,280,000
High Q's Toyota Qty. Sold	224,000	896,000
High Q's Toyota Revenues	4,480,000	17,920,000
Additional Revenue		\$13,440,000

Part 4

4. Provide client recommendation

Please summarize your findings to the CEO, including any other potential opportunities to increase High Q's profits over the next few years.

The interviewee should concisely summarize the overall goal of the case (to increase High Q's declining profitability due to new, low-cost competition), and main findings from each question, and a recommendation (yes, High Q should implement the lean manufacturing initiative, while recognizing that this initiative alone will not hit the CEO's total profit goal in 2014). The interviewee should also generate a list of additional opportunities that were not explored in the case, including:

- a) Consolidation of the 4 manufacturing plants (especially Plant D, with its high overhead costs)
- b) Pursue growth in the aftermarket segment of their business
- c) Diversify their business into plastic injection-molded parts for other industries (outside of automotive), with less price competition

Case 13

Kellogg Capital

Interviewer-led

Concepts tested

- Z08 Market sizing (2A)
- Z04 Capacity (2B)
- Z12 Creativity (2B)
- Z14 Pricing strategy (3)
- Z07 Market Share (4)

Primary sector(s)

- X06 Financial Services

Case type

- Y02 Growth strategy
- Y04 New product / Market entry

Similar cases

- Institutional Asset Manager Fees (Columbia 2006)
- Retirement Plan (Ross 2006)
- Credit Card Processor (Ross 2012)

Case author: Eli Derrow (Kellogg '21)
Edited By: AnnaClare Smith (Kellogg '22)

Kellogg Capital

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- The Chief Strategy and Innovation Officer of Kellogg Capital, an Evanston-based asset management firm, has retained you to help with her top priority of the year (2021).
- Kellogg Capital has amassed \$5 billion in assets under management (AUM) since its founding in 2015. However, despite stellar investment performance of their active investment strategies, Kellogg Capital's growth, as defined by revenue, is plateauing.
- What **new**, profitable opportunity should Kellogg Capital pursue to continue their growth?

Interviewer guide

- Problem: How can Kellogg Capital maintain its high revenue growth rate?
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 - 2A. Analyze the current customer and channel market
 - 2B. Brainstorm reasons why Kellogg Capital has not yet entered the retail market
 3. Analyze Kellogg Capital's current product mix
 4. Estimate revenue from new product launch
 5. Provide Chief Strategy and Innovation Officer recommendation

Kellogg Capital

Fit: Tell me about a time when you had to provide critical feedback to a team member or client.

Case prompt

- The Chief Strategy and Innovation Officer of Kellogg Capital, an Evanston-based asset management firm, has retained you to help with her top priority of the year (2021).
- Kellogg Capital has amassed \$5 billion in assets under management (AUM) since its founding in 2015. However, despite stellar investment performance of their active investment strategies, Kellogg Capital's growth, as defined by revenue, is plateauing.
- What **new**, profitable opportunity should Kellogg Capital pursue to continue their growth?

Clarifying content (1/2)

- **Products/Business Model:** Kellogg Capital has 3 investment products that investors can choose from. The 3 products have varying volatilities and asset mixes, but are similar in that they each have illiquid assets that require extended lock-up periods for clients. Kellogg Capital's only revenue source is the performance and management fees on AUM in their 3 products. *(A performance fee is a payment made to an investment manager for generating positive returns. This is as opposed to a management fee, which is charged without regard to returns. Management fees are the cost of having an investment fund professionally managed by an investment manager. Management fees structures are usually based on a percentage of AUM; they tend to range from 0.1% to more than 2% of AUM)*

Kellogg Capital

Fit: Tell me about a time when you had to provide critical feedback to a team member or client.

Case prompt

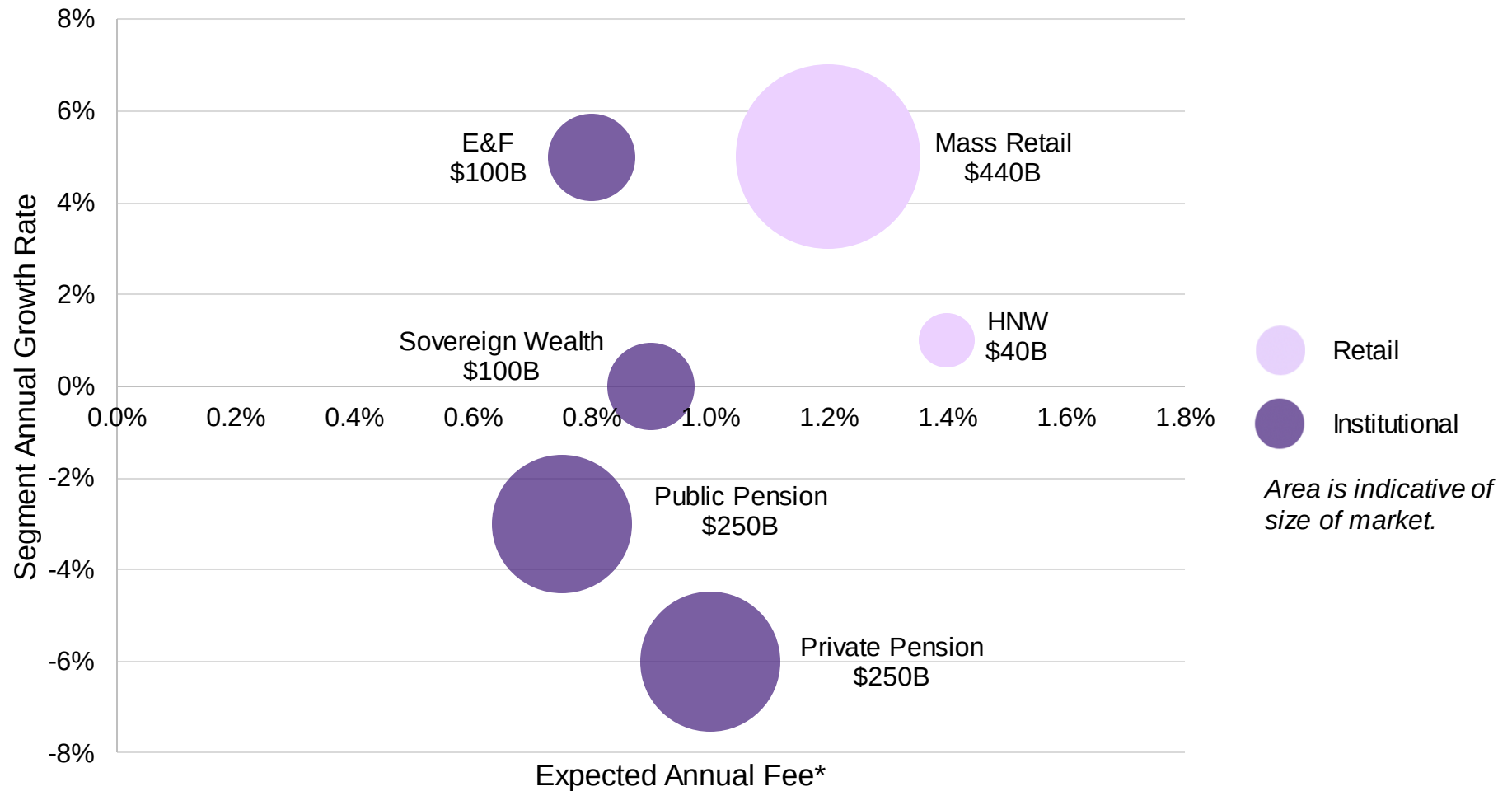
- The Chief Strategy and Innovation Officer of Kellogg Capital, an Evanston-based asset management firm, has retained you to help with her top priority of the year (2021).
- Kellogg Capital has amassed \$5 billion in assets under management (AUM) since its founding in 2015. However, despite stellar investment performance of their active investment strategies, Kellogg Capital's growth, as defined by revenue, is plateauing.
- What **new**, profitable opportunity should Kellogg Capital pursue to continue their growth?

Clarifying content (2/2)

- **Location/Customers:** Due to compliance concerns, Kellogg Capital only has offices in the U.S. and is only allowing investments from U.S.-based investors; they do not expect this to change. Further, Kellogg Capital currently only allows investments from pension funds, sovereign wealth funds (e.g. Texas Permanent School Fund), and endowments and foundations (E&Fs).
- **Competitive Dynamics:** Kellogg Capital competes against both active and passive asset managers, and does not want to change the fees on its current products for institutional clients. It is not looking to acquire any competitors.
- **Market:** The interviewee may want to find out more about the stock market performance. Say it is strong, or irrelevant, to the case.
- **Timeline and Goal:** The Chief Strategy and Innovation Officer is looking for medium-term (1+ year) growth opportunities, but hopes to double Kellogg Capital's 2020 revenue within 3 years. 2020 revenue was approximately \$50M.

Kellogg Capital

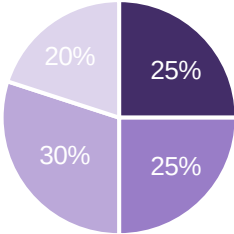
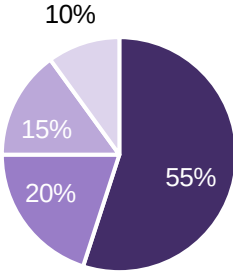
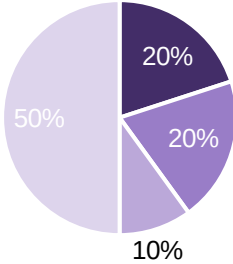
Exhibit A – Kellogg Capital Prospective U.S. Customers and Channels (2021)



*Annual fee is calculated as a blend of potential fee structures (e.g. the equivalent annual management fee expected from a performance fee) for similar products to those Kellogg Capital manages.

Kellogg Capital

Exhibit B – Kellogg Capital Current Products (As of 6/30/2021)

	Probability-Optimized Enhanced Trading Systematic Fund, L.P.	Purple Pride Fund, L.P.	Wildcat Investment Fund, L.P.
Current AUM	\$2.5 Billion	\$2 Billion	\$0.5 Billion
Annual Excess Performance Expectations	15%	10%	7.5%
Standard Fee	0.5% Mgmt. and 5% Performance	0.7% Mgmt. Fee and 5% Performance	0.75% Mgmt. Fee
Performance Allocation			

Stocks
 Bonds
 Commodities
 Illiquid Securities

Exhibit C – “Lite” Products Mass Retail 2024 Penetration: Probability Distribution

Expected Mass Retail Penetration	Probability-Optimized Enhanced Trading Systematic Fund Lite	Purple Pride Fund Lite	Wildcat Investment Fund Lite
0.5%	40%	50%	30%
1%	20%	50%	30%
1.5%	40%	0%	40%

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

- A structure should cover the key long-term growth opportunities for an asset manager, taking into account the revenue opportunities, costs, and relevant capabilities needed for each. A matrix framework example is provided below. Note, costs are not a critical aspect of this case, and thus not essential for the framework. The key client question is also about new opportunities, and thus the interviewee should not focus on current product-customer combinations (e.g. pricing).

		Growth Opportunities			
		New Geography	New Customer	New Distribution	New Product
Considerations	Revenue Opportunity	A. Market: Size/Growth/Trends? B. Competition: Fragmented? Response? C. Ongoing Revenue: Pricing model (performance vs. management fee)? Capacity constrained / cannibalization of our current products?			
	Costs	A. Initial Investment Cost B. Opportunity Cost (i.e. will new products impact performance of our current products?) C. Ongoing Costs (e.g. trading execution costs, trader salaries, taxes, technology infrastructure improvements, regulatory compliance, etc.)			
	Capabilities / Risks	A. Synergies with current products/distribution/customers/geography? B. Does it provide diversification to the business? C. Are there operational risks (e.g. compliance / geopolitical) to be aware of?			

Part 2A

2A. Analyze the current customer and channel market

- As part of their growth framework, interviewees should have addressed the general market growth rates and identifying new customers or channels to enter. Once they have addressed these topics:

Provide Exhibit A

- We have data on the current market landscape for Kellogg Capital prospective clients. **What customer segment / channel should Kellogg Capital target?**
-
- If not already addressed and if requested, tell the interviewee that Kellogg Capital has not yet entered the retail market. It is currently only targeting institutional investors. The chart depicts AUM that Kellogg Capital could achieve for each market segment if it achieved 100% penetration.
 - The interviewee should fairly quickly clear the chart, recognizing that the ideal prospective clients are in the upper right quadrant of the chart with the largest sized bubble.
 - Takeaway: Kellogg Capital should start targeting the retail customer base, and specifically the mass retail segment, to continue their growth.
 - Ensure the interviewee focuses on mass retail – Kellogg Capital is waiting to build out tax-advantaged solutions before entering the high net worth segment. Further, their current institutional investor base is shrinking.
 - Strong interviewees will proactively start brainstorming either ways to enter this new channel or ask questions to investigate why Kellogg Capital has not already entered the market given the obvious strengths (growth rate, fees, and size), leading to part 2B of the case.
 - Exhibit A data will be used later on in the case, so interviewees should likely make note of the key mass retail information.

Part 2B

2B. Brainstorm reasons why Kellogg Capital has not yet entered the retail market

- Why do you think Kellogg Capital has not yet entered the retail market given the strength of this market?
- There are many directions the interviewee can take this; one structured approach may be the below table:

Internal (Capabilities)		External (Environment/Risks)	
Product	Sales/Distribution	Competition	Regulatory
• Is mass retail interested in Kellogg Capital products (e.g. too high volatility, complicated to understand)? Can Kellogg Capital products meet mass retail needs (e.g. disclosure of holdings, daily NAV)?	• Does Kellogg Capital have the sales team in place to target retail investors (i.e. targeting volume of clients with smaller investments compared to institutional investors that can invest \$100M easily)?	• Is the mass retail market much more competitive? Is there increasing fee compression within the retail space (or clients choose funds increasingly based on price)?	• Does Kellogg Capital have the regulatory and compliance infrastructure in place to move forward with entering a much more regulated space of mass retail?

- The key to the brainstorm is that **Kellogg products are both at capacity and cannot meet the daily contribution/redemption requirements of mass retail** due to the illiquid components of the products.
- Strong interviewees will recall the illiquid aspect after clarifying the prompt and will proactively suggest creating products with only liquid assets to alleviate this constraint, leading to part 3 of the case.

Part 3

3. Analyze Kellogg Capital's current product mix

- Kellogg Capital has not yet entered the retail market because their products invest in illiquid securities. All of the products are hard closed / at capacity due to illiquid securities, and none of the products could meet the daily contribution/redemption requirements of mutual funds and other mass retail vehicles. However, Kellogg Capital believes it can create “lite” products, derived by removing the illiquid components from its 3 products. **What would be the expected fees of these new “lite” products?**
- Importantly, mutual funds do not allow performance fees, so first Kellogg Capital wants to calculate the equivalent management fee for each of their current products (e.g. 10% performance fee on 10% excess return would be equivalent to a 1% mgmt. fee). Then they want to adjust these equivalent management fees for the proportional performance of the new “lite” products (e.g. a 10% lower performance expectation from removing illiquid assets should reduce the equivalent management fee by 10%).

Provide Exhibit B

- Clarifying Content: “Performance Allocation” pie charts illustrate what percentage of the excess returns is attributed to each of the asset classes. Calculations should be:

	Probability-Optimized Enhanced Trading Systematic Fund, L.P.	Purple Pride Fund, L.P.	Wildcat Investment Fund, L.P.
Equivalent Mgmt. Fees (Current)	0.5% Mgmt. and 5% Performance = $0.5\% + 5\% \times 15 = 1.25\% \text{ Mgmt. Fee}$	0.7% Mgmt. and 5% Performance = $0.7\% + 5\% \times 10 = 1.2\% \text{ Mgmt. Fee}$	0.75% Mgmt. Fee
Expected Lite Fee	$1.25\% \times 80\% = 1.0\% \text{ Mgmt. Fee}$	$1.2\% \times 90\% = 1.08\% \text{ Mgmt. Fee}$	$0.75\% \times 50\% = 0.375\% \text{ Mgmt. Fee}$

- Strong interviewees should call out the Purple Pride fund as the highest fee product and request penetration data to confirm it could hit Kellogg Capital's growth target.
- If requested: Excess returns is in excess of the U.S. 3-Month Treasuries. AUM data provided is not needed to crack the case given all products are at capacity and we are creating a new product, but could be used to approximate current annual revenue.

Part 4

4. Estimate revenue from new product launch

- Kellogg Capital has conducted a market analysis to understand potential penetration 3 years from now, should they launch a lite product. **Which one of the three products should Kellogg Capital pursue?**

Provide Exhibit C

- Key information is the size of the mass retail market *in year 3*. Importantly, they already have the \$440M number alongside the 5% growth rate from Exhibit A. Assuming the growth rate is constant, an *estimated* market size for the segment would be:

$$\$440B * 1.15 = \sim \$500B \text{ (indeed even slightly higher due to compounding growth)}$$

- The interviewee should also get the weighted-average penetrations from Exhibit C. Strong interviewees may immediately recognize the Wildcat Fund is not going to hit Kellogg Capital's target and not do calculations to save time.

	Probability-Optimized Enhanced Trading Systematic Fund Lite	Purple Pride Fund Lite	Wildcat Investment Fund Lite
Weighted Avg. Penetration	1%	0.75%	1.05%
Market Penetration	~\$5B	~\$3.75B	~\$5.25B
Expected Fees (Already Calculated)	1.0% Mgmt. Fee	1.08% Mgmt. Fee	0.375% Mgmt. Fee
Est. Revenue	~\$50M	~\$40M	N/A (~\$20M if Calculated)

- Notably, even though Purple Pride has the highest fees, only the first fund meets Kellogg Capital's target of \$50M.
- If costs are brought up by the interviewee, note that the Chief Strategy and Innovation Officer believes any of the lite funds would be profitable and they should focus on revenue.

Part 5

5. Provide Chief Strategy and Innovation Officer recommendation

- Request the interviewee provide a recommendation to the Chief Strategy and Innovation Officer
-
- Kellogg Capital should enter the mass retail market with its Probability-Optimized Enhanced Trading Systematic Fund Lite product.
 - While it has slightly lower fees than the Purple Pride Fund, it is the only fund that would be able to hit the target of ~\$50M of annual revenue by year 3 given expected penetration levels.
 - Risks could include: cannibalization of their current investors (i.e. institutional investors may want the lower fees the mutual funds provide); mass retail clients are generally more impacted by short-term performance bringing volatility to asset flows.
 - Mitigation steps include: conducting a study on pricing the mutual funds higher (currently Kellogg Capital would come in below avg. market fees for the segment); study introducing lower-volatility versions of the lite products for risk-averse investors.
-
- Strong interviewees recognize that growth may be stalled due to capacity constraints of the products; suggest new products, customers, geographies, or distribution channels/vehicles for future growth; consider why Kellogg Capital may not already be working with retail clients; answer the immediate questions (i.e. for each part) as well as the overarching question (i.e. how does Kellogg Capital double revenue by year 3).
 - Outstanding interviewees lay out math appropriately and accurately, recognizing that only one of the lite funds is able to meet Kellogg Capital's targets; they may also recognize the nuances of the case such as comparisons between the proposed lite products and current average fee for mass retail products. They may also notice that entering the mass retail market (and retail market generally) is likely critical for Kellogg Capital's growth given the negative growth rates of many institutional segments.

Case 14

Kellogg in India

Concepts tested

- Z08 Market sizing (2)
- Z07 Market share (3)
- Z03 Breakeven analysis (3)

Primary sector(s)

- X07 Government & Public Sector

Case type

- Y04 New product / Market entry

Similar cases

- Big Public High School (Darden 2012)
- Busch's Barber Shop (Kellogg 2021)
- Chic Cosmetology (Kellogg 2021)

{ Case author(s): Abhilash Sridharan (Kellogg 2015), Rashaad Jamaal (Kellogg 2015)
Edited by: Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020) }

Kellogg in India

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client is the Dean of Kellogg School of Management. She has hired you to advise her on an idea, which struck her during the previous week – To consider starting a satellite campus of Kellogg in India. She has asked you to determine whether Kellogg should enter the Indian market.

Interviewer guide

- This case is a quintessential market entry case.
- The two main quantitative concepts on which the candidate is being tested are on market size estimation and breakeven analysis.
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Confirm market attractiveness (sizing)
 3. Market share and breakeven analysis
 4. Conduct risk analysis
 5. Provide client recommendation

Kellogg in India

Fit: Tell me about a time when you were provided feedback and what action you took.

Case prompt

- Our client is the Dean of Kellogg School of Management. She has hired you to advise her on an idea, which struck her during the previous week – To consider starting a satellite campus of Kellogg in India. She has asked you to determine whether Kellogg should enter the Indian market.

Clarifying information

- **Strategic Rationale:** India is a fast growing economy with huge demand for MBAs. Kellogg's Dean believes that an India campus would help Kellogg become a Top 3 global MBA program. The caliber of India candidates is the same as in the US.
- **Objective:** The Dean wants the satellite campus to breakeven in 4 years
- **Competition:** Eight top-tier business schools: 7 IIMs and the ISB (ISB has a partnership with Kellogg, for its pedagogy).
- **Candidate selection:** IIMs select based on CAT test results. The ISB admits candidates based on the GMAT.
- **Pricing:** Indian MBAs cost \$20k per year (US MBAs cost \$70k). Indian schools don't offer scholarships but banks offer loans.
- **Product:** Kellogg would only launch the 2Y MBA program in India.

Kellogg in India

Exhibit A – Indian business schools

Category	Indian Institutes of Management (IIMs)	Indian School of Business (ISB)
Description of program	• IIMs select via the Common Admission Test (CAT) • IIM interviews candidates with the top 6% CAT scores • 5 candidates are interviewed for every available seat • 85% of admitted candidates matriculate	• 70% of admitted students matriculate • Two campuses with a total class size of 1,400
Cost incurred by Student	• INR 1,200,000 per year* • 1 USD = 60 INR	

Notes:

- Assume the total cost incurred by a student annually at Kellogg is \$70k per annum

Kellogg in India

Exhibit B – Admitted students

Year	Expected admits per year
1	600 (7.5% of 8,000)
2	600
3	900
4	900

Notes:

- Only source of revenue is the fee charged to students

Kellogg in India

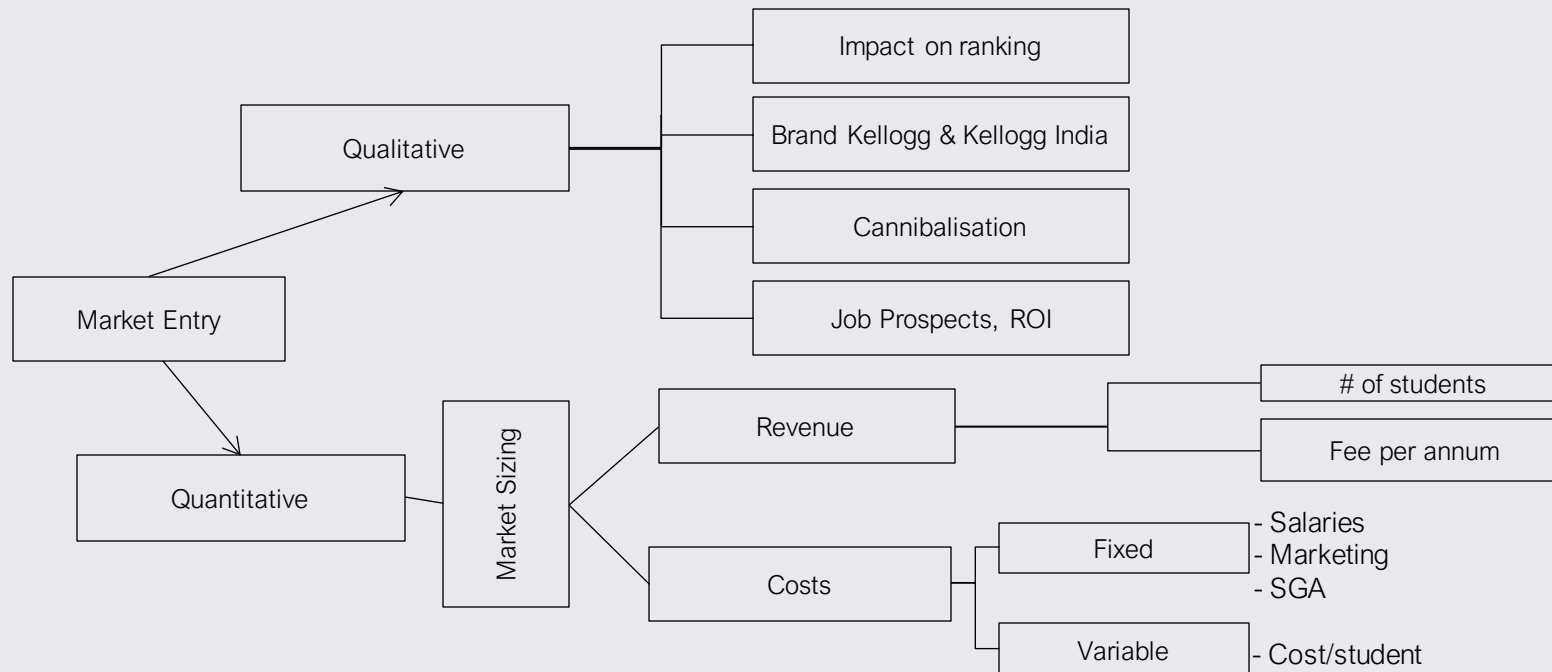
Exhibit C – Estimated cost structure

Fixed Costs	Annual Variable Costs			
Year 0	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4
\$100M (land) \$50 (support infrastructure)	\$30M	\$30M	\$30M	\$20M

Kellogg in India

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem



Kellogg in India

Part 2

2. Confirm market attractiveness (size)

The candidate can choose to size the market either top-down or bottom-up. A top-down approach becomes too dependent on assumptions. Exhibit A can be used for a bottom-up approach.

Provide Exhibit A when the candidate requests any of the information that it contains

A. Estimate the Total Addressable Market from competition

1. IIMs

- IIMs get 500k applications per year (provide this information if asked or if candidate proceeds to assume)
- Top 6% are interviewed = 30,000 applicants
- 1 in 5 are accepted = **6,000 eligible students**

2. ISB

- 1,400 matriculated students / 70% of total admitted students = **2,000 eligible students**
- If interviewee gets this wrong, ask which student pool are we most interested in: matriculated students or all accepted students.

Total Addressable Market = 6,000 + 2,000 = **8,000 high quality applicants**

B. Market Size

Fee to be charged annually needs to be calculated. A value somewhere in between \$20,000 and \$70,000 is acceptable. \$50,000 per year for 2 years: $8,000 * \$50,000 * 2 = \$800M$

Part 3

3. Market share and breakeven analysis

- The candidate should mention a target market share in the year of launch. A lower number would be preferable to start with. After letting the candidate present their logic, ask them to assume 7.5% market share in the year of launch.

Provide the information below when requested:

- Breakeven Analysis: Expected breakeven in 4 years

Provide Exhibit B when asked about Revenue

- The candidate should note that from the second year onwards, last year's fee should be included in the current year.

Provide Exhibit C after Cost brainstorming

- Costs: Ask the candidate to brainstorm for costs
- The candidate must move towards a NPV Calculation:

	Y0	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4
Number of students		600	600	900	900
Yearly Fee per student (\$)		50,000	50,000	50,000	50,000
Revenue \$m from students in year 1		30	30	45	45
Revenue \$m from students in year 2			30	30	45
Total Revenue (\$ M)		30	60	75	90
Costs (\$ M)	150	30	30	30	20
Profits	-150	0	30	45	70

- When asked for a discount rate, confirm there is none.
- Conclusion: The project should go ahead: by the 4th year, the project doesn't breakeven by only \$5M. Given rising revenues and declining costs, breakeven would be achieved in the first month of year 5.

Kellogg in India

Part 4

4. Conduct risk analysis

Ideally, the candidate will raise risks related to the project. If not, ask them to brainstorm:

Brand impact	Rankings impact	Cannibalization	Brand parity	Job prospects	Support
• No top US schools is successful in India • Satellite campus might dilute brand	• Diversity • International presence • Proximity to Asia • Job prospects	• 50-60 Indian students matriculate at Kellogg US • Impact on US MBA candidate pool across Asia	• Kellogg US MBA = Kellogg India MBA	• Premium for Kellogg India versus IIM / ISB	• Parent campus pedagogical support for satellites

Part 4

6. Provide client recommendation

Overall

- While starting a satellite campus makes financial sense, further scrutiny is needed on the impact of this move on Kellogg's brand and other factors that impact rankings
- Other additional points, which the candidate may add, could be:
 - Negotiate on the costs for initial investments, to lower it down from \$150M.
 - Support from Indian government on subsidies to be offered
 - Develop additional sources of revenue, from supporting programs and corporate training sessions

Risks

- Brand dilution / considering the impact of a satellite campus on Brand Kellogg
- Cannibalization of existing revenue from Indian students
- Admission percentage is projected to increase from Year 2 to Year 3 by 50% (This is quite high)
- The salaries of Indian graduates, as per Indian Market conditions, (considering Indian PPP) may influence the average salary of Kellogg School of Management given global reporting, eventually impacting the ranking negatively
- Given Kellogg's new building being constructed, the \$150M additional investment for a satellite campus, may require additional rounds of fund raising for the India campus

Next Steps

- Employ a Brand agency / consultant to figure out the impact of starting a satellite campus on Brand Kellogg
- Fund Raising for \$150M to be worked out
- Potential Partners for promoting the program and supporting with faculty initially
- Discussions to be started with the government of India for the land, infrastructure investment and licenses.

Case 15

Kellogg Klogs

Interviewee-led

Concepts tested

- Z14 Pricing strategy (2,3)
- Z12 Creativity (4)
- Z10 Customer marketing strategy (4)
- Z03 Breakeven analysis (5)

Primary sector(s)

- X12 Retail & CPG

Case type

- Y04 New product / Market entry

Similar cases

- Tacotle (KCC 2021)
- BoxCo (Bain Case Chain 2020)
- Montoya Soup (KCC 2021)
- California Parking Lot (Columbia 2017)

Case author: AnnaClare Smith (Kellogg 2022)
Edited by: Eli Derrow (Kellogg 2021)

Kellogg Klogs

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client, Kellogg Klogs, is startup that has received significant funding to launch the market's first eco-friendly, stylish clogs, produced from sustainable plant-based materials.
- Kellogg Klogs already has a perfect sustainable prototype ready to launch. The shoe has received positive feedback from beta testers and investors.
- The CMO has come to us to ask, how should Kellogg Klogs price the shoe?

Interviewer guide

- Problem: What is the maximum price that Kellogg Klogs can charge without losing target customers to non-sustainable competitors, i.e. what is the appropriate sustainability premium they can charge?
- This purpose of this case is to force the interviewee to think deeper about the trade-offs associated with sustainability. Customers expect to pay more for eco-friendly products, but how much more?
 1. Develop structure to address the problem
 2. Analyze competitor pricing
 3. Examine sustainability premium on various products to calculate optimal price
 4. Brainstorm how to improve Kellogg Klogs' competitive advantage
 5. Calculate warranty breakeven
 6. Provide client recommendation

Kellogg Klogs

Fit: Tell me about a time that you disagreed with your supervisor. How did you resolve the situation?

Case prompt

- Our client, Kellogg Klogs, is startup that has received significant funding to launch the market's first eco-friendly, stylish clogs, produced from sustainable plant-based materials.
- Kellogg Klogs already has a perfect sustainable prototype ready to launch. The shoe has received positive feedback from beta testers and investors.
- The CMO has come to us to ask, how should Kellogg Klogs price the shoe?

Clarifying information

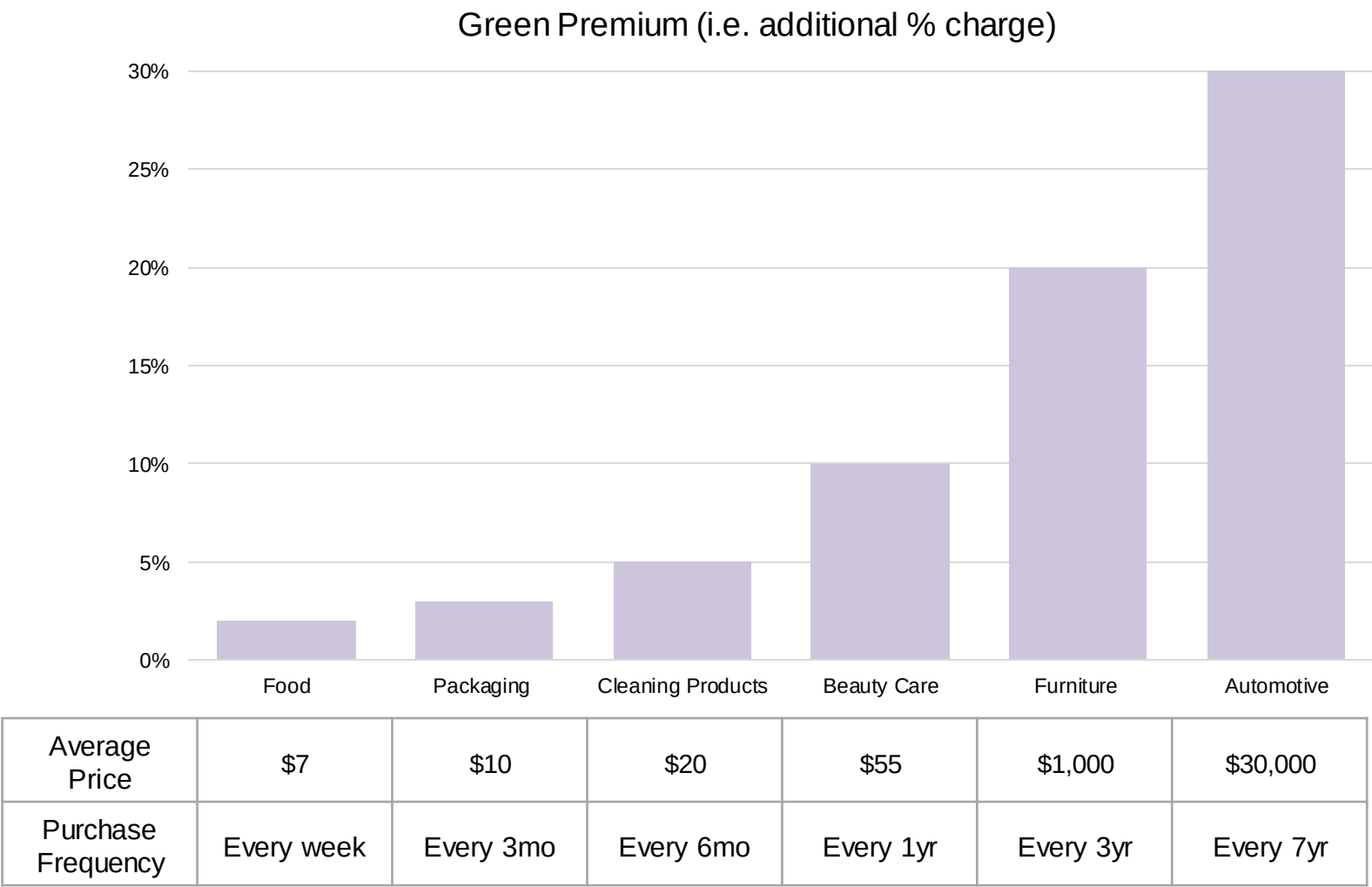
- **Timeline and Goal:** Kellogg Klogs wants to launch the clogs as soon as possible (within the next quarter). The company's goal is to maximize revenue and market penetration. For the time being, they are not concerned about profitability.
- **Cost:** It costs Kellogg Klogs \$70 to produce a pair of their clogs.
- **Product:** The clogs are made of sustainable plant-based materials – a novel innovative substitute for leather that has been lauded by animal-rights activists. The shoes are unisex and come in just one color – purple.
- **Geography:** Kellogg Klogs is based in San Francisco. The startup plans to sell direct-to-consumer in the US and is open to the idea of launching a few retail locations.
- **Competition:** There are 4 main competitors in the clog market, none of which use sustainable materials or production methods. We do not expect competitors to adjust their prices in response to Kellogg Klogs entering the market.
- **Customer:** Kellogg Klogs is targeting millennial consumers and young working professionals.

Kellogg Klogs

Exhibit A – Competitor Pricing (2020)

	Company A	Company B	Company C	Company D
Price per clog	\$175	\$50	\$75	\$100
Location	NYC	UK	SF	CHI
Date Founded	2010	2000	2018	1920
US Market Share	10%	20%	10%	60%
Growth Rate	7%	7%	25%	2%
Customer Demographics	Company A produces high-end, designer-label clogs often worn by upper class, middle-aged women.	Company B produces no-frills clogs for service professionals that entered the market to undercut Competitor D.	Company C produces fashionable leather clogs and targets young working professionals.	Company D produces the staple clog that has been around for generations and is worn by middle-aged and elderly consumers.

Exhibit B – Average Sustainability Premium Across Industries



Kellogg Klogs

Exhibit C – Criteria importance millennial customer survey

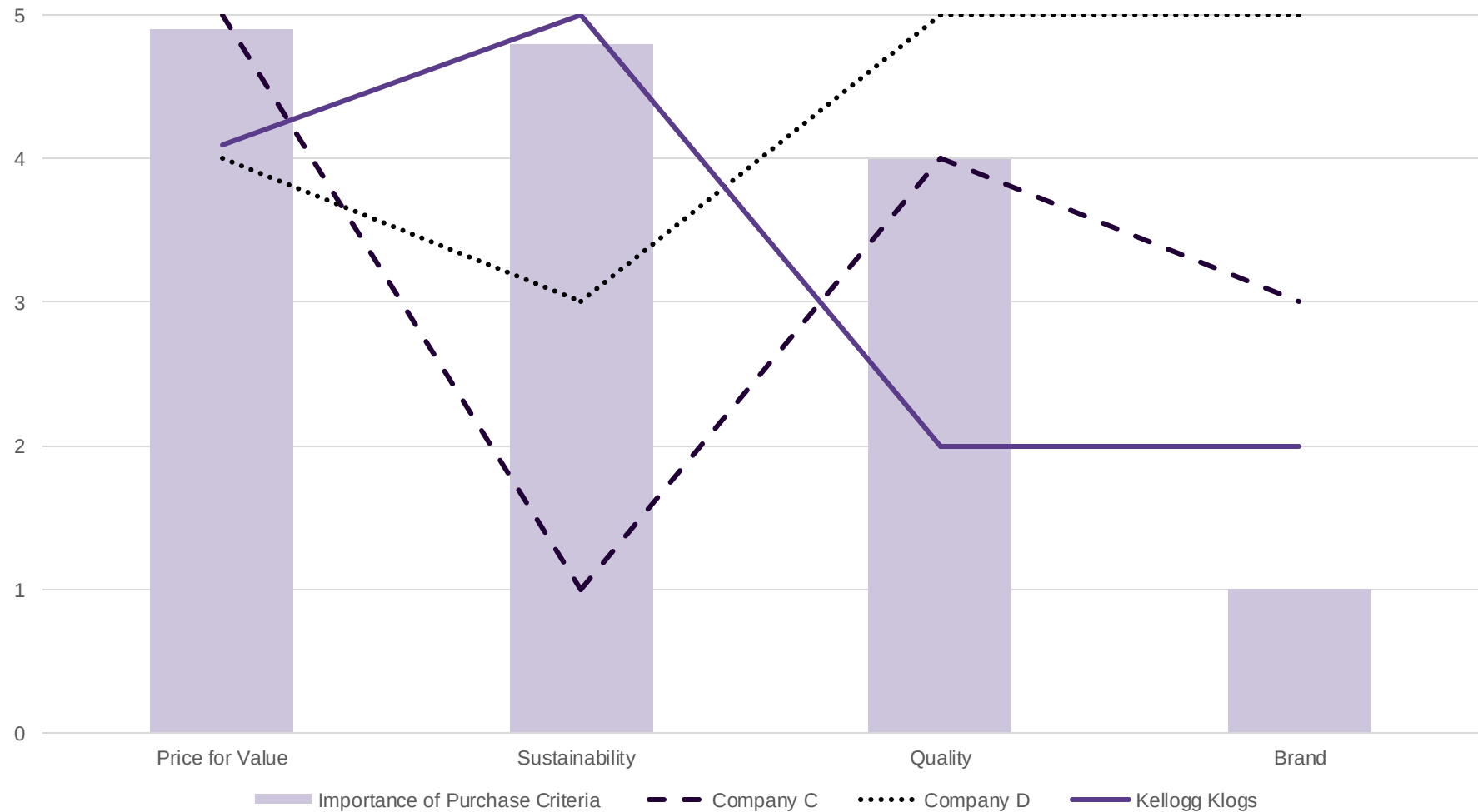


Exhibit D – Expected Claims Per Years of Warranty

Years of Warranty	1	2	3	4
% Expected Claims	10%	20%	30%	40%

Kellogg Klogs

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

- Structure should cover the key areas needed to determine how Kellogg Klogs should price the clogs. The interviewee should cover 1) the main elements of pricing strategy, 2) the price premium often associated with green products, and 3) risks associated with pricing.
- Example structure below:

Cost-Based	Value-Based	Competitor-Based	Other Considerations & Risks
• What are per unit costs? What is desired profit margin? • What drives these costs? VC v. FC • R&D for sustainable design • Input costs of new sustainable materials • Do we expect FC to decline over time?	• Customer's willingness-to-pay plus price elasticity of demand • How much is the sustainability premium worth to customers?	• What is industry average price for non-sustainable clogs? • How are other substitutes priced – sneakers, sandals, boots – for same target customers? • What are industry benchmarks for sustainability premiums in other industries?	• Competitor reaction: will comps price lower, launch of sustainable alternative, etc. • Image/brand: How does a chosen price affect the brand? • Consumer preferences: • Quality of shoes not worth the premium • Change in consumer preferences

Part 2

2. Analyze competitor pricing

- As part of their growth framework, interviewees should have addressed a competitor-based pricing model. Once they have asked about competitor pricing:

Provide Exhibit A

- The client has data on the average prices of comparable clogs and sandals.
 - How should Kellogg Klogs use this information to start working towards an optimal price?
-
- The interviewee should take some time to read through the text on the exhibit. The purpose of this exhibit is to test the interviewee's ability to take in a busy slide, digest information, and ignore the superfluous information. If the interviewee has not already asked who Kellogg Klogs' target customer is, then guide them to it.
 - The prices and customer demographics vary significantly across competitors, which the interviewee should use to identify the best comparable(s) to use as a benchmark for price.
 - Takeaway: Kellogg Klogs should use the average of C & D as baseline price: $\$87.50 = (100+75)/2$
 - C has a similar target demographic, but D is the industry leader and the baseline comparison for quality. If the interviewee selects only one of the two, suggest the blended proxy between the two (i.e. \$87.50).
 - A strong interviewee will now direct attention to how we can price in the sustainability factor and what premium Kellogg Klogs should charge.** If they don't, guide the interviewee to think about what other factors must be priced in.

Part 3

3. Examine sustainability premium on various products to calculate optimal price

- Once the interviewee suggests that we should consider how much Kellogg Klogs can charge for the sustainability added value:

Provide Exhibit B

- The client has consulted with other firms to determine various average industry-wide “green premiums” that customers are willing to pay for certain products.
- How can Kellogg Klogs use this information to price its product?

- If necessary, tell the interviewee that we have no information regarding sustainability premiums in other markets (e.g. shoe markets), as this is the first retail product of its kind.
- The interviewee should notice that green premiums increase with price and durability of product. Thus, the interviewee should suggest a premium for the product that seems the most comparable to shoes in terms of price and purchasing frequency: **beauty care**. Guide the interviewee towards beauty care if needed.
- Assuming a premium of 10%, the interviewee should use the premium to calculate optimal price based off the average of competitors C&D's prices.

Average Competitor's Price	Premium	Optimal Price
$(100+75)/2 = \$87.5$	10%	$\$87.5 * 110\% = \96.25

- An excellent Interviewee will now question whether this price point is viable for Kellogg Klogs' target demographic. What are the key purchasing criteria for millennial consumers?

Kellogg Klogs

Part 4a

4a. Brainstorm how to improve Kellogg Klogs' competitive advantage

- Once the interviewee has questioned if \$96.25 is a viable price for millennial consumers:

Provide [Exhibit C](#)

- The client provided us with a graphic that compares Kellogg Klogs to Company C and D at the suggested price point of \$96.25. The exhibit includes data on key purchasing criteria for millennial consumers and estimates how Kellogg Klogs compares to Company C and Company D across KPCs.
-
- Strong interviewees should clear the chart to confirm that \$96.25 is reasonable and recommend next steps.
 - Kellogg Klogs outperforms Company C on sustainability, but underperforms on price, quality, and brand.
 - Kellogg Klogs outperforms Company D on price and sustainability, but underperforms on quality and brand.
 - The Interviewee should not get distracted by the fact that Companies C & D perform better (or the same) on brand, as it is of very little importance to millennial consumers. Quality, however, is still important to consumers. A good interviewee will ask what can be done to increase quality to improve competitive advantage.
 - Takeaways:
 - The price point of \$96.25 is appropriate for Kellogg Klog's target consumers, as it edges out Company D on price and Company C on sustainability. Client should capture millennial market share from both companies at this price.
 - Kellogg Klogs should improve quality to increase its competitive advantage.

Kellogg Klogs

Part 4b

4b. Brainstorm how to improve Kellogg Klogs' competitive advantage

- Once the interviewee confirms that \$96.25 is a competitive price, ask the candidate to brainstorm **how Kellogg Klogs can improve its competitive advantage?**
- Per Exhibit C, Kellogg Klogs should focus on the criteria that are most important to their target consumers. They already win on sustainability, which leaves them with “price”, “quality”, and “brand” to focus on. (Note that brand is less important to millennial consumers, but it still may increase competitive advantage)

Price	Quality	Brand
Lower price to undercut both C & D	- Bolster perception of quality through customer testimonials and warranty programs, - Place retail locations near stores associated with high quality	Create more brand recognition through loyalty programs, strategic partnerships, and targeted ads

- If the interviewee suggests that Kellogg Klogs ensure quality through a warranty program, provide them with Exhibit D. If not, try to push them to think creatively about how they can ease concerns about quality (if struggling, mention that customers are concerned that the product will not last a long time).

Part 5

5. Calculate warranty breakeven

Provide Exhibit D when the interviewee mentions a warranty program

- The client likes the idea of a warranty program. They're considering offering a warranty program in which a customer can replace their clogs with a brand-new pair of clogs if there are any quality defects.
 - What is the longest warranty Kellogg Klogs can offer and remain profitable?
-
- To calculate the breakeven, the interviewee will need to recall the recommended price per shoe (\$96.25) and confirm the unit cost per shoe (\$70). Note – the expected value of a claim is the % of expected claims times the cost to Kellogg Klogs (\$70).
 - Based on the below calculations, Kellogg Klogs would begin losing money on each pair sold after Year 4. Thus, Kellogg Klogs should offer a 3-year warranty, as Kellogg Klogs is not concerned with maximizing profitability.

Years of Warranty	1	2	3	4
% Expected Claims	10%	20%	30%	40%
Unit Profit	\$26.25	\$26.25	\$26.25	\$26.25
Expected Unit Value of Claims	\$7.00	\$14.00	\$21.00	\$28.00
Net Expected Profit	\$19.25	\$12.25	\$5.25	(\$1.75)

Part 6

6. Provide client recommendation

- Ask the interviewee to provide recommendation to the CMO who is about to enter the room
-
- Kellogg Klogs should price the clogs at \$96.25 per pair and include a 3-year warranty with each purchase.
 - \$96.25 is an appropriate price, as it uses prices of competitors C/D as a baseline and assumes a 10% premium for sustainability value-add.
 - The 3-year warranty program will ease customers concerns about quality and increase Kellogg Klogs' competitive advantage, while still breaking even on each pair sold.
 - Risks could include: consumers not be willing to pay 10% premium for apparel, competitors react, expected % of warranty claims increases
 - Next steps could include: pilot study to ensure \$96.25 is right price, develop distribution plan (D2C or retail locations), sensitivity analysis to examine adjustments in green-premium or expected warranty claims
-
- Strong interviewees will drive the case to the sustainability premium on their own. They will work through the math quickly and accurately and will know to use proxies (e.g. competitor pricing; adjacent product premiums) to move the case forward.
 - Outstanding interviewees will mention the above and begin to think through how to bring the product to market. They will drive the case forward at each part – considering second-level aspects throughout (e.g. do customers simply say they would pay more for a product, competitor reaction, etc.). They will also be creative in creating their framework and during the brainstorm. They will be able to clear charts quickly and be able to quickly disregard irrelevant data (e.g. much of Exhibit A).

Case 34

Lobster-Woman

Concepts tested

- Creativity
- NPV

Primary sector(s)

- Non-Traditional

Case type

- Valuation / Financial Decision

Casing Skills tested

- Creative Framework
- Math Structuring
- Attention-to-Detail

Case author(s): Robert Pontrelli (Kellogg 2023)
Edited By: Aditi Kannan (Kellogg 2023)

Lobster-Woman

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- While on vacation in a mid-sized (~70,000 population) city on the coast of Maine, you meet a high school student who is so impressed by your MBA that she asks you for career advice.
- She loves the ocean and wants to become a career lobster fisherman (Lobster-Woman) like her mother and many of her friends. She is a very bright girl, but she often skips school to fish for lobsters which has hurt her grades: a trend she plans to continue.
- A school guidance counselor encouraged your new friend to instead consider a less risky career path either in professional services or as a trade worker. She would like your opinion on which of these three career options she should pursue.

Interviewer guide

- This case forces the interviewee to thinking creatively in order to consider all the relevant variables then assign a financial value to each in order to make a recommendation based on the NPV of each career. Steps 2-5 can be done in any order and the interviewee should drive the order.
 1. Develop structure to address the problem
 2. Determine student's cost-of-living plus retirement savings
 3. Calculate expected earnings & costs for each profession
 4. Consider alignment between the student's skills and each job's requirements
 5. Calculate NPV of each profession and brainstorm other considerations
 6. Provide recommendation

Lobster-Woman

Fit: Where do you see yourself in 5 and 10 years?

Case prompt

- While on vacation in a mid-sized (~70,000 population) city on the coast of Maine, you meet a high school student who is so impressed by your MBA that she asks you for career advice.
- She loves the ocean and wants to become a career lobster fisherman (Lobster-Woman) like her mother and many of her friends. She is a very bright girl, but she often skips school to fish for lobsters which has hurt her grades: a trend she plans to continue.
- A school guidance counselor encouraged your new friend to instead consider a less risky career path either in professional services or as a trade worker. She would like your opinion on which of these three career options she should pursue.

Clarifying Information

- **Industry:**
 - *Lobster Fishing* – Lobster are a large marine crustacean which are a culinary delicacy. Lobster-women own their own lobster boats, work for themselves, and sell the lobster they catch to distributors who sell them to restaurants or grocery stores
 - *Professional Service* – White collar jobs; think accountant, consultant, financial analyst. Requires 4-year college degree.
 - *Trade Jobs* – Skilled manual-labor roles; think carpenter, electrician, plumber. Requires 2-year vocational degree.
- **Timeline:** She needs to make this decision in the next few months, and she plans to keep the same career for her whole life
- **Goals:** Her main goal is financial: she wants to make enough money to cover her cost-of-living plus retirement savings. After that, her main goal is to follow her dream of becoming a Lobster-Woman. She is also concerned about the safety of each profession.
- **Geography:** She plans to stay in the same city in Maine regardless of which career she chooses.

Lobster-Woman

Exhibit A – Cost-of-Living Index in Select U.S. Cities (2020)

City	Cost-of-Living Index (Excl. Rent)*	Rent Index**	Cost-of-Living Plus Rent Index***	Average Retirement Contributions‡	Population (thousands)	Select Major Industry
Seattle, WA	88.12	64.42	76.96	63.74	737	Technology
Oakland, CA	92.12	85.35	88.91	57.86	441	Logistics
New York, NY	100.00	100.00	100.00	51.34	8,380	Finance
Asheville, NC	76.51	54.74	67.12	49.89	92	Tourism
Tampa, FL	75.82	53.62	66.72	45.03	385	Healthcare

* Relative indicator of consumer goods prices, including groceries, restaurants, transportation and utilities. Cost-of-Living Index does not include accommodation expenses such as rent or mortgage or retirement contributions. If a city has a Cost-of-Living Index of 120, it is 20% more expensive than New York (excluding rent).

** Estimation of prices of renting apartments in the city compared to New York City. If Rent index is 80, the price of rents in that city is on average 20% less than the price in New York.

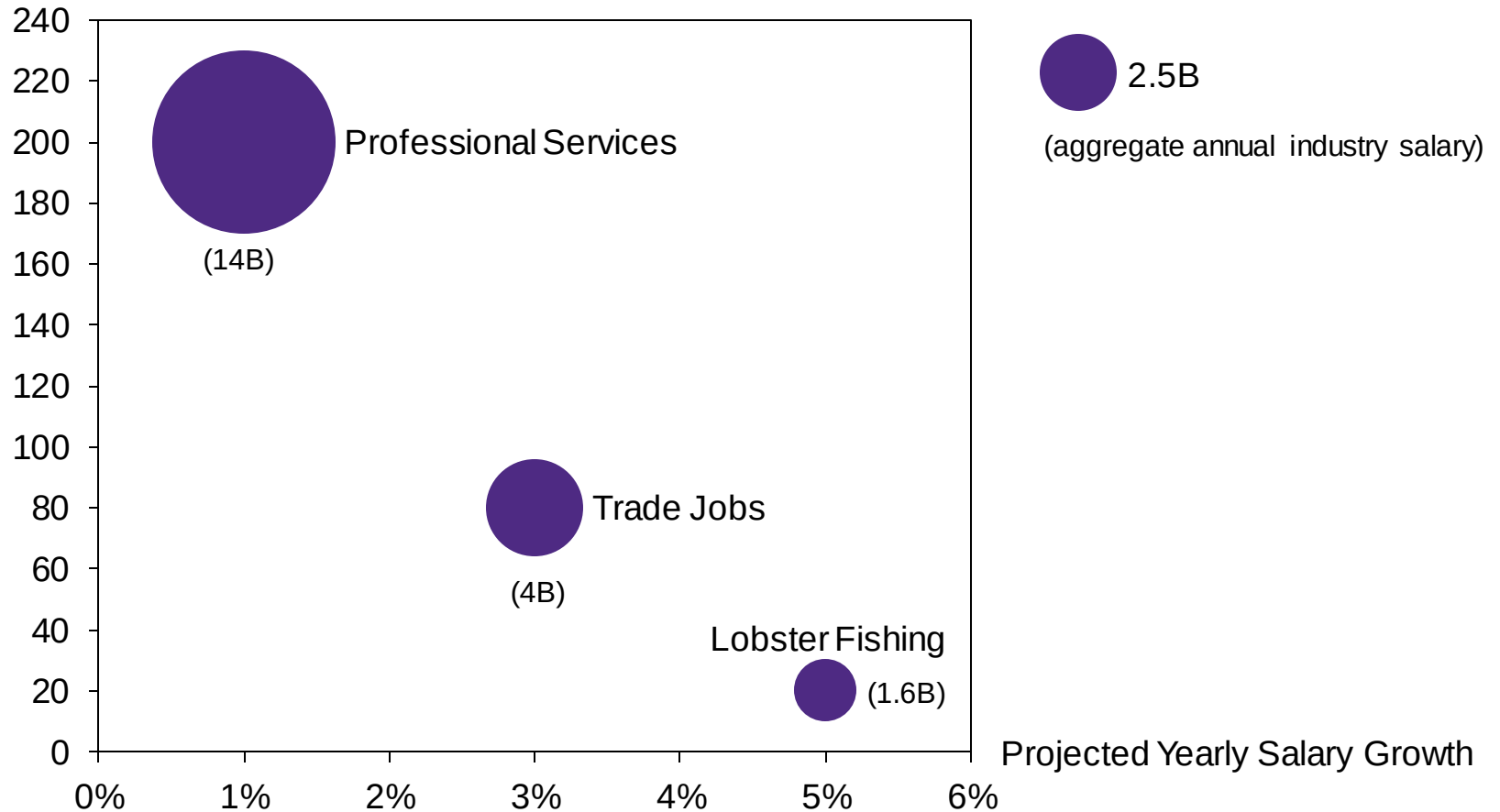
*** Estimation of consumer goods prices including rent, but not including retirement contributions, comparing to New York City. New York City average Monthly Cost-of-Living Plus Rent is \$3,000.

‡ Percentage of Cost-of-Living Plus Rent amount

Lobster-Woman

Exhibit B – Industry Salary Information (2020)

Industry Size (Thousands of Workers)



Lobster-Woman

Exhibit C – Job Requirements

		Based on Study of Job Descriptions & Career Earnings (2020)		
Career	Predictors of Success	Traits of an Under Performer (Earns ~80% of Average Salary)	Traits of an Average Performer (Earns Average Salary)	Traits of an Over Performer (Earns ~120% of Average Salary)
Professional Services	Academic Performance	Low Grades	Average Grades	High Grades
Trade Jobs	Technical Ability	N/A – high demand inflates all salaries	N/A – high demand inflates all salaries	All new trade workers will be paid as high performers due to high demand
Lobster Fishing	Connections in the industry	No connections or industry knowledge	Has industry knowledge, but no direct connections	Many connections already working in industry

Lobster-Woman

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

- Structure should cover the key areas needed to determine the financial return of each career path. The interviewee should cover 1) determining students' earning goals 2) alignment between student skills and job requirements 3) earning potential and costs of each career.
- Example structure below:

Earning Goals	Skills Alignment	Earnings/Costs	Other Considerations
• Cost-of-living • Housing • Transportation • Food/Grocery • Utilities • Etc. • Retirement goals	• Likelihood of successfully entering chosen profession • Ability to succeed in chosen profession	• Earnings • Salary potential • Salary growth • Costs • Education • Equipment • Healthcare	• Health/safety • Lifestyle • Industry strength • Regulatory risks

Lobster-Woman

Part 2

2. Determine Student's Cost-of-Living Plus Retirement Savings

Provide Exhibit A when interviewee asks about student's earnings goals

- The student wants to earn enough money to cover her monthly expenses and contribute to her retirement savings. She doesn't know what her monthly expenses or retirement contribution will be and would like your advice.
 - How much money does she need to earn each month to meet her earnings/savings goal?
-
- This exhibit challenges the interviewee recall information from the prompt and to sift through a lot of information to pull out the key pieces – by doing this correctly, the math becomes very easy.
 - Interviewee should recognize that the student's city in Maine is not listed and should try to find the best comparable city. Based on the Maine city's population (~70,000) and major industry (tourism) – both provided in prompt, **Asheville NC is the best comp.**
 - By reading the footnotes, the interviewee should identify that "**Cost-of-Living Plus Rent**" is the relevant variable and the others can be ignored. Calculation is relative to New York City and interviewee should request to round
 - $(\sim 66.67 / 100) * \$3,000 = \mathbf{\$2,000}$ (Maine City cost-of-living plus rent)
 - Average Retirement Contributions for Asheville are **49.89%** of Cost-of-Living Plus Rent. Interviewee should ask to round to 50%
 - $\$2000 * 1.5 = \mathbf{\$3,000}$ (Student's monthly earnings goal)
 - $\$3,000 * 12 = \mathbf{\$36,000}$ (Student's annual earnings goal)

Lobster-Woman

Part 3a

3a. Calculate expected earnings of each industry

Provide Exhibit B when interviewee asks about industry salaries

- The interviewee should use this exhibit to calculate average salaries for each industry and make note of the projected growth rates to use in the final NPV calculation. If they do not drive here on their own, guide them to this calculation.
-
- Calculation:
 - $\text{Aggregate industry salary} / \text{number of jobs} = \text{average individual industry salary}$
 - Professional Services:
 - $14\text{M} / 200\text{K} = 70\text{K}$
 - Growth rate = 1%
 - Trade Jobs:
 - $4\text{M} / 80\text{K} = 50\text{K}$
 - Growth rate = 3%
 - Lobster Fishing:
 - $1.6\text{M} / 20\text{K} = 80\text{K}$
 - Growth rate = 5%

Lobster-Woman

Part 3b

3b. Calculate expected costs of each industry

Read below information when interviewee asks about industry costs

- Before providing below information, **ask interviewee what the major costs** of working in each industry will be
 - Professional Services:
 - 4-Year College: **\$230,000** (one-time up-front)
 - Employer subsidized health insurance: **\$1,000** (annual)
 - Trade Jobs:
 - 2-Year Vocational School: **\$50,000** (one-time up-front)
 - Out-of-pocket health insurance: **\$4,000** (annual)
 - Lobster Fishing:
 - Purchase boat & equipment: **\$450,000** (one-time up-front)
 - Out-of-pocket health & boat insurance: **\$6,000** (annual)
-
- Note that Part 3b differs from Part 2 in that these costs vary based on the career choice, while Part 2 are constant.
 - Candidate should use these costs along with projected earnings to perform an NPV calculation for each career path. Guide them towards this if they do not drive there. See Step 5 for NPV calculations.

Part 4

4. Consider alignment between student's skills and each job's requirements

Provide Exhibit C when interviewee asks about skill alignment

- This study of job descriptions and lifetime earnings of different candidates captures an estimate of combined probabilities of ability to enter each industry and performance in each industry.
 - How does the student's profile as a candidate impact her likely earnings in each industry?
-
- This exhibit pushes the interviewee to recall information about the student provided in the prompt and use to take qualitative information and translate it into quantitative earnings impact. The interviewee should not spend much time on this exhibit.
 - Interviewee should draw these conclusions:
 - Professional Services:
 - Student has bad grades (provided in prompt) and will likely be an under performer
 - Earnings **80% of industry average salary**
 - Trade Jobs:
 - Such high demand for jobs all new hires will be paid as over performers
 - Earnings **120% of industry average salary**
 - Lobster Fishing:
 - Student has many connections in the industry (provided in prompt) and will likely be an over performer
 - Earnings **120% of industry average salary**

Lobster-Woman

Part 5

5. Calculate NPV of each career option & brainstorm other considerations

- Interviewee should drive towards an NPV calculation to compare options. Instruct them to use a **growing perpetuity formula**.
- Because these different career options carry different levels of risk, use different discount rates for each:
 - Costs (**do not grow**): **10%**, Professional Services: **11%**, Trade Jobs: **13%**, and Lobster Fishing: **15%**
- Calculation Procedure (if interviewee performs one calculation correctly, option to skip second two and provide NPV values)
 - $(\text{Performance factor} * \text{Average Salary} - \text{Ongoing Costs}) / (\text{Discount rate} - \text{Growth rate}) - \text{Upfront costs} = \text{NPV of career path}$
- Professional Services
 - $(0.8 * 70K - 36K - 1K) / (11\% - 1\%) - 230K = \text{-40K}$ (do not recommend)
- Trade Jobs
 - $(1.2 * 50K - 36K - 4K) / (13\% - 3\%) - 50K = \text{150K}$ (ok to recommend)
- Lobster Fishing
 - $(1.2 * 80K - 36K - 6K) / (15\% - 5\%) - 450K = \text{90K}$ (best recommendation)
- Example brainstorm:

Ask interviewee to brainstorm other considerations besides NPV

Impact on Personal Life	Industry Forces
• Work-life-balance • Risk tolerance • Health impacts	• Regulation around lobstering • Global warming impact on lobstering • Technological changes / upskilling

Lobster-Woman

Part 6

6. Provide client recommendation

- She should pursue a career as a Lobster-Woman.
 - Both Trade Jobs and Lobster Fishing allow her to meet her earnings goals. Since her goal was to earn enough to follow her dream of becoming a Lobster-Woman, she should pursue that career.
 - The other factors she should consider are her personal goals (work-life-balance, risk tolerance, etc.) and industry trends that could impact her decision (global warming, regulation, etc.).
-
- Strong interviewees will identify all the relevant variables (cost-of-living expenses as a benchmark, alignment of skills to job requirements, earning potential, and costs associated with each career) and will drive from one to the next to collect all the relevant numbers. They will also structure their math in a logical way and perform an accurate NPV calculation to inform their final recommendation. They will recommend either Trade Jobs or Lobster Fishing because both have a positive NPV.
 - Outstanding interviewees will do all the above and will also outstanding display attention to detail and creativity. They will note key details in the prompt and rely on them throughout the case (details about the city in Maine to find a comp city, details about student's grades and industry connections for skills alignment). They will display a high degree of creativity throughout the case especially in the framework and brainstorm by including issues specifically relevant to a high school student. They will recommend Lobster Fishing because despite having a lower NPV than Trade Jobs, it better aligns with the student's stated goals.

Case 16

Maine Apples

Concepts tested

- Z08 Market sizing (2)
- Z14 Pricing strategy (3,4)
- Z15 Supply/value chain (4)

Primary sector(s)

- X02 Agriculture & Food

Case type

- Y04 New product / Market entry
- Y06 Opportunity assessment
- Y07 Profitability

Similar cases

- Antidepressant pricing (Sloan 2011)
- Jamaican Land Investment (Haas 2015)
- Mission Eternity (Fuqua 2016)

{ Case author(s): Adam Borchert and Joep Knijn (Tuck 2004)
Edited By: Peter Manoogian (Kellogg 2012), Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020) }

Maine Apples

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client is a Korean conglomerate named Danut that has acquired a small Boston-based biotechnology firm
- The biotech firm has developed a chemical that helps control the ripening of produce. After testing, this chemical appears to work especially well with apples: it allows apple orchards to harvest earlier and it improves the overall quality of the harvest.
- Danut traditionally uses a test market to determine commercialization. Given Danut's proximity to Boston and average apple yields, Maine has been chosen.
- Danut would like to know if they should attempt to commercialize this chemical.

Interviewer guide

- Problem: Is the market size large enough and the estimated profitability high enough for Danut to commercialize this chemical?
- Key case steps:
 1. Confirm market attractiveness (size)
 2. Quantify cost savings from earlier harvests
 3. Quantify revenue growth from improved yields
 4. Project farmers' margins and pricing for Danut
 5. Provide a recommendation and highlight risks

Maine Apples

Fit: Analysis is not always perfect. Tell me a time when the analysis wasn't perfect but you still had to use it.

Case prompt

- Our client is a Korean conglomerate named Danut that has acquired a small Boston-based biotechnology firm
- The biotech firm has developed a chemical that helps control the ripening of produce. After testing, this chemical appears to work especially well with apples: it allows apple orchards to harvest earlier and it improves the overall quality of the harvest.
- Danut traditionally uses a test market to determine commercialization. Given Danut's proximity to Boston and average apple yields, Maine has been chosen.
- Danut would like to know if they should attempt to commercialize this chemical.

Clarifying information

- **Product Benefits:**
 - Reduced costs through earlier harvesting
 - Improved apple yields
 - Improved juice yields (with higher quality apples)
- **Client Characteristics:** Only concerned about a “test-market” in the state of Maine
- **Competitive Dynamics:** No other competitive products on the market currently
- **Industry:** Growing at the rate of GDP

Maine Apples

Parts 1 - 3

1. Confirm market attractiveness (size)

When asked, provide the following:

- Maine has 200 orchards
- Avg. annual orchard revenue is \$30K/acre
- Avg. orchard has 100 acres of land
- Only one apple harvest per year

Interviewee should calculate the market size based on info provided:

- $(\$30\text{K/acre} \times 200 \text{ orchards} \times 100 \text{ acres/orchard} = \$600\text{M})$

This is a significant market and warrants further investigation

2. Quantify cost savings from earlier harvests

When asked to quantify the improvements, provide the following:

- It costs \$1.5K/day to maintain crops for 100 acre orchard
- With the chemical, farmers are able to harvest crop 10 days sooner

Interviewee should calculate cost savings per year using this information:

- $(\$1.5\text{K/day} \times 10 \text{ days} / 100 \text{ acres} = \$150\text{/acre/year})$

3. Quantify revenue growth from improved yields

When asked to quantify additional revenue, provide the following:

- Our client's product improves the consistency of red apples and increases the selling price by 10%
- The sweetness factor increases the selling price of juice by 5%
- 25% of revenue comes from whole apple sales, 75% from juice sales

Improved yield:

- $(\$30\text{K/acre} \times 25\% \times 10\% = \$750\text{/acre/year})$

Improved sweetness:

- $(\$30\text{K/acre} \times 75\% \times 5\% = \$1,125\text{/acre/year})$

Total improvement (with cost reduction) = \$2,025/acre/year

Maine Apples

Part 4

4. Project farmers' margins and pricing for Danut

When asked about product pricing, provide the following:

- Danut's product costs \$100k per 200 acre farm

Farmer's incremental revenue/cost savings = \$2,025/acre

Product costs = \$100K/200 acres = \$500/acre

Profit margin = $(\$2025 - \$500) / \$2025 = 75\%$ [\$1,525 per acre]

The interviewee should note that this is an extremely high profit margin for the farmer and realize that there is a significant opportunity for profits with this product.

- How much of this benefit can we capture in our pricing?
- Interviewee should provide a percentage between 25% and 50%. Anything higher than 50% should be questioned due to the novelty of the product and resulting lack of social proof.

A 50% profit margin for our client would also realize a 50% profit margin for farmers. This is absolutely a realistic price to set, if not a little low.

- Given the costs provided, will we make a profit? Yes
- Interviewee should calculate profit: $(\$100,000 / 200 \text{ acres} = \$500/\text{acre})$. Assuming \$1,000 price per acre, gross margin will be 50%. $[(\$1,000 - \$500) / \$1,000]$

Part 5

5. Provide a recommendation and highlight risks

- Overall, our client should commercialize this chemical and price it at approximately \$1,000 per acre to make a 50% margin.

Risks/Next steps:

- Differentiation: What is our positioning?
 - Environmental issues: Is there a risk of backlash and/or boycott from the general public? Could the U.S. government attempt to regulate our product?
 - Operational reality check: Does the company have the resources to do this?
 - Patenting: Is the product already patented? If yes, then when does it expire? If no, then is it possible to patent? If not, then can we patent the manufacturing process?
 - Representativeness of test market: Does it cost less to cover apples in other states?
 - Strategic fit: Is this opportunity too small relative to the size of the client?
-
- **Strong interviewees** share several qualitative issues listed above to supplement the recommendation to enter the market.
 - **Outstanding interviewees** consider value-based pricing: the need to quantify added profits that our client's product will make for its clients and how much of that money our client can capture.

Case 17

Money Bank Call Center

Concepts tested

- Z01 Accounting
- Z05 Capacity
- Z13 Organizational changes

Primary sector(s)

- X10 Legal & Professional Services
- X06 Financial Services

Case type

- Y01 Cost reduction
- Y05 Operations

Similar cases

- Call Center (Yale 2013)
- EasyNAV (Wharton 2009)

{ Case authors: Guruprasad Sankaranarayanan (Kellogg 2012)
Edited by Nikola Jakić (Kellogg 2016), Elizabeth Henry (Kellogg 2020) }

Money Bank Call Center

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client is a large financial services firm with multiple locations around the world. Part of their service offering includes a 24-hour helpline. The client has their call centers in New York and Paris.
- The client has recently acquired a small firm (Firm B) in order to expand its reach in a particular geography. Firm B provides a subset of the services and has its call center located in the Philippines.
- The client has asked us to determine its strategy going forward for handling customer calls. In particular they want us to look into the call center operations.

Interviewer guide

- This is an outsourcing case with the following elements:
 - Use a framework that covers the most important areas of M&A and cost cutting
 - Read the exhibits to assess the cost effectiveness and efficiency of the 3 locations
 - Discuss qualitative information on the acquired company – products, culture, customers, etc.
- There is no right or wrong recommendation, as it will depend on the interviewees assessment of the qualitative concerns
- Key case steps:
 1. Evaluate existing and potential cost structure
 2. Explore alternative ideas for implementation
 3. Provide client recommendation

Money Bank Call Center

Fit: If you were a partner and could choose to work on any type of case, what would you do? What do you think you would learn?

Case prompt

- Our client is a large financial services firm with multiple locations around the world. Part of their service offering includes a 24-hour helpline. The client has their call centers in New York and Paris.
- The client has recently acquired a small firm (Firm B) in order to expand its reach in a particular geography. Firm B provides a subset of the services and has its call center located in the Philippines.
- The client has asked us to determine its strategy going forward for handling customer calls. In particular they want us to look into the call center operations.

Clarifying information

- Client Characteristics:
 - Provides full range of financial services for individuals and small organizations
 - Acquired firm was started 5 years ago and is still run by the original founders
- Call Center Characteristics:
 - New employees are college graduates with basic knowledge of financial services and products
 - Fluency in English and several European languages required
- Regulatory Environment:
 - Very difficult to lay off employees in the Paris location & significant costs will be incurred
 - Philippines government encourages investment in the country & significant tax advantage possible

Money Bank Call Center

Exhibit A – Call Center Performance FY 2010

Center	Calls / Year	Employee Cost / Year (\$)	Overhead Cost / Year (\$)	# Employees
New York	600,000	50,000	450,000	75
Paris	400,000	50,000	600,000	60
Philippines	300,000	20,000	300,000	75

Money Bank Call Center

Part 1

1. Evaluate existing and potential cost structure

Provide Exhibit A when the interviewee asks about call center performance

- Here, the interviewee needs to:
 - Compare the efficacy of the three locations & possible explanations for variance;
 - Identify the cost effective options & how it is impacted by integration cost
 - Additional information:
 - Total cost incurred by the 2 firms is \$9.6M
 - Philippines currently processes calls at half the efficiency of NY (per employee)
 - Interviewee could ask about available slack at any of the call centers but should be advised that all call centers are currently operating at capacity
 - If asked, state that currently, we have space, infrastructure necessary to expand. Assume overhead is variable in this case. The candidate should be able to calculate that to process total call volume Philippines will need an additional 250 employees to handle the traffic (1.3M total calls/ 4000 calls/employee in Philippines). Operating cost after the change will be \$7.8M; net savings of \$1.8M.
-
- The interviewee should realize that this does not account for all the costs, including hiring and training costs. When prompted inform the interviewee about a 1 time cost of \$5M (includes severance for NY and Paris, expanding the Philippines facility) implying that the move is not profitable

Money Bank Call Center

Part 2

2. Explore alternative ideas for implementation

- Client will not budge on two-year breakeven
 - Prompt the interviewee to explore ways to make outsourcing to the Philippines feasible
 - Other options: decrease \$5m investment cost; increase efficiency of Philippines employees (guide interviewee towards the latter)
-
- The interviewee needs to identify the difference in calls / employee between the New York and Philippines locations
 - Ask the interviewee to assume that the best practices can be transferred and implemented within 3-6 months
 - Potential cost savings if Philippines achieves same effectiveness as New York
 - # employees required = $1.3\text{M calls} / 8,000 \text{ calls / employee / year} = 162.5$ (allow rounding to 160)
 - New employee cost = $160 * \$20,000 = \3.2M
 - Ask interviewee to assume overheads double with the need for better equipment. Before the efficiency improvement, OH = \$1.3M for 1.3M call. New OH = \$2.6M
 - New total cost = $\$3.2\text{M} + \$2.6 = \$5.8\text{M}$ (\$3.8M savings from status quo and \$2M better than pre-efficiency improved option)
 - Other questions interviewee needs to consider
 - Will the client be able to acquire sufficient talented personnel within the short time frame?
 - How will customer satisfaction be impacted with the new labor base?
 - Legal constraints / requirements in NY and Paris – how quickly can we lay off the staff?
 - How will public opinion be impacted by the news of massive outsourcing?

Money Bank Call Center

Part 3

3. Provide client recommendation

- This is an open ended case. The interviewee needs to justify the recommendation based on the qualitative considerations
 - A good recommendation would include 3 sections:
 - Recommendation: If the recommendation is to outsource the interviewee needs to highlight the risks associated with outsourcing and nature of the acquired firm. If the recommendation uses any other approach sufficient justification needs to be given to overcome the cost savings
 - Risks:
 - Risks associated with increasing capacity by more than 200% in the Philippines – people, infrastructure, service quality, gaps in knowledge transfer, organizational changes, etc.
 - Reputational impact – do customers notice a difference in service, can the competitor leverage this to steal customers?
 - Next steps: If outsourcing, some of the next steps would be to analyze the infrastructure requirements and capabilities, find the right talent, ensure smooth transfer and implementation of best practices, etc.
-
- The interviewee should explore the option of improving effectiveness of the Philippines location without being prompted
 - Excellent interviewees need to address the qualitative information provided in the case: nature of merger, nature of markets being served, etc.

Case 18

Montoya Soup

Concepts tested

- Z14 Pricing strategy (2)
- Z10 Customer marketing strategy (3)

Primary sector(s)

- X02 Agriculture & Food
- X12 Retail & CPG

Case type

- Y01 Cost Reduction
- Y07 Profitability

Similar cases

- Frozen Food Co (Columbia 2017)
- Dark Sky (Kellogg 2021)
- Orrington Office Supplies (Kellogg 2021)

Case author(s): Nico Montoya (Kellogg 2016)
Edited by: Michael Eidem (Kellogg 2020)

Montoya Soup

Interviewer guide

Case Question

- In F14, Montoya Soup, a business unit of Izzy's Healthy Foods, grew revenue and increased the contribution margins on their traditional and light soups.
- However, a spike in fixed costs caused them to see a dip in profitability. To offset this effect in F15, they launched a line of premium soups to increase volume and generate economies of scale.
- Though they felt the new launch was a success, their profitability dropped again in F15. They have hired you to diagnose the problem and propose a solution for F16.

Interviewer guide

- Problem: Determine what is causing Montoya's profitability decrease and analyze/recommend a method for improving it.
- Key case steps:
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Deep dive – Why did profitability decline?
 3. Deep dive – How do we fix profitability? (pricing strategy and potential cost reductions)
 4. Provide client recommendation

Montoya Soup

Fit: Tell me about your favorite class at business school thus far.

Case Question

- In F14, Montoya Soup, a business unit of Izzy's Healthy Foods, grew revenue and increased the contribution margins on their traditional and light soups.
- However, a spike in fixed costs caused them to see a dip in profitability. To offset this effect in F15, they launched a line of premium soups to increase volume and generate economies of scale.
- Though they felt the new launch was a success, their profitability dropped again in F15. They have hired you to diagnose the problem and propose a solution for F16.

Clarifying information

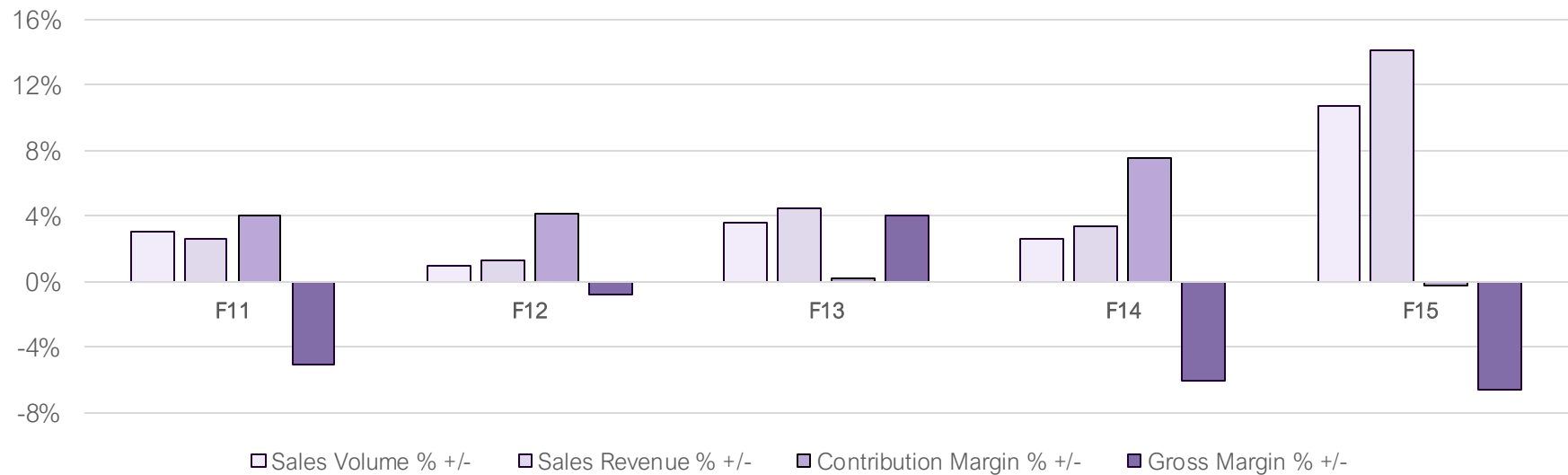
There is limited clarifying info up front, the interviewee will have to be comfortable making assumptions regarding the prompt and moving forward based on an inherent knowledge of the grocery industry.

- **Client:** Montoya sells cases of soup to buyers at grocery retailers who mark up the units inside to sell.
- **Product:** Traditional, Light, and Premium are the only product lines in Montoya Soup Co.'s product portfolio.

The prompt hints that revenue is up and fixed costs haven't increased in 2015, so the candidate should be thinking about variable costs right away. That said, this is a portfolio pricing strategy case disguised as a cost reduction case and a strong candidate might recognize that possibility.

Montoya Soup

Exhibit A – Performance Metrics



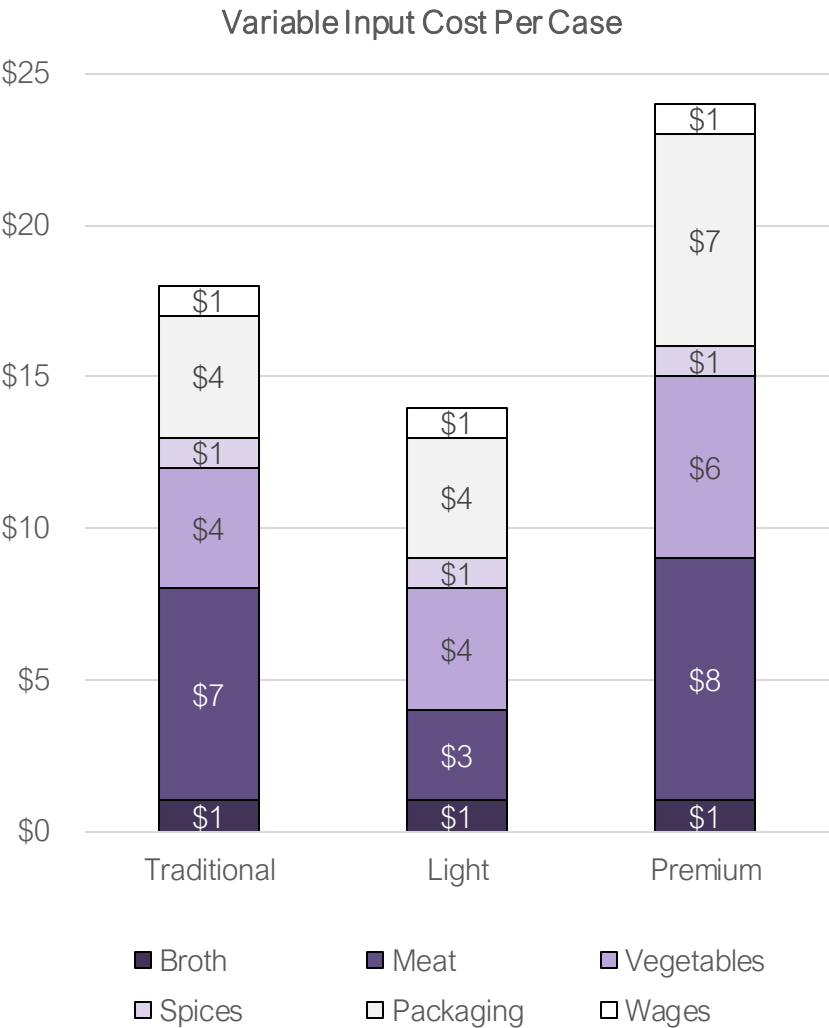
	F10	F11	F12	F13	F14	F15
Sales Vol. (M of cases)	126.5	130.4	131.7	136.5	140.0	155.0
Sales Rev. (M)	\$3,282	\$3,366	\$3,409	\$3,560	\$3,680	\$4,200
Contribution Margin (M)	\$1,165	\$1,212	\$1,261	\$1,264	\$1,360	\$1,356
Gross Margin (M)	\$65.2	\$61.9	\$61.4	\$63.9	\$60.0	\$56.0

Montoya Soup

Exhibit B – Product Lines

“Our research showed that many of our consumers were willing to pay more for a product with more meat and vegetable bounty in a carton (instead of a can). After testing several price points, we decided a lower margin and higher volume would help us reach the economies of scale we wanted to see. Consumers loved the product and thought it was a great bargain!”

	Trad.	Light	Prem.
Wholesale Price	\$28	\$24	\$30
F 14 Vol. (M cases)	80	60	-
F 15 Vol. (M cases)	60	55	40



Montoya Soup

Exhibit C – Demand Analysis

Cost Reduction Effect on Demand

“We looked into moving premium out of cartons and into cans. On the plus side, it would gain us \$3 of margin per case, but on the con side it would decrease demand by 20% and cannibalization of our Traditional line would spike to 75%.”

“We could decrease our meat and vegetable bounty to be on par with Traditional. That would buy us \$3 of margin points and consumers shouldn’t know the difference, in the short run at least.”

Price Elasticity & Cannibalization

	Last Year	Increase Price
Premium Price	\$30	\$33
Premium Demand (M cases)	40	20
Traditional Cannibalization Rate	50%	10%
Light Cannibalization Rate	12.5%	0%

Montoya Soup

Exhibit D – Stakeholder Input

Customer Feedback

- *“We really loved the new Premium Montoya Soup offering, it brought a new consumer to the shelf-stable soup category when all of the other players were introducing products that just stole from their competitors.”*
- *“We’re planning to give more shelf space to Montoya Soup in F16 after their successful premium launch this year. Our guests really loved the new packaging format and the higher meat and vegetable content. Product trial wasn’t extremely high, but we saw a lot of repeat purchases from the people who were buying.”*

Consumer Focus Group Excerpts

- *“I’m trying to eat healthier, and I’m really nervous about canned products with their BPA lining. As soon as Montoya came out with their new carton soup, I switched right away from their Traditional line and I’m never going back!”*
- *“I definitely think their brand is rising with me, the old stuff was mostly broth, this new stuff is a huge bargain and it actually has actual stuff in it.”*
- *“Glad to see that when everyone else is trying to rip you off, Montoya is making soup that actually tastes like something I would make at home.”*

Montoya Soup

Part 1

1. Develop framework for how to approach this problem

A sample case structure would include the following:

Question: Why is profitability down and what to do about it?

- Has **Revenue** decreased?
 - Volume: Has volume of sales changed? Are we selling different quantities of different products? How can we increase sales of higher margin soups? Are there new customer types we could target (restaurants, convenience stores, etc.)?
 - Price: Has price changed? How elastic is price to customers / is there room to increase it? Are we in line with our competition?
- Have **Costs** gone up?
 - Fixed: How have fixed costs changed? Facilities, R&D, marketing spend, distribution systems, etc. How can we adjust costs?
 - Variable: Have variable costs changed? Raw soup materials, labor, packaging, etc.
- Have there been changes in the **Market**?
 - Is the soup market growing/shrinking? Are grocery store sales increasing/decreasing?
 - Customers: Have shoppers' tastes & preferences changed? Are shoppers shifting to freshly made soup instead of packed?
 - Competition: Are there new companies competing with us? Have substitute products entered the market?
- **Risks** that need to be considered when making changes:
 - Competitive response, cannibalization of our other soup product lines, upsetting major grocery chain customers, etc.

Montoya Soup

Part 2

2. Deep dive – Why did profitability decline?

Several potential paths a candidate might want to dig into.

Provide Exhibit A

and then follow the below lines of thought:

Revenue

- Growth was driven by premium line. There was some cannibalization of traditional and light lines.

Question: “What trends do you see with regard to top line growth?”

Insights:

- Revenue grew significantly in F15, much faster than in any other year in recent history.
- Revenue outpaced volume, meaning that not only did revenue grow, but it grew even though avg price increased

Provide Exhibit B

Costs

- Input prices are the same as F14 for the traditional & light lines. No add'l wastage. No change in formulation.

Question:

- “What happened with fixed costs in F15? Variable costs?”
- “What could have driven up VC’s?”

Insights:

- FC’s were flat at \$1.3B in F15 (GM – CM = FC’s), so profit decline was driven by an increase in VC’s.
- Increase in VC’s could have come from pricier mix of inputs, same inputs but increase in input prices, more waste, or change in demand mix.

Provide Exhibit B

Product Mix

Questions:

- “How can profitability be down if revenue is up, FC’s are flat, and the cost of our inputs have not changed?”
- “What info do you need to look into fixing the product mix to optimize profitability?”

Insights:

- Assuming no change in formulation or wastage, then the issue must be with cannibalization of higher margin products by lower margin ones.
- Candidates should want to look at the product lines’ prices, COGS, elasticity, and cannibalization rates.

Provide Exhibit B

Montoya Soup

Part 3

3. Deep dive – How do we fix profitability?

There are several potential routes towards improving profits. When appropriate:

Provide Exhibit B&C

Cost Reduction

- If asked: Competitors aren't playing in the "premium" space, only in "value" and "super-premium."

Question:

- "How much profit do we make per case of Premium? Traditional? Light?"

Insight:

- \$10 contribution margin on Traditional & Light, \$6 contribution margin on Premium (price – sum of VC's).
- Largest opportunity for variable cost reduction would be in packaging, meat, and vegetable, but reducing these might erode value prop of premium product.
- *(Math on following page)*

Pricing (Cannibalization / Elasticity)

- If we both raise prices and change packaging, we will lose enormous distribution.

Question:

- "What is the optimum price for profitability?"

Insights:

- Candidate should infer from Exhibit B that Premium cannibalized Traditional substantially.
- *(Math on next page)*

Stakeholder Value Proposition

Provide Exhibit D

Questions:

- "What are the long-run effects on customers for changing packaging? For reducing meat/veg costs? For increasing prices?"
- "What about for the end consumer?"

Insights:

- Candidate should see that customers are willing to pay for a pricier product, but that reducing variable costs (and thereby reducing quality) is not a viable long run strategy and will hurt the brand.

Montoya Soup

Part 3 (continued)

3. How do we fix profitability (math solutions)

Logic behind the math:

Below are the calculations the candidate would have to make if they calculated every single scenario. It seems like a lot, but keep in mind that the margins on Traditional and Light are \$10, so candidates can simply add a zero to the cannibalized volume number to get cannibalized profit.

The candidate should feel free to elect not to calculate the first two scenarios if deemed strategically unwise long-term decisions.

Net profit from Premium will be the profit from Premium minus profit lost from cannibalizing Traditional and Light.

	Unit Margin	Volume	Profit	Trad. Vol. Cannib.	Trad. Margin	Trad. Profit Lost	Light Vol. Cannib.	Light Margin	Light Profit Lost	Net Total Profit
Last Year	\$6	40	\$240	-20	\$10	(\$200)	-5	\$10	(\$50)	(\$10)
If packaging changed	\$9	32	\$288	-24	\$10	(\$240)	-5	\$10	(\$50)	(\$2)
If meat/veg costs reduced	\$9	40	\$360	-20	\$10	(\$200)	-5	\$10	(\$50)	\$110
If price raised to \$33	\$9	20	\$180	-2	\$10	(\$20)	0	\$10	\$0	\$160

Montoya Soup

Part 4

4. Provide client recommendation

Overall:

- Profits have declined due to the introduction of a margin-dilutive product line that cannibalized higher margin products.
- Recommendation is to increase price of Premium product line to \$33 per case to maximize profitability (Gross profit would more than quadruple). This recommendation:
 - Increases margins (though volume will drop)
 - Reduces cannibalization substantially
 - Other alternative cost-reduction measures hurt value proposition and will cause long-run issues with brand equity.

Risks:

- Pricing measures didn't consider competitive response (could competitor come in with a lower priced premium soup and force us out of the category?)
- Raising prices could upset some buyers and lose distribution
- Opportunity cost: could be better long-term strategy to keep prices low and start phasing out of old lines, ramping up Premium.

Next steps:

- Perform due diligence on long-term consumer preference forecast
- Launch advertising campaign to make sure we can justify higher prices and defend from competitors
- Look to reduce high fixed costs so we can protect against potentially price-aggressive competitors or increased commodity prices.

Case 19

Mustard Clinic

Interviewer-led

Concepts tested

- Z04 Capacity (3)
- Z12 Creativity (4)

Primary sector(s)

- X08 Healthcare

Case type

- Y07 Profitability
- Y01 Cost reduction
- Y05 Operations

Similar cases

- Alkaline Ash (Columbia 2017)
- Garthwaite Healthcare (Kellogg 2021)
- Princeton-Plainsboro (Wharton 2012)
- Orrington Office Supplies (Kellogg 2021)

Edited by: Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020)

Mustard Clinic

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Your client is the CEO of the Mustard Clinic, a for-profit hospital in the United States.
- The hospital is known primarily for its leading care for babies and young children.
- Patients pay a fixed fee to access services on arrival, and all subsequent costs are borne by the Mustard Clinic.
- Sugar Magnolia does not deal with insurance providers. Instead, patients submit expense claims directly with their insurance provider(s).
- In the last few years, the hospital's profitability has fallen, and they are facing bankruptcy. Last year they lost \$1.4m
- The CEO asks you: "Why has profitability gone down and how can we turn it around?"

Interviewer guide

- Problem: How can the Mustard Clinic break even (increase profits by \$1.4m)?
 1. Analyze customer segments
 2. Determine cost impact of shorter patient stays
 3. Determine profit impact of shorter patient stays
 4. Brainstorm ways to shorten patient stays
 5. Provide client recommendation

Mustard Clinic

Experience: Tell me about a time you implemented a new way of doing things in an organization.

Case prompt

- Your client is the CEO of the Mustard Clinic, a for-profit hospital in the United States.
- The hospital is known primarily for its leading care for babies and young children.
- Patients pay a fixed fee to access services on arrival, and all subsequent costs are borne by the Mustard Clinic.
- Sugar Magnolia does not deal with insurance providers. Instead, patients submit expense claims directly with their insurance provider(s).
- In the last few years, the hospital's profitability has fallen, and they are facing bankruptcy. Last year they lost \$1.4m
- The CEO asks you: "Why has profitability gone down and how can we turn it around?"

Clarifying information

- **Goal**: The Mustard Clinic wants to at least break even.
- **Customers**: The Clinic cannot influence its patient mix in the short term.
- **Services**: The Clinic offers intrapartum (childbirth), neonatal (for newborns), pediatrics (for infants and children) and a small geriatrics (for the elderly) unit.
- **Competitors**: There aren't any competitors that have contributed to the Mustard Clinic's problem.
- **Revenue model**: Customers are charged a fixed fee at the time of checking-in. All subsequent costs are borne by the Mustard Clinic.

Mustard Clinic

Exhibit A – Key hospital unit metrics

Segment	Description	Annual volume (patients)	Average stay (nights)
Intrapartum	Care of due and in-labor mothers (during labor and childbirth)	500	10
Neonatal	Care of premature newborns (first 28 days of life)	300	7
Pediatrics	Care of infants, children, and adolescents (up to age 21)	150	11
Geriatrics	Care of elderly patients (aged 60 and over)	50	25

Mustard Clinic

Exhibit B – Cost structure

Fixed costs	\$1.4m
Variable costs	\$600/patient per night
Average stay (nights)	10
Patients per year	1,000
Capacity utilization*	100%

Notes:

- Capacity = Total number of patient nights per year that the Mustard Clinic can accommodate

Mustard Clinic

Part 1

1. Analyze customer segments

Provide Exhibit A

- Our team has conducted the following analysis on various groups of customers.
- Providing overnight care is expensive for the Mustard Clinic. In number of nights, what is the average stay duration for a Mustard Clinic patient?

Unit	Volume	Average stay (nights)	Total nights
Intrapartum	500	10	$500 \times 10 = 5,000$
Neonatal	300	7	$300 \times 7 = 2,100$
Pediatrics	150	11	$150 \times 11 = 1,650$
Geriatrics	50	25	$50 \times 25 = 1,250$
Total	1,000		10,000

- Average stay duration = Total nights / Number of patients = $10,000 / 1,000 = 10$ nights
- Takeaway: Because we have a fixed fee arrangement, it might be worth looking to reduce the average patient stay duration.

Part 2

2. Determine cost impact of shorter patient stays

Provide [Exhibit B](#)

- If the Mustard Clinic were to reduce the length of an average patient stay by two nights, what would be the cost savings?

Costs with 10 night stay

- Fixed costs: \$1.4m
- Variable costs: 1,000 patients x 10 night stay x \$600 per night = \$6m

Costs with 8 night stay

- Fixed costs: \$1.4m
- Variable costs: 1,000 patients x 8 night stay x \$600 per night = \$4.8m
- **Takeaway:** Shorter stays saves \$1.2m, which is promising but doesn't help the Mustard Clinic breakeven.
- But shorter stays also frees up capacity for new patients.

Part 3

3. Determine profit impact of shorter patient stays

- Reducing the average stay length frees up space for new patients. How many additional patients can we serve and what would be the impact on profit if the average revenue per patient is \$6,000?
-
- Hospital capacity: $1,000 \text{ patients} \times 10 \text{ nights average stay} = 10,000 \text{ patient nights}$
 - Capacity made available from stay reduction: $1,000 \text{ patients} \times 2 \text{ night stay reduction} = 2,000 \text{ patient nights}$
 - Additional patients that could be served: $2,000 \text{ patient nights} / 8 \text{ night average stay} = 250 \text{ additional patients}$
 - Revenue: $1,250 \text{ patients per year} \times \$6,000 \text{ revenue per patient} = \7.5m
 - Fixed Cost: \$1.4m
 - Variable Cost: $1,250 \text{ patients per year} \times 8 \text{ night average stay} \times \$600 \text{ variable costs per night} = \6m
 - Profit = $\$7.5\text{m} - (\$1.4\text{m} + \$6\text{m}) = \100k
 - **Takeaway:** The Mustard Clinic can return to profitability by shortening patient stays by 2 nights and using the freed up capacity.

Part 4

4. Brainstorm ways to shorten patient stays

- What are some ways in which the Mustard Clinic could reduce the average patient stay duration from 10 to 8 nights?
-
- The actual ideas are less important here than providing some approach to structuring the brainstorm. One example might be to use steps in the patient journey to identify areas to optimize speed.

Patient Journey				
Admittance	Diagnosis	Surgery	Recovery	Other
• Decrease/eliminate geriatrics unit	• More receptionists • Partner hospitals • Tele-diagnosis	• Technology • Doctor skill/quality • Operational delays?	• Tele-medicine • At-home care • Partner hospitals	• End fixed fee pricing • Drive awareness of cost structure to doctors

Part 5

5. Provide client recommendation

- **Overall**, the Mustard Clinic can meet their goal and return to profit.
 - This is based on decreasing average patient stay duration from 10 to 8 days, which:
 - Saves \$1.2m in variable costs per patient night for all patients
 - Frees up capacity for 250 additional patients
 - Brings in \$300k in profit from these additional patients
 - One way to reduce patient stay duration would be to close the Geriatrics unit, which is not our core competency.
 - **Risks:** Reducing average patient stay might affect revenues if patient care worsens or if Geriatrics is a complementary service.
 - **Next steps:** Feasibility study into tactical ways to actually reduce average without impacting patient care.
-
- Strong candidates maintain organization well since there are several points in the case when they will need to refer back to previous clarifying information, exhibits or calculations.
 - Outstanding candidates are able to think strategically about the impact of changes throughout the case. Structures math and finds quick ways to do calculations (eg. Q2 saving = 2 nights x 1,000 patients x \$600 per night = \$1.2m)

Case 20

Orrington Office Supplies

Concepts tested

- Z04 Capacity

Primary sector(s)

- X04 Engineering & Construction

Case type

- Y05 Operations
- Y07 Profitability

Similar cases

- Alkaline Ash (Columbia 2017)
- Garthwaite Healthcare (Kellogg 2021)
- Princeton-Plainsboro (Wharton 2012)
- Mustard Clinic (Kellogg 2021)

Edited By: Peter Manoogian (Kellogg 2012), Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020)

Orrington Office Supplies

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client, Orrington Office Supplies (OOS) is a leading manufacturer of office products in 1992, with sales of \$275m in 1991. They have strong brands, invest heavily in marketing and advertising, and have grown through product line extensions and 4 key acquisitions.
- OOS is organized into 5 autonomous divisions, but shares manufacturing and marketing functions. Shared costs (45% of total) are allocated on a percentage share of sales method. There are three plants running at a current capacity utilization of 50%.
- Analysts predict OOS is a potential acquisition target given its strong balance sheet but weakening earnings. They are publicly traded and have little long-term debt. As a potential investor, how would you improve its profitability?

Interviewer guide

- Problem: How can OOS increase profits?
- Problem solving steps:
 1. Identify trends in sales and profit
 2. Analyze plant production operations
 3. Determine financial impact of plant consolidation
 4. Provide client recommendation

Orrington Office Supplies

Fit: What role do you typically play in a team? Give me an example of this.

Case prompt

- Our client, Orrington Office Supplies (OOS) is a leading manufacturer of office products in 1992, with sales of \$275m in 1991. They have strong brands, invest heavily in marketing and advertising, and have grown through product line extensions and 4 key acquisitions.
- OOS is organized into 5 autonomous divisions, but shares manufacturing and marketing functions. Shared costs (45% of total) are allocated on a percentage share of sales method. There are three plants running at a current capacity utilization of 50%.
- Analysts predict OOS is a potential acquisition target given its strong balance sheet but weakening earnings. They are publicly traded and have little long-term debt. As a potential investor, how would you improve its profitability?

Clarifying information

Industry

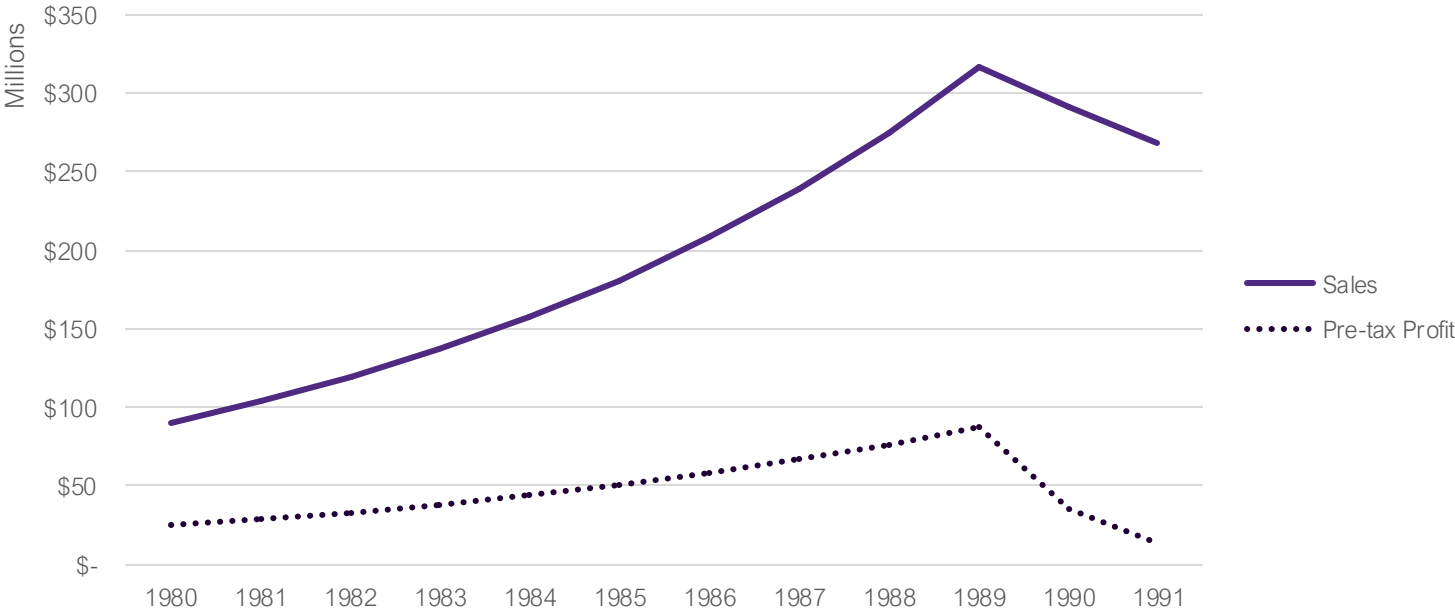
- U.S. Office supplies market grew at 5% CAGR historically. In 1990 and 1991, the market declined at 5% per year.
- Superstore channel is becoming increasingly critical
 - Gained 10 share pts in past 2 years
 - Typically discount products 30% to small retailers/dealers
- Superstores are aggressively substituting private label products for traditional brand names

Client Characteristics

- Broader product line than competitors (12.5k SKUs vs. 4-5k for competitors)
- Distribution: 75% wholesalers, 15% superstores, 10% end customers
- Highest selling product is a high-end branded stapler
- Staples, Inc. is OOS's largest customer

Orrington Office Supplies

Exhibit A – Historical revenues and profits



	1980 to 1989	1989 to 1991
Sales CAGR	15%	-8%
Pre-tax Profit CAGR	15%	-40%

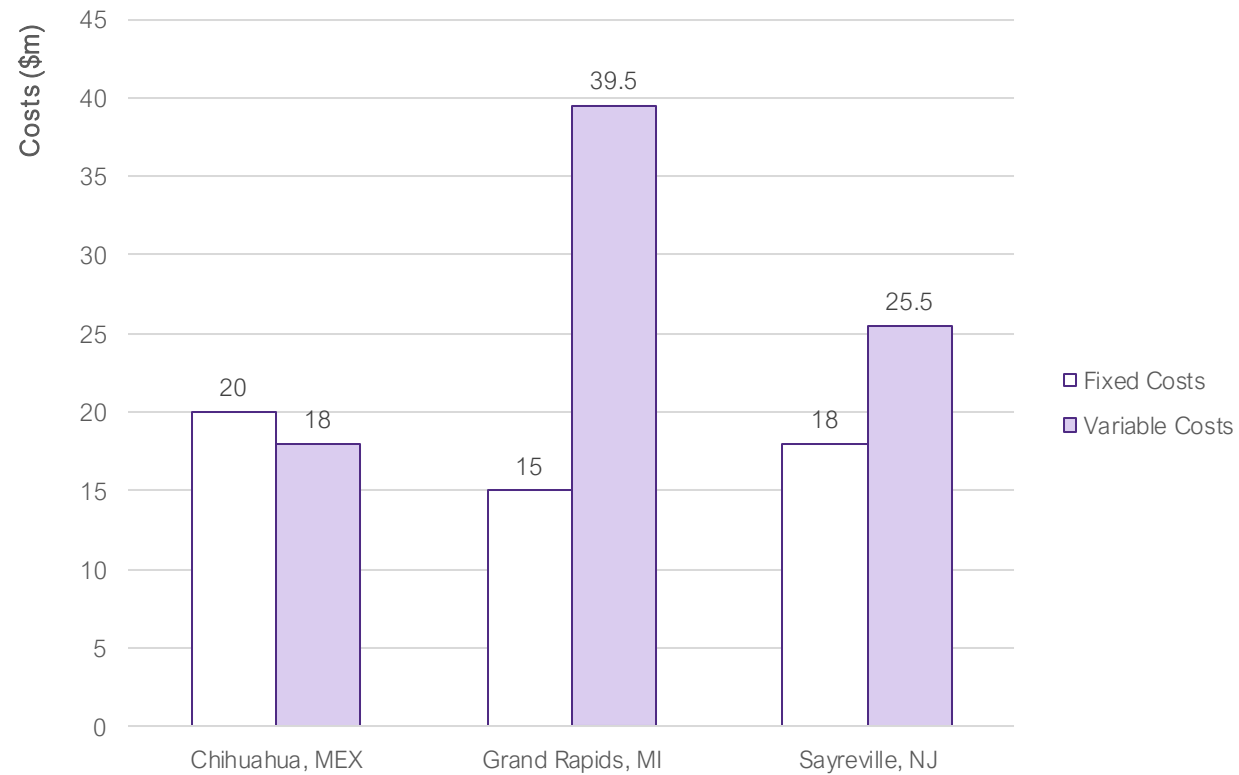
Orrington Office Supplies

Exhibit B – Production plants



Orrington Office Supplies

Exhibit C – Plant operating costs



Orrington Office Supplies

Part 1

1. Identify trends in sales and profit

Provide Exhibit A after the candidate asks about profitability

- Why do the slopes for sales and profits differ as time elapses?
-
- The interviewee should not only be able to interpret the data on this slide, but also come up with two insights:
 1. The fact profits have been declining more steeply than sales reflects the fixed-cost nature of this business, and;
 2. The reason that sales did not grow at a faster clip than profitability during the 1980s likely reflects a strategy to grow through acquisitions, which prevented OOS from seeing the gains through economies of scale that one would normally expect in a business such as this

Orrington Office Supplies

Part 2

2. Analyze plant production operations

Provide Exhibit B after the candidate asks about plant consolidation

- Qualitatively discuss the potential options for plant consolidation with the interviewee.
-
- The interviewee should recognize the Chihuahua plant is close to having capacity to produce OOS's 12.5k SKUs. Either OOS can close that plant and move all production to the US, or it could close the US plants, discontinue 500 SKUs and move production to Chihuahua.
 - Strong interviewees will note that Chihuahua is the most feasible strategy, but will ask to see fixed and variable cost data.

Orrington Office Supplies

Part 3

3. Determine financial impact of plant consolidation

Provide Exhibit C after the candidate asks about Costs

- How would this change revenues? (currently \$275m/year)
 - How would this change production costs? What are they now?
 - How would this change pre-tax profits (currently \$25m/year?)
-
- **Revenues:** Each SKU earns annual revenues of \$22k (\$275m divided by 12,500 SKUs) therefore, eliminating 500 SKUs will decrease annual revenue by \$11m, or 4%
 - **Costs:**

<i>Each plant currently has the following annual costs:</i>	<i>Each plant has the following variable cost per SLU:</i>
Chihuahua: \$20m + \$18m = \$38.0m	Chihuahua: \$18m / 4.5k SKUs = \$4k per SKU
Michigan: \$15m + \$39.5m = \$54.5m	Michigan: \$39.5m / 5k SKUs = \$7.9k per SKU
New Jersey: \$18m + \$25.5m = \$43.5m	New Jersey: \$25.5m / 3k SKUs = \$8.5k per SKU
\$136m	
 - Consolidating revenues to Chihuahua will reduce annual costs by 50% to:
 - Chihuahua: \$20m + (\$4k * 12k SKUs) = \$20m + \$48m = \$68.0m
 - **Profits:** We increased profits by \$57m (\$68m - \$11m) to \$82m, which more than triples them.

Orrington Office Supplies

Part 4

4. Provide client recommendation

- Overall, our client should eliminate 500 SKUs and consolidate all production to the Chihuahua plant to raise annual profits from \$25m to \$82m.
 - The client should also consider several qualitative issues:
 - Implementation: Long-term timeframe.
 - Unionized labor: Whether organized labor exists at closing plants and the impact of that
 - Distribution and Warehousing: We will need a carefully-developed transition plan.
 - Purchasing: We will need to transition to a strong central purchasing department, rather than smaller local ones.
 - Culture: Communicating the change properly is key, and we will need to ensure that morale does not take a nosedive.
-
- **Excellent interviewees** need to recognize what macroeconomic issues are beyond the scope of the client's control and then quickly dive into the plant consolidation, then analyze the cost structures

Case 21

Plastic World

Concepts tested

- Z13 Organizational changes
- Z07 Market share
- Z10 Customer strategy

Primary sector(s)

- X06 Financial Services

Case type

- Y03 Mergers & Acquisitions

Similar cases

- Snack Foods Acquisition (Wharton 2017)
- Steel Corp (Haas 2015)
- Soda Ash Producer (Columbia 2017)

Case authors: Milija Medic
Edited By: Peter Manoogian (Kellogg 2012), Laura Mast (Kellogg 2020)

Plastic World

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client is a private equity firm interested in Plastic World, a plastic packaging manufacturer.
- Plastic World's owners are requesting \$25m. The offer is final. Should our client buy the company?

Interviewer guide

- Problem: Should the PE firm purchase Plastic World for \$25m?
- Problem solving steps:
 1. Examine financial statements
 2. Explore feasibility of target's profit margin improvement
 3. Provide client recommendations

Plastic World

Fit: Tell me about a time that you demonstrated entrepreneurial drive in a non-professional environment.

Case prompt

- Our client is a private equity firm interested in Plastic World, a plastic packaging manufacturer.
- Plastic World's owners are requesting \$25m. The offer is final. Should our client buy the company?

Clarifying information

- **Company**
 - Makes plastic packaging for beverages, cosmetics, household and automotive chemicals
 - Products are top quality, they have 350 sets of molds, with different materials, finish, colors, always innovating
 - Overall product mix has not changed in recent years
 - The sales force is "the best in breed", they hold market share, and they are compensated on market share
 - Two years ago they invested further in equipment for product innovation
- **Customers**
 - Plastic Worlds' customers exhibit strong loyalty
 - They are experiencing increasing pressures in their industries to innovate the plastic packaging

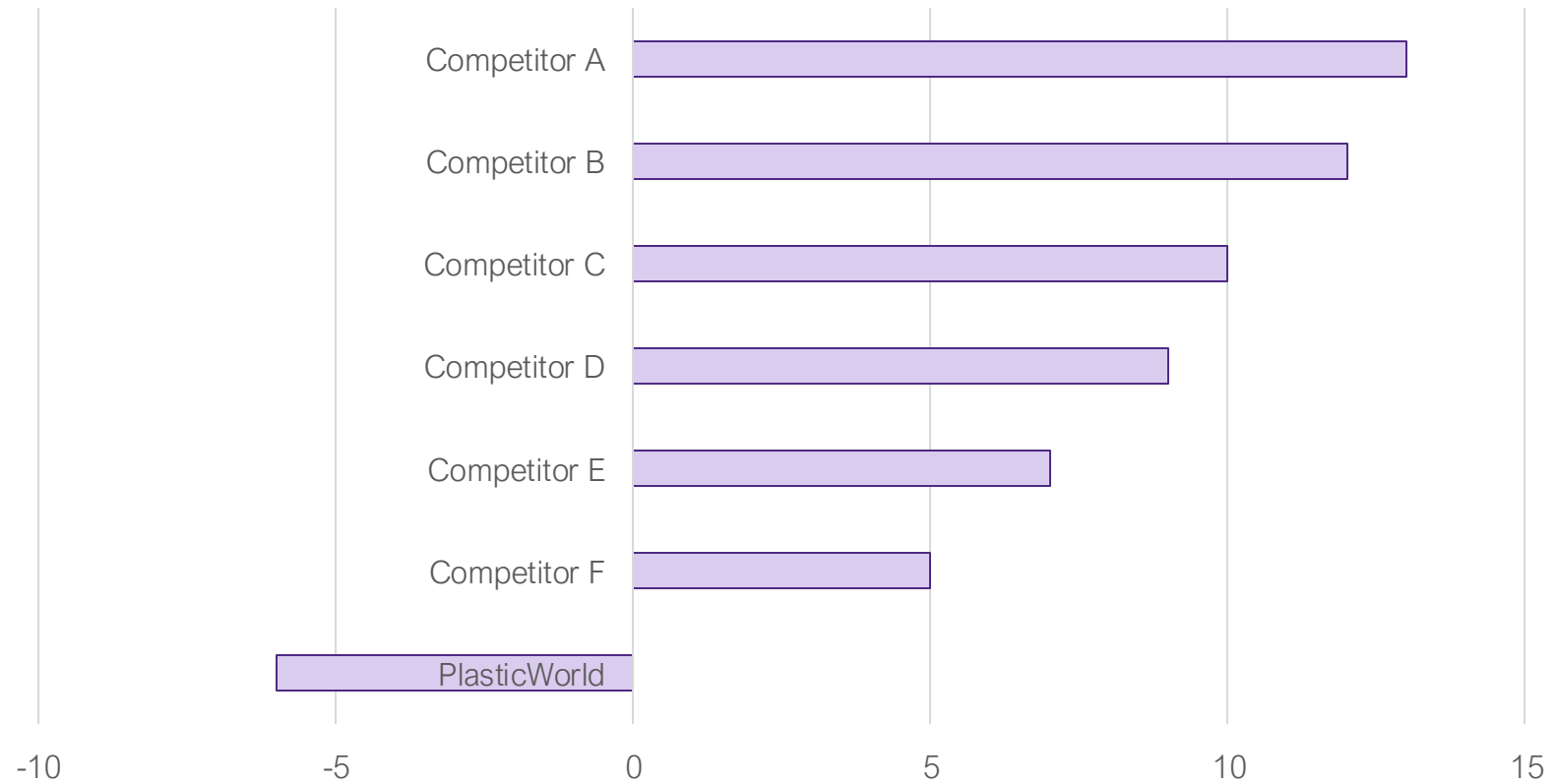
Plastic World

Exhibit A – Profit & Loss statement

		2018	2017	2016
Sales	(\$)	18,824,000	19,180,000	19,650,000
Volume	(units)	36,200,000	34,250,000	32,750,000
COGS	(\$)	9,050,000	8,900,000	8,650,000
SG&A	(\$)	7,500,000	7,200,000	7,300,000
Depreciation	(\$)	3,450,000	3,450,000	2,250,000
EBIT	(\$)	(1,176,000)	(370,000)	1,450,000

Plastic World

Exhibit B – Competitor Profit Margins



Plastic World

Exhibit C – Valuation by Profit Margin



Plastic World

Part 1

1. Examine financial statements

Provide Exhibit A immediately after the interviewee runs through their problem-solving structure

- What observations can be made from this P&L statement?
 - Would could be the reasons behind what is in the data?
-
- Plastic World has experienced a steady drop in revenues while the sales volume has been growing.
 - Profit margin is dropping and negative; Interviewee should calculate the profit margin (-6%)
 - Given the unchanged product mix and increasing sales volume, the drop in revenues is caused by a reduction in prices;
 - Depreciation change – it was equipment investment.
 - To check if it's an industry-wide or company-specific drop in profitability, they should request competition profitability data
 - Interviewee should ask about the product quality and customer loyalty to discard price competition as the reason to drop prices. The products are high-quality and customers are loyal, so most of them would buy even at a higher price.
 - The interviewee should find, asking independently or with your help, that sales force is compensated based on market share. This gives the sales force incentive to drop the prices.

Part 2

2. Explore feasibility of target's profit margin improvement

Provide Exhibit B when the interviewee requests information about Competitors

Provide Exhibit C after the interviewee starts talking about using Profit Margins in Valuation

- Exhibit B
 - The candidate should identify the profitability problem is client-specific, all competitors are profitable
 - Push the interviewee to discuss a realistic profit margin goal for Plastic World based on this industry profitability data
- Exhibit C
 - The observation from the graph is that the company would be worth \$25M if Plastic World increased profit margin from -6% to 0%. If the profit margin reached the industry average, the company would be worth \$40M.
 - Now the question is how easily can the profitability be increased above zero (making the company worth more than the \$25M). The sales force incentive change is easy to make.
 - Looking for other high-impact improvements, the dense product line and constant innovation is the next largest candidate. Eliminate some molds to cut costs, mindful of innovation pressures in PW's clients' industries.
- Interviewee should investigate the profitability drop and the low prices further and suggest options to get Plastic World's profitability in line with the industry, and their feasibility

Part 3

3. Provide client recommendation

- Our client should accept the \$25M offer and boost the profitability (and value) of PlasticWorld.
 - The client should engage in the following easy-to-implement changes:
 - Compensate sales force based on company earnings instead of market share.
 - Simplify the product line - eliminate some of the 350 molds to cut costs while leveraging the superior sales force to maintain client satisfaction.
 - Examine the industry best practices to find other areas for improvement.
-
- **Excellent interviewees** will immediately notice that the company would be worth more than \$25M if its profit margin was at the level of industry average.
 - **Outstanding interviewees** will quickly identify the pricing as the issue behind the revenue decrease and lay out potential causes for the price drop, finding the sales force incentive. A framework comprehensive enough to find the product line size problem is a bonus.

Case 22

Rotisserie Ranch

Interviewer-led

Concepts tested

- Z10 Customer marketing strategy

Primary sector(s)

- X02 Agriculture & Food
- X12 Retail & CPG

Case type

- Y04 New product
- Y06 Opportunity assessment

Similar cases

- Beverage Manufacturer (Wharton 2012)
- Botox (Stern 2012)

Case author(s): Brian Fox (Kellogg 2004)
Edited By: Adam Louras (Kellogg 2011), Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020)

Rotisserie Ranch

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client is Rotisserie Ranch, a poultry farming company that specializes in growing chickens for rotisserie roasting. Its primary customer segment is comprised of large grocery chains that buy chickens to fresh roast in the meat departments of their grocery stores.
- Market research has revealed to Rotisserie Ranch that more and more consumers have begun buying flavored rotisserie chickens recently.
- Rotisserie Ranch is thinking of pre-flavoring some of its chickens for grocers, what would you consider in making this recommendation?

Interviewer guide

- Problem: Should Rotisserie Ranch pre-flavor its chickens?
- Problem solving steps:
 1. Brainstorm value to customers of new product
 2. Analyze results of market test
 3. Provide client recommendation

Rotisserie Ranch

Fit: Tell me about a time you had to deal with a difficult boss.

Case prompt

- Our client is Rotisserie Ranch, a poultry farming company that specializes in growing chickens for rotisserie roasting. Its primary customer segment is comprised of large grocery chains that buy chickens to fresh roast in the meat departments of their grocery stores.
- Market research has revealed to Rotisserie Ranch that more and more consumers have begun buying flavored rotisserie chickens recently.
- Rotisserie Ranch is thinking of pre-flavoring some of its chickens for grocers, what would you consider in making this recommendation?

Clarifying information

- **Industry:** Predicting demand for cooked chickens is difficult for grocers; any leftover cooked chickens at the end of the day are thrown out; unthawed chickens cannot be re-frozen
- **Client:** Client has patented process for sterilely packaging chicken, so that it will remain fresh for 30 days, making freezing unnecessary. Client is currently the industry market share leader in rotisserie-ready chicken
- **Product:** Four New “Flavored” Products to be introduced concurrently: Barbecue, lemon herb, tandoori and teriyaki
- **Competitor:** No competition in new product market due to patented process

Rotisserie Ranch

Exhibit A – Store sales

	Standard Rotisserie		BBQ Seasoned Rotisserie	
Store	A	B	C	D
Weekly Sales	\$1,000	\$2,000	\$1,600	\$2,700
Retail Price	\$3.33	\$2.50	\$4.00	\$3.00
Retailer Margin	30%	30%	25%	25%

Rotisserie Ranch

Part 1

1. Brainstorm value to customers of new product

- Do you think that grocery retailers would be interested in pre-seasoned chickens from Rotisserie Ranch?
- After the interviewee brainstorms, ask them:
 - After several interviews, grocers are interested in Rotisserie Ranch's proposed new product, but first they want to be sure that the chickens will sell well. How would you make sure?
- The candidate may begin going into detail on how this test would be run. Cut him or her off as soon as you are comfortable that they understand that: (a) a pilot test should be run and (b) the pilot needs to have some control or comparison group.

Yes	No
• Labor Cost Reduction: Meat department workers; don't need to spend time seasoning the chickens. • Economies of Scale: Seasoning centralization; lower cost. • Product Consistency: Centrally managed; able to spend more on R&D.	• Loss of Differentiation: Grocery chains differentiate by value-added . • Attune to Local Needs: Likely to be better at gauging consumer tastes. • Increases Inventory & SKUs.

Rotisserie Ranch

Part 1

2. Analyze results of market test

Provide Exhibit A once the interviewee identifies the need for market testing

- A test market launch for the new Rotisserie Ranch BBQ chicken was administered. What is the overall profit for both Store A and B from the test market?
-
- Using Exhibit A, interviewee should calculate:
 - Retailer profit for Seasoned Chicken compared to Standard Chicken
 - Retailer profit = # of chickens sold * (price per chicken * retailer margin per chicken)
 - Standard Chicken (total profit for retailers = \$300 + \$600 = \$900/week)
 - Store A: \$1,000 (weekly sales) * 30% (retailer margin) = \$300 overall profit
 - Store B: \$2,000 (weekly sales) * 30% (retailer margin) = \$600 overall profit
 - Test Market BBQ Seasoned Chicken (total profit for retailers = \$400 + \$675 = \$1,075/week)
 - Store C: \$1,600 (weekly sales) * 25% (retailer margin) = \$400 overall profit
 - Store D: \$2,700 (weekly sales) * 25% (retailer margin) = \$675 overall profit

Part 3

3. Provide client recommendation

- Overall, our client should launch the Pre-Seasoned BBQ Chicken product and test other products because:
 - Competitive Necessity: Consumers are spending more money on seasoned rotisserie chicken than traditional rotisserie chicken and the market is shifting in this direction
 - Benefit to Grocers: Assuming test market was representative, Grocers can expect to earn \$175 more gross profit using our client's product relative to the standard rotisserie chicken
 - Potential scale benefits to our Client over time as more pre-seasoned chickens are sold

Case 23

Salty Sole Shoe

Concepts tested

- Z12 Creativity
- Z01 Accounting (2/3)
- Z09 Microeconomics

Primary sector(s)

- X12 Retail and Consumer
- X06 Financial Services

Case type

- Y07 Profitability

Similar cases

- US Shoe Manufacturing (Wharton 2017)
- Kicks (Tuck 2009)

{ Case authors: Meredith Tierney (Kellogg 2011)
Edited By: Uri Kalir (Kellogg 2012), Derek Wiatrowski (Kellogg 2020) }

Salty Sole Shoe

Interviewer Guide

Case prompt

- Your client is a large retail-focused private equity firm that owns Salty Sole, a leading designer of junior women's footwear, primarily targeting the 14 – 22 year old age group.
- Salty Sole was purchased last year by the private equity firm expecting to realize substantial profits upon sale in 2012 by increasing the company's EBITDA. The situation, however, is that due to a current recession, annual profit has only grown modestly post the acquisition and is not on track to generate the double-digit returns that the private equity firm originally anticipated.
- How can the company increase profitability and achieve the private equity firm's return on investment objectives?

Interviewer guide

- The case primarily tests an understanding of profitability and profitability growth strategies. Begin by reading the case question and asking the interviewee to take a few moments and then explain how they would like to proceed in the client's problem
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Analyze client costs
 3. Analyze client revenues
 4. Analyze market size/share
 5. Provide client recommendation

Salty Sole Shoe

Fit: What is an example of when you showed initiative and leadership?

Case prompt

- Your client is a large retail-focused private equity firm that owns Salty Sole, a leading designer of junior women's footwear, primarily targeting the 14 – 22 year old age group.
- Salty Sole was purchased last year by the private equity firm expecting to realize substantial profits upon sale in 2012 by increasing the company's EBITDA. The situation, however, is that due to a current recession, annual profit has only grown modestly post the acquisition and is not on track to generate the double-digit returns that the private equity firm originally anticipated.
- How can the company increase profitability and achieve the private equity firm's return on investment objectives?

Clarifying information

- **Industry Characteristics/Market Economics:** Client is the market leader in junior women's footwear in the U.S. only. Apparel industry is characterized by cyclical due to economy and consumer preferences.
- **Client Characteristics:** Client designs and distributes footwear to discount retailers (like Kohl's) and is considered mid-priced. Client outsources all manufacturing on a fixed-contract basis (i.e. manufacturing costs with outsourced providers fall under Fixed Costs for simplicity).
- **Competitive Dynamics:** Client follows a "me-too" strategy and follows fashion rather than inventing it then offering lower prices than name brands (i.e. not subject to fashion risk). Client competes on the basis of trendy fashion and value pricing.

Salty Sole Shoe

Exhibit A – Salty Sole Financial Estimates

(\$ in millions)

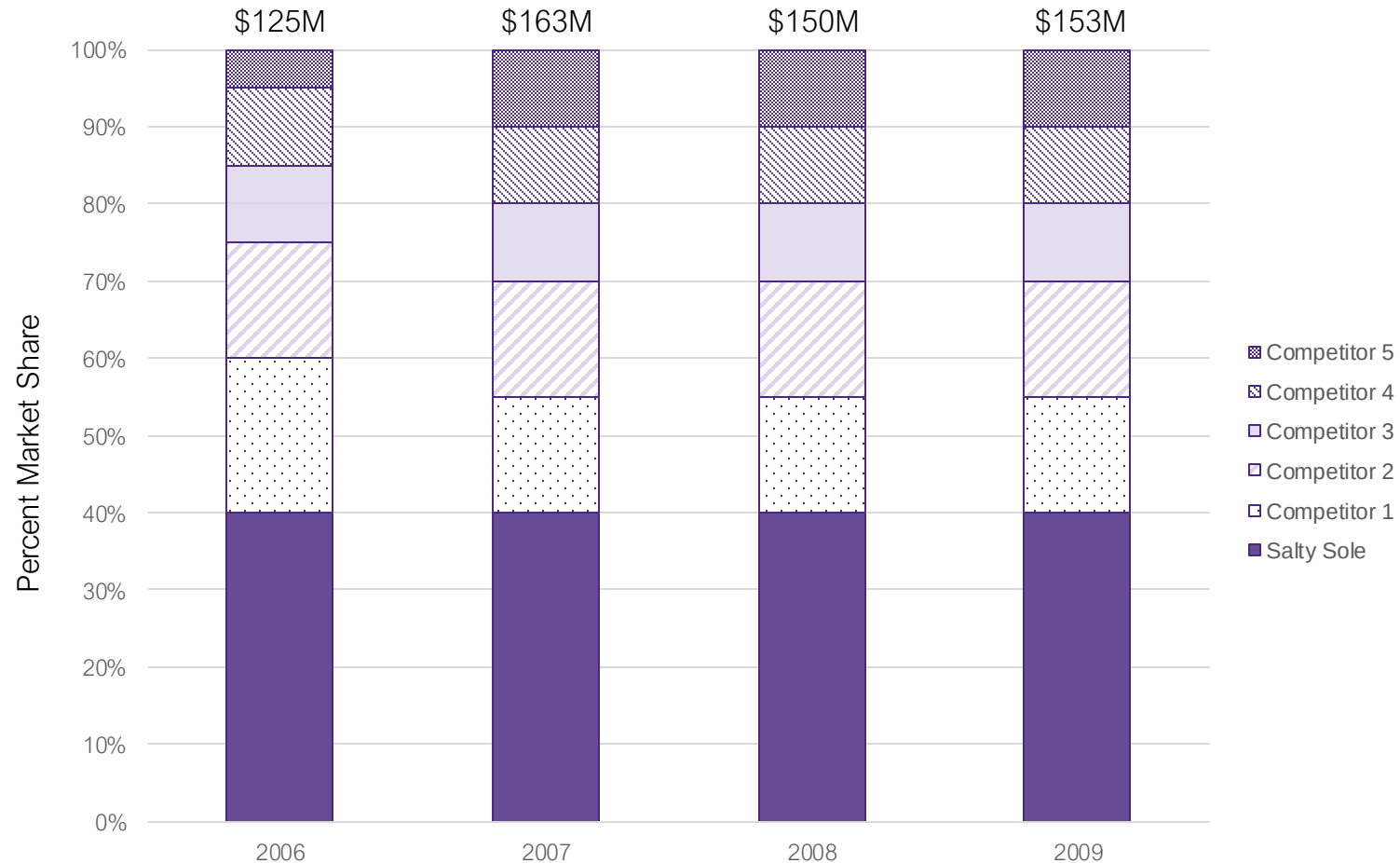
	2006A	2007A	2008A	2009E	2010E	2011E	2012E
Sales \$	50.0	65.0	60.0	61.0	62.0	65.0	70.0
Less Discounts/Allowances \$	(0.5)	(0.65)	(0.60)	(0.61)	(0.62)	(0.65)	(0.7)
Net Sales \$	49.5	64.35	59.4	60.39	61.38	64.38	69.3
% Increase	20.0	30.0	(7.7)	1.7	1.6	4.8	7.7
COGS	24.75	32.18	29.70	30.20	30.69	32.18	34.65
Fixed Costs	15.00	15.00	15.00	15.00	15.00	15.00	15.00
Total Costs	39.75	47.18	44.70	45.20	45.69	47.18	49.65
EBITDA \$	9.75	17.18	14.70	15.20	15.69	17.18	19.65
Sale Multiple	6.5x	6.5x	6.5x	6.5x	6.5x	6.5x	6.5x
Purchase/Sale Price \$		111.64	95.55	98.77	101.99	111.64	127.73
Return on Investment %							2.7

Notes:

- Acquisition occurred on December 31, 2006

Salty Sole Shoe

Exhibit B – US Casual Footwear Market Size and Share

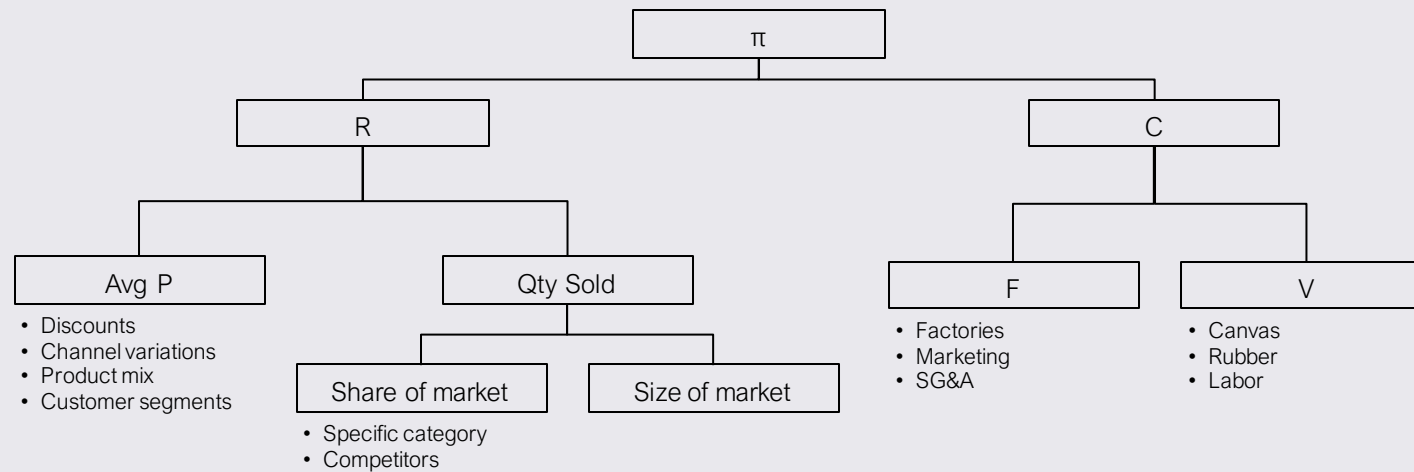


Salty Sole Shoe

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

- After asking the case question, the interviewee should draw a framework that outlines the basic concept that profit is driven by revenue (price and volume) and cost (fixed and variable)



Salty Sole Shoe

Part 2

2. Analyze client costs

Provide Exhibit A

- What observations can be made from this chart? Interviewee should point out that the company experienced significant growth during the pre-recession years, but a decline and only gradual pick-up following.
- Interviewee should pick-up on the fact that the change in net sales is not due to increased discounts/allowances (remains 1% throughout years).
- Have a quick discussion on the company's **cost** structure
 - On the cost side, interviewee should note that variable costs remained flat at 50% and fixed costs remained flat
 - **Fixed:** Interviewee should note that fixed costs are not extremely high (about 23-25%), but could be an area for improvement. Ask how interviewee would reduce fixed costs? Examples include: renegotiate contracts, find cheaper manufacturing partners, etc.
 - State that in-fact fixed costs cannot be adjusted based on the company's research.
 - **Variable:** Interviewee should note that variable costs are approximately 50% of sales. Ask how interviewee would think about reducing variable costs? Examples include: reduce labor/sales force, use technology, renegotiate / volume purchase materials
 - State that variable costs are currently at the lowest possible rates based on market research.

Salty Sole Shoe

Part 3

3. Analyze client revenues

- Once interviewee determines that cost is not the issue, have a discussion on the components of **revenue** – price and volume.
- Price: Interviewee should ask if pricing has remained constant over time or if the company has adjusted its pricing to reflect lower consumer discretionary income.
- Ask what considerations the interviewee would have when considering adjusting price?
 - Answers should be price sensitivity / elasticity, cost structure, brand equity (dilute brand through price decrease but compete with more upscale brands if increase).
 - State that pricing has remained constant at an average of \$25/unit. The company has determined that it would not be prudent to adjust pricing based on industry research. Interviewee can now determine the # of pairs sold for later in the case.
- Now that the interviewee has hopefully zeroed-in on the fact that the issue is volume, ask how many units must be sold by 2012 in order for the private equity firm to achieve a 20% return on the investment in Salty Sole Shoe, which equals approximately \$300 million sale value (give this number). Note that interviewee should ignore discounts/allowances for simplicity.
- Interviewee should determine that if the sale value needs to be \$300mm in 2012, then EBITDA will need to be $\$300 / 6.5 = \46.15 (round up to \$50 million).
- The formula to determine how many pairs of shoes must be sold to reach that EBITDA level is as follows:
 - $\$50,000,000 = \$25*v - (.5 * 25 * v) - 15,000,000$
 - $\$65,000,000 = 12.5v$
 - $V = 5,200,000$ pairs of shoes

Salty Sole Shoe

Part 4

4. Analyze market size/share

- Interviewee should note that this is more than double the 2008 and 2009 volume levels. Ask what the interviewee would want to know to determine if this volume is feasible? Answer: market size / share.

Provide Exhibit B

- Show the candidate Exhibit B when he/she notes that market size/share would be helpful.
- Candidate should note that the client is already the market leader with 40% and that the market size is not projected to increase.
- This should lead to the conclusion that the client can increase volume by stealing share and/or new products in other categories.

Salty Sole Shoe

Part 5

5. Provide client recommendation

- The interviewee should zero-in on the fact that since cost-structure is fixed and price is also fixed, volume is the only real way to increase profitability.
 - However, volume must more than double in order to achieve the growth desired by the private equity firm for a 20% return, which could be difficult given recession and the fact that the industry as a whole isn't growing.
 - Interviewee should recommend potential strategies for achieving that volume growth while outlining the risks of each: 1) Volume: new products / geographies / distribution channels (international?); increase marketing to steal share; acquire growth (brands); adjust product mix to higher-margin products. 2) Price: add value / features. 3) Risks: Capacity, cannibalization if new products.
-
- **Excellent interviewees** quickly identify that volume is the issue by ticking through the parts of the profitability equation.
 - They will also ask about product mix and question the 50% gross margin. The interviewer should note that it's assumed that all products have the same margin, but that's a great question.
 - **Outstanding interviewees** will note that since the company is not projected to have to adjust discounts / allowances, then it probably has a good product that is highly-valued by customers and/or this may be aggressive projecting.

Case 24

Sosland Sports

Concepts tested

- Z03 Breakeven analysis (2)
- Z11 Competitive analysis (3a)
- Z12 Creativity (3b)
- Z10 Customer strategy (4)

Primary sector(s)

- X09 Hospitality & Leisure

Case type

- Y04 Market Entry

Similar cases

- Thrill Park (Fuqua 2016)
- Tommy's Tennis (WSO 2012)
- Snack Foods Acquisition (Wharton 2017)

{ Case source: PrepLounge ('Fysikum')
Edited by: Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020) }

Sosland Sports

Interviewer guide

Case Question

- Your client, Sosland (pronounced sauce-land) Sports, is an operator of squash centers in Sweden. The squash centers include sauna, spa, pool, gym and - of course - the squash courts!
- Due to the extreme success in Sweden the company is considering expanding to other countries in Europe, in particular Germany.
- The founder and CEO, Felicity Sosland, has asked us to evaluate this possible expansion.
- What factors would you consider in order to estimate the outcomes of this expansion?

Interviewer guide

- Problem: Should Sosland Sports expand into Germany?
- Problem solving steps
 1. Develop problem solving structure
 2. Determine the breakeven point
 - 3a. Conduct competitive analysis
 - 3b. Brainstorm service differentiators
 4. Provide client recommendation

Sosland Sports

Experience: Tell me about your most meaningful career achievement to date.

Case Question

- Your client, Sosland (pronounced sauce-land) Sports, is an operator of squash centers in Sweden. The squash centers include sauna, spa, pool, gym and - of course - the squash courts!
- Due to the extreme success in Sweden the company is considering expanding to other countries in Europe, in particular Germany.
- The founder and CEO, Felicity Sosland, has asked us to evaluate this possible expansion.
- What factors would you consider in order to estimate the outcomes of this expansion?

Clarifying information

- **Company**: Sosland Sports centers are mid-range centers with medium-quality facilities. They only exist in Sweden.
- **Goal**: Breakeven at least. No timeframe.
- **Revenue**: Annual subscription based revenue model.

Sosland Sports

Exhibit A – Cost overview

Total annual cost	€200,000
Number of courts	15
Opening hours	8am – 6pm
Days of use per week	7
Court use	1 hour per member per week
Usage capacity	70%

Part 1

1a. Develop problem solving structure

- This question should give an overview of the candidate's ability to structure an answer. The best way to solve this is by using a "3C's" or "Five Forces" analysis.
- The interviewee should recognize the question as an opportunity to brainstorm.
- The answer should include some of the following points:

Customers

- Market size and growth rate
- Market segmentation (activity level, ages)
- Cultural factors (ie. German sporting preferences)

Competitors

- Number and concentration, substitutes
- Intensity
- Positioning

Company

- Replication of business model
- Economies of scale
- Cost of expansion
- Projected profitability

1b. Determine data gathering approach

Good answers

- Purchase marketing analyses / research reports
- Internet research on competitors
- Contact real estate agent for real estate costs
- Contacting someone in the consulting company who has experience in the market or industry

Outstanding answer

- An outstanding candidate would structure their answer. For example: they would gather information (1) internally, using firm resources and within the client's own organization, and (2) externally from third party sources.

Part 2

2a. Determine the breakeven point

Provide Exhibit A

- Can you determine the minimum annual membership fee Sosland Sports has to charge in order to cover the running cost?
 - Information that can be shared if inquired: If the candidate asks about revenues, tell him/her that they are equal to the annual costs.
 - Courts are always used during operating hours.
 - The candidate should think about the possibility of doubles. If they ask, they should assume 50% single and 50% double matches.
-
- Number of hours available per week = 10 hours/day x 7 days/week x 15 courts = 1,050
 - Number of hours courts in use = 70% utilization x 1,050 = 735
 - Average number of players per hour = (50% x 2) + (50% x 4) = 3
 - Members = 735 hours x 3 members/hour = 2,205
 - Membership = €200,000 / 2,205 = €90.70

2b. Sense check calculation

Are you sure this is an annual fee and not a weekly one?

This is meant to be a tricky question to show the confidence of the interviewee. But as the annual costs are divided by the total number of members this is indeed an annual fee.

Ideally the candidate should note that the €90 membership fee seems low and look to compare against the competition.

Part 3

3a. Conduct competitive analysis

The dominant market player for squash centers (70% market share in Germany) offers memberships for €70. Would you recommend entering the market?

Good answer

- Further investigation is required, in particular what the competitor is offering and if Sosland Sports can differentiate its services from this offering.
- For instance if the competitor is using a cost leadership strategy and offers a very cheap, but low-quality service, Sosland Sports could launch a premium, high quality squash center.

Outstanding answer

- There could be other outcomes of the investigation.
- If the competitor operates across all segments, from low-end to high quality, and has a lower cost base, Sosland Sports should not enter the market. An entrance would only lead to a price competition that our client cannot win.

3b. Brainstorm service differentiators

What could Sosland Sports offer to customers to differentiate their service offering?

There are several possible solutions (some mentioned at the beginning of the case) but these should be structured by the interviewee:

- Providing high-quality courses
- Setting up cross-country tournaments between Sweden and Germany
- Advertise the squash center with famous people (celebrities)
- Offer longer opening-hours for members paying a higher fee
- Offer services like a café or a bar

Part 4

4. Provide client recommendation

- Overall, there is only a case for Sosland Sports to enter the German market if they can differentiate themselves from the dominant competitor.
 - Sosland Sports needs to charge €90 for an annual membership to break-even
 - The major incumbent charges €70 per year
 - Sosland Sports needs to determine how they can differentiate themselves to charge this higher price
 - Risks: Competitor reaction to a new entrant, differing consumer preferences/buying habits in Germany
 - Next steps: Deeper dive into competitors' businesses and market research into Germans' leisure buying habits
-
- Strong interviewees quickly contextualize the €90 fee in terms of the client problem and look to compare in the market.
 - Outstanding interviewees structure the math correctly and solve it in a simple and clear manner.

Case 25

Swagger Llamas

Concepts tested

- Z09 Microeconomics (2)
- Z07 Market share (3)
- Z10 Marketing strategy (4)
- Z12 Creativity (4)

Primary sector(s)

- X13 Technology

Case type

- Y02 Growth Strategy

Similar cases

- Dark Sky (Kellogg 2021)
- Healthy Foods (Kellogg 2021)

Case author: Lance Ho (Kellogg 2021)

Swagger Llamas

Interviewer Guide

Case prompt

- It is the year 2025. Our client is Swagger Llamas, a start-up that was founded in 2020 by a Kellogg graduate who participated in KWEST Peru and was inspired by the famous “Goat 2 Meeting” service that took the world of virtual meetings by storm during the 2020 pandemic.
- Swagger Llamas targets Top-10 MBA programs, offering students and faculty the ability to invite llamas dressed in that program’s swag onto virtual conferences for a service fee.
- Despite explosive growth in the first year of the business, revenues have since declined steadily. The client is now worried about Swagger Llamas’ future, as revenue is expected to fall another 15% this year. How would you advise the client in growing their revenues in the near and long term?

Interviewer guide

- Problem: How can Swagger Llamas grow its revenues?
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Evaluate situation and identify trends in historical revenues
 3. Analyze penetration and growth opportunity
 4. Brainstorm potential ways to grow penetration in core business
 5. Provide client recommendation

Swagger Llamas

Experience: Tell me about a time that you lead a time to meet an aggressive deadline.

Case prompt

- It is the year 2025. Our client is Swagger Llamas, a start-up that was founded in 2020 by a Kellogg graduate who participated in KWEST Peru and was inspired by the famous “Goat 2 Meeting” service that took the world of virtual meetings by storm during the 2020 pandemic.
- Swagger Llamas targets Top-10 MBA programs, offering students and faculty the ability to invite llamas dressed in that program’s swag onto virtual conferences for a service fee. Think a llama dressed as a Big Dog joining the section connection via Zoom.
- Despite explosive growth in the first year of the business, revenues have since declined steadily. The client is now worried about Swagger Llamas’ future, as revenue is expected to fall another 15% this year. How would you advise the client in growing their revenues in the near and long term?

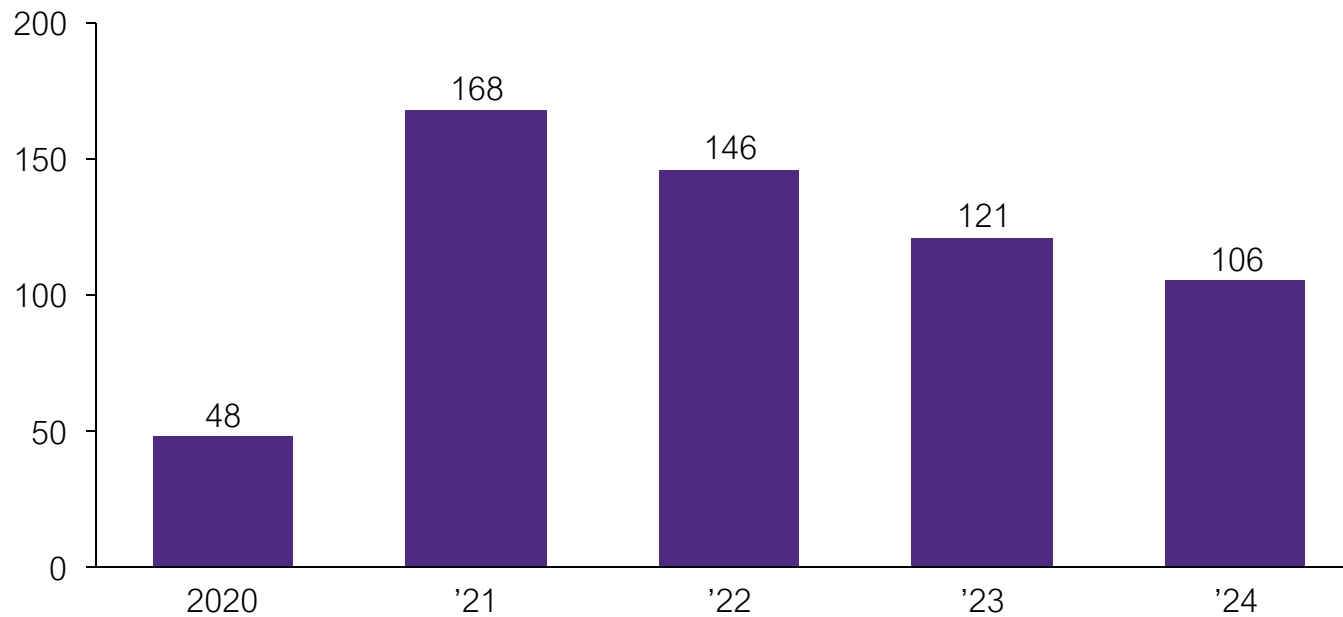
Clarifying content

- **Goal:** Grow revenue by 5% in the next year; no set goal for the longer term
- **Business model:** Direct-to-customer – A customer signs into online portal, schedules a meeting, and provides a credit card to hold on file; at the time of the scheduled meeting, a Swagger Llamas representative joins the meeting with a llama dressed in swag; after the conclusion of the meeting, an invoice is sent based on a flat fee per every 15 minutes
- **Customers:** Swagger Llamas currently serves students and faculty at Top-10 MBA programs in the U.S.; assume rankings don’t change from year to year
- **Competitive Dynamics:** There are no other providers that provides similar services as the client; Goat 2 Meeting ceased operations after 2020

Swagger Llamas

Exhibit A – Swagger Llamas historical revenue

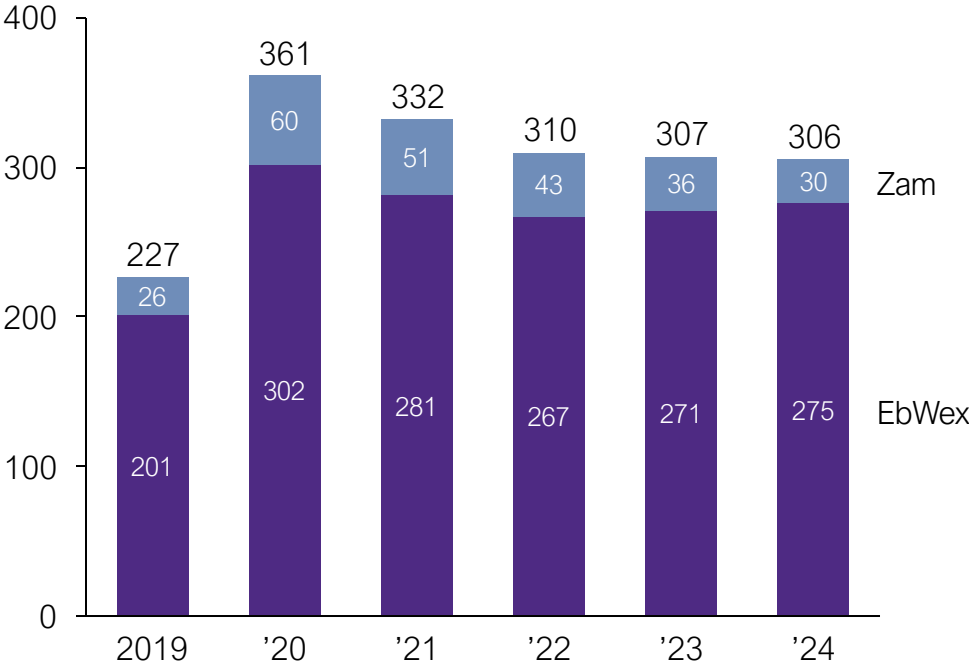
Historical revenue
(2020-24)
Thousands of USD



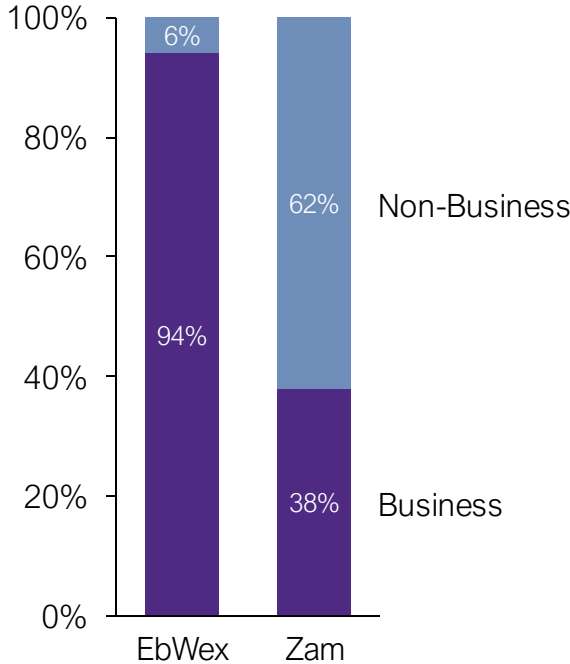
Swagger Llamas

Exhibit B – Virtual meetings and events in the U.S.

Virtual meetings and events by platform
(2019-24)
Millions of meetings and events

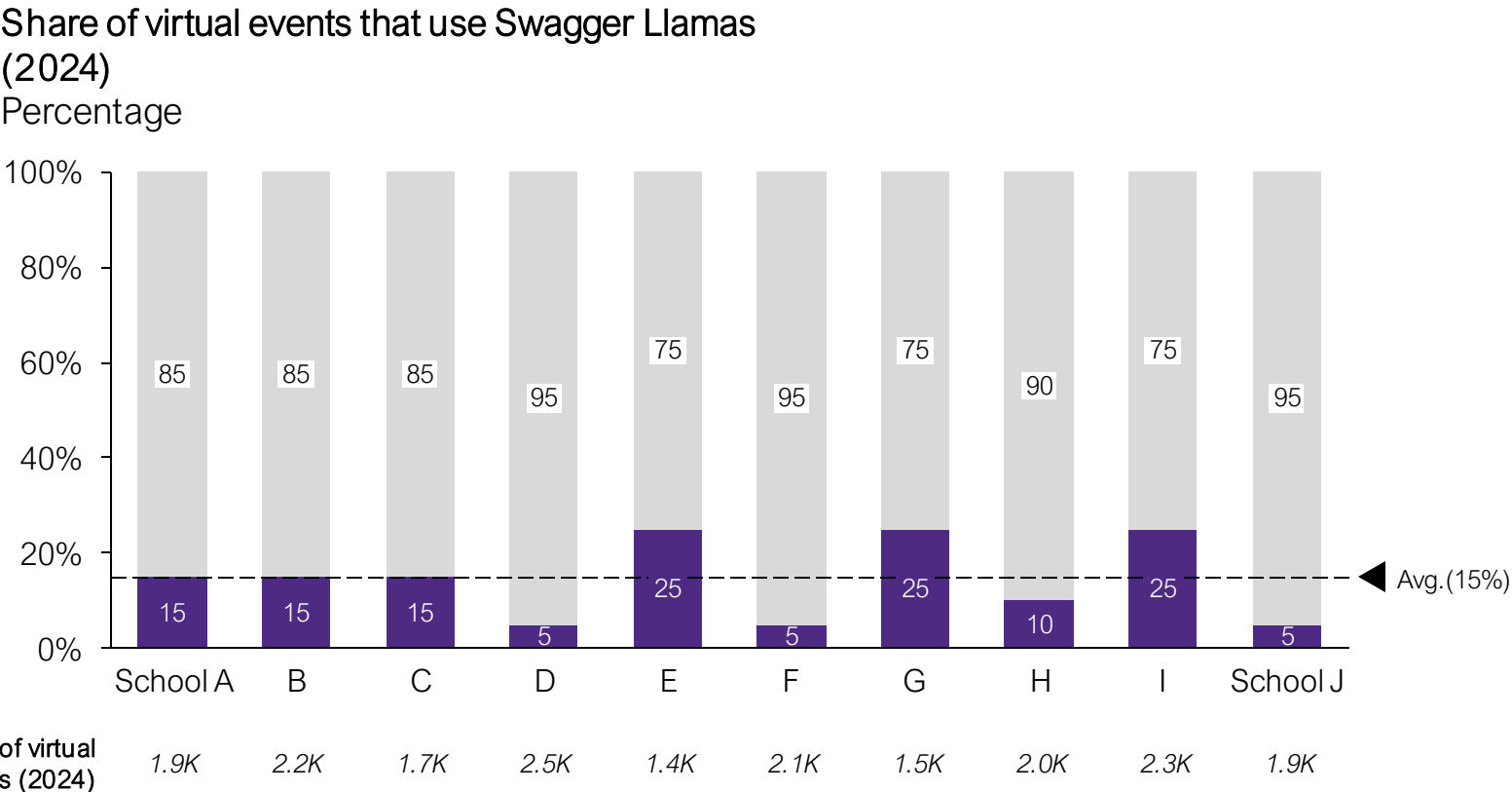


Virtual meetings and events by purpose
(2024)
Percentage



Swagger Llamas

Exhibit C – Penetration at Top-10 programs



Swagger Llamas

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

- The candidate should develop a structure that methodically breaks down the problem and identifies the different levers/ways the client can grow its revenue. The candidate can demonstrate their creativity, but potential elements to include are:
 - **Market landscape:** What will happen to Swagger Llamas if they do nothing? What is the market size and growth trend? How does Swagger Llamas meet its customers' preferences?
 - **Growth in core business:** What are the possible levers to grow the current business (i.e., Top 10 MBA programs)?
 - Penetration (e.g., number of schools, usage within each school)
 - Frequency of purchase
 - Price
 - **New growth opportunities:** How can Swagger Llamas diversify from the core business? New products (e.g., new animals)? New markets (e.g., non-MBA)?
 - **Inorganic growth:** Are there inorganic options for Swagger Llamas to grow through acquisition or joint ventures?
 - **Execution considerations:** How much investment will be needed? What timing is needed to capture the opportunity?

Swagger Llamas

Part 2a

2a. Evaluate situation and identify trends in historical revenues

Provide Exhibit A if candidate asks about historical revenue

- What can be derived from Swagger Llamas' historical revenue data?
 - If candidate asks:
 - Swagger Llamas was founded in the second half of 2020
 - Pricing has remained constant every year since 2020 at \$11 for each 15-min interval
 - Swagger Llamas only offers one type of service at one price point across all of the MBA programs
 - Swagger Llamas' penetration at the Top-10 MBA programs has remained relatively stable over time
-
- Insights the candidate can raise include: 1) revenue jumped significantly in 2021 because the first year was a partial year and Swagger Llamas was a new business, 2) revenue has continued to decline since the peak in 2021, 3) pricing has stayed constant, so the revenue trend must be a result of declining volume, 4) because there is no competition and penetration has remained stable, the declining volume is likely the result of external factors (e.g., a shrinking market)
 - Takeaway: Swagger Llama's declining revenue is likely the result of external factors (i.e., reverting back to pre-pandemic norms). As a next step, candidate should ask about the market trends of virtual meetings and events.

Swagger Llamas

Part 2b

2b. Evaluate situation and identify trends in historical revenues

Provide Exhibit B if candidate asks about market trends

- What are the implications for Swagger Llamas given the trends in virtual meetings and events?
-
- The exhibit has a lot of details by design and tests the candidate's ability to parse out what is relevant
 - Candidate should recognize that EbWex is predominantly for business use, whereas Zam has more non-business use (and given nature of Swagger Llamas EbWex is less relevant)
 - 2020: Both Zam and EbWex saw a jump in volume because of the pandemic. Zam had disproportionate growth (~2.3x) vs. EbWex (~1.5x). Strong candidates hypothesize that this is because business virtual meetings were less affected by the pandemic, while non-business uses of virtual meetings grew significantly during the pandemic for social events and classes
 - Post-2020: non-business use of video conferencing declines ~15% p.a. continuously, while business use sees a smaller drop before growing slowly again
 - Strong candidates hypothesize drivers for the above trends and draw conclusions about what it means for Swagger Llamas' business. Candidates may propose many different levers for growing revenue, but guide them to growing via gaining penetration within the Top-10 programs. If candidate suggests entering new markets, reply that Swagger Llamas believes in its business model and does not want to expand its core offering or consider customers outside of the Top-10 programs.
 - Takeaway: Because the market is shrinking rapidly, Swagger Llamas should grow its revenue by increasing its penetration. As a next step, candidate should ask about Swagger Llamas' current penetration at the Top-10 programs.

Swagger Llamas

Part 3

3. Analyze penetration and growth opportunity

Provide Exhibit C if candidate asks about penetration

- What could Swagger Llamas do to grow its revenues?
- If candidate asks:
 - Virtual events last 45 minutes on average
 - 2025 prices will remain at \$11 per 15-min interval

- Candidate should recognize that Swagger Llamas' level of penetration varies across the schools, and it will be easier to gain penetration at schools with lower penetrations today (i.e., D, F, H, J)
 - If penetration at D, F, H, and J is increased to the average of 15% (candidate can make other *reasonable* goals), this represents an incremental \$24.8K.

Program	Increase in Penetration	# of events in 2025	15-min intervals per Event	Price per 15-min	Incremental Revenue
D	10%	2.5K	3	\$11	\$8.3K
F	10%	2.1K			\$6.9K
H	5%	2.0K			\$3.3K
J	10%	1.9K			\$6.3K
				Total	\$24.8K

- Total revenues for 2025 would be **\$114.9K** = \$24.8K + \$90.1K (15% decline from \$106K), which is ~8% growth over 2024
- Takeaway: Swagger Llamas should focus on growing penetration at programs D, F, H, and J, which will allow it to meet its 5% growth goal in 2025. As a next step, candidate should start to brainstorm how to grow penetration.

Swagger Llamas

Part 4

4. Brainstorm potential ways to grow penetration in core business

- Swagger Llamas likes the idea of focusing on D, F, H, and J to grow revenues for 2025. Tactically, how could Swagger Llamas grow its penetration at these under-penetrated programs?
- Disregard prior assumptions and restrictions around Swagger Llamas' business model – the client is now looking for creativity, as it is desperate to grow its revenues.

Improve Awareness	Improve Conversion	
	<i>Price Levers</i>	<i>Non-Price Levers</i>
• Campus flyers • Marketing through student clubs • Sponsorship of events • On-campus student liaisons	• Volume discounts • Tiered pricing • Introductory pricing offers	• Negotiation at school administration level • Free trial periods • Endorsement campaign from happy users • Referral programs • Product offering modifications

- The goal here is to test the candidate's creativity. As appropriate, push for more ideas. Strong candidates will hypothesize 1-2 ideas that are likely to move the needle the most.

Swagger Llamas

Part 5

5. Provide client recommendation

- Swagger Llamas should focus its efforts on growing penetration at programs D, F, H, and J
 - Increasing penetration at D, F, H, and J to Swagger Llamas' average level of 15% yields ~\$24.8K of incremental revenue, resulting in ~8% growth from 2024 revenues
 - [Candidate should include 1-2 top tactics to help Swagger Llamas growth penetration]
 - Risks could include 1) the fact that Swagger Llamas' core market of non-business virtual meetings continue to decline at a fast rate, and 2) that the recommendation only relieves the problem for 1 year and long-term growth is still questionable
 - Possible next steps include:
 - Piloting growth efforts at 1-2 schools before fully investing across all 4 schools
 - Exploring options to evolve the Swagger Llamas business model beyond its current offering (e.g., non-MBA customers)
 - Diversifying the business away from its reliance on virtual modes in the medium-long term
-
- Strong candidates are able to drive the case without much probing from interviewer: recognizing external headwind in Ex. A, knowing what to do with the penetration data in Ex. C
 - Outstanding candidates continuously consider the implications for Swagger Llamas' business and goals (e.g., what levers would be most relevant after recognizing strong headwind in external market) and does not get bogged down by unnecessary details (e.g., rounding when clearing charts). The case comes as a problem-solving collaboration as opposed to a question-and-answer format.

Case 26

Tacotle

Concepts tested

- Z06 Macroeconomics (2)
- Z01 Accounting (4,5)
- Z10 Customer strategy (6)

Primary sector(s)

- X02 Agriculture & Food

Case type

- Y07 Profitability
- Y05 Operations

Similar cases

- Yumy Co (Yale 2013)
- Burger Chain (Ross 2012)
- Le Seine (Harvard 2015)

Case author(s): Ryan Sullivan (Kellogg 2016)
Edited by: Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020)

Tacotle

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Your client is Tacotle, a leading national fast casual restaurant with \$420m in revenue in 2019.
- Over the five years proceeding 2019, Tacotle has experienced steady revenue growth and industry leading profitability. But for the first time in its 15 year history, Tacotle has experienced three straight quarters of EBITDA erosion.
- Tacotle's CEO has hired you to explore what is causing profits to drop and what can be done to reverse the tide.

Interviewer guide

- Problem: How can we return Tacotle to profit growth?
- Problem solving steps:
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Analyze external market conditions
 3. Identify trends in profitability over time
 4. Deep dive into drivers of revenue change
 5. Calculate change in units sold between 2018 and 2019
 6. Analyze operational reasons for price increases
 7. Provide client recommendation

Tacotle

Fit: Tell me about a time you felt conflict in the workplace.

Case prompt

- Your client is Tacotle, a leading national fast casual restaurant with \$420m in revenue in 2019.
- Over the five years proceeding 2019, Tacotle has experienced steady revenue growth and industry leading profitability. But for the first time in its 15 year history, Tacotle has experienced three straight quarters of EBITDA erosion.
- Tacotle's CEO has hired you to explore what is causing profits to drop and what can be done to reverse the tide.

Clarifying information

- **Goal:** Profitability (no specific milestones, looking for positive annual profit growth in the short term)
- **Market:** Defer until after the framework presentation
- **EBITDA:** Ensure interviewee understands that EBITDA is Earnings before interest, tax, depreciation and amortization (profit)

Exhibit A – Quarterly revenue and EBITDA

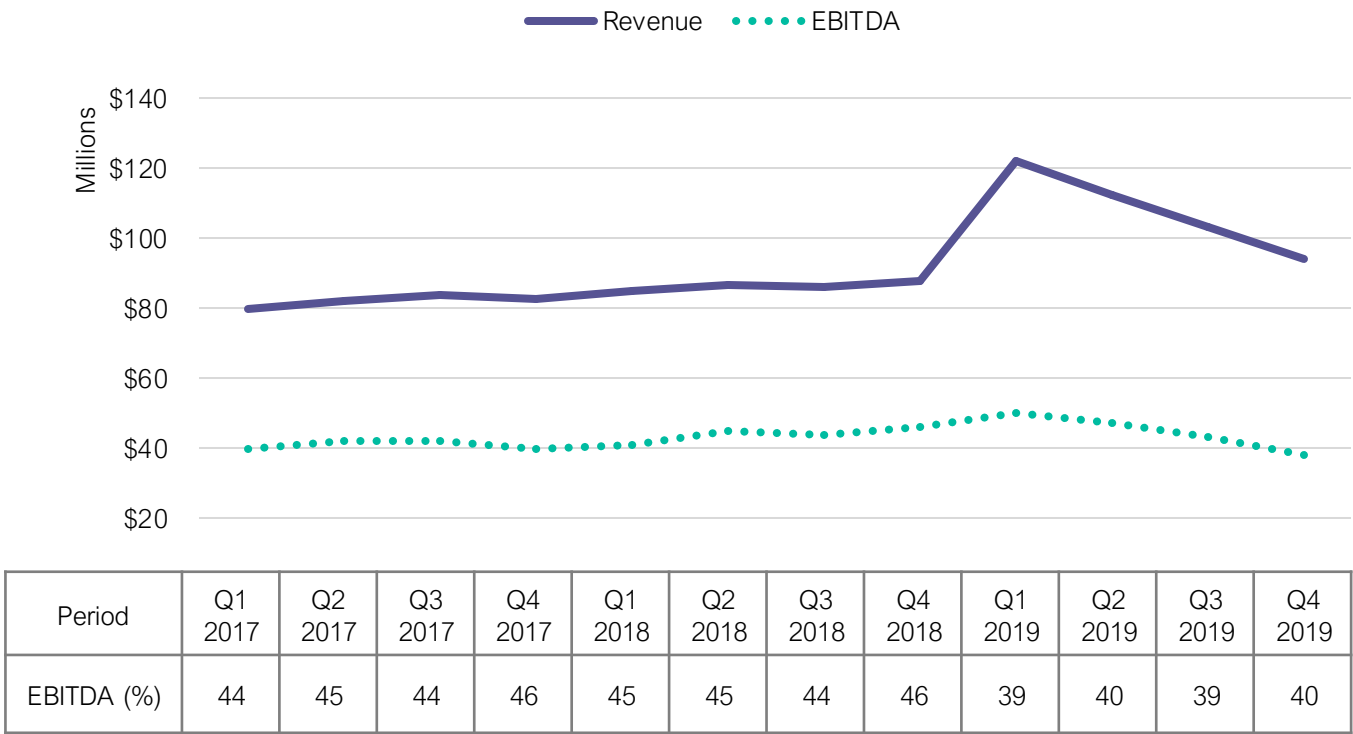


Exhibit B – Average revenue per order

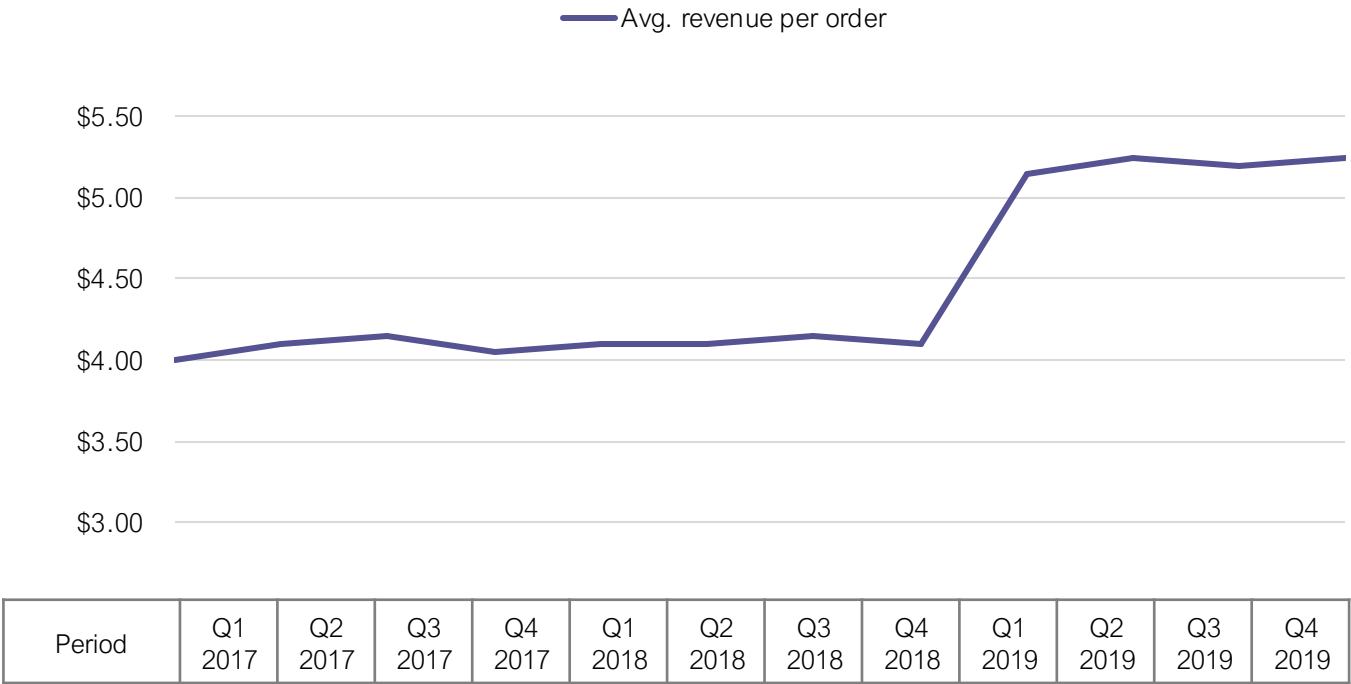
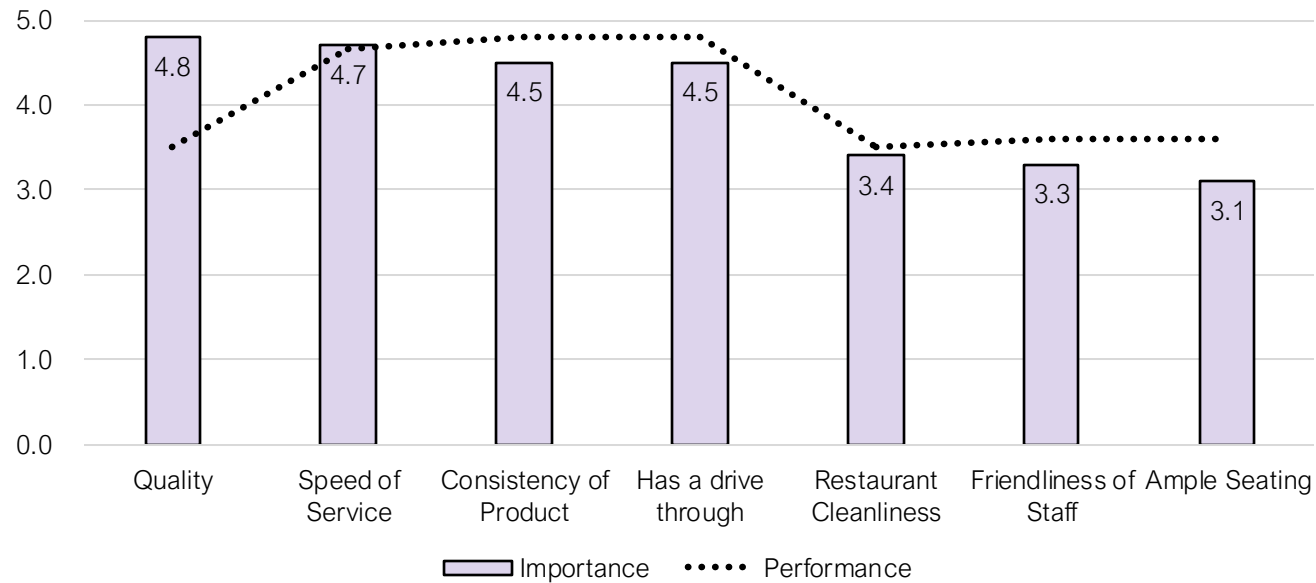


Exhibit C – Income statement

	2017	2018	2019
Revenue (\$M)	364	377	420
Expenses (\$M)			
COGS	51	54	96
Wages	96	99	101
SG&A	11	10	10
Fixed Overhead	43	44	44
EBITDA (\$M)	163	170	169

Exhibit D – Customer survey (2018)

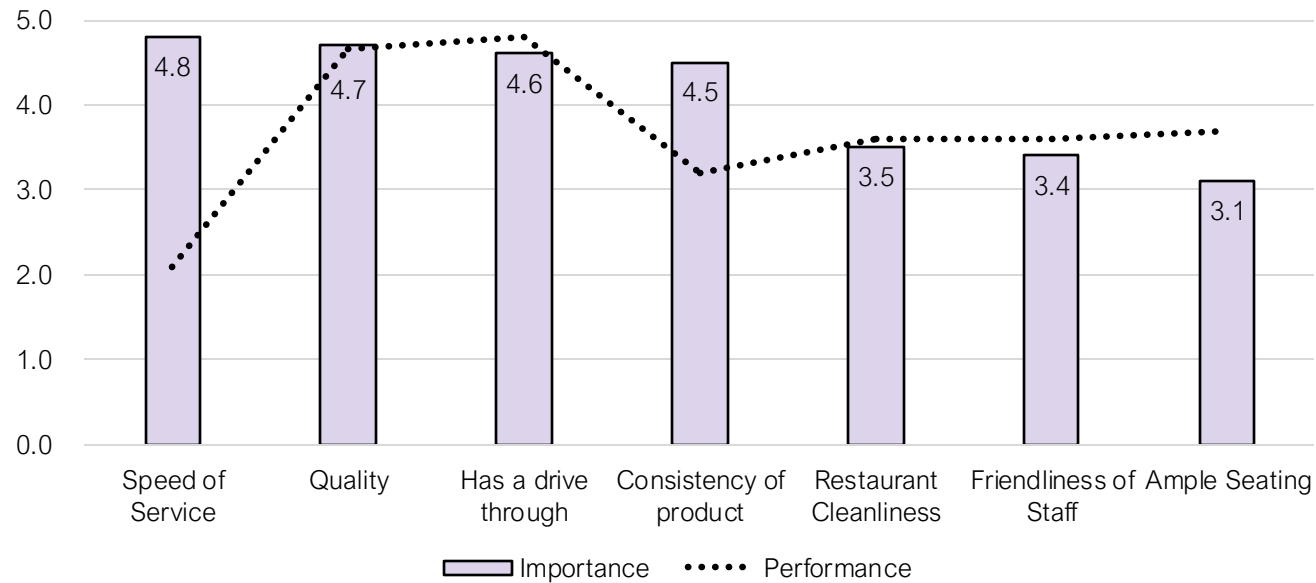


Notes:

- On a scale of 0-5, how important are the following characteristics when dining at fast casual restaurants?
- On a scale of 0-5, how well does Tacotle Co. perform against the following characteristics?

Tacotle

Exhibit E – Customer survey (2019)



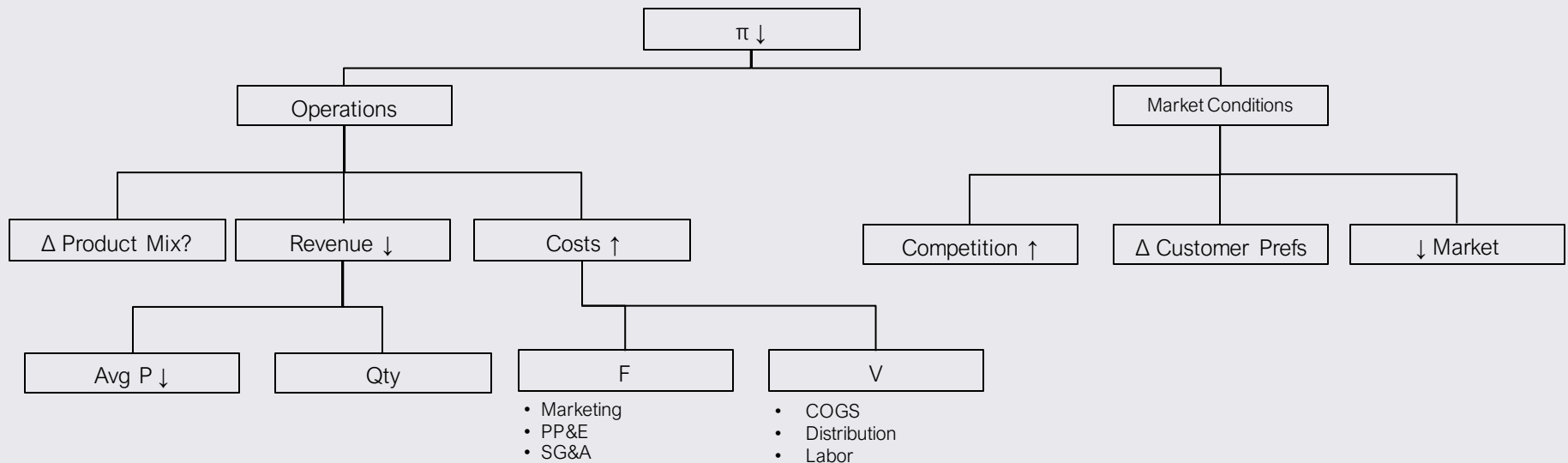
Notes:

- On a scale of 0-5, how important are the following characteristics when dining at fast casual restaurants?
- On a scale of 0-5, how well does Tacotle Co. perform against the following characteristics?

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

- After framework review, Candidate should:
 - Understand that the problem could originate from market conditions or company operations
 - Discuss the basis profitability framework with some focus on anticipated fixed and variable cost drivers for Tacotle



Part 2

2. Analyze external market conditions

- When asked, provide the interviewee with the following information about the market, competitors and customers:
 - Market growth
 - Market is growing at the same rate as GDP
 - Mature market
 - Competition
 - No major competitors have entered or exited
 - No new substitutes introduced
 - Tacotle currently has a 30% market share (by revenue) which it has maintained
 - Customers
 - Customers are beginning to stress the importance of ingredient quality and order customization
-
- Takeaway: the profitability issue is not one that is market wide. The problem seems to be specific to Tacotle.
 - There are no major competition related factors that are driving the decreased profitability. The issue is most likely related to a change within Tacotle
 - The change in customer preferences doesn't seem like it is directly driving decreased profits but it may have influenced decisions made within Tacotle

Part 3

3. Identify trends in profitability over time

Provide Exhibit A once the interviewee requests information regarding Tacotle's Revenue or Profitability

- What are potential drivers of:
 - Revenue spike? (Increase in price or units sold)
 - EBITDA erosion? (Increase in cost, decrease in rev.)
 - EBITDA % decline? (Decrease in margin)
-
- Spike in revenue in Q1 2019 with relatively flat EBITDA and large decrease in EBITDA %. Followed by steady revenue decline
 - Good response will hypothesize what could cause this, with the conclusion that either prices and/or purchases increased with costs increasing more than the additional revenue
 - A good interviewee will take a deep dive into the profitability framework looking to determine why:
 1. Revenue spiked then declined over the following quarters
 2. Profitability (EBITDA) did not follow revenue

Part 4

4. Deep dive into drivers of revenue change

- Guide the candidate down the revenue side of the profitability framework if they do not do so.

Provide Exhibit B once the interviewee has hypothesized potential drivers of increased revenue

- After interviewee has stated that price increased, interviewee should recognize that a change in price could lead to a change in quantity.

Provide Exhibit C once the interviewee asks how the units sold changed in 2019

- Takeaways (Exhibit B):
 - A good interviewee will quickly identify that Tacotle increased the average price of their orders.
 - It should initially be ambiguous whether units sold increased or decreased. A good interviewee will not rush to a conclusion
- Takeaways (Exhibit C):
 - Interviewee should evaluate the entire slide then attempt to answer the question posed regarding units sold in 2019
 - Interviewee should refer back to the exhibit and notice that COGS nearly doubled from 2018 to 2019

Part 5

5. Calculate change in units sold between 2018 and 2019

- If the interviewee does not calculate the change in units sold themselves, ask them to

Units sold in 2018:

- Units sold = Revenue / (Avg. price per unit)
- 2018 Revenue = \$377m (Round to 380M)
- 2018 Avg. price per unit = \$4.05 (Round to \$4)
- Units sold = $\$380\text{m} / \$4 = 95\text{m units sold}$

Units sold in 2019:

- Units sold = Revenue / (Avg. price per unit)
- 2019 Revenue = \$420m
- 2019 Avg. price per unit = \$5.25
- Units sold = $\$420\text{m} / \$5.25 = 80\text{m units sold}$

Takeaways:

- Although revenue increased sharply, the total number of orders decreased.
- As revenue continued to decline over the last three quarters of 2019, prices remained the same. Therefore, a decrease in the quantity sold is responsible for the eroding revenues and EBITDA

Part 6a

6a. Analyze operational reasons for price increases

- Why did Tacotle increase prices?
- Why did units sold continue to decrease throughout 2019?

Provide Exhibit D once the interviewee or interviewer asks these questions

- Ensure that before moving into 'operations' the interviewee has analysed Exhibits A, B and C and has received Exhibit D.
-
- Exhibit D illustrates Tacotle's performance against customer preferences
 - Tacotle lags with regards to quality but is on par or exceeding expectations for all other categories
 - Interviewee should conclude that Tacotle did something that was aimed to increase quality which most likely caused COGS and revenue to increase

Part 6b

6b. Analyze operational reasons for price increases

- After interviewee has speculated on potential operational changes Tacotle could have implemented, inform them that Tacotle introduced a new menu focused on allowing the consumer to customize their orders more and higher quality and selection of ingredients

Provide Exhibit E at this point

- If asked for, the average time to serve a customer increased from ~1 minute to ~3.5 minutes.
-
- Interviewee should recognize that Exhibit E is the same survey as Exhibit D but for the next year (post menu upgrade)
 - Interviewee should also recognize that the order of attributes has changed
 - “Speed of Service” is now Tacotle’s weakest attribute
 - This is due to the new menu which added complexity to food preparation
 - “Consistency of Service” has also dropped below customer expectations due to the added complexity of food preparation
 - Although Tacotle has met expectations with regard to “Quality”, the decline of ratings in “Speed of Service” and “Consistency of Service” have more than cancelled it out, resulting in a net decrease in customer satisfaction
 - Takeaway: The menu change was not effective

Part 7

7. Provide client recommendation

Overall: Scale back the menu changes that were implemented during 2019.

- The menu change led to a significant increase in COGS which decreased EBITDA %
- The menu change led to overall customer dissatisfaction, degrading brand equity
- The customer dissatisfaction lead to decreasing unit sales (quarter over quarter) which is driving the EBITDA erosion

Risks

- Scaling back the menu too much could lead to decrease in customer satisfaction for “Quality”
- Scaling back could disrupt relationships with suppliers require asset divestiture relating to initial menu change
- A scale back that does not focus on margin improvement could lead to smaller revenues and profits, effectively downsizing the company.

Next steps

- Perform more detailed and focused customer surveys to gage what Tacotle customers expect from the chain
- Perform a scale back on the menu size that focuses on cost cutting balanced with customer needs
- Follow-on menu changes should be implemented on a smaller/trial basis at a small number of individual restaurants

Case 27

Vitality Insurance

Concepts tested

- Z13 Organizational changes (3)

Primary sector(s)

- X06 Financial Services

Case type

- Y07 Profitability

Similar cases

- TV Screens (Wharton 2017)



Case author(s): Peter Manoogian (Kellogg 2012)
Edited by: Matthew Heintz (Kellogg 2016), Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020)



Vitality Insurance

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client, Vitality Insurance, is a leading provider of supplemental insurance products in the United States.
- Vitality agents partner with companies to offer their employees optional, supplemental insurance for such conditions as life, long-term disability, etc.
- Vitality has undergone fairly steady growth in the past two years, but profit margin is decreasing. What should they do about it?

Interviewer guide

- Problem: How can Vitality improve its profit margins?
- Problem solving steps:
 1. Identify cost trends
 2. Determine root-cause of sales cost changes
 3. Examine mis-aligned incentive programs
 4. Provide client recommendation

Vitality Insurance

Fit: What role do you typically play in a team? Give me an example of this.

Case prompt

- Our client, Vitality Insurance, is a leading provider of supplemental insurance products in the United States.
- Vitality agents partner with companies to offer their employees optional, supplemental insurance for such conditions as life, long-term disability, etc.
- Vitality has undergone fairly steady growth in the past two years, but profit margin is decreasing. What should they do about it?

Clarifying information

- **Client:**
 - Vitality is the leader in its category and has over 10,000 field sales agents (FSAs)
 - Vitality sells all policies through FSAs who are solely compensated on a percentage commission of total new premium, (defined as premium from new customers or additional premium up-sell from existing policyholders)
 - In addition to the commission, short term priorities are often communicated via sales contests that focus on a particular customer segment or activity and pay a bonus in addition to standard commission
 - Major costs: sales, G&A, and advertising
- **Competition:** Few competitors in this mature market with similar growth. Vitality is a leader in the space; competition not the focus
- **Industry:** Agent turnover is very high on a yearly basis (though was lower during the recessionary period)

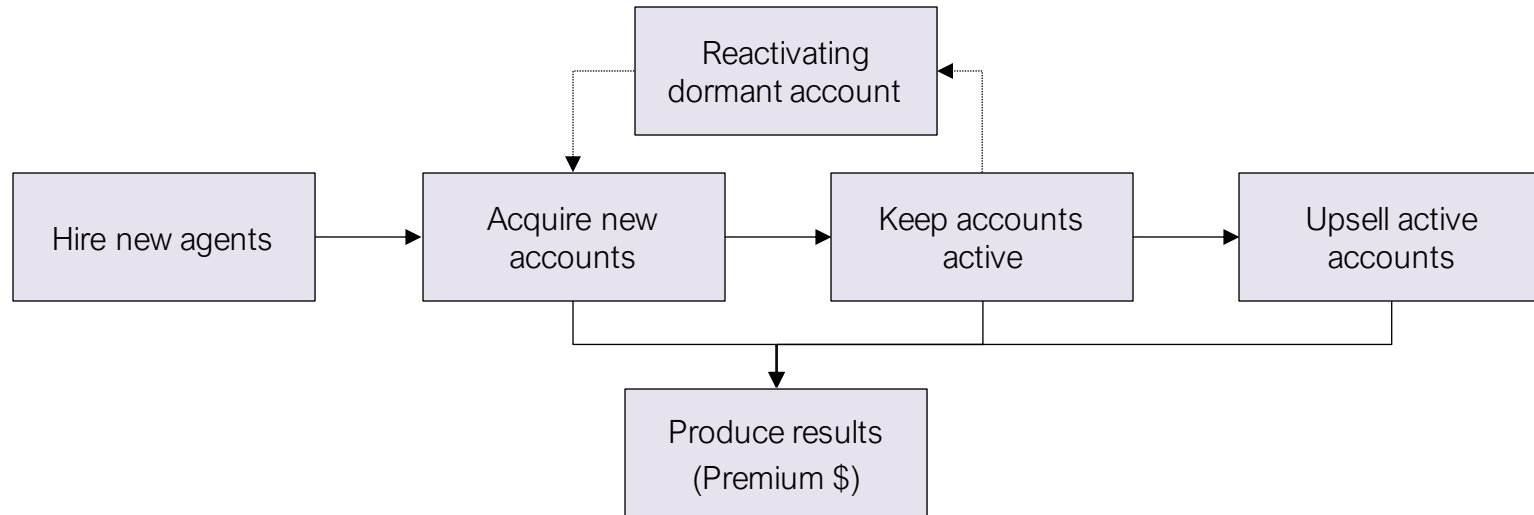
Vitality Insurance

Exhibit A – Results and Costs

Vitality insurance key results and costs (figures in '000s)			
	<u>2008</u>	<u>2009</u>	<u>2010</u>
Accounts converted	500	550	605
Total policyholders enrolled	1,500	1,650	1,815
Total premium from policyholders	\$2,500,000	\$2,750,000	\$3,025,000
Total costs			
General and Administrative	\$50	\$55	\$58
Sales	\$250	\$275	\$400
Advertising	\$25	\$28	\$30
Profit margin	9.50%	9.40%	8.50%

Vitality Insurance

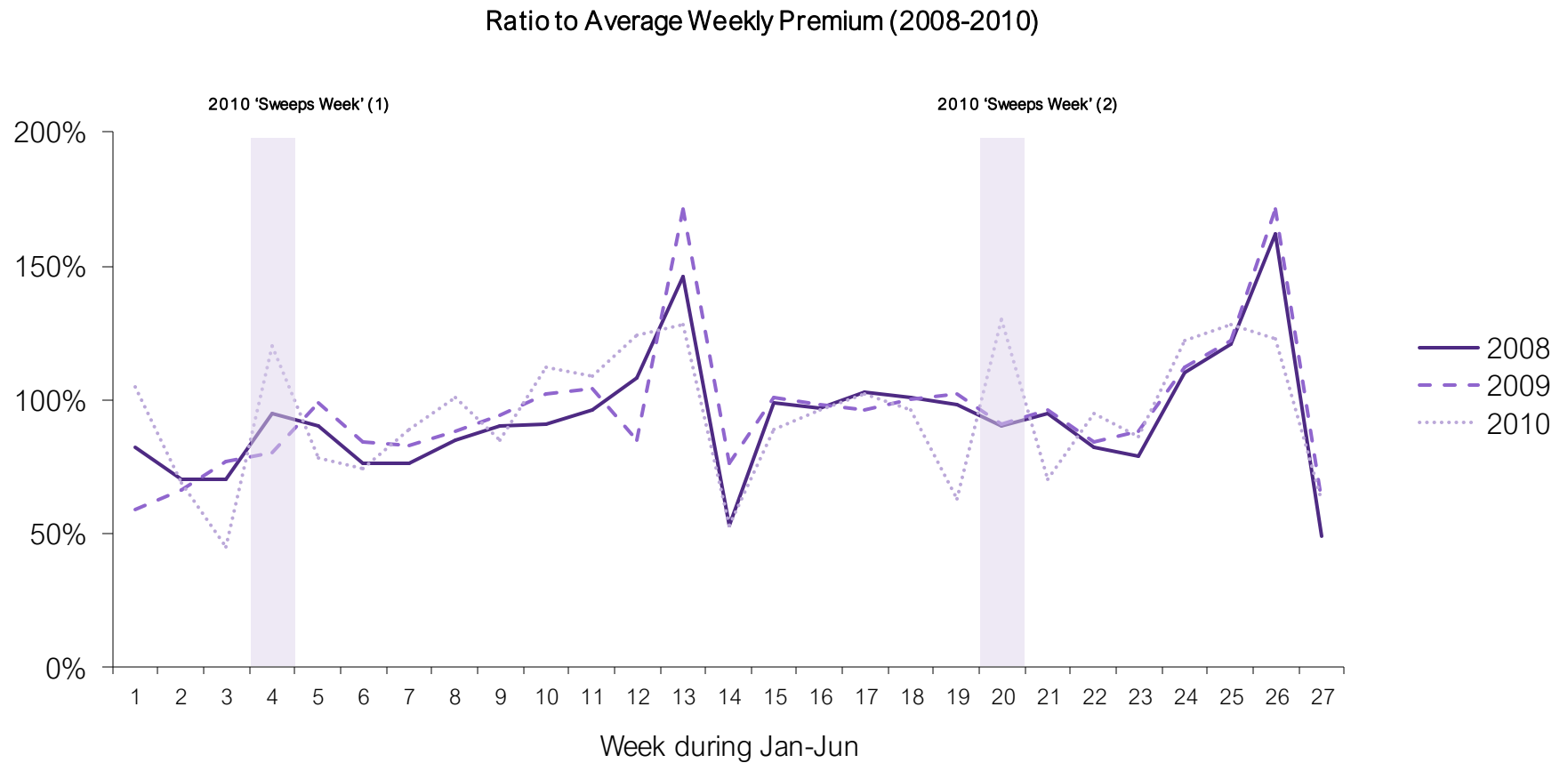
Exhibit B – Insurance sales process



Number of sales contests targeted at these leverage points on the selling process					
	New Agents	Acquire new accounts (bonus based on # of accounts)	Keep accounts active (bonus based on # of accounts)	Upsell active accounts (bonus based on # of accounts)	Produce results (bonus based on total premium \$)
2008	n/a	2	4	1	2
2009	n/a	2	4	1	2
2010	n/a	4	0	1	4

Vitality Insurance

Exhibit C – Snapshot of ‘Sweeps Week’ contest results



Validity Insurance

Part 1

1. Identify cost trends

Provide Exhibit A when the interviewee asks for cost information

- Interviewee should recognize the following:
 - All line items except for sales costs growing at 10% per year
 - Sales costs grow at 10% from 2008 to 2009, but at 45% from 2009 to 2010 (while premium growth remains at 10%)
 - Stronger interviewees will quickly note that something is strange with the 2010 sales costs, but will calculate to confirm
 - Finally, profit margins are declining significantly from 2009-10, suggesting that the increase in sales costs is not paying off

Vitality Insurance

Part 2

2. Determine root-cause of sales cost changes

Provide Exhibit B if the interviewee asks about the value chain or sales process

- If the interviewee asks about the new contests focused on premium, provide the following information:
 - Vitality launched a contest called 'Sweeps Week' that aimed to drive increased premium in weeks that were traditionally low volume for the company. Vitality paid an extra 10% bonus on all premium booked in those two weeks.
 - Sales agents thought 'Sweeps Week' was a great contest
 - Assume the types of contests run in 2008 and 2009 were fairly similar
 - Do not share Exhibit C until the interviewee recognizes this shift in mix and begins asking questions about the new programs
-
- As seen in Exhibit B; Vitality's sales agents are engaged in several activities along the sales process, and that new premium can be generated in many ways.
 - The interviewee should recognize the shift in contest mix from 2008/09 to 2010. Coupled with the additional information provided in the previous slide, the interviewee should realize that Vitality has shifted its focus more toward total premium and new accounts in 2010

Vitality Insurance

Part 3

3. Examine mis-aligned incentive programs

Provide Exhibit C if the interviewee asks about the effectiveness of 'Sweeps Week'

- If asked, confirm that agents have authority to 'book' sales whenever they want by influencing the enrollment timing by up to one week
 - Strong interviewees will also recognize that, despite not having charts to support it, a shift in customer focus toward acquiring new accounts in 2010 will likely also hinder profit margins, as acquiring a new customer costs considerably more than retaining (or up-selling) an existing customer
-
- Exhibit C shows weekly premiums for all of Vitality from 2008 – 2010. The chart is shown in a way that compares each year's actual premium to the average of historical premium for that year, so as to provide for a 'benchmark' comparison.
 - The 'Sweeps Week' contest launched in 2010 is shown in weeks 4 and 20 in the chart, and clearly yields high premium volume for those particular weeks. However, it is done at the expense of the weeks surrounding the sweeps week.
 - This implies that agents may be 'gaming' the system by pushing/pulling sales into that week to earn the contest rewards

Part 4

4. Provide client recommendation

- The interviewee should conclude that Vitality overspent in 2010 on the 'Sweeps Week' sales contest, thus hurting its profitability
 - Exhibit C indicates that the contest influenced the sales force to conduct undesirable selling practices by pushing / pulling forward business to earn the extra commission
 - Further, the contest's focus, driving new premium was duplicative with that of the main commission system, therefore it did not add much value
 - Recommendation: eliminate 'Sweeps Week' for 2011 and potentially repurpose those funds toward an activity that is not already covered by the main commission structure
 - It is unclear whether we should remove the increased contests on new accounts, as this could be a new customer focus that we do not know about
-
- **Excellent candidates** will make the following observations:
 - Recognize that the likely decline in profit margin from 2009 to 2010 is linked to the abnormal increase to sales costs
 - That the 'contest mix' in Exhibit B is similar to a firm's marketing mix, especially given that the sales channel has already been established as the main marketing channel for these products
 - Suggest that the added contests on acquiring new accounts will also decrease profitability because acquiring new customers is more costly than retaining existing ones.

Case 28

Wildcat Wings

Concepts tested

- Z08 Market sizing (2)
- Z12 Creativity (4)
- Z16 Vertical integration (4)

Primary sector(s)

- X01 Aerospace & Defense
- X15 Transportation & Logistics

Case type

- Y06 Opportunity assessment
- Y05 Operations

Similar cases

- Formerly A+ Airlines, Kellogg 2018

{ Case author(s): Adam J. Louras (Kellogg 2011) [formerly A+ Airlines]
Edited by: Deepika Singh (Kellogg Class'16), Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020) }

Wildcat Wings

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client is Wildcat Wings, the third largest airline in the United States by passengers carried. This week, the CEO flew with our primary competitor, Phoenix Air, and she noticed something interesting: Phoenix has stopped accepting cash for in-flight food and beverage services and they now only accept major credit cards.
- The CEO of Wildcat Wings wants to know why Phoenix Air switched to Card only, and if Wildcat Wings should follow them.

Interviewer guide

- Problem: Should Wildcat Wings go cashless for in-flight purchases?
- Problem solving steps:
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Analyze current in-flight purchases
 3. Explore cost impacts of switching to card only
 4. Brainstorm additional benefits
 5. Provide client recommendation

Wildcat Wings

Fit: Tell me how about a time someone convinced you to take a different approach.

Case prompt

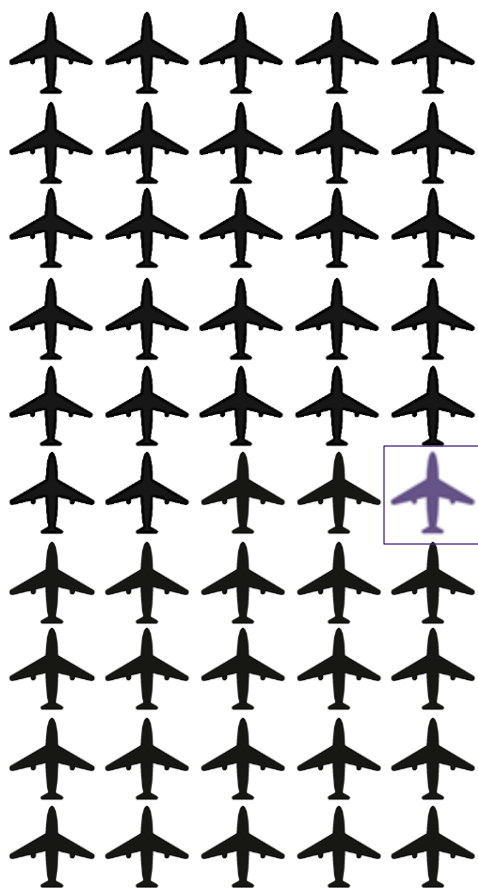
- Our client is Wildcat Wings, the third largest airline in the United States by passengers carried. This week, the CEO flew with our primary competitor, Phoenix Air, and she noticed something interesting: Phoenix has stopped accepting cash for in-flight food and beverage services and they now only accept major credit cards.
- The CEO of Wildcat Wings wants to know why Phoenix Air switched to Card only, and if Wildcat Wings should follow them.

Clarifying information

- **Card Use:** Roughly 99% of all consumers purchase their airline tickets using a credit card, i.e. all consumers on an airplane have a credit card available to them.
- **Items Sold:** Only food and alcoholic beverage items are sold on Wildcat flights.
- **Competitive Dynamics:** Phoenix is the only airline that has made the switch; however all other airlines are evaluating the switch.
- **Competitors:** For the purposes of this case, Phoenix and Wildcat should be considered to be exactly the same in all regards.

Wildcat Wings

Exhibit A – Flight economics



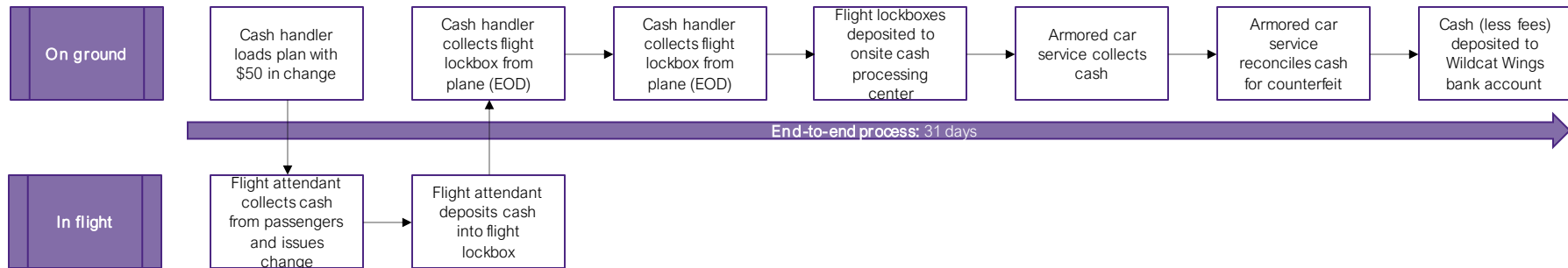
Fleet size: 50

Average Wildcat Wings flight <i>Boeing 737-800</i>				
Total seats	200			
Cabin	Cabin share of seats	Traveler type		Seat utilization
		Business	Leisure	
First Class	25%	100%	0%	100%
Economy	75%	50%	50%	80%
Traveler type	Purchase rate		Average purchase value	
Business	40%		\$10	
Leisure	25%		\$5	
	Method of payment			
Cash	20%			
Card	80%			

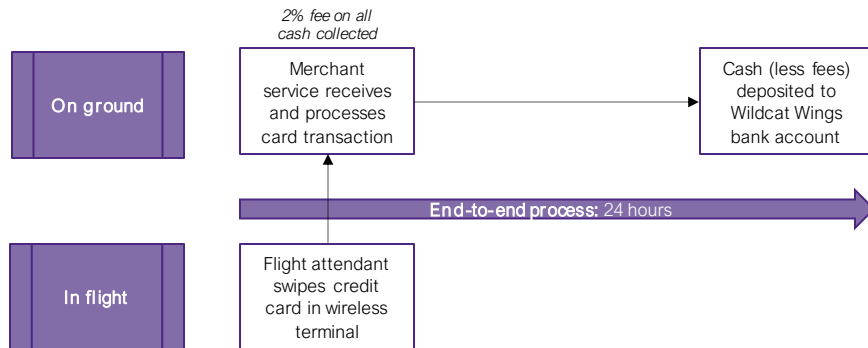
Wildcat Wings

Exhibit A – Cash and Credit Card management processes

Wildcat Wings Cash Management Process*



Wildcat Wings Credit Card Process



Additional information:

- 5 cash handlers per airport
- 2 employees onsite cash processing center at each airport where Wildcat operates

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

- Case Structure – Interviewee's structure should be a before and after comparison of the switch from Cash & Card to Card only and should include:
 - **Revenue Changes:** Loss of Cash Only customers vs. Increase in Credit Card customers
 - **Cost Changes:** Benefit of Cash Management Cost Removed vs. Incremental Cost (Fee) of Credit Card
 - **Cash Flow Changes:** Interest and Time Value of Money (TVM), and Working Capital impacts due to an increase in collection speed

Part 2

2. Analyze current in-flight purchases

Provide Exhibit A when the interviewee asks about market sizing

When asked, state we will lose 1/3 of cash customers when we move to card-only

- Ask the interviewee to determine the Total Market Size in (\$) for food and beverage purchases on an average flight
-
- The interviewee should calculate the current allocation of purchases (Cash vs Card) for an average flight.
 - The interviewee should begin with the correct assumption that revenue will be lost due to unhappy, cash-only passengers
 - First class business passengers = 200 seats x 25% share x 100% utilization x 100% business = 50 passengers
 - Economy business passengers = 200 seats x 75% share x 80% utilization x 50% business = 60 passengers
 - Economy leisure passengers = 200 seats x 75% share x 80% utilization x 50% leisure = 60 passengers
 - Business spend = $(50 + 60) \times 40\% \times \$10 = \$440$
 - Leisure spend = $60 \times 25\% \times \$5 = \75
 - Cash payments = $\$515 \times 20\% = \103
 - Card payments = $\$515 \times 80\% = \412
 - Takeaway: Lost revenue = $1/3 \times 103 = \sim\$35$

Part 3

3. Explore cost impacts of switching to card only

- Interviewee should make mention of Cost changes due to the shift to a Card Only strategy.

Provide Exhibit B when the candidate after cash and credit card processing cost brainstorming

When asked, explain that the total, per flight, savings from eliminating overhead due to Cash Management Operations is \$35/flight

- The interviewee should notice the following information:
 - Cash Management & Card Management both have 2% fees associated, so this is a “wash” in terms of savings.
 - Cash Management requires additional overhead, 7 total employees per airport, that could be eliminated for further savings.
- Interviewee should notice that the \$35 savings offsets the \$35 loss in revenue. A good candidate will notice that savings go straight to the bottom line whereas revenue doesn't.

Part 4

4. Brainstorm additional benefits

If the candidate does not mention TVM, ask them about benefits of collecting payment early

- The interviewee should qualitatively mention that there are benefits to eliminating the longer cash management process:
 - Time Value of Money: Wildcat Wings will receive their money 30 days sooner, and this money could be used to:
 - Invest in interest earning accounts or growth projects
 - Pay off suppliers early and take advantage of discounts
 - Pay down lines of credit faster
 - Working Capital Improvement: \$50 per flight in change can be eliminated, thus freeing up cash flow. Additionally, there will be a reduction in loss of cash due to theft and damage
 - Happier Customers: The majority of customers will be able to place and receive their order faster on the plane which will also increase sales

Part 5

5. Provide client recommendation

- Overall, our client Wildcat Wings, should switch to a Credit Card only system for in-flight food & beverage because:
 - **Quantitative Benefits:** We calculated that there would be a loss of 3 business customers and 1 economy customer per flight which amounted to a Revenue loss of \$35. We also found that we could save \$35 in overhead expenses by eliminating the Cash Management process. In sum, the decision to switch is in favor because the savings are to the bottom line and the revenue losses are top line.
 - **Qualitative Benefits:** We also found that we will receive payment 30 days sooner by only accepting credit cards. This improves our cash flow and could allow us to earn interest, pay down creditors, or invest in projects. Additionally, by reducing cash losses and eliminating “Change” tied up on airplanes, we can improve our Working Capital and also put this money to work for us. Finally, it appears as though customers, in general, might actually be happier because the speed of transactions on the airplane will improve.
- **Outstanding interviewees** will note:
 - Due to the increased transaction speed, probability of purchase for both Business and Economy passengers in the AFTER state should go up due to a reduction in frustration. The people on the back of the airplane often abandon a purchase if it takes too long to place an order. Making change takes a lot of time!
 - Average purchase amount should also increase. There is a proven psychological phenomenon that shows how consumers who do not carry cash purchase less when a cash option is offered because they feel guilty using their card. A card-only option eliminates this guilt and consumers don't mind using the card.
 - Being creative when listing the change of costs as: Wifi cost (connect with banks and verify transaction), Fraud cost (increased chance of fraud to happen after implementing card only payment).

Case 29

Wine & Co

Interviewer-led

Concepts tested

- Z02 Net Present Value (2)
- Z10 Marketing strategy (3)

Primary sector(s)

- X02 Agriculture & Food

Case type

- Y06 Opportunity assessment

Similar cases

- Pharmacy in Supermarket (Sloan 2011)
- Rocky Resort (WSO 2012)
- Jamaican Land Investment (Haas 2015)



Case authors: Anil Goteti (Kellogg 2011)
Edited By: Mauricio Atri (Kellogg 2012), Laura Mast (Kellogg 2020)



Interviewer Guide

Case prompt

- Wine & Co is a niche wine manufacturer in the San Francisco Bay area. Wine & Co recently acquired 12 acres of land outside San Francisco.
- The company wants to investigate opportunities to best use the land and needs a recommendation from you.
- What are the different ways in which Wine & Co can use the land?

Interviewer guide

- Problem: How can Wine Co maximize the
- Problem solving steps:
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Identify most profitable product
 3. Determine preferred product for manufacturing
 4. Provide client recommendation

Wine & Co

Experience: Tell me about a time when you faced conflict in a team setting.

Case prompt

- Wine & Co is a niche wine manufacturer in the San Francisco Bay area. Wine & Co recently acquired 12 acres of land outside San Francisco.
- The company wants to investigate opportunities to best use the land and needs a recommendation from you.
- What are the different ways in which Wine & Co can use the land?

Clarifying information

- **Product:** Wine & Co only manufactures red wines. The company does not sell any other products.
- **Customers:** The company serves only the local market (the San Francisco Bay area).
- **Company:** The company is currently very healthy and does not face any problems.

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

- The interviewee should create a framework and structure the problem. The interviewee should suggest options including manufacturing the wine, creating adjacent products (like wine tasting tours), using the land for other uses (commercial real estate/selling the land for a profit/other opportunity costs).
- A strong candidate would provide a detailed structure (eg. profitability framework for manufacturing feasibility with customization of the framework - yield of grapes, cost per liter of wine, etc.) and outline the risks or considerations involved in some of these options (like usability of land for manufacturing or company competency in pursuing in other opportunities unrelated to wine manufacturing).

Part 2a

2. Determine most profitable product

- Wine & Co has decided to use the land to manufacture wine. Each acre of land produces 1,000kg of grapes annually. Wine & Co has an option to manufacture Merlot or Bordeaux.
 - The two wines use different grapes and the grapes have varying yields. While the Merlot grapes yield 2 litres/kg, the Bordeaux grapes yield 1 litre/kg. Wine & Co can charge \$20 per liter of Merlot and can charge \$40 per liter of Bordeaux.
 - Which wine yields more profits annually?
 - When asked, provide the following information:
 - Profit Margins on Merlot are 10% while the margins on Bordeaux are 15%.
-
- A good candidate would ask for the profit margins/costs without being prompted. Look for organization and structure when the candidate evaluates the annual profits for each wine (a good candidate would use a table like structure when doing the math). The revenues would be \$480,000 for both wines annually but the margins would be higher for Bordeaux (\$72,000 for Bordeaux versus \$48,000 for Merlot). After the candidate arrives at the profits, look for interpretation.
 - A strong candidate would recommend using Bordeaux while at the same time consider other factors (competency in manufacturing either of the wines, customer demand in the bay area, sensitivity to product yields, customer reservation price, etc.)
 - A creative candidate might suggest that we compare the age of the two wines (and hence will impact when the profits might actually start)

Part 2 (continued)

2. Determine most profitable product

- Math working for Part 2

	Description	Value
A	Acres of Land	12
B	kg of grapes produced/acre	1,000
C	kg of grapes produced total [A x B]	12,000

	Description	Merlot	Bordeaux
D	Yield (Liter/kg)	2	1
E	Total Yield (Liter) [C x D]	24,000	12,000
F	Price / Liter	\$20	\$40
G	Total Revenue [E x F]	\$480,000	\$480,000
H	Profit Margin	10%	15%
I	Total Profit [G x H]	\$48,000	\$72,000

Part 3

3. Determine preferred product for manufacturing

- Aging has an effect on the revenues and profitability. Merlot has to be stored for 6 years while Bordeaux has to be stored for 12 years before revenues can be generated. Which wine would you choose for manufacturing?
 - When asked, provide the following information:
 - Discount rate is 12% (strong candidates will use the 'Rule of 72' to discount)
 - Assume the costs are only incurred when the revenues are realized after aging (no costs until year 6 for Merlot and no costs until year 12 for Bordeaux).
-
- The interviewee should identify that the cash flows for Merlot would be \$48,000 annually starting year 6. Cash flows for Bordeaux would start in year 12 (\$72,000 annually). Then, consider TVM, calculating annual cash flow discounted to the same year:
 - **Merlot:** Perpetuity value of cash flow (value in year 6) = $\$48,000 / 0.12 = \$400,000$
 - **Bordeaux:** Perpetuity value of cash flow (value in year 12) = $\$72,000 / 0.12 = \$600,000$
Value of perpetuity in year 6 = $\$600,000 / (1.12^6) = \$300,000$ (Rule of 72).
 - Provide help here if the candidate is struggling with the division. Look for the candidate's approach rather than the exact number. Since value of pursuing Merlot (\$400,000) is higher than value of pursuing Bordeaux (\$300,000), the company should manufacture Merlot.
 - Strong interviewees interpret the results and suggest we consider factors like inventory costs, sensitivity to discount rate, etc.

Part 3 (continued)

3. Determine preferred product for manufacturing

- Math working for Part 3

		Merlot	Bordeaux	Comments
A	Annual Profit	\$48,000	\$72,000	See Part 2
B	Years to Maturity	6	12	
C	Discount Rate	12%	12%	
D	Merlot NPV once ripe (at year 6)	\$400,000		A/C
E	Bordeaux NPV once ripe (at year 12)		\$600,000	A/C

	Method 1			
F	Bordeaux NPV at year 6 (using discount rate)		\$300,000	$E/(1.12)^6$
G	Comparison at year 6	\$400,000	\$300,000	D and F

	Method 2			
H	Merlot NPV at year 12 (using discount rate)	\$800,000	\$600,000	$D \times (1.12)^6$
I	Comparable comparison at year 12	\$800,000	\$600,000	I and E

	Method 3			
J	Discount rate	12%	12%	
K	Years to double value = $72/\text{Discount Rate}$	6	6	$72/12$
L	Value after 6 years	\$400,000	\$300,000	Halve Bordeaux at 12 years
M	Value after 12 years	\$800,000	\$600,000	Double Merlot at 6 years

Part 4

4. Recommend a marketing strategy

- Wine & Co has decided to manufacture Merlot. How should they market this product in the San Francisco Bay area?
-
- Customer segment currently served by Wine & Co is **niche wine enthusiasts**.
 - Candidate should ask for the customer segments that the company might sell to and suggest appropriate marketing channels/strategies to consider. Look for a MECE structure here.
 - Suggestions should include retail strategies, direct to consumer strategies (like wine clubs, wine tasting), traditional media and print advertising and online advertising.

Part 5

5. Provide client recommendation

- **Excellent interviewees** would recommend a solution (manufacturing Merlot) but would detail out the risks/next steps associated with the recommendation. Next steps may involve market research, land usability testing, evaluation of opportunity costs. Risks have been discussed previously.
- **Outstanding interviewees** provide an answer that includes:
 - Identification of opportunity costs, particularly of not selling/leasing the land, which might be more profitable considering the current value of land in the Bay Area and/or Napa
 - Considering industry specific issues like aging of wine
 - Considering time value of money/perpetuity of cash flow
 - Considering risks like customer demand, land usability
 - Potential benefits of diversifying the acreage and producing multiple types of grapes (compensate for shifts in consumer demand, broader appeal to local market, etc.)

Case 30

Winter Olympics Bidding

Concepts tested

- Z02 Net Present Value (2)
- Z12 Creativity (3)

Primary sector(s)

- X05 Entertainment & Media

Case type

- Y06 Opportunity assessment

Similar cases

- World View (Harvard 2015)
- Mobilizing Your World (Fuqua 2015)
- Footloose (LBS 2012)

Case author(s): Chris Dupre (Kellogg 2003)
Edited By: Uri Kalir (Kellogg 2012), Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020)

Winter Olympics Bidding

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client, a major US television network, is trying to figure out how much to bid for the exclusive right to broadcast the Winter Olympics Games in four years time
- The Winter Olympics are a huge deal and will require a significant amount of capital to secure the rights, so our client has brought us in to help them figure out the right bid amount after considering all relevant factors.

Interviewer guide

- This is a very quantitative case that requires the interviewee to run the numbers on an Olympics bid. The candidate will have to decide potential ad revenue/cost information, as well as the NPV, to determine bid size.
- The candidate will need to ask for additional information to solve the problem, rather than relying on the interviewer to dispense it. After getting the initial calculations right, there are a lot of implications that may change the level of the bid.
- Especially for less finance-minded interviewees, you may have to help nudge candidates through the math.
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Calculate NPV
 3. Brainstorm intangible benefits and risks
 4. Provide client recommendation

Winter Olympics Bidding

Fit: Why do you want to join our consultancy in particular?

Case prompt

- Our client, a major US television network, is trying to figure out how much to bid for the exclusive right to broadcast the Winter Olympics Games in four years time
- The Winter Olympics are a huge deal and will require a significant amount of capital to secure the rights, so our client has brought us in to help them figure out the right bid amount after considering all relevant factors.

Clarifying information

Revenues

- No subscription revenue, but can keep 100% of advertising revenue
- Ad rates are \$400k per 30 second ad for prime time (weekends, weekdays 1900 - 2300) and \$200k non-prime time
- Market research has shown that you can include no more than 10 minutes of advertising per hour.

Costs

- \$482m of total production costs
- Opportunity cost: \$1m/hour
- Time value of money: 4 year lag for receipt of revenue

Winter Olympics Bidding

Exhibit A – Winter Olympics Schedule

	Day 1 <i>Opening Ceremony</i>	Day 2 – 15 <i>Main events</i>		Day 16 <i>Closing Ceremony</i>
	Friday	Weekday	Weekend	Saturday
0800 – 0900				
0900 – 1000		Biathlon		
1000 – 1100		Bobsleigh		
1100 – 1200		Skating / Skiing	Biathlon	
1200 – 1300			Skiing	
1300 – 1400			Skating	
1400 – 1500		Curling	Bobsleigh	
1500 – 1600		Ice Hockey	Skating	
1600 – 1700		Luge	Skiing	
1700 – 1800			Ice Hockey	
1800 – 1900			Skiing	
1900 – 2000		Skating	Luge	
2000 – 2100	Opening commentary	Luge	Skiing	Closing commentary
2100 – 2200	Opening ceremony	Skiing		Closing speeches
2200 – 2300	Opening speeches	Luge		Closing ceremony

Winter Olympics Bidding

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

Provide Exhibit A if the interviewee asks for TV schedules or identifies ad revenues in their structure

- Candidate should determine that this is a cost-benefit / NPV analysis.
- Candidate should identify potential revenue streams from hosting the Olympics, i.e. ad revenue, product placements, etc.
- Then, the candidate will have to figure out if this is a good investment. They should identify 3 costs (production costs, opportunity costs, and time value of money). By factoring in these costs, the candidate will find out if the Olympics are worth the investment.
- Some of the numbers and assumptions here are difficult, so nudge the candidate along if necessary.

Winter Olympics Bidding

Part 2

2. Calculate NPV

Revenues

- \$400k/ad for prime time (M-F 7-11 PM, all weekend) and \$200k/ad for non-prime time
- 10 minutes/hour of advertisements

Costs

- \$482M of production costs
- Opportunity: \$1m/hr
- WACC: 10%

- Total revenues should be equal to \$928M for the project.
 - Primetime: Weekdays (M-F): $10 \text{ weekdays} \times 4 \text{ hrs/day} \times 10 \text{ min/hr} \times 2 \text{ slots/min} \times \$400,000/\text{ad} = \$320\text{M}$
 - Non-prime: Weekdays (M-F): $10 \text{ weekdays} \times 6 \text{ hrs/day} \times 10 \text{ min/hr} \times 2 \text{ slots/min} \times \$200\text{K}/\text{ad} = \240M
 - Weekend: $4 \text{ days} \times 10 \text{ hrs/day} \times 10 \text{ min/hr} \times 2 \text{ slots/min} \times 400\text{K}/\text{ad} = \320M
 - Opening/Closing: $2 \text{ days} \times 3 \text{ hrs/day} \times 10 \text{ min/hr} \times 2 \text{ slots/min} \times 400\text{K}/\text{ad} = \48M
- Total profit should be equal to \$300M.
 - Profit: Revenues \$928m - \$482m of total costs - \$146m of opportunity cost ($2 \text{ days} \times 3 \text{ hours} \times \$1\text{m/hr} + 14 \text{ days} \times 10 \text{ hours} \times \1m/hr) = \$300m
- NPV should be equal to \$200m.
 - Discount rate: $1.104 = 1.4641$ (ask candidate to round to 1.50)
 - $\$300\text{m}/1.5 = \200m

Winter Olympics Bidding

Part 3

3. Brainstorm intangible benefits and risks

- Might give network access to new viewers
- There is prestige associated with hosting this event
- We can use the air time to promote other programming
- Opportunities for product tie-ins, supplemental revenue
- After finishing the discussion, ask the candidate for a recommendation

Winter Olympics Bidding

Part 4

4. Provide client recommendation

- While the NPV of the project is \$200m, the fact that there are other intangibles (new viewers, plugging our programs, and prestige) the bid should just be \$200m.
- While there is no one correct answer, most answers should be in the range of \$200m. If there is significant fluctuation from \$200m, the candidate will have to provide in-depth justifications and make a concrete argument.
- This case tests the interviewee's comfort with numbers and understanding of how intangible factors may influence financial value. The bid process requires another level of understanding around game theory and what dynamics will ultimately determine the value of the bid beyond NPV.
- Ultimately, the best interviewees will make a very strong argument using the facts provided and support their bid and explain why they moved their bid from the NPV figure.
- There is also a lot of room for creativity for the interviewee to discuss other factors, including supplemental streams of revenue, intangible factors, and things to consider during the bid process.

Case 31

Zephyr Beverages

Concepts tested

- Z10 Customer marketing strategy
- Z11 Competitive analysis

Primary sector(s)

- X12 Retail & CPG

Case type

- Y03 Mergers & Acquisitions

Similar cases

- ABC Conglomerate (Wharton 2005)
- InsureCo (Fuqua 2015)

{ Case author(s): Edwin Van Dusen, Brian Fox and David Welch (Kellogg 2004)
Edited by: Rohan Maini (Kellogg 2020) }

Zephyr Beverages

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client, Zephyr Beverages, is a division of a large consumer products company. The division produces fruit juices in three forms, all under the Zephyr name: chilled, juice boxes, and frozen concentrate. Zephyr had sales of \$600 million last year, about 3% of the company's overall sales of \$20 billion.
- The chilled segment represents \$120 million in sales per year. While juice boxes and frozen concentrate have been consistently profitable, chilled juices are only breaking even in good quarters and are losing money in bad quarters. Zephyr has received a proposal from upper management to sell the chilled juices business. We need to help them decide whether or not this is a good idea.

Interviewer guide

- Problem: What does Zephyr do with an underperforming business?
- Problem solving steps:
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Conduct competitive analysis
 3. Determine product analysis
 4. Provide client recommendation

Zephyr Beverages

Fit: What do you think makes a good management consultant?

Case prompt

- Our client, Zephyr Beverages, is a division of a large consumer products company. The division produces fruit juices in three forms, all under the Zephyr name: chilled, juice boxes, and frozen concentrate. Zephyr had sales of \$600 million last year, about 3% of the company's overall sales of \$20 billion.
- The chilled segment represents \$120 million in sales per year. While juice boxes and frozen concentrate have been consistently profitable, chilled juices are only breaking even in good quarters and are losing money in bad quarters. Zephyr has received a proposal from upper management to sell the chilled juices business. We need to help them decide whether or not this is a good idea.

Clarifying information

Industry:

- It has been growing at GDP (~3%) the last few years and is projected to continue that growth rate.
- The market for chilled juices is dominated by mothers with young kids.
- Brand name is important in this market, as mothers tend to prefer reliable products. However, the brand premium must be in line with other branded products and all branded juices sell in the same price range.
- This is a highly price sensitive market that loves coupons, promotions, etc.

Competition: Highly concentrated market. There has not been a lot of change, technological progress or threat of new entrants

Zephyr Beverages

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

- A sample case structure would include the following:
 1. Identifying the options: sell chilled juice, sell all juice businesses, continue on with all businesses
 2. Qualitative discussion of competitive dynamics
 3. Discussion of product selection/components, as well as ways to cut costs

When asked, the interviewer can reveal the following additional information:

- Chilled beverages are a \$1 billion worldwide industry

Zephyr Beverages

Part 2

2. Conduct competitive analysis

- Using basic information provided, interviewee should deep dive the competitive dynamics in further detail.
-
- Relevant info:
 - Bad market position: 12% vs. 40% and 25%
 - Assumed profitability differences
 - Disadvantage on trade promotions
 - The two largest players have market shares of 40% and 25%, respectively. Zephyr's market share, 12% makes it third in the industry.
 - The two market leaders are able to do more advertising, couponing, promotion, and trade than Zephyr is able to do. We do not know about their profitability, but assume it is positive
 - Interviewee should be able to see that Zephyr is at a serious disadvantage on all fronts as a smaller company that is both less profitable and less engaged in the kinds of trade promotions that key customers covet. The overall conclusion should be that this is a weak competitive position.

Part 3

3. Determine product selection

- Using information about our products vs. our competitors, the interviewee should focus on discussion about how to cut costs.
-
- Relevant info (when asked):
 - The market leaders produce pure orange juice/blends based on citrus juices. Zephyr uses more elaborate blends, usually with a base of pear or peach juice (60% of inputs) and flavor with cranberries, bananas, mangoes, etc. (the other 40%). Pear and peach juice are a similarly price to orange juice, but the other flavorings cost about twice as much.
 - A plant in California produces all products; chilled, juice boxes and frozen. Each of the three products uses different machinery. It would be difficult to find another use for the plant without a major conversion.
 - Additionally, there are currently synergies between chilled, frozen and juice boxes – mothers are slightly more likely to buy products from the same brand
 - This indicates that, despite a disadvantage, divesting is not realistic and there may be room for cost reduction based on reformulation to make Zephyr profitable.

Part 4

4. Provide client recommendation

There are three possible solutions, with no right answer. The recommendation should be well-reasoned, comprehensive, and include as much relevant information as possible.

- Sell the chilled juice business. This would, however, affect the juice and frozen concentrate businesses, as there are both advertising and manufacturing synergies.
 - Sell all of the juice business. This may be more feasible, as the buyer could capture the synergies, but would not be too likely to turn the business around. The selling price is likely to be low.
 - Keep the chilled juice business and rework the ingredients and costs. This is the most feasible option, as evidenced by the success of the competitors. We are probably developing extra features in our ingredient mix that the market does not want and is not willing to pay for. Eliminating or scaling back those features will probably allow us to cut costs without affecting revenue.
-
- Interviewees who do well on this case will have to be comfortable with ambiguity and with a lack of perfect information. They will quickly grasp the issues and delve into the underlying qualitative discussions, coming up with a lot of additional risks/potential benefits for each option.
 - Creative solutions beyond those listed are possible and encouraged, though should be done within the framework of the information available.

Case 32

Zoo Co

Concepts tested

- Z12 Creativity (1)
- Z02 Net Present Value (2)
- Z02 Breakeven analysis (3)

Primary sector(s)

- X06 Financial Services

Case type

- Y03 Mergers & Acquisitions

Similar cases

- Car Wash Chain (Columbia 2017)
- National Zoo (Wharton 2011)

Case authors: Aneri Jambusaria (Kellogg 2011)
Edited By: Ron Mantel (Kellogg 2015), Matthew Heintz (Kellogg 2016), Michael Eidem (Kellogg 2020)

Interviewer Guide

Case prompt

- Our client is a zoo that is thinking about acquiring a famous zebra from an African preserve.
- It's a huge investment, but they believe the new zebra would be a great contribution to their animal community. You have been engaged to help decide whether this is a good idea. What would you consider when trying to help your client make this decision?

Interviewer guide

- Even though the client is a zoo, we're undertaking a similar process to what is done when underwriting an insurance policy. The case evaluates basic concepts but involves many calculations and the use of financial assessment techniques.
 1. Develop a structure to address the problem
 2. Investment valuation - Walk through the valuation process of an asset.
 3. Breakeven analysis – Determine the revenue increase needed for a positive NPV
 4. Risk assessment – Should the zoo use an insurance contract to hedge downside risk?
 5. Provide CEO recommendation
- Note: Rounding numbers is generally okay but should not be done to the extreme as it will alter the results.

Zoo Co

Fit: Talk about a time when you had to influence someone who initially disagreed with you.

Case prompt

- Our client is a zoo that is thinking about acquiring a famous zebra from an African preserve.
- It's a huge investment, but they believe the new zebra would be a great contribution to their animal community. You have been engaged to help decide whether this is a good idea. What would you consider when trying to help your client make this decision?

Clarifying information

- **Goal:** Zoo's primary concern is whether the zebra acquisition would be profitable. No specific timeline, but zebras do have a finite lifespan.
- **Client Characteristics:** Major zoo within the US. Majority of revenue generated through admission sales to daily zoo visitors.
- **Competitive Dynamics:** No other zoo within the local market.

Exhibit A – Market Research Findings

Possible Attendance Increases	Annual Revenue	Probability
3% Increase	\$135,000	20%
5% Increase	\$225,000	40%
7% Increase	\$315,000	30%
9% Increase	\$405,000	10%
Expected Additional Annual Revenue	\$252,000	
Plus: Current Annual Revenue	\$4,500,000	
Expected Total Annual Revenue	\$4,752,000	

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to address the problem

An ideal structure should resemble the typical M&A framework. Focus should be on determining whether the acquisition of this zebra is a smart financial decision. Key elements expected to be included in this framework are:

- **Market:** What does local competitive landscape look like? (Not necessarily other zoos, but substitutes for how families/individuals spend their leisure time) How has the zoo attendance market been trending? Who are the target customers and what do they care about? (i.e. more concerned with animal selection, activities hosted by the zoo, general cleanliness and layout, etc.)
- **Target (the zebra):**
 - **Financial evaluation** – What are the expected costs (purchase price, transportation, ongoing maintenance, update in habitat space) vs the expected revenue increase (increased attendance, change in ticket price, merchandise sales)
 - **Non-financial evaluation** – How old is the zebra? What is its expected lifespan? Why is the zebra famous, does that matter?
- **Transition:**
 - What synergies does the zebra provide? Are there ways to reduce cost by sharing food production/habitat/maintenance investment with a similar animal? Are there revenue synergies (example: being able to promote a complete African exhibit)
 - How will the zoo market the acquisition of this new zebra?
 - Does adding a zebra benefit/fit the zoo's brand?
- **Deal execution:** What will the payment structure look like? Are there opportunities to lease a zebra from another zoo instead of purchase?

Part 2

2. Walk through the valuation process of an asset.

Data to provide when asked more about expected revenues and costs:

Revenue:

- 300K people visit the zoo annually; admission is \$15 per person
- Benefits from zebra acquisition could lead to increased attendance. Another zoo that acquired a similar zebra had an 8% increase.

Costs from zebra acquisition:

- Immediate costs: Acquisition cost (\$235K), new facilities (\$850K), transportation (\$110K)
- Annual maintenances: Food, health costs, and additional trainers (\$90K)
- Discount rate = 20%, Assume that the immediate costs are paid today, and annual costs and benefits are realized beginning next year and sustained into perpetuity, even though the Zebra will not live on to perpetuity.

The interviewee should use the above data to calculate the NPV of the acquisition:

- *Assume that the attendance benefits are realized immediately and maintained thereafter*
- Annual benefits = $(300K) * (\$15) * (0.08) = \$360K$
- Upfront costs = $\$235K + \$850K + \$110K = \$1.195M$
- Annual costs = \$90K
- NPV = $-\$1,195K + ((\$360K - \$90K)/0.20) = \$155K$
- **Takeaway:** Acquisition is NPV positive. Financially (assuming assumptions are accurate), this is a smart decision.

Part 3

3. Breakeven analysis – Determine the revenue increase needed for a positive NPV

- **Additional prompt:** Zoo Co is concerned about using the other zoo's attendance benefits as a proxy. They think that attendance could increase by less than 8%. What analysis could you perform to address their concerns? What is the breakeven attendance increase required?
- The interviewee should think about performing a break-even and a sensitivity analysis. Afterwards, they need to think about performing a risk assessment.

Break-even Analysis:

- Break-even = 0 = $-\$1,195,000 + ((\text{revenue} - \$90,000)/0.20)$

$$(\$1,195,000) * 0.20 = \text{revenue} - \$90,000$$

$$\text{Revenue} = \$239,000 + \$90,000 = \$329,000 \quad (\text{this is the required additional revenue to break even})$$

$$\$329,000 = (300,000) * (15) * (\% \text{ increase in attendance})$$

$$\% \text{ increase in attendance} = (\$329,000 / \$4.5\text{M}) = 7.3\%$$

- **Takeaway:** We already knew from the previous calculation that the acquisition of the zebra was profitable if attendance increased by 8%. This new calculation shows us that our 8% assumption is barely above the break-even calculation. If our attendance assumption is wrong by even 1%, the investment may end up NPV negative.

Part 4

4. Risk assessment – Should the zoo use an insurance contract to hedge downside risk?

- Since the zoo is very risk-averse, they're interested in hedging some of their downside risk. An insurance company has offered to provide the zoo with a constant revenue to increase revenue to \$250K per year if attendance increases are less than or equal to 5% (example: If post-zebra acquisition is only 3% and thus revenue increases by only \$135K, the insurance will give the zoo \$115K to reach a total increase of \$250K). In exchange, the insurance company wants the zoo to pay 1% of the zoo's total annual revenues as a premium. What might you do to determine if this was a good deal?
- The interviewee should recognize that additional information is needed and that a market research study could aid in this process. Hand out exhibit after interviewee identifies this notion.

Provide Exhibit A

The interviewee should use the market research to determine the probable attendance increase:

- Annual cost to zoo: $1\% \text{ of total zoo revenues} = (0.01) * (\$4,752,000) = \$47,520$
- Annual expected benefit to zoo: $(\$250,000 - \$225,000) * (0.40) + (\$250,000 - \$135,000) * (0.20) = \$33,000$
- **Takeaway:** Costs > Benefits, so this is not a good deal.

Part 5

5. Provide CEO recommendation

- It is unlikely that the zebra acquisition is a good idea for the zoo to undertake given the information provided. At other zoos, attendance has gone up substantially due to a new zebra; however, based upon our market research, it seems less likely that we can breakeven on the investment through increased attendance. We have received an insurance contract to help mitigate some of the downside risk; however, it is too expensive to create value.

Other items to consider:

- In order to make the investment more palatable, we may consider negotiating with the insurance company to either increase the revenue benefits provided or decrease the premium cost.
- There are other creative options to drive zebra related revenue (merchandise) or decrease cost (look for a less expensive zebra)

• Excellent interviewees:

- Identify that we can use another zoo's attendance increase as a proxy for estimating our own attendance increases.
- Notice in Exhibit A that it is unlikely that attendance will increase sufficiently enough for the zoo to break even.

• Outstanding interviewees:

- Notice that the insurance company's premiums and benefits are both impacted by attendance increases; so if attendance increases are always greater than 5%, the zoo will be paying even more but getting no benefit.
- Notice that the insurance company's contract is essentially an option; so a different structure to the contract may be more suitable for the zoo.

Case 35

Andrew's Simple Delights

Concepts tested

- Pricing strategy
- Profitability analysis
- Business insight

Primary sector(s)

- Restaurant industry

Case type

- Profitability

Similar cases

- Tacotle (Kellogg 2024)
- Kellogg Klogs (Kellogg 2024)
- Orange Yoga Studio (Fuqua 2014)

Case author(s): Steve Azzolino (Kellogg 2024)
Inspired by Andrew Tran (Kellogg 2024)

Andrew's Simple Delights

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client, Simple Delights, is a restaurant in Evanston, Illinois. They are an Asian-fusion restaurant and have been open for the last 12 months.
- Customers in the area have called Simple Delights one of their favorite restaurants. They particularly love the restaurant's crab rangoons, which some customers have called "the best in the world." The majority of customers are students at Northwestern University.
- Despite their popularity, the restaurant has become increasingly unprofitable. If they do not fix the situation soon, the owner will have to close the restaurant.
- How would you advise Simple Delights to turn around the business?

Interviewer guide

- This case challenges the caser to pick up on key facts throughout the case that will be relevant at later stages while also challenging them to analyze a unique industry. The caser will have to:
 1. Develop a comprehensive framework
 2. Analyze historical revenues and costs
 3. Explore the impact of pricing strategy on profit
 4. Brainstorm impacts of updating pricing
 5. Provide a client recommendation

Andrew's Simple Delights

Fit: Tell me about a time that you had to work collaboratively, but the project did not go as planned.

Case prompt

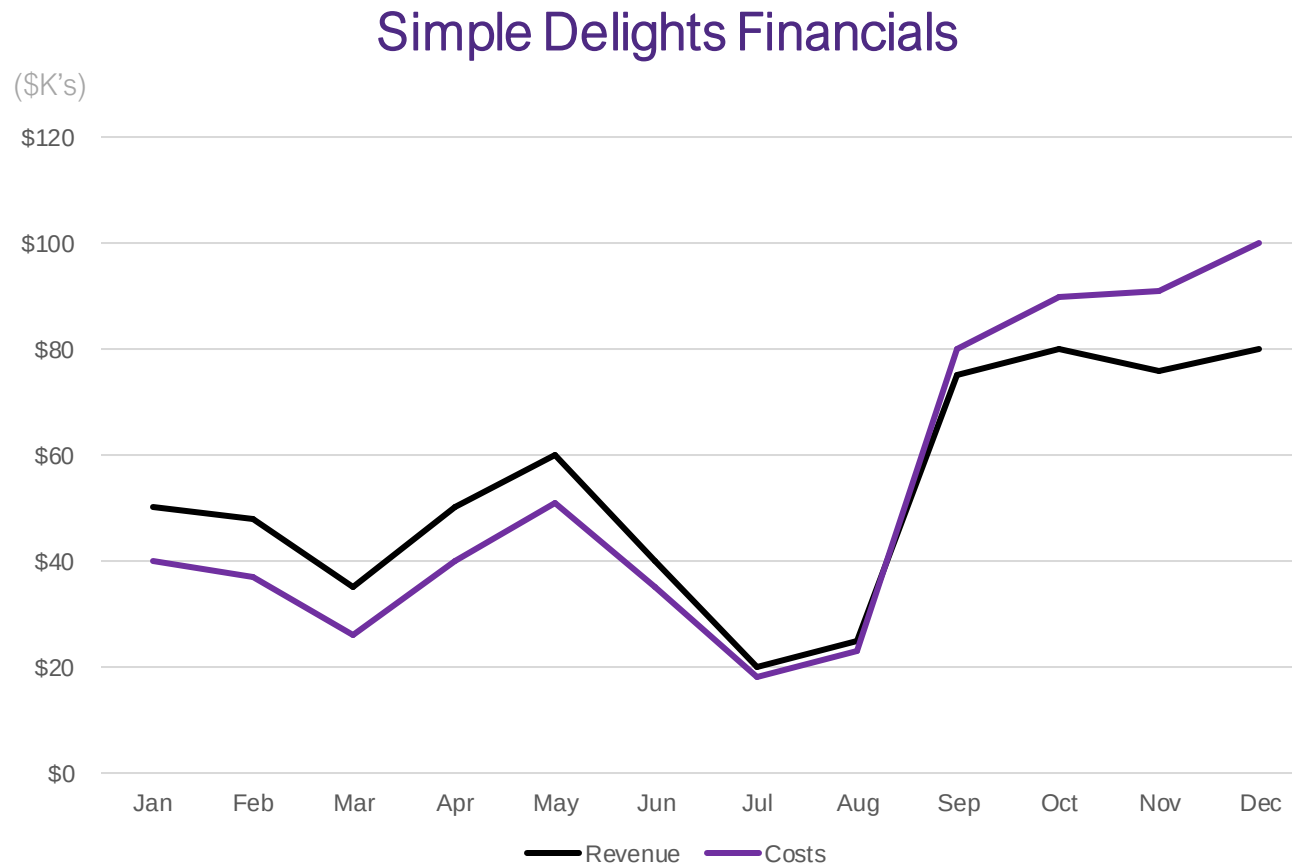
- Our client, Simple Delights, is a restaurant in Evanston, Illinois. They are an Asian-fusion restaurant and have been open for the last 12 months.
- Customers in the area have called Simple Delights one of their favorite restaurants. They particularly love the restaurant's crab rangoons, which some customers have called "the best in the world." The majority of customers are students at Northwestern University.
- Despite their popularity, the restaurant has become increasingly unprofitable. If they do not fix the situation soon, the owner will have to close the restaurant.
- How would you advise Simple Delights to turn around the business?

Clarifying information

- **Competition:** Evanston has a saturated restaurant industry and several Asian-fusion restaurants
- **Company:** Simple Delights operates as a counter-service restaurant. This means that customers will order at the counter and pick up their food from the counter once it is ready. They offer dine-in and take-out. They are also available on food delivery apps. If asked about Crab Rangoons, explain that Crab Rangoons are an appetizer with a mixture of crab, cream cheese, and seasonings wrapped in a crispy wonton.
- **Geography:** The restaurant only has one location, and it is in Evanston
- **Goal:** The owner would like to make a profit of \$120,000 per year and would like to do so as soon as possible.

Andrew's Simple Delights

Exhibit A – TTM Financial Performance



TTM: Trailing twelve months

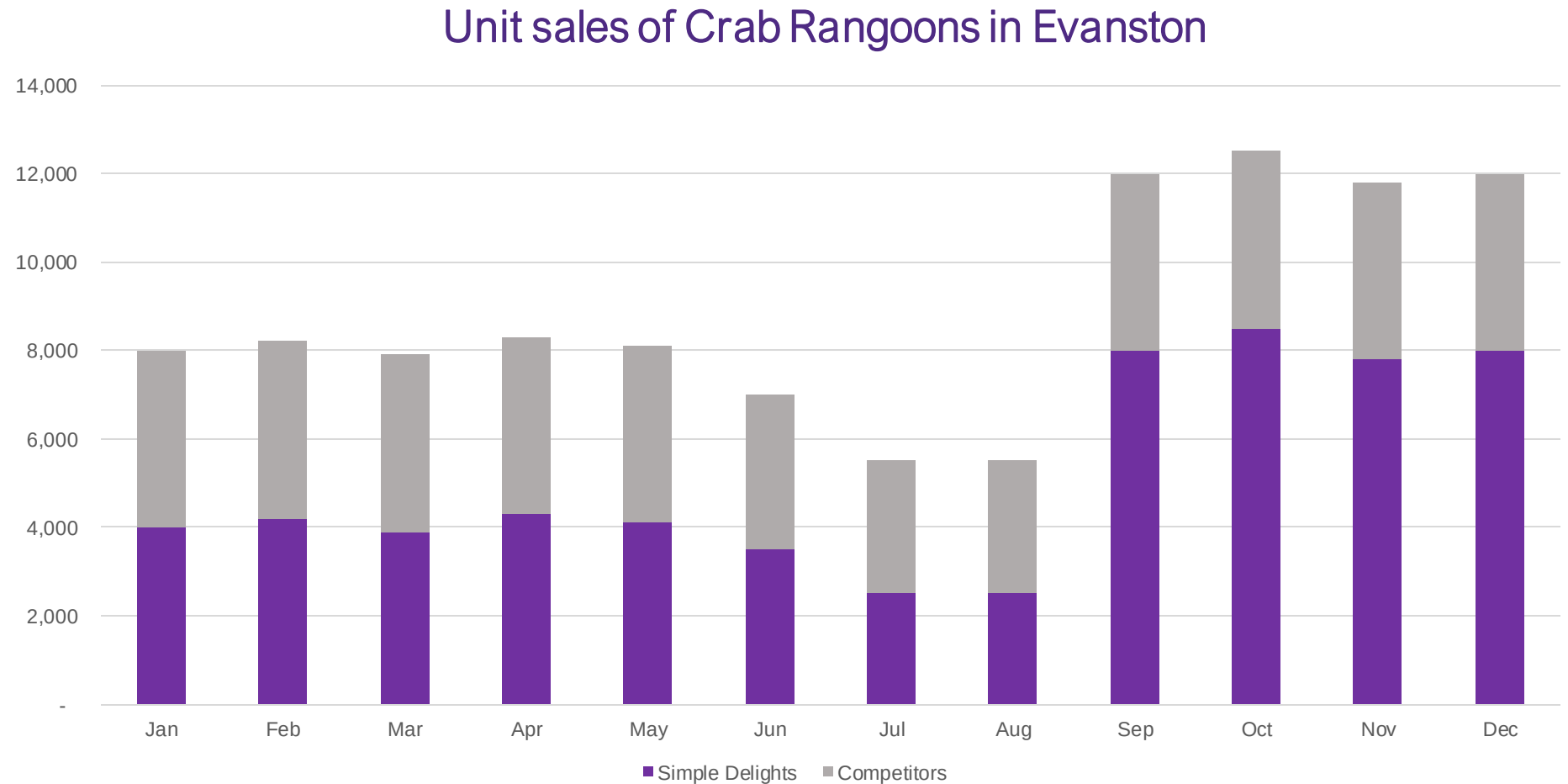
Andrew's Simple Delights

Exhibit B – Menu pricing update

Menu item	January price	September price
Appetizers		
Chicken Satay	\$4.99	\$4.49
Spring Rolls	\$5.99	\$5.49
Crab Rangoons	\$8.99	\$3.49
Main Courses		
Pad Thai	\$19.99	\$18.99
Crawfish	\$24.99	\$21.99
Green Curry	\$23.99	\$22.99
California Roll (6-piece)	\$12.49	\$11.49

Andrew's Simple Delights

Exhibit C – Unit sales of Crab Rangoons



Andrew's Simple Delights

Part 1

1. Develop a comprehensive framework

A comprehensive framework can address the following items:

- **Restaurant market in Evanston**
 - Market share of the food industry in Evanston
 - Customer profile (food tastes + preferences, switch to healthy food, etc.)
 - Available substitutes (e.g. free food on campus, grocery shopping, etc.)
- **Business financials**
 - Revenue
 - Number of customers
 - Average ticket price
 - What items are they selling?
 - What are the prices of the items they are selling?
 - Streams of revenue (in-person vs. take-out vs. delivery)
 - Merchandise, coupons, etc.
 - Costs
 - Ingredient cost (e.g. impacted by nationwide agricultural issue)
 - Rent
 - Employee wages + number of employees (cashiers, etc.)
 - Insurance + licenses to operate
- **Operations & logistical concerns**
 - Capacity considerations + utilization rate (can they actually sell to more customers if they wanted to?)
 - Impact on brand image from any strategic changes
 - Competitive response following changes (will competitors change prices, introduce new items, etc.?)

Andrew's Simple Delights

Part 2

2. Analyze historical revenues and costs

Provide Exhibit A when the interviewee asks about revenue or costs

- If asked, remind the caser that the restaurant opened in January.
- If asked why sales decreased from May to August, ask the caser to hypothesize. If required, push them toward the solution that sales decreased over the summer because most customers are students and they are no longer in Evanston (this is partially provided in the prompt).
- The caser should clear the chart and recognize that the restaurant is losing \$20k per month. With a goal of \$120k per year, the restaurant needs to make \$10k per month, which means they need to increase profitability by \$30k per month.
- The caser should also acknowledge that both revenues and costs have increased significantly and are each at all-time highs. This suggests that there is not a demand problem but that there is a cost problem. The caser should at this point ask about costs or margins.
- You will not have any cost information to provide except for menu item margins/prices. Do not move on to the next step until the caser asks for information about margins/prices on food items. DO NOT show the next exhibit until you read the prompt on the next page.

Andrew's Simple Delights

Part 3a

3a. Explore the impact of pricing strategy on profit

Provide Exhibit B after the caser asks about menu margins/prices

- BEFORE presenting the chart, read out “In late-August, because of the drop in demand, the owner made two strategic changes. First, they changed the name from “Andrew’s Bodega” to the current name of “Simple Delights”, to highlight the quality of the food. Next, they explored several pricing updates. What is your initial reaction to this strategy?”
 - While the caser can list out pros (increase short-term demand, revitalize the brand, etc) and cons (impact on margins, etc.), **the main caser takeaway should be that this approach was not an appropriate strategy.** Demand fell because students left for the summer, and students are the majority of their customers. **After the caser lists pros and cons, present the exhibit.**
- The caser will be tested to quickly sort through the menu items and determine that the price for crab rangoons has dropped dramatically (by \$5.50, or ~60%). They might highlight that there were other pricing adjustments as well, but direct them to focus on crab rangoons.
- When asked, reveal that crab rangoons cost \$5.49 to produce. The caser should immediately recognize that the restaurant is losing \$2 every time someone orders crab rangoons.
- If asked why they priced crab rangoons below marginal cost, you can say that the restaurant did not have a firm idea of their costs and they wanted to increase sales of everyone’s favorite item.
- The caser at this point should drive the conversation toward potentially increasing the price to become more profitable. They should consider the impact on sales if they were to increase the price. Do not reveal the next exhibit until they ask for the impact on sales of increasing the price or mention price elasticity. You may also reveal this exhibit if they ask about market share, but this is not the preferred insight.

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Part 3b

3b. Explore the impact of pricing strategy on profit

Provide Exhibit C only if the interviewee asks about the impact of changing

- The interviewer should ask about pricing OR about market share (if asked about market share, show the prior exhibit or 2). Asked about market share of crab rangoon sales (at any point in the case).
- The caser should recognize:
 - Unit sales of crab rangoons were relatively steady and fell over the summer, mirroring the trend in revenue
 - Unit sales increased dramatically in September. They should identify that they doubled on average from Jan-May vs. Sep-Dec. If asked, the interviewer can clarify that on average unit sales were 4000 per month prior to the summer and that they increased to 8000 per month after the pricing change - this should be assumable from the exhibit.
 - An excellent caser will note that the total market size has increased because of the price cut. This is likely because people started ordering crab rangoons when they otherwise would have ordered something else.
- The caser now has enough information to test the impact of increasing the price of crab rangoons and should test this hypothesis. Push them toward raising the price back to their original price (\$3.49 to \$8.99) if they try to set a higher price but not as high as the original price.
 - At 4000 sales, \$8.99 in price, and a cost of \$5.49, the unit contribution is \$3.50. Total profit = $4000 \times \$3.50 = \$14,000/\text{month}$
 - At 8000 sales, \$3.49 in price, and a cost of \$5.49, the unit contribution is negative \$2. Total profit is **negative** \$16,000/month
 - If the price increases to \$8.99 and sales become 4000 again, profit per month increases by \$30,000/month, achieving the owner's goal (**Note: This is technically not true if the caser assumes summer months will have lower volumes – this would be an excellent insight**).

Andrew's Simple Delights

Part 4

4. Brainstorm impacts of updating pricing

- If the candidate doesn't start listing other considerations relevant to changing the pricing, prompt them to brainstorm

This section tests the case's business insight and is an area to go from good to great by tying together themes throughout the case. An excellent case will highlight that increasing prices might not achieve revenue goals as anticipated. They will also note that there is still a larger problem to address (the lack of demand in the summer). Below are some potential takeaways, but the list is not exhaustive:

Non-Financial Implications:

- Impact on brand: If the restaurant nearly triples the price of an item after a rebrand, will the brand be damaged? Note that the name changed in late-August, which means that students returning to campus will only associate the restaurant with the low price introduced in August
- Competitive response: How have other restaurants responded to your price cut? If they cut prices, will they also increase them when you do? This could impact the restaurant's positioning in the market if the restaurant's price is greater than the market price (this potentially could be a "financial" observation depending on wording)

Financial Implications:

- Complementary sales: Crab rangoons are an appetizer. Is the low price of crab rangoons driving sales of other more profitable items, like main courses?
- The annual profit goal is likely not achieved: sales are expected to be below 4000 units in the summer months if past trends persist, which means yearly profitability will fall short of the \$120,000 goal (this is a critical observation)

IF TIME ALLOWS (OPTIONAL): Ask the interviewer to brainstorm options to increase profitability, specifically in the summer months

Andrew's Simple Delights

Part 5

5. Provide a client recommendation

- Example recommendation to INCREASE the price (the caser may argue against raising the price as long as they identify reasons discussed throughout the case)
- Simple Delights should increase its price on crab rangoons from \$3.49 to \$8.99.
 - The pricing change is expected to increase monthly profit by \$30,000, bringing monthly profitability on average to \$10,000
- However, this plan has several risks (caser should aim for at least 3). The following list is not exhaustive but captures potential ideas:
 - Brand likely damaged as a result of the price increase
 - Next step: customer survey to assess potential brand damage of a pricing change
 - Potential decrease in sales on higher margin menu items
 - Next step: Analyze unit sales of other menu items following the pricing change to determine the restaurant-wide impact of the price cut
 - No plan to address decrease in demand over the summer months
 - Next step: Perform a growth strategy analysis, potentially assessing serving new markets, geographies, distribution channels, etc.

Case 36

Pandora Coaching

Concepts tested

- Creativity
- Market sizing
- Pricing strategy
- New market entry

Primary sector(s)

- Education Services

Case type

- New product / Market entry
- Opportunity assessment

Casing Skills tested

- Brainstorming
- Final recommendations
- Tying in prior knowledge

Similar cases:

- Busch's Barbershop

Case author(s): Jake Zellner (Kellogg 2024)
Edited by: David King (Kellogg 2024)

Pandora Coaching

Interviewer guide

Case prompt

- Our client, Pandora Coaching, is an admissions advisory firm.
- Pandora specializes in MBA coaching for business school applicants.
- Since the COVID pandemic, profits have stagnated, and the founders are considering changing Pandora's business model and/or target customers.
- What are some steps Pandora Coaching could explore to turn around their business?

Interviewer guide

- This case starts vague, to encourage creativity before delving into a market entry problem. This is meant to challenge the interviewee to generate creative ideas before exploring a market entry strategy in an industry they may have personal experience with, allowing them to practice weaving in personal anecdotes. Excellent candidates will ask clarifying questions to realize that Pandora is a premium provider only targeting the upper end of the market (see suggested Q&A on following page).
 1. Drive (or help pivot) to key question: whether Pandora should enter the mass MBA admissions coaching market?
 2. Market segmentation analysis of MBA consultant landscape
 3. Competitive landscaping
 4. Provide client recommendation

Pandora Coaching

Fit: What does a successful internship look like to you?

Case prompt

- Our client, Pandora Coaching, is an admissions advisory firm.
- Pandora specializes in MBA coaching.
- Since the COVID pandemic, profits have stagnated, and the founders are considering changing Pandora's business model and/or target customers.
- What are some steps Pandora Coaching could explore to turn around their business?

Provide the Products clarifying information below even if interviewee does not request

Clarifying information

- **Business model / products:** Pandora offers an ultra-premium service with 2 coaches per applicant, leading the market in coach-to-applicant ratio. They offer a comprehensive "one size fits all" approach which is priced 2-3x above their competitors. The service supports customers through the entire application process, for however many applications a customer would like help with.
- **Company:** Pandora is based in the UK and has operated for ~20 years. All coaches are full-time, as opposed to competitors using mostly part-time coaches. It is owned by two founders.
- **Competition:** There are approximately 5 major competitors that service 100s of applicants per year, and there is a long tail of small competitors (think businesses that coach their own applicants, freelancers who consult 1-2 applicants per year, etc)
- **Projections:** Inquiries are down significantly this year. Pandora expects revenues to fall marginally or remain flat.

Pandora Coaching

Part 1

1. Develop a structure to solve the problem

- An ideal structure will be growth-centric (think revenue) and include some preliminary ideas for how to grow the business. Good candidates will have picked up on the fact that Pandora currently serves only the highest priced segment of the admissions consulting market and could explore other segments.
- A good framework will examine Pandora's financials, the competitive landscape, the market (size, trends, etc), and include some early ideas for how to increase revenues and thereby profits.
- Example framework:
 - **Admissions consulting market:** size, growth forecasts, key competitors in each segment, customer willingness to pay, relevant segmentation, etc.
 - **Pandora's financials:**
 - Revenue: services offered, pricing, potential for add-on services
 - Costs: labor (high coach ratio), full-time vs. part-time employees, overhead, rent;
 - Current cash situation (can we buy another firm?)
 - **Strategies to explore:** Launching down market service, decreasing coach ratio, cutting prices, capping applications per customer, acquiring a down market competitor, partnering with other firm, partnering with key employers to increase willingness to pay, etc.

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Part 2

1. Brainstorm segmentation and determine market sizes

- Pandora has conducted calls with potential customers who selected a competitor.
- Most of these potential customers named price as the reason they did not select Pandora.
- Pandora wants to explore offering a lighter touch service to capture more of the market.
- **Ask:** When thinking about the market for MBA applicants, what are some ways we could segment it? [no need to size yet]
 - Any MECE segmentation will be fine here; good candidates will break out the up-market and down-market segments per the case's guidance to this point
- Redirect to the below "market report" (you can say: "Great, thanks for that. We actually just received a segmentation report...")

2. Market sizing

- **Read:** Preliminary market research has found the following groups of MBA applicants [walk through the below table verbally]. What are the relative sizes of this market, using this report?
- Share: 50,000 MBA applicants per year; following segmentation estimates:

Non-Consultant Users	Users of piecemeal services	"Mass Market" Full Package Users	Ultra-Premium Full Package Users
• 40% of market • Utilize friends, family, peers, etc. • Spend \$0	• 30% of market • May use specific admissions consulting services (e.g. GMAT prep) • Average spend \$600	• 27% of market • Engages an admissions consultant • Average spend \$7,000	• 3% of market • Engages an admissions consultant • Average spend \$18,000

Pandora Coaching

Part 2

3. Market sizing

Non-Consultant Users	Users of piecemeal services	"Mass Market" Full Package Users	Ultra-Premium Full Package Users
50K applicants x 40% = 20K in segment x \$0 = \$0 segment value	50K applicants x 30% = 15K in segment x \$600 = \$9M segment value	50K applicants x 27% = 13.5K in segment x \$7K = \$94.5M segment value	50K applicants x 3% = 1.5K in segment x \$18K = \$27M segment value

- Total market size of \$130.5M / year, of which ultra-premium is ~20%
- Mass Market and Ultra Premium segments are expected to grow at similar rates (3% over the next 5 years)

4. Takeaways

- Mass market is over 3x the size of Pandora's current market
- Excellent candidates will drive to the following areas:
 - Are these customer looking for different things than Pandora can currently provide?
 - Whitespace (e.g., how many competitors are in the mass market)?

Pandora Coaching

Part 3

1. Determining appeal of other markets

Provide Exhibit A when the interviewee asks about competitive landscape

- Analysis:
 - Pandora controls the ultra-premium market, with “mom and pop” competitors
 - The mass market, while larger, is very fragmented with no player having more than 20% market share
 - We can infer that the mass market is a competitive segment with limited whitespace

2. Determining ability of Pandora to enter Mass Market

Provide Exhibit B when the interviewee asks about competitor's/Pandora's strengths or customer preferences (or if they don't ask)

- On purpose a tricky, hard-to-read chart
- **Read:** *Exhibit B compiles the results of a survey. Respondents were placed in the Mass Market or Ultra-Premium segments based on salary information. Respondents then rated how important four characteristics were to them on a scale of 0 (completely unimportant) to 5 (utmost importance). Customers of four selected firms were also polled on how satisfied they were with their selected MBA admissions consulting firm on the four relevant attributes (satisfaction).*
- Main point: Pandora is on-track or exceeding expectations for the ultra-premium market. The competitors in the mass market are (mostly) covering that segment's preferences as well, and Pandora would be significantly overdelivering with its current offering.
- Great applicants may notice that Pandora is overachieving on all characteristics except price, and may be able to water down their ultra premium service marginally to cut costs

Pandora Coaching

Part 4

1. Brainstorm

Ask: If Pandora were going to enter the mass market, it could launch a “lighter touch” service. What are some key considerations they should make when exploring this possibility?

Example good response:

Operational (internal) considerations:

- Would our current coaches be willing to move down-market, or would we need to hire new staff (perhaps part-time)?
- What is the founders' appetite for risk?
- To what extent can we use our existing software, consulting materials, etc?

Market (external) considerations:

- Would we launch with our current brand, or would that dilute / we should launch a new brand?
- Competitive response / price war?
- Do these mass market competitors offer additional services we do not (e.g. GMAT prep)?
- Pricing: is it common in the mass market for service to be fixed price (e.g. you pay \$10K and can apply to however many schools), or do applicants pay per application?

Pandora Coaching

Part 5

Final Recommendation

Read: Joel McMannus, Founder and Co-CEO of Pandora, is about to walk into the room and wants to hear your thoughts. Do you recommend changing Pandora's business model? If so, how?

Interviewer guidance: this case does not have a clear-cut answer. A good candidate will structure his or her thoughts and provide a recommendation that includes entering the mass market (with a reason why) or making smaller changes to Pandora's business model and staying in the ultra-premium segment.

Example recommendations:

1) Pandora should enter the mass market segment.

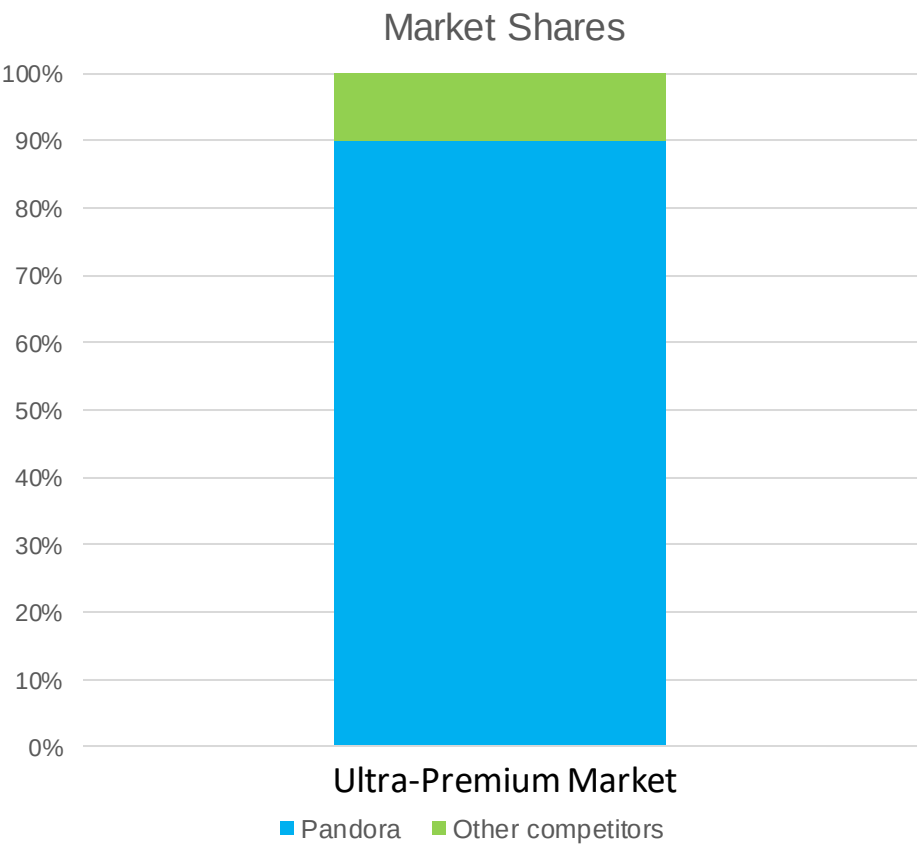
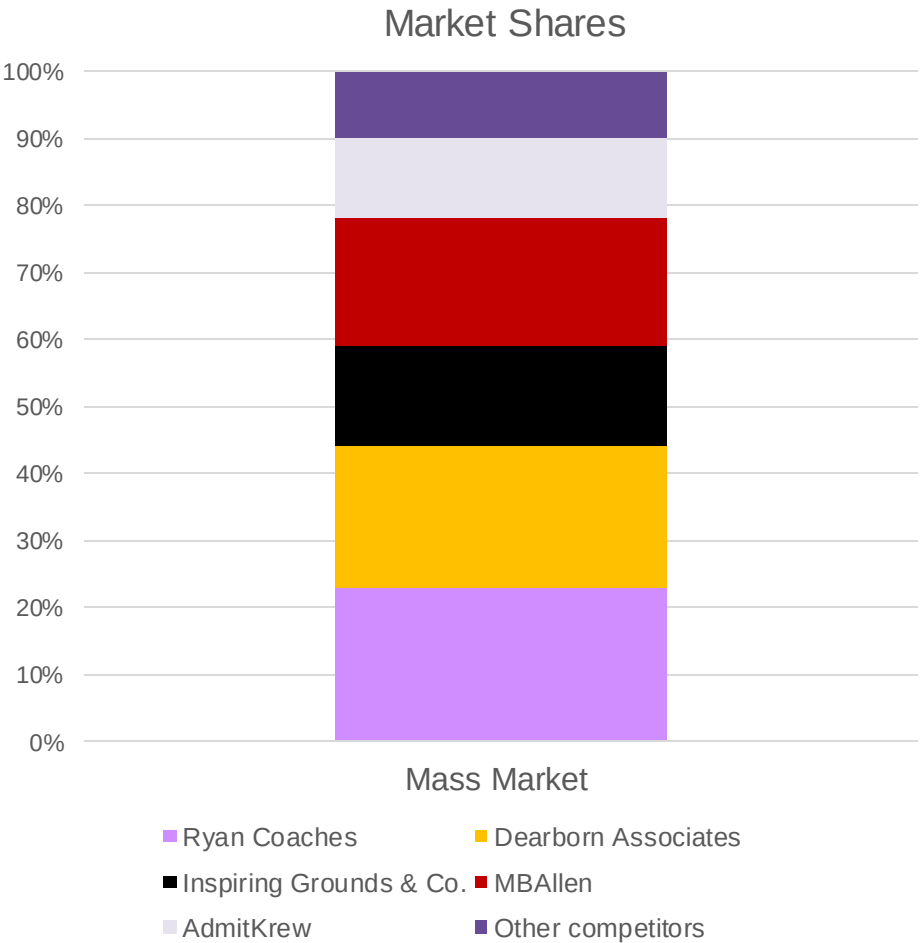
- The mass market is ~3x the size of the ultra premium category, which they are unlikely to expand market penetration in (they already have ~90%)
- Risks: competitive response (price cuts), brand dilution in ultra-premium segment, needs to hire entirely new staff
- Next steps: analyze if current infrastructure / staff will work in another segment, conduct due diligence of mass market competitors

2) Pandora should not enter the mass market segment and should instead change their ultra-premium offering

- Pandora overachieves on success record, responsiveness, and touchpoints; can we spread coaches (e.g. 1.5 / customer) to reduce staff and cut costs?
- Risks: employee backlash, loss of ultra premium market penetration to smaller competitors, opportunity cost of missing out on mass market segment
- Next steps: poll employees, use advertising to try to grow the ultra premium category (can we steal share from mass market)

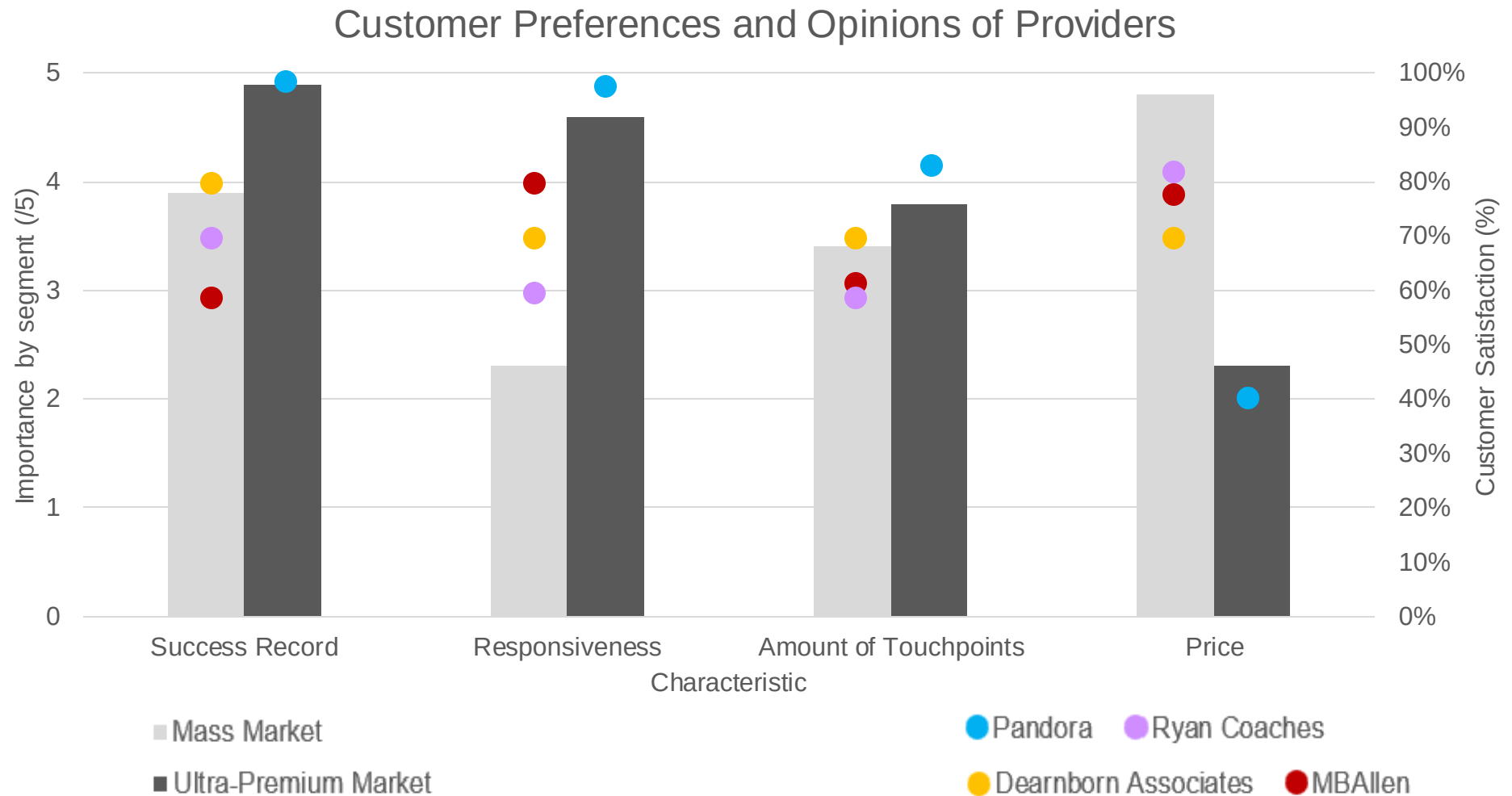
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Exhibit A – Market Shares



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Exhibit B – MBA Applicant Polls



Kellogg Case Book

2024 Edition

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